Just Friends

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31478570.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Eventual Smut, Angst and Hurt/Comfort, Angst, Hurt/Comfort, Unrequited Love, Unrequited Crush, pinning, Alternate Universe - Roommates/Housemates, Roommates, Canon Lesbian Character, Temporarily Unrequited Love, Implied/Referenced Homophobia, glimmer is bad at boardgames, Best Friends Squad, Tension, Sexual Tension, Consent, Implied/Referenced Drug Use, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Smut, Developing Relationship, Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Useless Lesbians, due to popular demand, Useless Bow, Incredibly angsty, Its gonna hurt sometimes, Emotional Hurt, Hurt No Comfort, Sad, Idiots in Love, Falling In Love, just hang in there, Fluff, Cute, Friends to Lovers, Domestic Fluff, Fluff and Smut, First Time, Explicit Sexual Content, Slice of Life

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read again she ra, Banco Fic

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Just Friends

by FriendshipSnakes

Summary

Adora and Catra have been best friends for a lifetime. They have a house together, a cat, and a group of wonderful friends. But after a series of terrible dates, Adora starts to give space to the feelings that have gone unnamed for years. Give feelings and inch, and they take a mile. Her once controlled feelings are quickly becoming overwhelming, and she has to make a decision. But Is it worth risking their friendship?

Notes

Okay, here we go again! I wanted to try a Catradora roommate story. I will say that I am a bit nervous to post this. I've been feeling a bit angsty myself lately and this seemed to sprout from that. But, who knows, maybe someone will enjoy it! I have about a dozen chapters planned out, but who ever knows with these things. Rated E for eventual smut.

Content warning: "mild" homophobia (if you can even call homophobia mild) in the form of a text.

As always thank you to my wonderful beta reader myhypotheticalromance for literally being so awesome.

Enjoy! Comments and feedback are always welcome!

This story has easter eggs/secrets. If you can find at least one, I will write you a one-shot of your choosing. (of course, there may be some restrictions lol) No one has been able to figure them out thus far. But, if you can, a fic just for you awaits

See the end of the work for more notes

Do you have this in another scent?

Glimmer crossed her arms and stared blankly at Adora. "So what are you saying, that you can't come to the farmers market with me?"

Adora scratched the back of her head and looked to the side. "Uh...yeah...well no. I can't go. He keeps asking, and I always tell him no. I feel like I should give him a chance." Uncomfortable wasn't a strong enough word for what Adora was feeling. She hated when Glimmer was mad, especially when she was the reason for it. It would take weeks for Glimmer to let it go, even after they made up.

"Adora, we have had this planned for months. Who even is this guy? And why do you care if he gets upset that you keep saying no? He sounds like a jerk." Glimmer started to move boxes into her car.

"I don-" Before Adora could finish, Glimmer cut her off.

"Ugh! I am so mad right now. I'll have to watch the booth alone. We had this planned. Do whatever you want, Adora, but I have to go." Glimmer slammed the hatchback down and walked over to the driver's side door.

Adora held her head down. *God, why does this always happen?* She walked back to her car, opened the door, and watched as Glimmer drove away. She was obviously very pissed off. Adora grabbed her phone out of her back pocket and got into the car to text Catra.

Adora [8:37 am] : *Hey Catra? Glimmer is mad at me again.*

Catra [8:38 am] : *yep*

Catra [8:38 am]: *she called me*

Catra [8:39 am]: *I have to say that I agree with her*

Adora [8:40 am] : *Well, what do you want me to do? I already said yes to this guy, and he won't stop asking. I have a class with him.*

The three-dot bubble popped up, then disappeared. Adora sat in her car, wanting to cry. She sat there silently, waiting for a few minutes. No reply. She sighed, started up the engine, and pulled out. *This better be the best damn date I have ever been on.*

She parked at the restaurant. It looked like a typical brunch place with its cozy, unkempt exterior and mismatched outdoor seating. There were some, what looked to be statues, throughout the property. She walked up to one. Art *was* subjective. At this point in her life, she had been to almost every brunch spot in the Brightmoon, but not this one.

She found her way to the host and asked if the guy she was there to see was already there. The host hadn't had a lone guest be seated yet. So, Adora put her name on the list and walked outside to wait. Her phone vibrated in her pocket, and she pulled it out to see that Catra had replied.

Catra [9:01 am]: *can we talk about it more when you get home? I'm late to work.*

Catra [9:22 am]: *when will you be home, and why are you going on a date at 8 am, lol*

Adora [9:24 am]: *I don't know. I just got here.*

She waited outside for twenty minutes, and the guy didn't show. They called her name to be seated, and she told them that she was gonna leave—what a way to add insult to injury. Glimmer would be pissed at her for weeks after this, especially when the guy didn't even show up. She started walking to her car when her phone buzzed.

Unknown [9:50 am]: *hey...sorry. I'll be there in like 5 mins.*

She scoffed and slid her phone back in her pocket, unlocked her car door, and got in. Maybe she could salvage the morning with Glimmer.

It took Adora ten minutes to drive over to the farmer's market and another ten to find parking. She sent a quick text to Perfuma asking if she'd be the person at the vendor's entrance so she didn't have to battle with anyone to get in. After turning the car off, she looked in her back seat for the box of items for the booth she forgot to give to Glimmer.

When she finally made it to the vendor's entrance, Perfuma was visibly stressed out.

"Perfuma! Did you get my text?" She waved.

"Adora, I don't have time to check my phone! Everything is going wrong, and I just need to sit for a moment to collect myself, but…" Perfuma was spiraling.

Adora set down the box of artisan soaps on the check-in table. "Hey Perfuma, look at me. Everything's gonna be okay. What happened?"

"Well, the watermelon vendor never showed up, and we have a watermelon theme today, so that's ruined, and Glimmer is extra moody today. Is she mad at me?" She looked at Adora with tears streaming down her face.

Adora rubbed the back of her head. "Err...well, Glimmer is mad at me and probably taking it out on everyone."

"Well, whatever you did, it was bad." She tightened her hands into fists and straightened her arms on her sides.

"That's...why I'm here. I'm trying to fix it. I don't have my vendor badge; Glimmer has it. Can I get through?" She stood there for a second before picking up the box of artisan soaps.

Perfuma waved her through. "You better fix whatever you did. My Zen is ruined."

Adora walked quickly through the farmers market, trying to find the Brightmoon Soap's booth. She made two complete circles around the Farmer's market and couldn't find the booth. Before she could reach into her pocket to grab her phone, Scorpia called out to her. "Adora! What the heck are you doing here?"

"Oh, hey Scorpia. I'm looking for Glimmer and our booth. Do you know where it is?" She looked around, trying to catch sight of the missing booth.

"Yeah. Your booth. Well, Glimmer was pretty upset earlier and didn't get the spot she wanted. So, she's over in overflow." Scorpia chuckled. "I know you've known her as a friend for a long time, but she's real mad, and maybe you should be careful. I mean, yeah. Gosh, just be careful." Scorpia smiled and waved goodbye.

Adora breathed in. *Oh, this is going to be great* . She started walking toward overflow. Adora knew how much Glimmer hated being in overflow. Fewer people walked through, which meant fewer sales, which meant less money to pay for supplies. She walked past the trellis and instantly spotted Glimmer. She was one of 3 booths out there. Glimmer was talking to a customer who looked like they were buying a few bars of soap. "Hey, Glimmer! I brought the rest of the soaps." Adora held up the box and smiled.

Glimmer ignored her and continued her conversation with the customer, and swiped her card on her phone. "Well, here you go. Do you want your receipt via text or email?"

Adora walked behind the booth and slipped in the back. She set the box of soaps down and made a cursory check of what needed to be restocked on the table. It looked like they had sold more than would be expected while being stationed out here in the overflow area. "Hey, it looks like you've made a lot of sales!"

Glimmer sighed. "Why are you here?"

Adora awkwardly smiled. "He didn't show."

"Hmm."

"Yeah, I waited for twenty minutes, and when I was leaving, he texted. I wasn't about to go wait for him any longer." Adora said, pushing her foot into the ground.

Glimmer looked in the box that Adora had brought, grabbed a handful of soaps, and set them out. "These are the new scents I wanted to debut today. But, I guess the watermelon theme isn't a thing anymore." She looked at Adora. "I'm still mad at you. I'm sorry he didn't show. But, this isn't the first time that you've blown off one of your friends for a random guy you don't even know." She folded her arms. "I really think you need to think about that the next time. It isn't fair that you put their feelings over the people who actually care about you."

Adora stood there for a second. Glimmer wasn't wrong. She just didn't want to have to deal with it. This guy had asked her out at least ten times, and she would ignore it and laugh. But, he was pushy this time, and she felt like she couldn't leave the situation unless she said yes. "You're right. I don't even enjoy myself on these dates, but I keep saying yes." She pushed her hands in her pockets and bit her lip.

Glimmer sighed. "If you want to go on dates, then do it. If you don't, then don't. Just don't blow off your friends. Now, will you watch the booth so I can run to the bathroom? Also, you're buying lunch." She pushed her way out of the booth.

Adora pulled out her phone and texted Catra.

Adora [10:20 am]: *I got stood up. I went to the farmer's market. Glimmer seems to be less mad now.*

Adora [10:20 am]: *I feel like shit. Can we make pasta tonight? I'll start the dough as soon as I get home from this.*

Adora stared blankly at her phone. The screen eventually went black. She tapped it, revealing her favorite picture of Catra and her. They were eating pizza and laughing. She couldn't remember how long this had been her lock screen background, but it gave her some comfort when Catra wasn't with her. They had been roommates for a few months and best friends for much longer. She couldn't imagine not seeing Catra every day, and now that they lived together, that was almost guaranteed.

The sound of someone clearing their throat snapped Adora out of her daydream. "Do you have any more cherry almond?" the person standing in front of their booth asked.

"Oh! Welcome, let me check. Are you looking for the bar or the shampoo?" she asked while bending over to grab a box.

"If you have both, that would be great." They smiled.

Adora took a second looking through a few boxes and found two bars of soap and a bottle of shampoo. "Found it. It looks like this is what we have left. Do you want it all?" She walked over to the table to set the items in front of the customer.

"Do you know when you'll have more?" they asked while grabbing their wallet.

"That's a good question. We should have some in the next few weeks. We are out of a few of the scents and are working to replenish those too!" She unlocked her phone to pull up the app. "Anything else? The honey lemon conditioner is one of my favorites, and I like to use it with the cherry almond shampoo. I end up smelling like a lemon poppy seed muffin." She chuckled.

"Yeah, that sounds great. Add one of those too." They handed Adora their credit card.

Adora processed their payment and put the items in a bag. "Thank you! Check back with us next week for new stuff. Have a good rest of your day."

Glimmer waited for the customer to walk away and clapped. "Wow, look at you making up for not showing up earlier!" she laughed.

Adora unlocked the house door and set her keys on the table. She didn't think Catra would be home yet; she hadn't gotten a text back from her. *Looks like the book store is busy today.* Catra had been talking about a big release of some warrior woman, Xena or She-Ra or something. Adora hadn't been much of a reader, but Catra was really excited about it. Hopefully, she would tell her all about it when she got home. She grabbed the flour, eggs, and salt to make the pasta dough. That's one thing she loved to do, make her own pasta. Catra was fine with any form of pasta. It was her favorite food, but Adora liked to go the extra mile and make it a little more special for them. She grabbed her phone to turn on a video to watch while she made the dough.

She had 12 message notifications—none from Catra.

Unknown [10:23 am]: hey where are you

Unknown [10:23 am]: I got a table

Unknown [10:24 am]: hello?

Unknown [10:24 am]: this is ben

Unknown [10:24 am]: the guy from class

Unknown [10:25 am]: i'm ordering

Unknown [10:27 am]: i was a little late, and this is how you act?

Unknown [10:27 am]: you are so stuck up

Unknown [10:28 am]: cobalt said you never put out, you won't even kiss

Unknown [10:29 am]: guess I know why. your little gay friend probably got your tongue.

Unknown [10:30 am]: should have guessed your a lesbo

Unknown [10:34 am]: fuck you

Adora saw all the messages and then blocked the number. She sighed; she couldn't keep doing this. The dates were terrible, to begin with, and they usually ended badly. She washed her hands and started separating the yolks from the whites. *What a dick. He showed up late, then texted all that shit to me?* She was pissed. Probably not as pissed as Glimmer earlier, but close. She shook her head.

Class is going to be really awkward. She went to text Catra again.

Adora [3:12 pm] : *Hey, when will you be home? Is it busy today? Did that Xen-Ra book get released?*

After the dough had been kneaded, she covered it in plastic wrap and let it sit on the table. Since she had some extra time and Catra was still at work, she would work on some homework. *Oh great, a new assignment for Abnormal Psychology.* Ben was in the class with her, and this was a group work assignment. The professor better not have assigned them together. Her phone buzzed.

Catra [4:26 pm]: *hey Adora*

Catra [4:26 pm]: *i'm on my way home now. do I need to get anything from teh store?*

Catra [4:27 pm]: **the*

Adora [4:27 pm]: *No, I have everything. I'll start the pasta sauce now!*

Adora stood up from the laptop and grabbed a few cans out of the cupboard and a stockpot. *Maybe I should make it a little spicy this time.* She grabbed some spices and fresh garlic. Catra loved spicy food, and they ate pasta a few times a week *at least* .

After adding all of the ingredients, she set the sauce on the stove to simmer, and she started to roll out the dough. *I hope Catra gets home soon.* Adora grabbed a few plates and silverware to set on the table. She would wait to drop the pasta into the water until Catra walked in the door. No use in having sticky old pasta when it takes two minutes to cook. She worked on cutting the pasta into long strands.

A few moments later, the front door opened. "Adora? Where are you?" She set her keys down next to Adora's and walked into the kitchen. "Hey, Adora."

Adora was standing in front of the stove, waiting for the water to boil.

"Hey, Catra." She walked over to Catra and hugged her.

"Bad day, huh?" Catra hugged her back and walked over to the stove. "So you got stood up?"

Adora didn't answer immediately. She picked up the first pile of cut pasta and dropped it into the boiling water. She subsequently added the other bundles. "I did." She stirred the sauce. "Catra, Glimmer was so upset this morning, and I left to meet this guy, and he didn't even show. Then, when he did show, he texted me and went on a rant. Get my phone and look at what he said."

Catra picked up Adora's phone, unlocked it, and scrolled through her messages. "Is it the 801...number?"

Adora nodded, "Mmmhmm."

Catra read through the messages, her ears folded back, and her tail started to flick sharply. She had read many messages between Adora and the guys she dated, even seen a few dick pics that she never wanted to see. It didn't seem like Adora wished to see them either. But, these messages were on another level. There had been rants, there had been pleas, but these were targeted. "Whoa. What a jerk. Are you okay?"

Adora didn't turn to Catra. "I...I don't know." She pulled out a piece of pasta and gave it a check before taking the pot to the sink to strain it. She sighed. "No one has ever said anything about you before." She put the drained pasta back in the pot and set it on the counter. "I've had them go off on these stupid rants before, but…" she placed both her hands on the counter and slumped forward.

"It makes me so mad that he came after you. Like just because you're gay…" she stirred some butter into the noodles then poured the sauce over the pasta.

Catra stood up from the table and walked toward Adora. "Hey, it's okay. That stuff doesn't bother me; I'm not ashamed to be gay. He has the problem, not us...me." She placed her hand on Adora's shoulder and gently rubbed.

"How are you feeling?"

Adora turned around, crossed her hands on her chest, pressed against Catra, and laid her head on her shoulder. "I feel okay. I can't keep saying yes to things I don't want to do."

They stood there for a moment as Catra gently scratched Adora's back. "I wish I could find someone like you," Adora quietly spoke.

Catra's eyes shot fully open, her stomach dropped. She tried not to tense her body with Adora draped over her. It was not easy to do; she had wanted to hear Adora say she wanted her as Catra wanted her. But this couldn't have been anything close to that.

She was sure that Adora didn't mean anything by it, and she was just feeling down. Catra had gone to years of therapy and pushed down those feelings.

She moved her hands to Adora's shoulders. "Let's eat this delicious pasta you so painstakingly made by hand and not because you like me."

Adora's head shot up. "Oh, you wish!" She tickled Catra's sides and laughed. They stood there looking at each other; Adora opened her mouth to speak but choked on her words.

"Ahh...you should get the cheese from the fridge, and I'll plate the pasta."

Catra nodded and walked to the fridge, and looked for the bag of shredded cheese. "Do you want the shake kind too?" She grabbed both and set them on the table between them.

Adora scooped out the pasta on each of their plates. "So, I made this a little spicy. I know how much you love spice and wanted to try something new. Tell me what you think." She sat down and grabbed her fork.

"Damn, Adora! This is really good. We should put sausage in it next time. What do you think?" She was slurping pasta through her lips. Some of the sauce was splashing on her cheeks.

"Catra, I know you love pasta, but you're getting it all over!" She giggled and grabbed a towel and cleaned Catra's face and chin. Catra grinned. "And yes, let's do sausage next time," Adora added. She loved how messy Catra was when she ate pasta. Catra loved pasta so much that she couldn't get it in her mouth fast enough. Catra never got sick of it. The mere mention of pasta and Catra's tail would wave wildly.

After dinner, Adora cleaned up while Catra got ready for bed. "I'm so tired after all that set up at work and I have to get up early for the book release. Thanks for making dinner. I can make dinner tomorrow." She walked into the front room, picked up the pillows

that had fallen off, and brought the cups that were still on the end tables into the kitchen. Finn was sleeping on the couch in a cute little ball. Catra was tempted to pick Finn up but instead opted to give the cat a little scratch. She would never admit it, but she loved that Adora had talked her into them getting a cat.

Catra walked into her room, took off her pants, and slipped out of her bra. A sigh of relief filled that empty room as she walked over to her bed and slipped under the covers. Before getting too comfortable, she set the alarm on her phone. Work was going to be wild tomorrow. The most anticipated book of the year was being released tomorrow, and she had to be prepared to deal with all the preorders. Catra's phone buzzed.

Adora [8:06 pm]: *Good night.*

Catra looked at her phone. It was unusual for Adora to text her good night, especially after they had had dinner together. The texts from that asshole must have really upset her. It makes sense to be upset after receiving a barrage of terrible texts like that. There was something a bit off about Adora tonight, and Catra just couldn't put her finger on it. She opened the notification.

Catra [8:08 pm]: *night*

Catra [8:08 pm]: *are you doing ok*

The three dots popped up, then went away. Adora didn't text back that night.

If at first you don’t succeed

Chapter Summary

> The best friends squad go to dinner, but Adora has other plans.

Catra leaned on the frame of the bathroom door. "Soooooo you're going on another date then? You know Glimmer is gonna be pissed, right?"

"I knowwww. But, this is the last person that I said yes to. After this, I'll be done." Adora finished tying her hair up.

"You should make the poof bigger to cushion the blow." Catra's tail casually swayed behind her. "And, you should text Glimmer. Just to give her a heads up."

Adora unlocked her phone. This was not going to go over well. But, it was the last time this was going to happen, and that had to count for something.

Adora [5:34 pm]: *Heyyyyy Glimmer.*

Glimmer [5:36 pm]: *Are you not coming to dinner?*

Adora sighed; she was not looking forward to getting into it with Glimmer tonight, and right before they went on a Best Friends

Squad night out. It had been a while since the group had been able to schedule a night they all had free. Indeed, she was nervous; she breathed deeply and started typing.

Adora [5:40 pm]: *I'm getting ready with Catra right now. I just am meeting someone there at 7:30.*

Glimmer [5:41: pm]: *Wait, is this another date?*

Glimmer [5:41 pm]: *I swear to god, Adora. I'm not going to continue to be brushed off for these guys.*

Adora [5:43 pm]: *This is the last time it'll happen. He was the last person I said yes to.*

Catra's phone started buzzing. When she picked it up, there was a slew of messages from Glimmer. Oh, this is going to suck. The word 'pissed' wasn't strong enough to describe Glimmer's mood. She hoped that Glimmer had calmed down by the time they got to the restaurant. If not, this was going to be a long night.

"'Dor, are you ready? We should probably not be late." Catra shuddered at the thought of making Glimmer even more upset. While she waited, she inspected her tail. She had just conditioned it, and it was as soft as ever.

Adora walked into the front room wearing a Brightmoon University shirt and the tightest jeans Catra had ever seen. It was basically

Adora's work uniform. She wore it every day that she worked in the testing center before classes. Catra had seen the outfit a thousand times. She shook her head, trying not to blush.

"Hey, sorry. I'm ready." Adora put her phone in her back pocket and grabbed her keys. "It's right down the street. Do you want to just walk?" She opened the front door. "Why are your cheeks red?"

Catra sighed. "Come on; we don't want to be late."

They barely made it to the restaurant on time and waited outside for Glimmer and Bow to show up.

"Sparkles is coming, right?" Catra looked at her phone. No new messages.

"Yeah, I'm pretty sure."

"Catra!" Glimmer's voice rang out from across the street.

"Hey, Sparkles."

Bow came waddling over with Glimmer's purse in his arms. "Glim, I can't find the chapstick. Did we leave it at home?"

"Oh babe, I cleaned out my purse yesterday. I think it is at home. Do you want to walk to the store and get another stick?" She searched through her bag.

"No, I'll be okay." Bow kissed Glimmer on the forehead. "Adora! Catra!"

They both waved. Glimmer walked past them directly to the host and requested a table. It was ridiculously obvious that Glimmer was ignoring Adora.

Adora peered over at Catra, who shrugged her shoulders.

Everyone but Adora ordered. The group had been there numerous times; it was safe to say it was their favorite spot to meet up. Glimmer was still salty about the entire evening but was trying to enjoy herself. She had relaxed a bit and even engaged with Adora.

"Adora, aren't you gonna eat? Are you and Catra sharing?" Bow grabbed a napkin.

Adora looked over at Glimmer, who just stared at her. "I...uh…"

Glimmer quickly chimed in. "She's leaving to go on a date in a few minutes. So, she won't be eating with us."

Adora pushed her cup of water with her finger. She sighed, "I promise this is the last time. I've said no to the new ones." She knew that was a lie because there hadn’t been enough time for there to be another one.

Glimmer sighed. "You know you don't owe any of these guys anything? Even if you said yes to the date, you could cancel anytime."

"I just feel guilty."

"It's not your guilt. Just because they ask does not mean you have to say yes. You have a say in what you do."

"I agree with Sparkles. Half the time, you seem miserable before or after. Did you show them the texts?" Catra took a sip of her soda.

Adora groaned.

"Wait, what texts?" Bow was intrigued.

"The guy from the other day who was so late that I just left sent these really mean texts after." Adora picked up her phone, unlocked it, and handed it to Glimmer and Bow. The table was

silent for a few minutes. Glimmer's eyes were wide, and she covered her mouth before looking first at Catra, then to Adora. She was very aware of Catra's long-held feelings for Adora. Well, everyone was, but Adora.

"Oh, Adora. I'm so sorry he said those things. Are you okay?" Glimmer handed back her phone.

"He had no right to say that," Bow offered.

"Yeah, I'm okay. Catra and I talked about it."

After Adora finished her sentence, her phone buzzed, and the food arrived. Not surprisingly, Catra ordered pasta. She opted for a mixture of Alfredo and traditional marinara, while Bow and Glimmer shared a salad and a cheese pizza. After the best friends squad started eating, Adora looked at her phone and stood up. "He's here. I'll see you later."

Catra didn't look up; Glimmer and Bow nodded.

After Adora had left and was a reasonable distance away, Glimmer turned to Catra. "What happened when you two talked about those texts?"

Catra kept spinning her noodles, "It was interesting. She said something that surprised me, and I think I just need more time to

process it." She put the bite she had prepared in her mouth.

Glimmer and Bow looked at each other, then at Catra.

"It was just different. I've known Adora for a long time, and something seems to have changed. I mean, we've lived together for a few months now, and I imagine that's going to be a growing period for her since it's her first time on her own." Catra paused for a minute, trying to put into words what she was thinking. "It's like she is slowly letting go of what her parents have forced upon her. She'll leave dishes in the front room, not squeegee the shower after she's done. We even have a cat now. It's like... she's...relaxing."

"I wonder what's been the catalyst for that?" Glimmer added the dressing to her salad.

"That's a good quest-" Her response was cut short when Adora and her date were seated at the table across from them.

Catra usually didn't have to see the people who Adora dated. This may have been what Adora always chose, but at least she didn't have to sit around and watch. Out of sight, out of mind. She couldn't help but roll her eyes every time she looked over at the pair.

The Best Friends Squad switched topics and started to talk about the new things in Bow and Glimmer's life mostly, that her parents

were pressuring them to get married and have a baby.

Adora turned to look at Catra and made a face. The guy she was on a date with was more than a little excited. Thankfully, this will be the last time she'll have to do this. These dates were usually so terrible. Either they just talk about themselves the whole time, or they try to kiss or touch her. And that was far from anything she wanted. This guy, Rok, or Darve, or something had been going on about some sports thing he did. His mouth had a piece of basil stuck to it for the last fifteen minutes. But there was no way Adora was going to tell him that. *This is who my parents want me to end up with?* She scoffed.

"What?" He looked at Adora.

She didn't realize that the response to her thoughts was out loud. "Oh nothing, just had something caught in my throat."

"Oh, anyway, so I caught the ball." He continued.

She wished she was sitting with Catra. This date should have been a quick thing, he should have gotten bored, and she could have gone back to hanging out with her friends. But, no such luck. This guy could talk.

Adora looked back over at Catra, who was still working on her plate of pasta. Catra was cute when she tried to eat pasta. She always ended up getting some on her ears. But, it meant that

Adora could give her a thorough ear cleaning which Catra loved, even if she wouldn't admit it. With how clean Catra was, Adora expected her ears to be equally as clean. But, she usually had her work cut out for her during those cleanings.

Listening to what Adora and her date were talking about was excruciating. Did this guy ever stop to breathe? Catra rolled her eyes and kept eating her pasta. *Ugh* . Her ears moved back. She looked at Bow and Glimmer, who were equally as over it.

"So, Bow, when are you gonna come over to play games with me?" Catra asked as she shoved the last of her garlic bread in her mouth.

"Are you two all moved in?"

"Bow, we have lived in that house for months. Why haven't you come over? You use to come

over to my apartment all the time. What gives?" She raised her eyebrow.

"It's been that long? Glimmer, has it been that long?" Bow turned to her as she just moved the food around her plate.

"Yes, we went over there like two months after they moved in for their house warming party." Glimmer raised her eyebrow.

"Oh yeah."

Catra scowled as the guy Adora was with tried to kiss her. Adora moved her face and pulled away. She stood up and walked over to the Best Friend Squad's table. Her arms were folded, and her brow was furrowed.

"Hey, are we ready to go soon? I can't get this guy to keep off me." Adora looked down.

"Who even is that guy?" Catra asked without looking up.

"Someone from the testing center."

Catra bent back in her seat and gave the guy a long hard look. "Seems like he is a wannabe jock who probably has nothing much going for him other than one game-winning score."

"Catra, can we go home?" Adora sat down next to her.

"Of course, we're just finishing up. Can we leave in a few minutes? Do you wanna say bye to your new...friend?" Catra smirked. Her passive-aggressive comments felt like they helped at the moment, but they didn't fully cover the feelings Catra was trying to hide.

Glimmer held back a laugh while Adora just scratched the back of her head.

"No, can we just go?"

"Yeah." Catra turned to Bow and Glimmer, "What about you two? Are you ready to head out?"

"No, we're going to stay for a while longer. We want to get dessert. And we can't wait to see what this guy does when he realizes the girl he was on a date with just left with another cute girl." Bow said as he turned to Glimmer and grinned.

Adora felt a pinch of nervousness. She wasn't *leaving* with Catra, they lived together, and she didn't want to walk home alone. They were *just* friends. Adora stood, "Catra…"

"Okay, have fun; we'll text when we get home." Catra stood up, and Adora took her hand as they walked out. They tried not to grab the attention of the guy Adora was avoiding. That was a scene she didn't want to make.

On the sidewalk, they walked hand in hand. Adora laid her head on Catra's shoulder. "Can we watch a movie when we get home?"

Catra silently sighed. "Yeah 'Dor." It's not that she didn't like the sudden increase in affection, but it just made things difficult. They

were generally affectionate with each other but rarely held hands or cuddled. The feelings she thought she had gotten over were coming back like a speeding train. She tried to let go of Adora's hand, but it just felt right. They walked quietly for a few blocks before Catra broke the silence. "Why do you date people you don't like?"

Adora stopped walking, let go of Catra's hand, and covered her chest with her arm. "I... don't know. I feel like it's what I'm supposed to do."

"Adora, you can say no. You don't have to date those meatheads."

"I guess. It feels like as soon as I get rid of one, another just pops up in his place. It never ends."

"I'm sorry. I can't even imagine what that's like." Catra rarely heard about the guys that Adora dated. It may have been because they only ever lasted a date or two or that Adora just didn't know them very well. She hadn't seen any of them until today, and she didn't want to repeat the experience. What Adora did in her life was her business.

They stopped in front of their favorite corner store. "Hey, want to stop in and grab some snacks for our movie?" Catra asked as her eyebrows lifted.

"Yes! Can we get Red Vines?" She grabbed Catra’s hand.

They picked out snacks and drinks, then walked across the street to their house. This was the house that they had been looking at for a while. Adora had wanted to move out of her parent's house, and she spent most of her time at Catra's apartment anyway, so they decided to buy a house together. When it finally went on the market, they jumped and put in an offer. Yeah, the realtors kept referring to them as a couple, but Adora didn't seem to mind; she almost relished in the title. The neighborhood was perfect. It was close to their favorite restaurant, Bow and Glimmer, work, and school.

Catra opened the door and let Adora in before she shut and locked it.

"Finn? Here kitty kitty. Ppsshhpp," Adora called for their cat.

"Has the cat ever come to you when you've called?"

"Well, no, but maybe tonight would be the night," she laughed.

Adora had been entirely devoted to that cat since the day they got it. They were doing yard work one morning and heard the tiniest of mews. Adora initially thought it was Catra being cute, but after Catra denied ever being cute, they had a look around. Following the sounds, they found the smallest, most pathetic kitten in the alleyway behind their house. Adora immediately picked it up and brought it home.

That was the day they got a cat. The thing had grown since they found it, and Adora had been in love since day one. Catra, on the other hand, tolerated the beast. Well, when other people were around. If she were alone, she would coax the cat to cuddle with her on the couch. And sneak the little fuzzball treats and kisses.

"I'm gonna start the movie; want to get the popcorn popped?" Catra walked into the front room.

"Yeah!" Adora sauntered off into the kitchen.

Catra headed for the couch. She grabbed the remote and clicked the tv on. The room looked like a fraternity had just come through. Well, maybe not that bad. She started picking things up and threw the pillows back on the couch. *Why are these pillows never on the couch?*

"Hey, what are you in the mood for?" Catra yelled.

"Nothing too violent. Maybe a rom-com?" Adora said as she walked into the room with the freshly popped popcorn and a few drinks.

Catra yelled, "Okay, what about…"

Adora cleared her throat, "Hey, I'm right here; you don't need to yell." She laughed.

Catra turned to her and smiled. That laugh never ceased to make her heart flutter. Adora was adorable when she laughed, especially over dumb things.

Adora sat down on the couch and set the drinks on the end table. "Oh hey, do you want to come with me to the gym in the morning before you have to work?"

"Yeah, what time? Are you still trying to PB your bench weight? Because last time, the crowd that gathered was a little over the top. Can we go to the less busy gym or have a casual workout?"

"What!? You don't like watching me struggle to lift heavy weights!? Oh Catra, can we even call ourselves friends?"

"Well, since we are best friends, I can tell you that I'm over that weird group of bros that goes to the bigger gym."

"Oh, I already knew that." She laughed and pinched Catra's tail.

"Hey!"

"What? I'm not doing anything."

Catra scowled and turned her attention back to the TV.

"Okay, this looks like one we haven't seen; it's been recently added." Catra selected the title and sat down close to Adora.

"What's it about?" Adora said with a mouth full of popcorn.

"Oh, two women who grew up together end up falling in love or something," she said while she wrapped a blanket around herself and Adora. "Are you comfortable?"

"Yeah, thank you. Here is your drink. I got you the Zero one."

"Oh, thanks."

Catra laid back and rested her head on the back of the couch as the movie played. It was your average romantic comedy, where two people who didn't have an attraction before met one day after years apart and had an undeniable connection. This one seemed like it may not be as predictable as the rest.

"Oh my god. She's just letting her walk away?" Adora chimed in as she moved forward, raising her arms at the screen, spilling some

of the popcorn.

"Oh, come on. You know how these all end; they'll get together by the time the credits roll. But there has to be some drama and suspense." Catra rolled her eyes.

"I guess you're right." Adora laughed and rested her hand on Catra's thigh.

Catra cleared her throat, readjusted, and tried to focus on the movie. They sometimes cuddled during movie night, but Adora had never put her hand on Catra's thigh, especially during a lesbian romantic comedy. It was always the tamest of cuddling. Maybe a head on a lap or leaning on each other, but nothing more. This was primarily due to Catra pushing away anything more than friendly interactions. One way that she was able to get over her feelings for Adora was to set firm boundaries. And that meant less touching and behaviors that could be misunderstood. It was for her own good, she'd tell herself.

When things couldn't get worse, the movie's sex scene started. But it was more intense than usual sex scenes they had seen; the camera angles were revealing to say the least. Catra was more than a little uncomfortable. "Oh wow." She readjusted and looked away from the screen, grabbing the remote to turn the sound down.

Adora watched intently. "Have you done that before?"

Catra took a second to respond. "Uh...go down on a woman before? Yeah, of course."

"Did you like doing it?"

"Very much so. I love doing it more than receiving it."

"So a woman has gone down on you before too?"

"Yes. Adora, you know this. I've had girlfriends before."

"Yeah, I was just wondering." She moved her hand from Catra's thigh, realizing where she had placed it. Her drink was on the table next to her, and she pretended to be thirsty and grabbed it. She knew that physical contact made Catra nervous and made her pull away sometimes. But she just liked to be close to Catra. She always assumed that Catra only did those things with people she dated, so she didn't push it too much. They were just friends.

"I know you haven't really done that stuff before, 'Dor," Catra added.

"Mmm, I have never really been into it with anyone I've dated. Granted, I've never dated anyone for longer than a date or two." She took a sip of her drink, set it down, then held her head up on her hand. "Can you blame me?"

"Not really." A moment passed, and Catra turned to Adora, ready to pounce, her ears back and tail waving wildly behind her. "Maybe because you date all these loser guys!" She flipped the blanket off of them and started tickling Adora. A series of screeches and giggles sprouted from Adora. "Not fair!"

They laughed for a minute, then Catra laid her head on Adora's chest, listening to her heartbeat. The sound would instantly calm her in times of stress and made her feel safe. There had only been a handful of times she heard Adora's heartbeat, mostly after she had a terrible day, and cried as Adora held her.

They laid there silently for a few moments; Adora thought about what Catra just said. She started to play with Catra's ears. "You're not wrong. I just hate it. But, I don't know how to change it." Thinking back on the dates she had been on, she couldn't remember a time where she really enjoyed herself, let alone remember a guy's name. Well, there was the date with DT. They had come out to her shortly after the date, and both had been good friends ever since.

"What do you want to change? The part where you date guys or date people, longer?" Catra's eye widened as soon as she said it. That was too far. Adora was more affectionate lately, but that did not mean anything. *Chill out, Catra.*

It's not that she had never thought about being with women; she just couldn't handle thinking about it. Many of her panic attacks stemmed from that. But, living with Catra had been beneficial in many ways. She got to see her best friend every day and didn't

have to hear the constant disapproval from her parents. She had done a bit of *research* online about sexual orientation and read a few *stories* . And by 'a few' she meant a lot. Lesbian romance was currently her favorite genre. Sometimes when she would visit Catra at work, she would peruse the erotica section, just to see what they had. There was no way she could buy one of them; she did not doubt that Catra would be able to determine that the book was a lesbian romance novel quickly.

A few times, when Catra was at work, and Adora had the day off; she would go into Catra's room and look at her books. There may have been a time or two that she borrowed a book and expertly placed it back where she had found it when she finished it. Catra probably wouldn’t have minded her borrowing the book, but she was not ready to have that conversation. One thing at a time.

Things felt lighter here. She had her own space, could do what she wanted and needed to, without the ever-present watchful eye of the people who planned out her entire life. It felt liberating to choose when and where she ate or if she cleaned the kitchen, and she could finally have a pet. Finn. It was a name that they both instantly agreed upon. Adora loved watching the two of them cuddling or playing. Catra was so gentle with Finn and always snuck the kitten treats, even though Catra didn't think Adora noticed.

Adora laughed uncomfortably and moved Catra's ear to look inside, trying desperately to change the subject, "Hey, when was the last time I cleaned your ears?"

Catra was absorbed in the movie, "Uh...I don't remember. I think it's been a while, is there pasta sauce in there or something?"

Adora did a cursory search. "I don't think so. But I'll go get a few Q-tips just in case."

"Okay, but don't like go inside-inside. It felt weird last time." She flicked her ears.

"Okay, I promise."

Catra didn't move off of Adora; she almost nestled in further, rubbing her nose in Adora's shirt. "Well, you gotta move silly."

Catra groaned. "But you're so comfortable." She reluctantly pushed herself up and sat to the side.

Adora stood up. "Will you pause the *film* , please?" She grabbed the empty popcorn bowl and walked out of the room.

Catra wouldn't admit it, but she loved when Adora cleaned her ears. She loved her ears played with in general, and when it was Adora's fingers caressing them, it was intoxicating. It would always make her purr; with anyone else, it would be embarrassing, but with Adora, it was safe. Sometimes Adora would trim her ear tufts and wild hairs that grew around her ears. It was such a relief because getting it done with a haircut was so expensive.

Adora walked over to the kitchen to drop off the popcorn bowl and grab a few paper towels. Then walked to the hallway closet where the Q-tips and other beauty supplies were. She looked through the mess and saw the pomade Catra used to use when she went through her slicked-back hair phase. That was a fun time. And the small hair ties when Catra would put her short hair in a little ponytail. Oh, Catra. She grabbed a handful of Q-tips and headed back to the front room.

"Hey, remember when you would slick back your hair?" Adora sauntered over to the couch and set down her supplies on the side table.

"Yeah. I should do that again. I really liked it. I seemed to get more girlfriends too."

A pang of dejection rippled through Adora's stomach. She awkwardly smiled. "Yeah, I mean, it did look good on you."

She sat down and patted her lap. "Come lay your head down. Do you want a pillow?"

"No, I'm fine." Catra yawned and laid her head down. "Can I start the movie? I mean *film* ."

"Yeah, I think it's almost over. Tell me if I'm hurting you, okay?" Adora started to massage the outsides of Catra's ears, and within a few seconds, Catra was purring. Cleaning Catra's ears was one

of Adora's favorite activities; her ears were so soft, and there was a small tear on one of her ears. When they were younger, they decided to get their ears pierced. But, Catra’s ears are much thinner than Adora’s and the earring didn’t stay long.

Catra never pulled away during ear cleanings. It was one of the few times Adora could touch Catra's face. It was so soothing to Catra, and it always calmed Adora down too. She sometimes caught herself playing with them while they were out with friends. Catra didn't seem to mind. "Okay, I'm gonna start cleaning."

There was no reply, but the soft purring continued. Adora made sure not to go inside but cleaned up some of the pasta sauce that had made its way onto the large ears. The soft meows of Finn entered the room; the cat was ready for their nightly cuddle. "Okay, turn over."

Without a sound, Catra turned over, facing the back of the couch. Her tail lay across her legs, gently moving. Finn jumped up onto the couch and slowly climbed onto Catra's side, laying down. Adora tried to reach over to give Finn a scratch, but the small animal was just barely out of reach.

Adora repeated the same routine on Catra's other ear, starting with a nice massage, then cleaning off anything that needed to be cleaned off. "Okay, I'm done. They weren't as bad as I thought." Adora set her supplies back on the side table. "Catra?"

Catra's breathing had become deep and slow, her tail had allayed, but the low sound of purring could still be heard. *Oh.* She didn't

want to disturb Catra or Finn, so she opted to run her fingers through the short dark hair. Catra recently had a haircut, and it held a slight wave that rippled through Adora's fingers. *You're so pretty.*

Adora picked up the remote and turned on a nature documentary.

No, it's leg day

Chapter Summary

The gal pals go to the gym. Adora's feelings become more apparent.

Chapter Notes

Content warning

The word "dyke" is used twice. Once in a homophobic way and once in an empowering way. And a description of a panic attack.

I hope you enjoy the chapter and as always any feedback is welcome. I did just get my twitter figured out, so go follow me on there for updates. @omoshiroimidori or tumblr @friendshipsnakes

Adora took a deep breath before she quietly twisted the doorknob to Catra's room. She had been in this room more times than she could remember, but there seemed to be many more books this time. It wasn't uncommon for Catra to bring home stacks of books from work. She sometimes was able to get pre-release copies and always jumped at the opportunity to read them. She had her favorite genres but just loved to read in general. But, this was excessive.

Catra was tucked tightly into her blankets, and only the tip of her ear could be seen. Adora tiptoed to her bed, trying desperately to avoid all of the stacks of books on the floor; it looked like Catra was organizing again. Maybe she could look through the books Catra was getting rid of for some choice reads. Inching ever closer to Catra's bed, she bent her knees to jump.

"Adora, you breathe so loud, it's impossible for you to sneak up on me. What do you want?" Catra groaned.

Adora jumped onto Catra's bed and draped her arm over the heap that was Catra. "Let's go to the gym! If we hurry, we can avoid those bros."

"What time is it?"

"Eight!"

"Ugh. Okay, just give me a minute."

"Do you want a snack before we go? I can make us some oatmeal."

"Actually, that would be nice. Blueberry?" She pulled the covers over her head.

"Okay, get ready, and I'll bring it to you." Adora rolled out of bed and almost ran to the kitchen. She tossed a few oatmeal packs into mugs and started boiling the water. Waiting for the water, she looked up workouts she wanted to do. There was a heavy-weight, low rep workout that sparked her interest. *Nope, don't think Catra would do that.* She settled on a cable routine for the chest.

The kettle whistled, and she poured the hot water into each mug, stirring immediately. She set her phone on the counter and slowly walked to Catra's room, careful not to spill the hot oatmeal. The door was now shut, but not one to be bested by a challenge, she nudged it open with her foot. "Here's y-"

Catra was pulling up her leggings. "Sorry, I guess I was more tired than I thought. Can we stop and get coffee?"

Adora stood frozen for a moment, her eyes focused on Catra's unclothed ass. She was wearing her typical black, basic briefs that rested just below her tail. Catra didn't care much for anything extravagant when it came to clothing. She had the necessities and a few special occasion pieces, but nothing more.

"Hello? Adora?" Catra snapped a few times in the air.

Adora felt her cheeks warm. "Oh, yeah yeah yeah. We can do that. Uh, when do you work today?" Adora was a little embarrassed that those basic underwear had thrown her off so much. She has been underwear shopping before and had tried many different styles. Why were these affecting her?

"I close, so I don't go in until two."

"Okay, I work the late shift too, but I do have class at noon. We may have time to grab brunch."

"That could work." She took her oatmeal from Adora's hand. "How were you holding this!? It's burning hot!"

"Yeah, I guess I didn't notice."

Catra raised her eyebrow as she blew on the hot oatmeal.

When they got to the gym, they put their bags in a locker and headed to the cardio area.

"Can we run today?" Catra looked over the various cardio machines that were much too close to one another. It looked like the gym had updated their equipment, some of the machines had attachments and platforms that seemed too complicated to attempt at this early hour.

"Yeah, and how do you feel about doing a cable chest workout?" Adora walked to the closest treadmill.

"Wait, I thought it was leg day."

"You said you wanted to do a casual workout."

"I wouldn't want you to stray from your gym schedule. How will you get dates?" Catra snorted.

Adora scoffed and started running. She knew she shouldn't take the teasing to heart, but she was making every effort to be a better friend. Setting boundaries was complex, but the process was going okay thus far. There was a sense of relief knowing that she didn't have to go on any more dates. The only problem was figuring out how to say no to the next guy who asked. She turned the treadmill up.

Catra watched as Adora turned the machine up and almost sprinted for a full ten minutes. She had been friends with Adora long enough to know when Adora was upset, and Adora was pissed. Typically, Catra had full teasing rights as Adora's best friend, but Adora was out of sorts. Something was really bothering her.

After thirty minutes of cardio, they hopped off the treadmills and headed to the cable machines. Adora started setting up the cables with handle attachments and lowering the weight. "Okay, so the first one we’re gonna do is going to target our lower chest. Start with the handles by your hips and bring them up in front of you while moving your hands together. Like this." Adora showed Catra the motion, which she was familiar with.

Adora was acting like Catra had never seen the inside of the gym before. And if she remembered correctly, she was the one that introduced Adora to this gym. She just followed directions and finished the workout. Having a conversation in the middle of a public space would not go well for either of them. It would have to wait until the ride home.

The rest of their workout went about the same. Adora remained distant, and Catra just kept quiet. When they made it to the locker

room, Catra wanted to change out of her sweaty clothes. Adora had left her phone at home, so she quietly sat there at the end of the bench.

Catra took off her pants and underwear and threw on some clean basketball shorts. Adora tried to divert her attention; she looked at the lockers, counted the numbers, tried to figure out how the locks worked. That didn't last long; the urge to just look was too strong. She peered over. Catra looked like she had never missed leg day, her toned thighs and pert ass were hard not to notice. Adora was starting to wonder if it wasn't the underwear that had distracted her before.

After Catra had finished tying her bottoms, she took off her shirt and sports bra. She didn't bother putting another bra back on because she hated doing laundry, and what's the point? They were just going to brunch and then home to get ready for work. *It's just Adora.* She put the t-shirt over her head and turned to ask Adora where she wanted to go and saw that Adora was looking at her—not just looking, but *looking.* Nervousness shot through her body. The only way she knew how to respond when she felt uncomfortable or nervous was sarcasm, which had gotten her in trouble earlier. She regretted what she said as soon as it left her mouth. "Hey, see something you like?" she laughed.

Adora's face dropped, her eyes widened, and her cheeks reddened. "No...I-" She quickly stood up and walked out of the locker room, not bothering to grab her bag.

"Adora, wait!" Catra grabbed both bags and ran after her.

Adora was walking so fast; she was almost jogging.

"Hey, Adora, you're walking too fast. Hold on."

Adora pushed open the gym doors and ran to the car, barely missing someone driving past.

Catra's heart was beating a thousand miles a minute. This was bad, and it had reached the point of no return. She waited for the cars to pass, then ran to her car, hoping to find Adora there. "Adora, wa-"

Catra almost ran past the car, trying to catch up with Adora. Standing by the car, Adora's eyes were closed as she tried to hold back tears, "Can we please just go home?" Her head dropped. "Please."

"Yeah, yeah, of course." As Catra was unlocking the car, two guys walked past them, talking loudly. Catra looked over, then back down, opening the doors.

"Well, if it isn't Adora," one of the guys said.

Adora looked up and immediately recognized them. Ben and Cobalt. She never wanted to be home more in her entire life. Her chest started to tighten. Grabbing at the car door, she desperately tried to get inside.

"Awww, it looks like the dykes are having a fight." Ben laughed.

Without thinking, Catra rushed Ben, ears back, tail puffed, and claws drawn. "Get the fuck outta here, bastard!"

Ben flinched and stepped back. "Chill out. I didn't mean anything by it."

Cobalt stood there with his arms hanging at his sides, mouth open, looking like a deer in headlights.

Catra pointed her finger in Ben's face, "Harass Adora again, and I'll show you what a fucking dyke can do!"

The two guys stumbled off, not saying another word.

Catra got in the car, her tail was still puffed up, and her claws dug into the steering wheel. A few moments passed, and she glanced at Adora. Adora was sitting back in the seat, her chest was rising and falling quickly, and she looked like she was going to pass out. She was having a panic attack. Catra had been present for many of Adora's panic attacks. Although they didn't happen often, she knew exactly what to do.

"Adora, I'm right here. It's going to be okay. Focus on my voice." Catra put her hand on Adora's shoulder.

Adora stared blankly at Catra. She heard the sounds of words and saw Catra's mouth moving but couldn't make out what she was saying. Grabbing tightly onto her shorts, she slowly started to calm down. Her hands stopped shaking, but her breathing took longer to steady. She focused on Catra, who was calmly comforting her. Trying not to cry, she reached over to take Catra's hand. Catra's fingers interlaced with hers. Blinking her eyes, she fell forward and hugged Catra, fully letting go.

She didn't hold back; she didn't try to quiet her cries; she just let go. Tears streamed down her face as she wailed, holding Catra tighter.

Catra gently ran her hand down Adora's back. "It's okay. Let it all out." Continuing her gentle caress, "I'm here." Without thinking, she kissed Adora's head.

After several minutes Adora sharply breathed in a few times. She tried to talk but was still too upset. "I-I just…"

Catra wiped Adora's tears away. "Hey, it's okay. We don't have to talk about anything right now. Just breathe 'Dor."

Adora nodded and laid her head on Catra's shoulder. "I...w-wish we w-weren't in t-the car." She tried to laugh.

Catra gently ran her fingers through Adora's hair. "Hey, at least it's a Prius, so it has lots of room." She smiled. "Want to head home? I'll make us something to eat."

Adora just nodded and held onto Catras hand, leaning on her shoulder.

After they ate, Adora went to lay down; she was not planning on going to class. She knew she couldn't miss her testing center shift, but she was definitely going to skip her Abnormal Psychology class. There was no way she was gonna risk seeing Ben in class. Not after this morning.

Her shift was slow, given it was usually a busy time during the semester. Luckily she was working with Octavia. The two worked well together, and they would take turns doing their assigned duties so the other could work on homework. Keeping her phone on the counter, she texted Catra throughout her shift, wishing they were home watching a movie together.

Adora [5:12 pm]: *How's work?*

Adora [5:12 pm]: *I miss you.*

Adora knew Catra generally didn't have her phone on the floor at the bookstore. She just had a major book release and was preparing for a complete inventory. Feeling bolder, she toyed with the idea of texting Glimmer. She wanted to talk to her about this morning and knew Glimmer could offer some insight.

Adora [6:03 pm]: *It's so slow today. I'm trying to do homework, but I feel so crummy.*

It was her turn to monitor the students taking tests in the exam room. She couldn't have her phone while she walked around in that room. Her primary role was looking for students cheating or needing help with the computers. *Click, click, click, click.* Making her way into the deathly quiet room, she glided around checking each student before sitting at the "watchtower," as the student employees called it. All it was was a high table that was stationed in the corner overlooking the entire room.

Her thoughts naturally drifted toward Catra. Was she having a good day? Did she make it to work, okay? What was she going to eat for dinner? Has she read that new book that came out? It wasn't uncommon for her to think about Catra, so it didn't really bother her, even with the events of the day. A student raised their hand from across the room; she popped out of her chair and made her way over. Within a few minutes, she had fixed their problem and started to walk around the room again. It was rare for students to cheat, but they still had to check.

Octavia entered the room and waved for her to switch to the post-test material collection. The exit door was much heavier than the entrance, and the soreness from her chest workout let itself be

known. *Oooohh.* She sat down and waited for students to turn in their notepaper. Her phone buzzed.

Catra [6:38 pm]: *work is ok.*

Catra [6:38 pm]: *for some reason everyone is buying romance novels today lol*

Catra [6:39 pm]: *i just sold one called "you're the key to my heart"*

Catra [6:39 pm]: *it was 37$*

Catra [6:40 pm]: *how are you feeling*

Her heartbeat sped up with each incoming message. Why did they both have to work today? All Adora wanted to do was cuddle with Catra and sit in front of the TV. She could even make pasta again, with sausage this time. Opening her messages, she replied to Catra.

Adora [6:41 pm]: *I feel okay. I wish we were at home. When's your next day off?*

Adora [6:41 pm]: *When will you be off work tonight?*

She stared at her phone, waiting for Catra to respond. A student cleared their throat, and she looked up. "I clicked 'end test now,' is that all I need to do?" the young student sneered.

"Yeah, your professor will grade any written portions. Have a nice day." She went right back to her phone.

Catra still hadn't texted back yet. Adora opened her pictures and started to scroll through them. She found the one from the other night when Finn was curled up on a sleeping Catra. She quickly made it her lock screen wallpaper. The two of them sleeping and purring was the cutest thing she had ever seen. Well, aside from waking them up and trying to get Catra to go to her bed. She wasn't the easiest person to wake up; there was always a bite to watch out for. Sometimes literally.

The clock finally reached eight, and only one student was taking a test. Adora would be able to go home early tonight. She finished her cleaning tasks and filled out the logbook as the last student dropped off her notepaper.

"I'll go turn off the computers." Adora slipped into the testing room. Usually, when it was a busy testing day, they would split up the room and see who could turn off their half first. But, tonight, she was working with one other person, so no such luck. After all the computers were turned off, she shut off the lights and locked the door. Her phone buzzed.

Catra [8:20 pm]: *I'm finishing up with xlozing duties right now*

Catra [8:20 pm]: **closing*

Catra [8:21 pm]: *i just have to count the last till and the safe after the store closes*

Catra [8:22 pm]: *so like 930*

Adora waited while Octavia finished her log entry, and they both clocked out. On their way out, she reached into the little candy bowl the testing center put out for students who were studying or about to take a test. Nothing like a small boost of energy to help you recall the 20 pages of notes you read on the walk over to the testing center. But, the bowl was empty. Maybe she could stop on the way home and grab a sweet treat for her and Catra. After she said goodbye to Octavia, she unlocked her car and got in.

Peach cobbler. They had just bought peach cobbler at the store the last time they bought groceries. Her mind was set.

Adora [8:32 pm]: *Oh great! I'm gonna put that peach cobbler we have in the freezer in the oven. So, it should be ready when you get home.*

Adora [8:33 pm]: *I can't wait to see you.*

When Catra walked out of work, she unlocked her car and checked her messages. *I can't wait to see you.* Her heart skipped a beat. Earlier, Adora had said she missed her, and now this? She must really be going through something because this, *this* was unusual. She stood for a second before sitting down. Was she reading too deep into this? This confusion started when Adora said that she wished she could meet someone like Catra. But, Adora had always dated guys. On the other hand, she had always done what she was 'supposed to.' Catra shook her head and took a deep breath. *Just friends.*

Okay, it was time to talk to someone. Perfuma had known Adora for years and was great at lessening the blow of hard truths. She started the car and sent a couple of quick texts.

Catra [9:31 pm]: *hey perfuma, when you get this, i need to talk to you about something*

Catra [9:31 pm]: *everything is okay I just need to talk something through with you*

Catra sat in her car a few moments longer. She had to get a hold of her emotions. She and Adora were *just friends.* Nothing more. Adora was just going through a hard time and needed extra support. That's all. It was innocent and had no secret meaning behind it— *just friends.*

When the door opened, Adora met Catra. "Hey! I'm glad you're home. Did you get my text? I made that cobbler we had."

Catra smiled and set her keys down. "Hey 'Dor." If Adora could feel the tension in Catra's body right now, she wasn't telling.

Adora led Catra by the hand to the kitchen.

Just friends.

Catra could barely hear anything; her heart was beating so quickly. In the kitchen, Adora released Catra's hand and started to plate the cobbler. "I wish we had ice cream; that would make this even better."

They made quick work of the cobbler.

"Thank you for making this. I guess I didn't know how much I needed it." Catra stood up and set her dishes in the sink, and leaned against the counter. "How are you feelin'?"

Adora walked over to the sink and set her dishes down. She moved in front of Catra, placing her hands on Catra's hips. She slid her hands to Catra's back and hugged her tightly. "I feel okay, thanks to you. I don't know what would have happened if you weren't there today."

Catra froze, barely able to just breathe. The sound of her heart pulsed in her ears. She worried that Adora could hear the swiftness of its beat. She cleared her throat and casually laughed. "Of course. You know I'm always here for you."

Adora laid on Catra for a few moments longer. "Can I sleep with you tonight?"

Catra's tail was wildly swinging behind her, her ears lay back on her head, and her chest felt tight. "Yeah, 'Dor, of course, you can."

Adora held her tighter. "I'm gonna go brush my teeth." She let go of Catra, lingering on her hips once more.

Catra was thankful for being a Scorpio. Always able to keep her cool when inside, she was a hot mess. *What the fuck is happening?* She knew Adora was going through something, but this was more than a comment some loser guy made. Not knowing what to expect when she went to her room, she took a detour to brush her teeth. *Perfuma, please text me back tomorrow.*

When she walked into her room, Adora was already under the covers. Of course, she knew which side was Catra's and took the other half. "I'm gonna change into my bedclothes. I'll be right back."

"You don't have to do anything special because I'm here. It's just me, Catra." Adora fluffed her pillow.

If Catra wasn't freaking out before, she sure as hell was now. She smiled and unbuttoned her pants, and slipped out of them. She was not about to take off her shirt to remove her bra, so she did the under-the-shirt trick and pulled it out of her sleeve. Her nipples immediately harden after taking the restrictive garment off. "Oh, that has got to be the best feeling in the world." She was trying to avoid Adora's gaze.

Adora laughed, "I agree."

Catra lifted the covers and sat down on the edge of the bed, looking at the wall. She picked up her phone and set an alarm. "I could do the gym again tomorrow; I don't work until later."

"Yeah, same. We could *actually* do leg day."

"Sounds good." Catra laid down and covered herself. She reached over to the lamp, "Is it okay if I turn off the light?"

"Yes, I'm about to fall asleep."

Catra reached over, turned off the light, and laid back down on her back. Within seconds, Adora slid her hand across Catra's stomach and laid her head on her chest. Catra's heart was still beating quickly, and Adora immediately noticed.

"Hey, your heart is beating really fast. Are you okay?" Adora lifted her head to look at Catra.

"Oh yeah. Totally. I think that sugar just got to me stronger than I thought."

"Oh, well, I'll remember that next time I want a late-night snack. No sugar before bed." She giggled.

Catra thought her heart was going to explode out of her chest. She just needed to calm down.

Adora moved her hand back to Catra's stomach, resting it just below her belly button.

"Sleep well," Adora mumbled before her breathing became slow and steady.

Catra knew it was going to be a sleepless night.

Wait, the one with dinosaurs?

Chapter Summary

The gal pals go to a movie with Perfuma and Scorpia.

Catra opened her eyes as her text tone went off multiple times.

Adora groaned and draped her arm around Catra's torso. "Who's texting you this early?"

Catra grabbed her phone and saw several notifications from Perfuma. "Oh, it's no one. I just forgot to silence my phone." Her alarm wasn't going to go off for another hour, but with Adora cuddled up so close to her, there was no way she was gonna be able to fall asleep again. Desperately wanting to break free from the entanglement, she sat up. "I'm gonna run to the bathroom."

"Okay."

Catra grabbed her phone and started to get up, but Adora was lying on her tail. "Hey, Adora, could you move off my tail?"

"But, it's so soft." Adora ran her hand along the appendage.

Catra could not handle this. Adora was in her bed, in her underwear, and wouldn't let her leave because she wanted to play with her tail? She awkwardly laughed. "I have to pee real bad."

"Okay, fine." Adora rolled over and released the tail.

Catra quickly stood up and walked to the bathroom. She locked the bathroom door after her. *Can't have Adora walking in.* As soon as she sat down, she opened her messages.

Plant girl 🌱 [7:00 am]: *I'm glad you are alright.* 🥰 🙌🏻

Plant girl 🌱 [7:00 am]: *Would you like to talk over text or phone?* 📱

Plant girl 🪴 [7:01 am]: *We could even meet in person.* 👫

Catra [7:05 am]: *hey. could we meet up this week*

The question was - should she tell Perfuma about what her issue was now, or should she wait until they met? Apprehension flooded her body. *Maybe I'm just overreacting. Do I even need to talk to Perfuma?* She went to wash her hands before sending another text.

Plant girl 🪴 [7:08 am]: *Yes! Scorpia and I are going to a movie tomorrow night.* 🦂 🎥 🍿 *Are you and Adora free? We could talk after.*

Plant girl 🪴 [7:09 am]: *It's the new dinosaur one.* 🦖 🦕

Catra [7:10 am]: *I'll ask Adora and let you know.*

It would be easy to speak to Perfuma for a few minutes after the movie while Adora and Scorpia played in the arcade. And this way, Catra didn't have to go into as many details. Perfuma would push for them, that's for sure. Catra dried her hands and walked back to her room. She immediately went to her closet to grab a pair of leggings, and slipped them on. "Are you ready to go to the gym?"

Adora had moved over to Catra's spot when she went to the bathroom. It didn't look like she was in any position to get up and work out. Catra continued to get ready for the gym, leaving her bra for when she was alone.

"How about I go make us some oatmeal while you get ready?" She grabbed a clean sports bra and headed to the kitchen; at this rate, who knows what will happen before Catra can talk to Perfuma. She started boiling water and went to the bathroom to finish getting dressed.

Adora meandered into the kitchen, fully dressed but not fully awake. "I slept so well last night." She yawned. "Can we go to the other gym today? I don't want to see...anyone."

"Of course, Adora. Be careful. This is hot. Let it cool down for a minute." Catra set the steaming oatmeal on the counter. "Do you want me to drive?"

"Could you?"

"Of course."

The smaller gym was a little more out of the way, but if it meant avoiding people they both disliked, then it was a win. Their workout went better than expected, given that yesterday was chest day and they decided to do burpees today. As they walked to the car, joking with each other about how sore they were gonna be tomorrow, Catra remembered to ask Adora about the movie. "Hey, Adora? Perfuma invited us to see the new prehistoric danger movie tomorrow. Can you go?"

"Wait, the one with the dinosaurs?"

"Yeah, I haven't seen the other ones, but it sounds fun. We could get dinner with them after."

"Okay, I'm in. I open the testing center tomorrow and will be off by three. Is that okay?"

"Yeah, I open too and get off at five. I'll text her and find out the details."

Catra's shift was busy; she was hosting an event for the She-Ra book that came out a week prior. This was one of her favorite parts of the job; she was able to plan cool events like this. There were dozens of cosplayers, mostly She-Ra. But almost every main

character had been represented. *Who wouldn't want to be an eight-foot-tall sword lesbian?* She laughed.

She had her phone in her pocket to take pictures of the cosplayers to add to the store's social media accounts. Her phone buzzed a handful of times during the event; each time, it was Adora. She secretly loved the new attention and flirty texts that Adora had been sending. Each time 'I miss you' popped up, her heart skipped a beat. She couldn't count how many times she wanted to hear those words from Adora. She wished they were meant differently, but she was just enjoying it for now.

When Catra got home, the house was dark and quiet. It looked like Adora had already gone to bed. The testing center opened at seven, and she had to be up early. Feeling a little hungry, Catra walked into the kitchen to grab a snack. A note was left on the counter.

Catra,

I made us both some overnight oats. When you wake up, all you have to do is stir and eat. One is apple cinnamon, and the other is blueberry.

I hope you had a good night at work.

Your Adora.

Her stomach dropped. *Your Adora.* Had this always been how Adora had communicated with her, and she just never noticed it? Was she the one who was going through something and just thought it was Adora? *Perfuma, I hope you can help.* Catra looked in the fridge and saw the two mason jars full of oats, artfully layered with different ingredients. They both had a little note attached.

Have a good day. ❤️

This was just something that best friends did, right? They wrote cute little notes to each other and signed sweet messages with 'your.' This was *just friends* stuff, right? She just needed to get some sleep. Maybe her day had taken a little bit more out of her than she realized. *Let's just see how tomorrow goes.*

Catra woke up before her alarm and immediately checked her phone.

Adora [6:45 am]: *I hope you have a good day today. I'm excited to see a movie with you tonight.*

These texts were like a drug. She knew it would eventually end in heartbreak, but she just wanted to experience the hope that there was a possibility that Adora felt the same. *Just get through today, Catra.* She got up and got ready for work.

Finn followed her into the kitchen, meowing and rubbing her legs. "Are you hungry, buddy?" She reached down to scratch the cat's chin. When she walked over to check the food dish, she saw another note on the counter.

Catra,

I took the Apple cinnamon. I hope that's okay. It just sounded so good. I also made you a sandwich and put it next to the oatmeal. The bag of chips and orange on the counter are also for your lunch.

I'll see you tonight.

Your Adora.

Catra stood there with the note in her hands. She was only torn away from the moment by Finn, who was still hungry and now desperately rubbing Catra's leg. "Oh yeah, you're hungry." She walked over to the pantry and picked up the cat food, and filled the bowl. "Oops. Well, you'll be fine for the day then." She turned

back to the note and read it again. *Your Adora.* It was evident that it was her favorite part of the notes. Her phone buzzed.

Adora [7:20 am]: *Hi.*

Adora [7:21 am]: *Did you sleep okay?*

Catra smiled at the messages, then noticed the time. *Oh crap, I need to eat then go.* She grabbed the jar of oats and twisted off the top. *So I just stir it and eat it cold?* She got out a spoon and stirred the contents. The blueberries had tinted the oats blue. Taking her first bite, she was surprised at how well the ingredients combined. *Wow, who would have known?*

Adora sighed; there must have been a scheduling error for the social science department because more than ten tests were scheduled for this morning. The line to the testing center wrapped around the floor. Adora had never seen this many students taking tests in one day. She worked with Octavia again, and their third person wouldn't be in until noon. They checked in students as others left the exam room as best they could.

Noon finally rolled around, and as soon as their third came, Adora took a break. "I'm hungry. Can I eat lunch quickly?" Octavia nodded. She grabbed her lunch and snuck away to an unpopular corner of the floor. Her phone buzzed.

Catra [12:05 pm]: *that oatmeal was so good.*

Catra [12:05 pm]: *where did you get the idea to make it like that*

Catra [12:06 pm]: *movie is at 630. Is that okay*

Adora immediately texted back. She had been so busy with work and school that she hadn't seen Scorpia or Perfuma in months. It would be nice to catch up with them. And honestly, she was mostly looking forward to seeing Catra.

Adora [12:06 pm]: *I'm glad you liked it. I just found it online. I'll leave the apple cinnamon one for you tomorrow.*

Adora [12:06 pm]: *Yes! I can't wait.*

Adora [12:07 pm]: *Did you find your sandwich? I hope you like it.*

Adora looked at the time, only a few more hours until she was off and she could finish a bit of homework before the movie. Her Abnormal Psychology professor was going to announce the groups for the group assignment soon; she was worried she would be put in a group with Ben. She sighed.

Catra got home a bit later than she wanted and was forced to change her clothes for the movie quickly. There was no way she was going to sit through a movie in the clothes she had worn all day while restocking all of the best sellers. She stepped out of her room, running her hands through her short hair. *Maybe tonight is the night to test out the slicked-back look again.* Looking across the hall to Adora's room, the light was off. She walked to the bathroom, turned on the light, and started to look for the pomade she liked to use. "Hey, Adora? Have you seen th-"

Adora stepped into the bathroom behind Catra; her hair was braided on the sides and looped back into her ponytail. She wore a tight white button-up with two buttons undone.

"Hey." Catra could not hide the blush on her cheeks.

"Are you gonna slick your hair back?"

"I was thinking about it. What do you think?"

"I think you definitely should do it. Let me grab the pomade for you."

"Ah...thanks." Catra stood there awkwardly like she forgot how to be a person.

Adora walked back into the bathroom with the can of pomade. "I think it's still good. This stuff doesn't expire, right? She twisted off the top. The familiar musky scent filled her senses as she breathed in. "Can I do it?"

Catra's ear fell back as she looked at Adora through the mirror. "Uh...yeah...sure."

Adora leaned her body on Catra's as she turned on the sink to wet her fingers a bit. Catra tried not to gasp and just braced herself as the weight of Adora's firm body pressed against her. Adora put a little pomade in her hands and rubbed them together. She ran her fingers through Catra's hair, watching what she was doing in the mirror. Once she finished, she made a few last-minute adjustments and looked at Catra in the reflection. "How does that look?"

"Um, I think that's perfect." Catra looked down, pretending to put the pomade away.

"I'm gonna wash my hands; then we can go. Scorpia already bought our tickets so that I can send them the money in a minute."

The bathroom never felt this small before. Catra could feel Adora's body on her and didn't know if she should move out of the way or stay standing there. She opted to wash her hands and try to turn around to dry them off to move out of Adora's way. When she turned around, Adora didn't move. Her hips pressed into Catra's, and Adora just looked into her eyes.

"You're so pretty." Adora studied Catra's face and moved a strand of hair that had fallen out of place.

Catra stared at Adora; every ounce of moisture had vacated her mouth. "Ado-" Her phone went off, playing a loud new wave synthpop song. "Oh shit. We need to go. It's almost 7." She quickly slipped past Adora and dried her hands. "I'll start the car."

Catra walked through the front room quickly and grabbed her keys. *Fuck fuck fuck. What was that?* She unlocked the car and sat there. For the first time in the past few weeks, Catra realized that this was not *just friends* stuff. Was Adora gay? Was she curious? Was this a *date* ?

Before she entirely fell into a spiral, she looked up to watch Adora check the door before she walked down the steps. Catra had never seen Adora do her hair like that; she loved it. *Act normal. Don't bring it up.* Adora knocked on the window. "Unlock it?"

"Oh yeah," Catra laughed. She felt like the shirt she just put on already needed to be changed.

Adora sat down and buckled her seat belt. "I just sent Scorpia the money. Can we get snacks for the movie? I want a cherry lime coke."

"Popcorn does sound good. I am a little hungry. Is there anywhere you'd like to go for dinner after?"

"Mexican sounds excellent. Can we try that new place by the gym? I'm pretty sure they have vegan options. Let me double-check."

Catra was glad that the drive was short. Adora was absorbed in her research for vegan Mexican restaurants. At the same time, Catra was quietly listing everything she wanted to talk to Perfuma about, starting with the bathroom incident.

"Okay, there’s one that's even closer. Let's see what Perfuma and Scorpia say."

Catra parked and quickly exited the car. Taking a deep breath of the cool evening air, she shut the door and started walking toward the building.

"Hey, Catra, wait up." Adora grabbed hold of Catra's hand.

Catra's ears stood straight up. Her phone rang in her back pocket. *Oh, thank god.* She let go of Adora's hand and answered her phone. "Hey, we're walking in. Where are you two?" She crossed her arm over her torso, "Mmhmm. Okay, see you in a second."

Turning to Adora, "They got popcorn and a drink for us; you can choose the soda when we find them." She smiled, feeling one of her fangs caught on her lip.

They all sat in their respective seats and waited for the lights to turn down. They were passing candy and popcorn around and giggling when they spilled some.

"Gosh, I am so glad you two could come tonight. We sure did miss you!" Scorpia beamed.

Adora laid her hand on Catra's thigh. "Yeah, what perfect timing."

Perfuma looked at Adora's hand then up to Catra. Catra slowly nodded, her eyes wide. Perfuma mouthed, *oh.* She now knew what Catra wanted to talk to her about. Was she surprised? No, no one would be. The only thing she was surprised about, is how long it took. She turned to Scorpia and whispered something in her ear. Scorpia bent to grab some popcorn while sneaking a look at Adora's hand. She smiled at Catra.

Catra rolled her eyes. The lights started to dim.

Adora's hand stayed on Catra's thigh the entire movie. At a few points, she could swear Adora's hand moved up her thigh. She readjusted a few times and offered Adora snacks, but she always used her other hand to take them. As much as she was trying to avoid thinking about it, she loved the feeling of Adora on her. Her hands were always so soft, and they fit with Catra's so perfectly. She was trying not to entertain whatever this was, but it was so hard not to. There were too many times she had wished for this to happen, and now that it was, it was terrifying.

The women immediately headed to the bathrooms after the movie ended - as per custom and the amount of soda they drank. Catra finished first and waited for the rest. Perfuma walked out and immediately b-lined it to Catra.

In a low voice, she asked, "What was *that* ?"

Catra whispered back. " *That* is what I wanted to talk to you about!"

Scorpia and Adora came walking out of the bathroom laughing. "Hey sweet pea, I'm gonna need to challenge Adora to a few games of Dance Dance Revolution. Do you have any cash?"

Perfuma looked in her wallet, "I'm sorry, honey, I don't."

Catra quickly pulled out her wallet and handed Scorpia all the cash she had.

"Um, Catra, that's way too much. We just need a few dollars."

Catra rubbed the back of her head. "Oh yeah, sorry." She took back most of the bills and handed her a five. "Have fun."

Catra and Perfuma stood outside the arcade, simultaneously watching the game and chatting.

"Okay, so it all started a few weeks ago. Adora was stood up, and the guy totally freaked out on her and sent a bunch of really mean texts. Well, he said that she was hooking up with me, and that's why she didn't show up for the date. But, he was the one that didn't show, so she left. Anyway, she said that she 'wished she could find someone' like me." Catra raised her fingers to make air quotes.

Perfuma held her hand over her mouth, trying not to appear shocked but also trying to hide her shock.

"Well, she has been really...flirty and keeps saying she misses me and puts her hand on my thigh." She pulled out her phone, not

knowing how to describe the situation entirely. "Look, read the texts." Her tail moved erratically behind her.

Perfuma scrolled through the texts and placed her hand on the front of her neck. "Catra…"

Catra cheered when Adora won the song, then turned back to Perfuma. "But, wait, there's more. When we were getting ready tonight, she came into the bathroom and wanted to do my hair for me, which doesn't seem all that weird, but after, when I turned around to dry my hands. She pushed into me and told me how pretty I was." Catra was rambling at this point, and Perfuma laid her hand on Catra's shoulder.

"Okay, this is a lot to process. I can see why you needed to talk. The first thing I want to ask is, how do you feel about all of this?" She handed Catra's phone back.

"I don't know. On the one hand, this is what I've wanted for so long. On the other hand, I don't think it means the same thing to her. I'm worried that our friendship will be affected if we talk about it. But, I think it's reached the point where we have to talk about it."

"I think you're right. You probably feel vulnerable right now. You and Adora have been friends since you were young, and your friendship is strong. I believe it can withstand this and much more. And it sounds like you know what you need to do." Perfuma wrapped her arms around Catra.

Catra stood there for a moment, then hugged back. "Thank you."

Scorpia and Adora walked back over to Perfuma and Catra.

Adora interlaced her fingers in Catra's.

Scorpia wrapped her arms around Perfuma, "Did you see how good I did?"

Perfuma giggled, "I did; I'm so proud of you." She laid a little kiss on Scorpia's cheek.

Scorpia was beaming. "Are you two ready for some food? I'm starving!"

They all tore into their food at the restaurant as soon as it hit the table. Popcorn wasn't as filling as they had hoped. But, the restaurant that Adora had picked out was outstanding and had so many different options.

"Hey, Catra? Will you pick out a dessert for us while I run to the bathroom?" Adora scooted toward Catra to let her out of the booth.

"Yeah." Catra hurried out of the booth, then moved back in after Adora got out.

The second Adora turned the corner, Scorpia whispered, "So what was *that* about?"

"What, Adora wanting dessert?" Catra knew exactly what Scorpia was talking about but wasn't thrilled to talk about it anymore.

"No, during the mo-"

"I know what you're talking about." She sighed. "She's just been really flirty lately, and keeps putting her hand on my thigh. It's really unusual, and I don't know what to do about it." She picked up her water and gulped it down. "Part of me is worried that if we talk about it, it'll stop."

"It sounds like maybe Adora is realizing she has feelings for you, wildcat."

"No. You can't put that thought in my mind. I have been over these feelings for years. They can't come back. It's already hard enough living with her."

Perfuma cleared her throat.

Adora sat down, "What dessert did you pick?"

"They haven't been by yet. You were too quick." Catra smiled.

No, you can’t reroll!

Chapter Summary

The gal pals have a game night with Bow and glimmer.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

As soon as they got home, Catra headed for the bathroom. "I'm gonna hop in the shower and go to bed. I'm exhausted." It had been a long day, and she was glad to have the next day off. She turned the shower on, went into her room, and grabbed her nightclothes. She was mindful not to be unclothed in their shared space. After entering the bathroom, Catra shut and locked the door.

She stood under the stream of water, letting the warmth envelop her body. She wasn't much of a shower person, mainly because it was such a chore. Masturbation was more of an in-bed thing for her, so she mostly just got bored in the shower. But, tonight, she wanted a bit of time to think. Yeah, she had been going back and forth on how she felt about Adora's attention. Who could blame her? She and Adora had a deep connection since they were children. It's hard not to look past that.

After Catra came out, Adora's affection and care didn't change. The only thing that changed was Adora now knew. Adora wasn't surprised, Catra was who she was, and Adora loved her unconditionally. It felt like something that only happened rarely. This connection was so important to Catra that she didn't want to do anything to jeopardize it. She couldn't lose Adora.

As soon as Catra's head hit the pillow, her eyelids started to droop. The shower had given her some much-needed time to decompress and process the day. The relaxation set in as her body acclimated to the warm bedding. She didn't work the next

day and could sleep in as late as she wanted. Her phone buzzed, but she didn't turn to check it.

The light sounds of mewing woke Catra. Finn was walking up behind her for a morning cuddle. She enjoyed all the new behaviors that the little furball displayed as the months went on, especially the cuddles. Turning over, she opened her blanket up for the cat to curl up in the warmth. She kissed Finn and smelled the distinct scent of bacon. *Oh, that smells good.* Not being one to turn away a home-cooked meal, she gave Finn one last kiss and got up to get dressed.

Adora had awoken early and couldn't get back to sleep, so she decided to go for a morning run. Their neighborhood was pleasant in the mornings, and there were fewer cars and people on the roads. This was one of her favorite times to run. The crisp morning air helped wake her up, and the path next to the river was usually empty. Popping in her earbuds, she jumped off the curb.

Her run took her around new streets in her neighborhood. She had not changed up her route much since Catra, and she moved in, and today was the perfect time to try something new. The river path was a favorite walk for her and Catra; they liked to walk in the evenings. There had been countless times when Adora wanted to hold Catra's hands or feel her arms wrapped around her while they watched the flow of the river. But, each time, she would be stopped by her nerves. She didn't fully understand her strong connection to Catra. However, she knew she always wanted to be close to her and thought about her when they parted. They were best friends after all, and that's what *friends* did, right?

When she arrived back home, she took a moment to look at the house that she and Catra owned *together.* Just a couple of best *friends* owning a house together. The past few weeks had brought

a twinge of uncertainty whenever she thought about or said the word *friends.* Lately, it seemed out of place. It's not like she didn't want to be friends with Catra; it was the exact opposite. She wanted to be closer with and spend more time with her. And by 'more time,' she meant, every waking moment.

She unlocked the front door and headed toward the kitchen. *It's time for breakfast.* After a simple search of the fridge's contents, she opted to make bacon, eggs, and pancakes. She forgot to prep the overnight oats last night. But, a freshly cooked meal sounded perfect. Was it elaborate and a bit over the top for this early in the morning? Yes. But did she care? No. It was her day off, and she wanted to indulge a bit. She was going over to Glimmers in a few hours to go on their yearly trip to the outlet mall to stock up on socks, underwear, lotion, and whatever else they could find. The last time Adora did laundry, she saw the state of Catra's socks and wanted to grab a few packs for her.

Adora plopped the bacon in the pan, not even bothering to break it up. She could save the uneaten pieces for meal prep later. Or maybe she could toss it into something for dinner tonight. Looking for the pancake mix, she felt the soft nuzzle of Finn at her ankles. "Hey there, little goose," she crouched down to scratch the cat's head. "Are you hungry?" Adora grabbed the cat food and poured a scoop into Finn's dish. "There you go."

After the batter was made, she warmed up the griddle and poured the first ladle onto the hot surface. She flipped the bacon while the pancake was cooking. *I wonder if Catra works today. Maybe she'll want to come shopping with us?* Adora knew that Catra's least favorite activity was clothes shopping. She had what she needed and didn't want to spend any more time buying clothes. But, it couldn't hurt to ask. She plated the bacon and set it on the table to drain and cool.

The distinct sounds of Catra's footsteps echoed through the hall. Adora felt the flutter of nervousness and excitement in her belly. After walking into the kitchen, Catra mumbled, "That smells good." She rubbed her eyes.

"Good morning! How did you sleep?" Adora cracked two eggs into the pan the bacon had cooked in. She was trying desperately to focus on cooking and not rush to hug Catra.

"Like a log. I was so tired last night." Catra stole a piece of bacon from the plate. "Oh, that's hot."

"Yeah, sorry, I just set that down. How do you want your eggs?"

"However you make yours." Catra went to the cabinets to set out plates and a few mugs for tea. "Do you want tea?"

"Yeah, the kettle has hot water in it. Can you make me the minty one I like?"

"Of course."

They had known each other long enough that they had an unspoken language, a sixth sense for each other. Usually, they could easily determine what the other was thinking or what the other one wanted or was in the mood for. It was part of what made their bond so strong.

Adora sat a plate full of hot food in front of Catra. "Enjoy."

After eating more than enough breakfast, Catra leaned back in her chair, patting her belly. "I could get used to this."

"Used to what? Waking up to me making you breakfast?" Adora smirked. She would love to wake up with Catra every morning and make them breakfast. Sneaking kisses between bits and cuddling after their bellies were full.

Catra was immediately embarrassed. Feeling her cheeks warm, "I...uh...mean...um." And yes, that was precisely what she wanted. But, not just the breakfast, she wanted to wake up with Adora in her arms. To smell the soft scent of Adora's hair. To feel Adora caress her tail. To *kiss* her. "Thank you for breakfast," she said meekly.

Adora collected their plates and set them in the sink. The loud thump of her heart echoed in her ears. "Do you know how cute you are when one of your fangs gets stuck on your lip?" She felt emboldened; her nerves seem to have left the building. Turning to look at Catra, her gaze peered deep into the mismatched eyes. The *need* to be close to Catra, to touch her, radiated through Adora. She walked over to Catra and stood in front of her. She bent over slightly to run her finger over Catra's bottom lip and release it from the fang's grip. "You should come with us to the outlets today."

Catra looked up at Adora, not knowing if she should say something or just sit there. Her ears fell back as she watched Adora. She generally felt when her fang was stuck on her lip, but today she was a bit *distracted.* All she could do was sit there and stare up at Adora. Her tail lay motionless, hanging off the chair. She instantly felt surprised, nervous, and uncharacteristically shy. At that moment, she wished she could pull Adora down and press her lips to hers.

Adora placed her hand on Catra's cheek, running her thumb across the soft skin. She shifted her hand to the back of her neck, moving her fingers through Catra's short hair. Letting her hand drift to her shoulder, she studied Catra's face. *You're so pretty.* Adora felt Finn rub against her legs, but she tried to ignore the affectionate cat.

Catra didn't want to move, and she was unsure that she could if she tried. The feel of Adora's soft hands on her was more than she could handle. She felt her breathing slow and deepen. "Adora…" Before she could stop it, Finn jumped up in her lap and stretched up onto her shoulder. The softest meow broke the tension that filled every inch of the room. Catra looked down, let out a long breath, and gave Finn a scratch. "Do you want to go help me organize my books today, little buddy?"

She picked Finn up, stood, and started walking toward her room. "I'm gonna go through my books. There isn't any more room to store them, and I should probably get rid of some. Have fun at

the outlets!" As soon as she got to her room, she set Finn on the bed and shut the door. Keeping both palms on the door, her eyes widened, and her tail straightened. *What the actual fuck just happened.* She started to pace the room, deciding what she should do. Her tail swung wildly behind her, ears going from laid back to straight-up when she heard Adora walk down the hallway. *Should I text Perfuma? Do I just hide in my room all day? Should I talk to her?* She stopped pacing, held her hands out, and took a deep breath. *You have to talk to her tonight. No more putting it off. It's probably nothing. Maybe she doesn't even know what she's doing. But what if she does know what she's doing? What then?* She was starting to spiral.

Adora stood in the middle of the kitchen and folded her arms after Catra got up and left. She felt...sad? No, that wasn't it. She felt something she hadn't felt before, a combination of elation and sorrow. It's not that she didn't want to spend the day with Glimmer; they usually had a good time. She just really wanted to spend the day with Catra. She sighed. Looking on the bright side, this way, she could talk to Glimmer about some of the things she had been feeling recently. She definitely needed help understanding these intense feelings.

She pulled out her phone and texted Glimmer.

Adora knocked on Catra's door as she was leaving. "Bye, good luck with your books." *I'll miss you* .

Catra had laid on her bed to pet Finn to help calm herself down. She was starting to get anxious and needed a distraction. Grabbing her phone from the nightstand, she saw the unread message from the night before.

Adora [10:27 pm]: *I hope you sleep well.*

She couldn't help but smile. Was it too late to go with Glimmer and Adora shopping? She wished she had said yes. Why did she

freeze up? *No. I needed to stay home. I have to finish organizing these books.* She sat down in the middle of the floor, leaned against her bed, and sighed. She was going through all of the options in her mind of what she should do. This is how it has been since Adora's behavior started to change. She loved every minute of Adora's flirtations, but then her logical brain would kick in and force her to think about the long-term consequences. It was so hard not to enjoy every touch, every " *I miss you."*

She felt miserable after each interaction because she felt guilty or knew that the situation's reality was much different from what she was feeling. Could anyone blame her? What do you do when the person who knows you the most, who you've known the longest, who you...love, starts showing interest in you? Well, apparently, you crumble.

Catra sighed and looked at Finn, who was quietly napping. *I guess all this tension is wearing you out, too, huh, buddy?* She slid the closest pile of books in front of her. Looking at each one and reading the back, she put it in a stack if she had already read it and was not attached to it, another if she read it and loved it, and finally a pile of unread books.

For a while, she was able to keep her focus on organizing her books. When she had sorted them into three piles, she set the books she was getting rid of in a box and shelved the rest. After she placed the books on the shelf, she ran her fingers along the spines of her favorites. Each book reminded her of a specific time in her life or a particularly juicy piece of the story. She smiled.

I should reread... She slowly rechecked the shelf for one of her favorite romance novels. Yet, it was not anywhere to be found. She looked through the other shelves and even behind some of the books to try and find it. *Hmm. I don't think I gave it away?* Maybe she left it in her car, or it's somewhere else in the house. She tended to leave her books in random places throughout the front room and kitchen.

Her phone buzzed.

Adora [12:59 pm]: *Hey, just thinking about you. How is the book sorting going?*

Adora [1:00 pm]: *There is a pile of books in the front room by the right end table. I don't know if you've seen those yet.*

She read the texts and sat for a few moments. She had to admit how good it felt to receive messages like this. Who wouldn't want someone they care about to send them messages like this? As much as she wanted it, she knew it couldn't end well. Adora didn't want her, not like she wanted Adora. *What's the point of even texting back when I'm just going to talk to her tonight and sort this all out?*

Adora knocked on Glimmer and Bow's apartment door, waiting quietly for one of them to answer. Bow swung the door open. "Adora! Glimmer is almost ready; come in."

"Thanks, Bow. How are you today?"

"Great, thanks for asking. I'm a little jealous that you two get to go to the outlets today. I have to finish an app for a client, but I'm almost done." He pointed to his laptop that had a bunch of text on the screen.

"I'm sure it would be boring anyway. You know how Glimmer gets carried away sometimes." Adora laughed. She was glad it would only be Glimmer and her. She needed someone else's input on how she's felt around Catra and didn't want everyone to know. Glimmer was just the person to talk to; she would give it straight to her and help her figure out a solution. *Will there be a solution?*

Glimmer stepped out of the bathroom. "Hey Adora, you ready to go?" She walked toward the front door and got her purse, and slipped on her shoes. "Can I drive? I just got new tires and want to make sure I like them."

"Yeah, sure."

There were two routes to the outlets, one that went through the city and the other that went through the canyon. They opted to take the scenic route, as it gave them longer to talk, and it was simply better than driving on the freeway. The canyon was beautiful that day, and the time was perfect to avoid any possible traffic and get to their destination in good time.

"Glimmer, can I talk to you about something?" Adora looked down at the packages of socks, not turning toward Glimmer.

"Is everything okay?"

"I think so. It's just, things have been different with Catra lately."

"Is that a good thing or a bad thing?" Glimmer knew what had been happening and was trying to appear as if she was clueless.

"I think it's a good thing. But, I don't know how to deal with…" Adora's heart rate started to increase. She had rehearsed a hundred times this morning. But actually talking about it with another person was terrifying. "I think I like Catra."

"I'm glad you like your best friend." Glimmer laughed, trying not to blurt out what she already knew.

"No, I mean, like more than friends." Adora threw a few packages of socks in her shopping tote.

Glimmer swallowed. "Oh." She took a shirt off the rack and held it up. "What makes you think that?"

Adora took a moment to answer. She tried to collect her thoughts to make sure she made sense. This was much more difficult saying it out loud. "I miss her when I'm not with her. I can't stop thinking about her. And...I…" She trailed off.

"And what, Adora? Everything you say here stays between us. Not even Bow will know."

"Okay, thank you. I just...sometimes think about, I don't know, being closer to her. Physically."

"Like sexually?"

"Um…" She looked around to make sure they were relatively alone. Thank god it was a slow day at the outlets; everyone must have been at work. "I have thought about that, but it's mostly kissing and just touching her right now."

"Touching her, how?"

Adora scratched the back of her head. "Like, every inch of her body. Even as little as holding her hand. I just want to be in contact with her." Adora held up a few different styles of underwear, trying to decide which one to buy. She knew which ones she usually got, but she wanted to try a different style. The ones she was drawn to looked like boy shorts but shorter. The sign only said, "love your cheeks." She added a few pairs to her tote. Maybe an extra pair or two for Catra; she knew how good Catra would look in these. *I guess that's a yes to thinking about Catra sexually.*

"Have you ever had these feelings before?"

"Well, I guess they've come and gone since we were kids. But, I feel like they are really intense now, and not even distracting myself with dating has helped. Normally that would be the trick, to be so busy with things that I couldn't think about Catra."

"Have you two talked about this?" Glimmer looked over at Adora.

"No, no. I have just figured it out myself. I'm so worried that it will ruin our friendship. I can't lose her, Glimmer. She means the world to me. We have a house and a cat together. I'm just so worried."

Glimmer was silent for a moment. "Why don't we pick her up after we're done shopping, play a few games, eat pizza, and then you two can talk on the way home. And if things go bad, call me, and you can stay overnight."

Adora walked around a few racks, not seeing anything that stood out to her. "Okay." She pulled out her phone.

Standing up, Catra bent down to pick the box of books she was getting rid of and walked out to the front room. She stopped at the couch to look at the stack of books. Most of them she had already read and was fine getting rid of. So, they went into the box. She set the full box next to the front door and looked around for any other rogue books. The missing book was sure to be around here somewhere.

Not having any luck finding the missing book but locating a dozen others hidden in every nook and cranny in the house, she decided it was time for lunch. She took out the stuff for a sandwich and felt her phone buzz again.

Adora [1:45 pm]: *Hey, we are done and gonna head back soon. Glimmer wants to know if you'd like to come over for board games and pizza?*

Adora [1:47 pm]: *We are about an hour out, and we could come pick you up.*

Okay, she couldn't ignore it any longer. This seemed to be the perfect scenario to talk with Adora. On their drive home, they could just talk about what's been going on and get everything

cleared up, so they could go on being *just friends* . Her heart ached just thinking about the eventual reality. *It's probably time to get a real girlfriend.*

Catra [1:52 pm]: *hey dor*

Catra [1:53 pm]: *that sounds great ill see you soon*

Catra [1:53 pm]: *should I get any games out*

Almost instantly, Adora messaged back.

Adora [1:54 pm]: *Nope! They recently received a few games they backed on some crowdfunding site, and they want to try them out with us.*

Adora [1:55 pm]: *i can't wait to see you.*

There was no use in stopping herself from enjoying these last few texts from Adora. After tonight, this would be put to rest, and they could go on with their lives. A deep sadness spread through her body, only a few more hours to live in this fantasy. She brought her phone to her face and started to type.

Catra [1:58 pm]: *i can't wait to see you either*

The door opened, and Adora yelled, "Catra! We're here. Come see what I bought for you."

Glimmer ran past Catra as she walked down the hall. "I have to pee!"

Catra looked at the blur that was Glimmer then over to Adora. Her heart started beating quickly. She was used to seeing Adora in *their* home, but things were just a bit different now. Adora was in knee-length shorts and a blank white shirt. Her hair was in a bun, but somehow a few strands were hanging loose on the side of her face. Was it wrong to want something to be true? Maybe Adora

did feel the same. It was just so hard to shake those feelings. Heck, she was giving herself one last day to enjoy this before it's squashed for good. She could indulge a little bit. "Hey, Adora."

Adora walked to Catra and hugged her tightly. "I'm glad to see you. Come look at what I bought you!"

She started taking things out of the few bags that she had. Grabbing a few tubes of lotion, she told Catra all the scents she got for them to use. "I think this one will smell really good on you." Adora popped open the top and brought it to Catra's nose.

"Oh, that is really nice. All of this was on sale?"

"Yes! It was even the end of the season sale; all the new stuff is coming in, so the old stuff is even cheaper. This is why we go during this time of the year!" Opening the last bag, she pulled out a few packs of socks and loose pairs of underwear. "Okay, so I got you a few more packs of socks since your claws have done a number to your old ones. These are cool; they have reinforced toes." She pointed to the packaging. "And...uh..these were on sale too, and I mean we can all use extra underwear, right?" She laughed awkwardly.

"Oh." Catra could feel her cheeks get warmer. "I've never tried this style before. They look similar to the kind I normally wear. Thanks."

Glimmer practically ran down the hallway. "You ladies ready for game night!?"

Catra and Adora both smiled.

Glimmer stood and threw her hands up. "Catra and Bow can't be on a team again. It just isn't fair. You both are nerds and know too much."

Bow laughed. "Okay, okay. How about I order the pizza, and we switch teams. I'll be with you, babe, and Adora and Catra can be on a team."

Glimmer pouted while she set up another game. "What did you get up to today, Catra?"

"Oh, I just organized my books and relaxed."

"Sounds like a nice day. Are you getting rid of any books? There are a few that you own that I'd like to read." She finished setting up the game and sat back, waiting for Bow.

"Actually, yes. I have a whole box of books that I am getting rid of. You can look through them and take what you'd like. I'm just gonna trade the rest of them in at work." Catra lifted her soda to her lips. "They're mostly suspense and a few biographies." She took a sip.

They started another game, which Bow and Glimmer quickly lost.

"Wait, the die fell off the table. I should reroll." Glimmer exclaimed.

"No, you can't reroll!" Adora threw her hands up.

"Why do we always play this game! I hate it." Glimmer fell back into the chair and folded her arms.

There was a knock on the door.

"Pizza is here!" Bow shot up and jogged to the door.

They all gathered around the table, more than ready to take a break from the game.

He handed Adora a plate. "Did Glimmer tell you about that guy from the pizza place the other night?" He smiled.

Adora didn't want to hear about him. She didn't care what happened to him after she left, as long as he left her alone. "No, did he ever leave?"

"Oh yeah, it took him about 15 minutes to realize that you were not coming back. He threw a fit as he left. It was quite the scene." Bow still got a laugh out of the story.

Glimmer looked over at Catra, who was not paying attention or pretending she wasn't, while Adora looked at Glimmer with a blank stare.

"Yeah, sounds like I was lucky to leave when I did." Adora sat next to Catra and pushed the pizza around her plate. She suddenly didn't feel hungry. "That'll be the last time that happens."

"Why? Are you giving up dating?" He handed Glimmer the ranch.

Catra was eating her pizza carefully with a knife and fork. She had never done that before, but the increased difficulty helped her detach from the conversation that she in no way wanted to be a part of. She was uncomfortable, to say the least.

Adora wanted this conversation to be over and never brought up again. She got that it was now a joke within the best friends squad, but damn, she wanted it to end. "Yeah, I don't even enjoy it, so why waste time. I have better things to do than pretend to like them." She pursed her lips.

"That makes sense. I'm surprised you two haven't ever dated. You have so much in common, and you've known each other for so long. And! You'd have the cutest couple name ever! *Catradora* . How cute is that? It fits so perfectly." He was so proud of himself. That name came to him while working on the app earlier in the day, and he was so excited to tell them.

Catra dropped her silverware and lifted her head to turn to Adora, who sat motionlessly. If anything could have made the night turn, it indeed was that.

Glimmer looked at Catra, then to Adora. The profound tension that had entered the room was impossible to ignore. "Oh, Bow, you are such a jokester. So, does anyone want dessert?"

Adora kept her face down. "No, I think I'm ready to go home. I'm a bit tired from all that shopping and I have an early morning."

"Let me give you half of the pizza! You can take it for lunch tomorrow." Bow grabbed a reusable food storage bag and filled it with the lukewarm pizza.

"Will you drive?" Adora handed Catra the keys to her car before she could answer.

"Yes, of course." Catra unlocked the doors and got into the car. She buckled her seatbelt and could feel her palms starting to sweat. *This is it.* Bow didn't know that he left the perfect opening for the conversation they were about to have. As Catra pulled out of Glimmer and Bow's parking lot, she debated whether or not to start the conversation with a question or just forget about it.

Adora wasn't mad at Bow, but she was nervous that he knew her feelings for Catra and now that Catra knew about them. She stared out of the window silently, debating whether she should say anything or pretend like it never happened.

At the same time, they both spoke.

"Why have you been putting your hand on my leg?"

"I think I have feelings for you."

Both women sat there in silence after the jumbled mess of words that were just spoken. Neither was ready to talk about what she heard the other say, nor did she want to talk over the other again.

Catra turned down their street, pulled into their driveway, placed the car in park, and turned off the engine. Neither of them moved or said a word. Adora looked out her window, which was starting to fog up, and Catra held the steering wheel tightly, looking stiffly forward.

Not surprisingly, Catra spoke first. "Adora, why have you been putting your hand on my thigh and holding my hand?"

There were several moments of silence. Adora's breathing was getting noticeably quicker. She grabbed the side of the seat tightly. "I…" What was she going to say? Repeat what she had said a few minutes before? Should she go into detail? What if Catra freaked out? Every worry she had melded into one, and she blurted out. "I think I like you, Catra."

Catra tried to hide her gasp. Her heart felt like it was beating out of her chest. She wasn't making it up. She wasn't looking into it too deeply. Adora *had* been different, and she noticed it. She felt relieved and nervous at the same time. *Now what?*

Both of their attention was drawn to their porch, as their porch light burnt out and it went dark. Catra turned off the headlights. "Well, it looks like we need a new bulb." Well, duh, Catra! Great detective work. Maybe, you should quit the bookselling business and join the force; you could perhaps single-handedly improve the dismal case solve rates. *FUCK FUCK FUCK FUCK.*

Not moving her head away from the window, Adora softly spoke. "Catra, I can't stop thinking about you." She took a breath. "And I just want to be close to you when I'm around you. I don't know what to do."

Catra sat in silence for several minutes. She was so nervous that she thought she would throw up. But, this is precisely what she wanted to happen, granted it was not at all how she expected it to go. "Is that why you've been extra touchy lately?" Her voice was smooth.

Adora turned to Catra. "Can I kiss you?"

Chapter End Notes

Oh HECK! Strap in folks, we are going for a ride.

We need a new light bulb

Chapter Summary

With Adora's feelings out in the open, Catra and Adora decide what to do.

Chapter Notes

Was the burn slow enough?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

As soon as the words left her mouth, Adora almost regretted asking Catra if she could kiss her. There was no turning back now. The cat was out of the bag, and she had no idea what Catra would say. She started to panic. *What if Catra says no? What do we do then?* She sat frozen, staring at Catra.

Catra's stomach dropped. There is no way she was going to kiss Adora. They were *just friends,* and they needed to stay that way. If they kissed, then their friendship would forever be changed. They could not go back if they crossed that line. Catra knew she had to set a firm line in the sand and stop all of this once and for all. She looked at Adora and took in a deep breath. "Yes."

Adora was not expecting Catra to answer so quickly. She didn't think that far ahead. Kissing Catra had been on her mind for quite some time, and now she finally had the chance to do it. Technically this would not be their first kiss. They had kissed before, but they were both stoned, and that really didn't count. Or did it? They were hanging out at Catra's apartment watching a movie and relaxing after an edible, and one second they were laying there, and the next they were kissing and caressing.

But it accelerated quickly, Adora climbed onto Catra, and they ended up making out for twenty minutes until Adora panicked and suddenly got off of Catra's lap. The day after, they just pretended as nothing had happened. There was never a discussion; it was

simply not mentioned - almost as if it never happened. Primarily due to Adora. Catra had tried to talk about it, but Adora kept changing the subject. She just wasn't ready to deal with it. But, it has lived rent-free in Adora's mind ever since.

Oh, but this kiss would count. There would be no doubt about that. She was ready to feel Catra's sweet lips for a second time. *I wonder if she feels the same?* It was now or never; if she didn't do it quickly, the moment would pass. She placed her hand on the side of Catra's neck, looked up at her, barely able to see her in the darkness, and placed her lips on hers.

The softness of Adora's lips wasn't surprising, and it was welcome. Their kiss was tender, slow, and mostly innocent. When their lips parted, Catra smiled. She didn't know what she expected, but that was nice. Her nervousness had mainly tamed itself. She sat for a moment while they both looked away from each other and she opened her mouth to speak. "So…"

Adora did it; she actually kissed Catra. She wanted to do it again; she wanted to kiss Catra all night. Her nervousness had turned to excitement. Taking in a breath, she turned to Catra, hesitating for a moment, before placing her hand on Catra's thigh. "Can we do that again?"

Without saying a word, Catra kissed Adora. She gently parted Adora's lips with her tongue as she placed her hand behind Adora's head. This kiss was different from the first, they had broken that initial barrier, and now their passion could be unleashed. All of their feelings and yearnings had been awoken, and there was nothing between them to stop it. Well, aside from the center console.

Their position was awkward in the car; the back seat would be much easier for them to navigate their exploration. But that didn't stop either of them. A restrictive position couldn't hamper the years of build up leading to this very moment. Adora was the first to allow her hands to travel across Catra's body, moving down her back pulling her closer.

Soft moans from both women broke the silence. Catra could feel the heat building in her core. She pulled away from Adora and placed their foreheads together. Both were trying to catch their breath; Adora moved her hands over Catra's chest as the women breathed.

Catra softly moaned as the strong hands moved over her clothed breasts. Her nipples hardened at the light touch, making it easy for Adora to hone in on the sensitive area.

The sounds Catra was making made it difficult not to want to touch every inch of her body. She wanted more. Adora pushed herself up and moved to straddle Catra. It was even more restrictive than their previous position, but it gave her better access to Catra. She pulled Catra's mouth to hers.

Adora felt Catra's smooth hands under her shirt, moving toward her chest. They usually go braless on their days off, because why not experience vast comfort in their own home and thankfully, today was no different. Catra stopped just below the swell of Adora's breasts. She broke away from the kiss and looked into Adora's eyes as she moved her palms across Adora's breasts.

Adora's breath hitched as Catra's skilled hands palmed her breasts. She arched her back into the sensation and held on to Catra's toned arms. She could feel the moisture that had collected between her legs. "Mmmm, Catra," she moaned.

Catra pulled Adora back down to her to continue their kiss. Their hands continued to explore each other's bodies; their shared arousal had more than fogged up the windows. Adora reached down to her shorts, undid the button, and leaned back, grinding her ass into Catra's lap. As much as they needed more space, their movements and touches became desperate.

Catra moved her hand between Adora's thighs, gently rubbing the crotch of Adora's shorts. She had only dreamed of the warmth that she would find. Their passionate kisses continued as Catra's fingers pressed into Adora.

Adora responded with a loud moan. Every drop of moisture left her mouth. She wanted to feel more of Catra. Reaching down, she unzipped her shorts and pushed the front down, looking at Catra. "Please."

The scent alone was overwhelming for Catra. She had briefly experienced this scent before but couldn't pinpoint what it was. There was no doubt now, and she wanted more of it. Without hesitation, she adjusted her arm to allow her fingers to slip between the soaked underwear and Adora's wet lips, pausing momentarily before making contact.

As soon as her fingers touched the wetness, they both moaned. Adora leaned further back as Catra's soft fingertips gently trailed up the length of her slit. "Oh god." She sighed and closed her eyes. Moving her hips with the motions of Catra's fingers, she rested her weight on the steering wheel behind her.

HOOOOOOONNNKK.

They both froze, looked at each other, and laughed.

"What are we even doing? We're at our house. Let's go inside," Catra laughed.

They tried to get out of the driver's side door, which proved to be much more complicated than they thought. Adora ended up falling onto the driveway, reaching up to Catra, laughing. "Why are we like this?" Their laughs intensified.

They eventually made their way to the porch, and without a light, it made unlocking the door tricky. Catra attempted to look through her keys by feeling alone as Adora kissed her neck and palmed her breasts. "Oh, Adora, you're making it hard to open the door."

"Good." She knelt in front of Catra, unbuttoning her pants as she kissed her stomach.

Catra could only stand in place, trying to brace herself on the door frame. She ran her hands over Adora's hair as Adora's fingers

explored. "Adora…" she moaned.

Adora pulled Catra's zipper down and kissed where the soft curls started. Holding Catra's underwear down a bit, she kissed her way closer to Catra's center.

As much as Catra wanted to feel Adora's tongue on her right this second, they couldn't do this on their porch. The last thing she wanted to hear about tomorrow was the angry neighbors complaining about their adventures in their front yard. "Adora, wait. Let's get inside. The neighbors…" Adora, reluctantly stood up and helped Catra locate the correct key.

Once inside, Catra threw her keys on the table and shut the door. Adora grabbed the hem of Catra's shirt and pulled it over her head, then removed her own. Adora grabbed Catra's face with both hands, kissing her deeply. They stumbled over to the couch and fell on it diagonally.

Catra kissed Adora's neck, and she rubbed her over her shorts. Making her way down Adora's chest, she kissed and licked around her sensitive nipples. Adora whimpered with each light placement of Catra's lips, which became more acute as she moved closer to her center.

Every touch felt amazing, Adora could feel her desire rise. She felt high. Catra’s gentle fingers knew exactly where to touch her. She couldn’t help but moan.

When Catra reached Adora's shorts, she kissed across her stomach and hooked her fingers into the garment’s band. "Can I?" She asked. Adora responded by lifting her butt to allow her shorts and underwear to be easily removed; she then spread her legs, a silent invitation to Catra.

Catra had dreamed of this moment for her entire adult life. She imagined what Adora would taste like, how she would feel, how she would sound. Sitting in front of Adora, she took in every inch of Adora's exposed body. Catra ran her fingers over Adora's neatly

trimmed pubic hair, letting them gingerly trace her folds. Adora’s slick had coated her outer lips; she was soaked. As much as Catra wanted to revel in this forever, she couldn't wait another minute; she had to taste Adora. Slowly, she lowered her mouth to Adora's sex.

Adora whimpered as Catra lightly blew on her. "Catra…"

With one swift stroke, Catra tasted the entire length of Adora's slit.

That was almost all that Adora needed to come. Grabbing the couch cushions, she groaned as a wave of pleasure floated over her. Catra's soft tongue felt so good. It gently moved over her clit, bringing a constant stream of gratification. She was so riled up that it wouldn't take long.

Catra looked up at Adora as she slowly licked her clit. The muscles of Adora’s torso flexed and released as her tongue lay flat against the sensitive nub, moving up and back again. The way Adora tasted was similar to other people she had been with, but it was unique, and she knew it would soon become a craving.

Adora's hips were moving with each stroke; she grabbed the back of the couch. "Catra, you feel so good," she moaned. She watched intently as Catra expertly licked her. Adora could hear Catra moan as she gently indulged, her brow furrowed. It was the single hottest thing she had ever seen. Adora’s moans were getting closer together and her grip on the couch tighter. She threw her head back as her orgasm rushed through her. "Ahhhhh."

Catra slowed her tongue while Adora *very* slowly came down. She could feel the intensity of Adora's orgasm. Adora was so sensitive; her muscles were still contracting as she worked through the aftershocks. She lay on the couch, occasionally twitching and grabbing the fabric of the couch. Her moans softened.

"Catra…" Adora melted into the couch.

Catra moved up onto the couch to lightly run her fingers over Adora's body. "How are you doing?"

"That felt so good." Adora covered her face with her hands, she could feel Finn rubbing on her legs, and there was no way she was going to deal with that right now. "Can we move to my room?"

Catra looked down at Finn. "Good idea."

Catra stood up and held her hand out for Adora. "I'm gonna grab some water; I'll meet you there." As Adora walked to her room, Catra filled a glass of water. When she was sure that Adora was in her room, she grinned and did a little dance. Not only did Adora have feelings for her, but they just...they just had sex! And that was just the beginning. *Wow. WOW!* She refilled the glass and headed to Adora's room.

When Catra entered, Adora was lying under her comforter, waiting for Catra. "Hi." She walked over to the bed and handed Adora the glass of water, which she quickly drank. Pulling her pants off, she slipped under the covers and cuddled up to Adora, who quickly started kissing her.

Adora moved her hand down Catra's body as their mouths intertwined. She slowed and moved her fingers through the short path of curly hair above Catra's sex. "Can I do that to you too? I know you don't really like it..."

Catra looked up at Adora, "Yes," and nodded. "I actually *really* like it. I just like giving a bit more."

Adora smiled and moved her hand over Catra's center. Nervousness was starting to set in. She had a general idea of what she was doing; she had read enough romance novels to have some sense of how to touch Catra. Masturbation wasn't foreign to her; she was able to bring herself to orgasm relatively quickly, most of the time with the help of the thoughts of Catra.

But, this was the real thing. What if Catra hated it? What if Catra couldn't come?

Catra could tell Adora was in her head. "Hey, where did you go?"

"I'm nervous."

"That's okay. We can do whatever you're comfortable with. I've really enjoyed myself so far. Come here." Catra pulled Adora close to her and kissed her forehead. "Do you want to keep going?"

Adora wanted to feel Catra and touch her in all the ways she just experienced. She was mostly looking forward to tasting her. "I do," she nodded.

Catra smiled and kissed her. "Do what feels natural. I'll help guide you."

Adora nodded and started kissing Catra's chest and moved her hand back over Catra's sex. Looking down at Catra, she parted her folds and moved her fingers through the slick. She moaned as Catra breathed in sharply. "Yeah, move your fingers around like that. You can gently circle my…" She moaned when Adora's fingers started to gingerly circle her clit.

Adora was a quick study. The way Adora's fingers felt on her was better than she could have imagined. For a moment, Catra had to remind herself that this was actually happening. It wasn't a dream; it wasn't a fantasy she floated to while doing a mindless task. Adora's fingers were touching her, caressing her, arousing her.

Catra grabbed the sheets as Adora slid two fingers inside. "Oh fuck."

Adora watched in awe as Catra threw her head back and moaned with each plunge of her fingers. Catra was so wet; her fingers easily slid inside. Adora watched Catra's body move and her

muscles tighten. She wanted to taste Catra, but she didn't want to stop, and Catra was *really* enjoying this.

Catra was trying to hold off her orgasm. She didn't want to come as fast her first time with Adora. But it felt so good. She was getting so close, and quick. "Adora, faster."

Adora couldn't help but groan at the request.

Catra's moans grew louder. "Curl your fingers a little." She pushed down on Adora's fingers.

Adora felt Catra's walls tighten around her fingers. Catra was barely able to speak. "Oh god, just like that." Her hips bucked as she grunted.

A few seconds later, Catra grabbed Adora's arm and slowed her movements. "Mmm. Adora. That...wow." She laid her head down on the pillow. "You can slowly pull your fingers out."

Adora slid her fingers out and looked at her slick-covered digits. *Wow.* With wonder in her eye, she brought them to her mouth but Catra spoke and she paused. She wanted to taste Catra's spendings, but would have to wait.

"Come cuddle me," Catra mumbled.

Adora laid next to Catra and wiped her fingers on her comforter.

She moved her head to Catra's chest, hearing her deep heartbeat. "I've wanted to do that with you for a while." She felt closer to Catra than she ever had before. There was no doubt in her mind that they were not *just friends* anymore. She wondered what it would be like after this. Would she always wake up and make Catra breakfast? Could she hold Catra's hand freely in public now? What would their friends say?

Catra kissed the top of Adora's head. "I have too."

Hearing that brought a massive smile across Adora's face. *She has thought about this too?* And another wave of arousal surged through Adora's body. The idea that they could do this in the future was exciting; they already lived together after all, and were always with each other. Movie nights were going to be a little different from now on. Adora pushed herself up from the bed. "Catra?"

"Yeah, 'Dor?"

"Will you do that thing with your tongue again?"

Catra smirked and gently rolled Adora onto her back.

Catra opened her eyes. She was still in Adora's room. Last night was not a dream. She and Adora had not only kissed but also *had sex.* That was the last thing that she thought would happen. She was sure that there would have been an awkward and uncomfortable conversation about what had been happening that would lead them to part into their rooms for the night. Possibly not having much interaction for the next few days while they figured out how to interact and not let their conversation bother them.

But, the opposite happened. Adora had confessed her attraction to Catra and that she wanted to kiss her. *Whoa!* To say that Catra was on cloud nine was not even close. She was ecstatic. She was elated. She was over the moon. She was feeling less and less nervous about telling Adora how much she...loved her. But the last thing she wanted to do was scare Adora away. They had just *found* each other even though they have been friends for decades. She didn't want to do anything to endanger that.

Catra turned around and reached over to Adora. "Hey 'Dor."

The bed was empty.

The feeling of a cold, empty bed was jarring. Catra was not expecting that, especially not after last night. Where was Adora? *Maybe she had to work early. She told Bow she had an early morning last night.* Uneasiness surged through Catra. Even if Adora had to work early, waking up to an empty bed after the night they had, was not easy. Her ears folded back.

Catra suddenly felt like a stranger in Adora's room. She picked up her clothes from the floor before walking out. She had no idea where her phone was. As she walked past the desk to open the door, she saw the novel she was missing with a bookmark more than halfway through. *Ahhh, there it is.* This little discovery made her smile. She had only wished that she knew sooner; there were so many books she'd love to share with Adora.

She walked to the bathroom, then to her room to get dressed. "Adora, are you home?" She didn't smell food cooking or hear Finn meowing for breakfast. The house seemed still. Almost like no one lived in it. There was an unnerving feeling that crept through her body as she walked into the front room, looking for her phone and Adora. The front room was empty, aside from their clothes thrown about from the night before.

She crossed her arms across her chest and started biting her lip. Her tail was quickly swinging behind her. *Maybe she left a note!* Her ears perked up, and she quickly made her way to the kitchen, looking first at the counter, then to the table. But, like the front room, the kitchen was empty. No note. No overnight oats. No phone. Finn had been fed and lay curled up on one of the kitchen chairs. *Maybe she texted?* Catra grabbed her keys and went outside to look in her car for her phone. As she looked under the seat, she remembered. *We didn't drive my damn car last night.* She sat in the seat with her head back on the headrest. Worry was starting to set in. She looked over and saw the empty space that usually parked Adora's white Subaru.

Walking back into the house, she set her keys down and stood in the empty house, feeling completely and utterly alone.

Chapter End Notes

Their journey begins.

Busy day

Chapter Summary

Adora spends the day worrying. (Adora POV)

Chapter Notes

There is a lot of angst in this chapter. We are at the super angsty part in the story. But, like all things, it will pass.

Enjoy!

Adora's eyes open. It was still dark. She looked for her phone to see if she still had time to sleep, before her alarm went off. Lifting her phone, the bright light forced her to close her eyes. She pulled the phone away from her face and slowly opened her eyes. It was 6:30 am. *Fuck!* She should have been up an hour ago to open the testing center. Moving the blanket off of her, she looked down to see she was naked. There was no time to shower, and she had a long day ahead of her. Not only was she late to opening the testing center, but she also had a test for her Abnormal Psychology class.

She felt the bed move and snapped her head to look. Catra lay naked next to her. She had kicked the blankets off during the night and was rolled into what resembled a ball. *Oh shit. Oh shit.* How could she have forgotten that they had sex last night? She couldn't deal with this right now. She had to get to work.

Slowly getting out of bed, she slipped on a clean pair of underwear, shirt, and jeans. *Where are my damn shoes?* She found a pair of sandals; it was a good thing they didn't have a dress code at the testing center; she slipped them on. Almost forgetting her phone, she walked back toward the bed and stood for a second watching Catra sleep, wanting to bend down and kiss her. *Would that be weird?*

She admitted that she had no idea what the protocol was after you had sex with someone and they were sleeping in your bed, especially when that person was your best friend with whom you owned a house. The person you cared about the most in the world. *I love you, Catra.* Looking at her phone, she quickly ran out of the room. She barely had enough time to park, unlock the doors, and start the computers before the testing center opened. Hopefully, Octavia was there to help her. *Why don't I have Octavia's number?* Before she left, she poured some food into Finn's dish. *Let Catra sleep in, okay buddy?* She grabbed her keys and ran to her car.

"Okay, you are on computer 35. Good luck." After sending the last student off to their test, Adora turned to Octavia and Kyle. "I'm so glad you were both here this morning. I'm so sorry I was late. I had a…" She blushed and rubbed the back of her head. "A busy night studying, and I forgot to set an alarm. I'm really sorry."

"It's okay, Adora. I do that too sometimes." Kyle smiled and took a student's notepaper as they left the exam room.

"Yeah, girl, it's not even a big deal. You're always on time and have covered for us more times than I can count." Octavia walked into the testing room to make her rounds.

Adora pulled out her phone. Catra still had not texted her, and the message was green, not blue. *Did she turn her phone off?* It was almost noon, and she had not heard anything from her. Was she upset that Adora left without saying goodbye? Was Adora's nervousness last night a big turn off and she didn't want to do anything like that again? Did their relationship change, and now they would text less? She slipped her phone back into her pocket. Her heart sank.

She sat for a few moments, zoning out before the next student walked up to take their exam. Without looking up, she asked, "What's your student number?"

"Um...2774653"

The voice sounded oddly familiar, she looked up, and Ben was standing in front of her. She stood frozen in place.

"Uh...hi. I um…" he mumbled.

She moved away from the computer and quickly walked out of the testing center. Kyle yelled to her, but she didn't hear a word he said. Adora walked as fast as she could to the closest bathroom, her chest was tight, and she struggled to get air in. She stumbled into a stall and sat on the toilet, trying to regulate her breathing. *Everything is okay. He can't find you in here. Just breathe.*

Where was Catra? She needed her so badly. Why wasn't she talking to her? What changed? She started to spiral. *Catra.* Leaning back on the cold wall, she looked at the ceiling fan and focused on the sound. Tears began to run down her face. If she thought that Catra would stop talking to her after they...she never would have done it. It wasn't worth the risk of losing her. How could she go home now? Would Catra treat her differently?

She pulled her phone out, hoping that Catra had texted her back. Nothing. No notifications. No messages. Silence. Would it be weird to call Catra? They were best friends and called one another from time to time. But, things were different now. Catra hasn't texted her back today; maybe she needed time to process what happened.

She pulled up Catra's contact and pressed the call icon. The screen changed and started counting the length of the call. She put the phone on her ear, biting her nails, not knowing what to expect. She wanted to hear Catra's voice, but her nerves were making it hard to focus. The call went straight to voicemail. Adora's cheeks warmed at the sound of Catra's voicemail. The words were so familiar and foreign at the same time. It felt like the first time she had heard them. Then she listened to the beep. She wasn't ready for it, and sure as hell didn't know what to say.

"Uh...hey...Catra. I haven't heard from you today and I...uh...just wanted to say hi...to you. Text me back. Bye."

She held her face in her hands. *Well, that was awkward.*

She opened her messages and started to text Glimmer.

Adora [11:23 am]: *Glimmer, I'm pretty sure I'm gay.*

Adora [11:23 am]: *Something...happened, and now Catra won't talk to me. It's really bad. Can I come over after I take my test?*

Adora [11:24 am]: *Please.*

She sat there after she sent the texts. She had forgotten entirely about Ben for a few moments, but that quickly changed when she looked at the stall she was sitting in. What was she going to do now? Go back to the testing center and have to see Ben taking the same damn test that she had to take in a few hours? Her emotions were quickly changing from sadness to anger. *Why should I have to hide from that asshole? I didn't do anything wrong. He is the one with the damn problem.* She left the stall and marched right back to the testing center.

Adora asked Kyle if she could monitor the exam room. He agreed to the switch. She walked into the room and made her rounds. Keeping her eye on Ben, she walked around and sat at the watchtower a few feet from the computer he was taking his test on. He looked up and caught her leer and quickly looked back down. She sat there for several minutes, staring at him. Each time he looked up, she was watching him.

A few moments later, he stood up, didn't bother pushing in his chair, and walked out. She followed him and stood at the post-test collection station. "I'll take your notes."

He didn't look up. He pushed his paper across the counter and walked out as fast as he could. He forgot to grab his backpack from the cubby and had to come back in. Adora watched him as he stumbled to get his bag and continued to avoid her gaze.

Her shift was finally over. She had to study for a bit before taking the exam, but she had a place she liked to go. Her favorite quiet corner on that floor was empty like usual. She sat her bag down and pulled out a few of the snacks she kept just in case. This was not the best scenario for her to take a test, as she didn't eat breakfast and felt nauseous all day. But, she had to eat something before studying.

The granola bar she pulled out had a note attached. "Have a good day at work." It was one of the prepped snacks that she had left for Catra a few days ago. She never knew which flavor Catra would want, so she left a note on both, just in case. This was the first time that she wished she hadn't. She tossed the bar back in the bag and sighed.

After she read over her notes and did a round of flashcards, she was ready to take her test on, oddly enough, anxiety disorders. She walked back to the testing center, put her bag in one of the cubbies, and signed in.

When she was finished, she pulled her phone out of her bag and checked her messages.

Glimmer [2:45 pm]: *Is everything okay? I haven't heard from Catra all day. Is she alright?*

Glimmer [2:46 pm]: *What happened? I get off at 5 and will be home a few mins after. You can stop by anytime.*

Adora walked to her car. She felt dizzy and didn't want to drive to Glimmer's. After she opened her door, she sat in her car in silence. *What do I say to Glimmer? Do I tell her everything?* Not moving for a few minutes, her stomach started to feel queasy. *What is that smell?* She rolled down her window and looked around her car, finding the bag of pizza that Bow had sent them home with last night. *Fuck.*

The smell was terrible. She grabbed the bag, walked back to the testing center, and threw the bag in the trash. *How could today get any worse?* As she walked to her car, her phone rang. It was an unknown caller. *Oh great. Ben calling to harass her or say sorry for being a jerk?* She rejected the call and texted Glimmer.

Adora [5:13 pm]: *I'm on my way from school.*

She sighed and slid her phone back into her pocket. The drive to Glimmer and Bow's apartment was grueling. She continued to ruminate on the night before. She had never felt closer to Catra, and they fell asleep in each other's arms after they had *sex.* Did this not mean anything to Catra? Her eyes welled up with tears. She didn't want this to be a mistake; she wanted it to be the start of something more.

Arriving at the apartment complex's parking lot, she found a parking space a few buildings over from Glimmer and Bow's. She grabbed her book bag and walked up to their door. Standing in front of the door for several minutes, she tried to muster the courage to knock. *Well, I can't go home.* She lifted her hand to knock. The door swung open.

"Oh, Adora! You're here. I'm just gonna throw out the trash." Glimmer walked past Adora.

"Okay." Adora stood there with her arms crossed. She tried to hold back the tears, but she couldn't. Tears dripped onto her forearms as Glimmer walked back to the door.

"Oh, honey. Come sit down." Glimmer placed her hand on Adora's shoulder.

They walked into the apartment; Adora set her backpack down on the table and sat next to Glimmer. "She won't talk to me." Adora couldn't stop the tears and covered her face with her hands.

Glimmer sat rubbing Adora's shoulder. "Do you want to tell me what happened?"

Adora dropped her hands in her lap and lifted her head. "We…" She couldn't say it out loud. What would Glimmer think? Maybe she could just say they had a fight, or that Catra was mad at her. Glimmer didn't need to know everything.

"Let me get you a tissue." Glimmer grabbed the box of tissues in the kitchen and set them next to Adora.

Adora grabbed a tissue and blew her nose. "Thank you." She sighed and looked at Glimmer. It wouldn't be good to lie to Glimmer, because she would eventually find out and it would just make things more messy. "We had sex, Glimmer."

Glimmer's eyes widened. This is not at all what she expected to hear. *Holy shit.* She was hardly surprised that they did finally have sex, but wow. "Oh, honey."

"And now she won't talk to me." Adora snuffled. "I texted her this morning because I woke up late for work, and she still hasn't texted me back. The message is green. So her phone must be off...or she blocked me." She pulled her phone out and handed it to Glimmer. "I just don't get it. Last night was so...it was so wonderful. I felt so close to her."

Glimmer looked through the messages. It was unusual for Catra not to answer Adora's texts, even if she was at work. She usually replied when she took a break. Even Glimmer knew that sometimes Catra's texts were slow, but she always texted back. "Let me try to get a hold of her." She pulled out her phone.

Glimmer [6:01 pm]: *Hey Catra, I haven't heard from you today. Is everything alright?*

The message was slow to send and quickly turned green. "Hmm, it turned green for me too. Maybe we should drive over there and see if she's alright?"

"No! I can't. What if she doesn't want to see me, and then we go over there, and she's upset?" Tears started to run down her cheeks.

"You live there, Adora. She can't keep you from your own home." Glimmer placed her hand on Adora's knee. "Can I ask Bow to drive by on his way home? He can see if her car is there and lights are on."

"I guess." Adora fell back onto the couch.

"We should at least check to make sure she's okay. To make sure something hasn't happened to her. Like maybe she fell?" Glimmer texted Bow.

Bowie 💘 [6:09 pm]: *Hey honey, can you stop by Adora's and Catra's and make sure Catra is okay? No one has heard from her today. Adora is here, and we are getting worried.*

"Are you hungry?" Glimmer turned back to Adora.

"Yeah, I tried to eat earlier, but I just felt sick." Adora curled up on her side.

Glimmer walked into the kitchen, "I was planning on making spaghetti; it should only take a few minutes to boil th-"

"NO! Please no pasta." She held herself tighter; she missed Catra even more. *I hope she's okay.* Adora felt lower than she had all day. The lack of food, stress from work, and the hole in her heart were wearing on her. All she wanted was to cuddle with Catra to help comfort her. But, what do you do when the person who you usually turn to for support is the one that has hurt you? She covered her face and started to cry again.

Bow turned down Adora and Catra's street and parked on the opposite side when he reached their house. The driveway was empty, and the lights were off, including the porch light. He had never seen the house that lifeless. Reaching for his phone, a set of headlights turned the corner in front of him, then turned into the driveway. It was Catra's Black Prius, but no one emerged from the car for a number of minutes. Bow called Glimmer.

"Is she home?" Gimmer asked without saying hello.

"Yeah, it looks like she just pulled in. She hasn't gotten out of the car yet."

"Oh, maybe she was at work then."

"Wait... she's getting out. Yeah, it's Catra. Okay, she walked into the house." Bow said softly, not knowing why he was lowering his voice. He was alone in his car.

"Thanks, Bow. Can you pick up something for dinner? Maybe burgers or something?" Glimmer's voice had a bit of worry in it.

"Of course, honey. Is Adora doing okay?"

"Let's talk about it when you get home. I love you."

"Love you too."

After they ate, Adora walked over to the couch and sat down. "Can I stay here tonight?"

Glimmer looked at Bow; Adora was hurting. "Of course you can. Let me get you some blankets and pillows."

"Thank you." Adora laid back and let the tears come. It was no use trying to control them; they were going to come regardless of how hard she tried. She was glad that Catra was okay, but she wished she was home with her now. *Catra.* Her heart ached; it felt like someone had punched her in the stomach, her muscles felt weak. *Catra.*

Glimmer returned with a pair of pajama bottoms, a few blankets, and a pillow. "Here. If you need anything, please come wake us up; we'll leave our door open for you." She sat next to Adora, "Things are going to be okay. I know they don't seem like it now.

But, things are going to work out." She laid her hand on Adora's side. "Good night Adora."

Adora laid there, not moving or saying anything. She had to pee but didn't want to get up. When Glimmer and Bow went to bed, she sat up, staring blankly into the darkness. *Catra.* She got up and went to the bathroom to change. Her body felt like dead weight; she finished changing and went back to the couch to adjust her pillow and blanket. She hoped that she could fall asleep. *Catra.* The tears came again.

Quiet

Chapter Summary

Catra spends the day at work worrying. (Catra POV)

Chapter Notes

This is ANGSTY. This is THE hardest chapter of the entire story. It's going to hurt, hang in there we'll get through it. This is a love story and sometimes things are tough, but they don't stay tough.

Also, I do love comments and feedback. Some of the comments on the last few chapters have been really mean. Please remember that there is a human person behind the screen who is putting a lot of time and effort into this. It's okay to not like something, you just don't need to be mean about it. This is a hobby and a form of self-care for me. When it stops bringing me joy, I stop doing it. Please be mindful.

Catra walked around the house looking for a clock, without her phone she had no idea what time it was. She had to go to work at noon and would like to be on time. *Why don't we have any damn clocks?* The stove's time couldn't be right; it wasn't 6:37 am. The sun was already out, and people were out mowing their lawns. She didn't realize how reliant they were on their phones. *Maybe I should buy a clock today.*

My laptop! She quickly went to her room, throwing open the door, looking first in her bag. *Not here*. The thorough cleaning she had given her room the day before made it easy to search for her computer. But, it was nowhere to be found. She walked out into the front room and came up with nothing. *Adora must be using it for school.* She stomped to the front door.

Picking up her keys, she went to check the time on her car's clock. The empty space next to her car was still unnerving, but

Adora was probably just working. There was no use in worrying about things she couldn't control. But, the upset stomach she had had all morning was making that difficult. It was 10:30 am; she needed to shower and get ready for the day. Maybe her phone would pop up somewhere, or Adora would find it when she came home later. *Everything is going to be fine.*

Catra had to eat something before she went to work. She didn't feel hungry, but it would be a long, hard shift if she was low on energy. Looking through the cabinets and the fridge, she didn't see anything that sounded at all appetizing. They did have a box of cereal. She could usually eat cereal at any time, so she grabbed it.

The cereal was unsurprisingly easy to eat. As soon as the cinnamon hit her tongue, she realized how hungry she really was. She had a busy day at work - inventory started today, and they were doing the prep work in the large sections and backroom. Lucky for her, they could count everything in the backroom and input it into the system early. Everything else had to be individually scanned after the store closed in a few days.

Catra was more than thankful that she didn't have to stay after work to do inventory. She usually would have to stay until three or four in the morning, and that would be terrible with how things were between her and Adora. Hopefully, they would be able to talk when she got off of work.

She stood up from the table and set her dish in the sink. *Time to shower.* Making her way to the bathroom, she stopped to look at their clothes from last night sprawled all over the floor in the front room. She popped over to pick them up, laughing to herself. *Wow.* The couch was in disarray. With how Adora was grabbing it, Catra was surprised they still had a couch. She went to pick up Adora's pants, and her mind was flooded with thoughts of Adora from the night before. The image of Adora splayed out on the couch sent a jolt of arousal through her. She wished she had her phone to text Adora about the state of the couch. Or is that weird? Were they still *just friends* or officially more?

She bent down to adjust the couch and fix the cushions that were probably permanently crinkled. What a story that would be to tell friends. *Oh, that's where we first had sex and figured out that we liked each other as more than friends.* Sex. They had sex. She started to salivate and caught herself before she fell too deep into the fantasy. *Okay. Shower. Definitely cold.*

After she finished getting dressed, she tossed a load of laundry in the washer. Their laundry basket was overflowing after the addition of their clothes from the night before. *Adora can switch this when she gets home.* She walked to the kitchen to look in the fridge for something to bring to work for lunch. *Didn't Bow give us a bunch of pizza last night?* Not finding anything she could easily make at work, she thought to leave a note for Adora in case she came home much earlier than Catra.

Hey Adora,

I can't find my phone. Can you look in your car? I think it may have fallen out when we were trying to get out of the car last night. Lol. Will you come by my work with my phone? I'd like to see you. I missed you this morning. I hope you had a good day at work, and I'll see you when I get home around 930.

And will you switch the laundry?

Your Catra

Catra grabbed her keys on the way out the door and hoped that she would see Adora in a few hours.

As soon as Catra walked into work, she was bombarded with questions from employees. They had sold out of all the She-Ra merchandise, and people were calling to put copies on hold. Their

next shipment wouldn't be here for a few more days, and people were unhappy. The response to this new She-Ra series was much more tenacious than she expected. It was refreshing to see such a community built around positive queer representation.

When Catra was young, there were no positive queer role models on tv or in books. It took her a while to even figure out what word described her experience. Well into her teens, she finally heard the term 'lesbian,' and it just fit. She just had to figure it out on her own. It would have been nice to have any sort of reference, but she managed as well as possible. She was happy to see the younger generations have more access to all things queer.

One of the first things she did as the new owner of the bookstore was to create a *Friends of Mara* section. It was popular from day one, and her employees seemed to add new books weekly that even Catra hadn't heard of.

She had been going to this book store for years and saw that the previous owners were going to retire. She acted. They were planning on liquidating, but she offered to buy the store instead, and surprisingly they accepted. Tomorrow would be her first inventory since the change in ownership, and after that, she would have a better idea of what changes could be made. She was sitting on many different products, and there were a few projects that the previous owners started but never finished. Seeing all of the possibilities, there were so many projects that she wanted to complete. So, every day was an adventure.

Catra was happy that she would be in the backroom all day; she didn't feel up to dealing with anyone. All she wanted to do was distract herself from thinking about Adora. She had done a good job so far at calming her nerves, but as the hours passed, she was getting increasingly nervous with Adora's lack of communication.

The day before, she had sorted all of the boxes of product from the backroom into manageable groups. Now all she had to do was go through every. Single. One. She turned on some music. *Let's do this.* She held up the first book and marked it off the list.

Several hours and boxes in, she was ready for a break. There were a lot more random products than she expected. She thought about doing a sort of giveaway to get rid of some of the items and generate some more traffic on the weekends. Looking through another box of random things, she found some promotional items from a sci-fi book released a few years ago, including a clock. So, it looked like she would have a way to tell the time when technology wasn't available. Well, aside from batteries. Chuckling, she walked out of the back room.

She had a few items from her discovery to show her employees; they were thrilled at the treasures. They each chose one to take home. Most of her employees were younger, and they had never seen some of the items that she found. Not that she had one foot in the grave, but she had several years on them and enjoyed their responses to things they didn't grow up with. Nostalgia was powerful, that was for sure.

That familiar feeling of hunger rumbled in her stomach. "Hey, I'm gonna run across the street to grab some dinner. Anyone want anything?"

Everyone waved her off or said no. A few of the employees were on a health and wellness journey and would bring prepared meals every day; that was something she wanted to try. Maybe she and Adora could do some meal prep this weekend? It sure would make lunch easy each day. Reaching to grab her phone, she was met with an empty pocket. *Ugh. Where is Adora? She should be home by now.* The anxiety that had been building was reaching a breaking point. Her cool, calm demeanor was starting to crack.

It was a pleasant day with light traffic, so the walk across the street was uneventful. She ordered her regular and stood waiting, taking in the area around her store. It was a cute part of town with a lot of old buildings and businesses. It was nice to see a random assortment of stores. Next to her bookstore was a game store, and next to that was a nickel arcade. She had thought about adding board games to her inventory. Especially with how many other game stores were in the area, she would have the

traffic already. Maybe she could do a joint promotion with the stores around her.

The arcade was busy today; it must be a school holiday. Sometimes on her breaks, she would walk over there and play a few games of pinball to ease her stress. *Maybe we can go on a date there.* She started to zone out, thinking about how cute Adora would be at an arcade. It was a little unusual that they had never been to an arcade before. She and Bow had been many times but never with Adora. Sometimes she could coax Adora into playing video games with her, and it was the most adorable thing. She always had a hard time figuring out the button layout, but Catra didn't stand a chance when she did. One of her favorite ways to pass the time was to start a new game, then work through it together. Catra would handle the controls, and Adora would help Catra figure out puzzles and where to go next.

She froze as her anxiety peaked. Were they dating? Or was it just sex? Was it a one-time thing that they would never talk about, like the kiss a few months ago? *Stop. Everything will be fine.* Not having her phone was a lot harder than she anticipated. She relied on it for almost everything, including podcasts, which she could listen to while she worked. Luckily, she found the radio the previous owners used and found a station with music she could tolerate.

She was starting to rationalize why Adora had not stopped by her work. *Maybe Adora had to work late. Sometimes, the testing center gets too busy, or someone calls in.* It was hard to figure out what to do with her hands without her phone. This felt strange because she wasn't the type of person to be on her phone much. But without it entirely, it was maddening.

Her order was called, and she grabbed it before waiting to cross the street. She saw a white Subaru pass that was like Adora's, and her heart started racing. But there was an entire family packed inside, and none of them were blonde. *Everything's fine. There is an explanation for all of this.* As soon as she got back to the store, she walked to the back room. She needed a minute to sit down.

Catra sat in her office chair and set her head back on the plushy material. Both of them get busy sometimes and can't text each other, or sometimes they come home late. There had been several times when the store was so busy that she couldn't respond to Adora's texts until right before she was headed home. Adora always understood. The testing center was sometimes understaffed, and Adora had to stay late or cover someone's shift when they were sick. And she couldn't have her phone while she was doing most of her job. *I should try calling her.*

Catra picked up the phone on her desk and dialed Adora's number. She felt like she was going to pass out. The nervousness that Adora wouldn't answer, mixed with the potential awkwardness of their first conversation after they...had sex, was a bit overwhelming. She started to tap her claws on the desk.

After one ring, Adora's voicemail started playing; one of Catra's employees walked into the back room.

"Hey, Catra? There is a customer here that's mad about one of the books they ordered. I think it's the wrong edition. Can you help? "

Catra sighed and hung up the phone. "Yes, of course." *Everything will be fine.*

Surprisingly, the upset customer was easier to deal with than she expected. The hidden gems Catra had found in the back room earlier that day had been a lifesaver. They had the edition the customer was looking for already, so another special order was not necessary. *I would never have thought that I would be so happy to be doing inventory this week.*

Opening the back room door, she saw that her food was sitting unopened. She knew that she needed to eat; it would help her anxiety, and then she could focus on the rest of these boxes before she left work in a few hours. She opened the take-out

container, revealing cheese enchiladas with a side of rice and beans. Oh, did it smell good. Grabbing the plastic cutlery, she quickly inhaled the meal.

When she had properly cleaned her plate, she sat back in her chair, wondering what she should do. Not that there was much she could do. She still didn't have her phone, Adora wasn't answering, and she hadn't stopped by the bookstore. As much as Catra was trying to remain calm, she couldn't keep the visage up anymore.

She felt dejected. Alone. Brokenhearted. She had no one to talk to. And the waiting was the worst part. Would she find Adora when she got home? Would she run up to Catra and hug her and kiss her? Would all her worries from the day melt away? Or would the house still be empty? Would it still be the dark, lifeless building she left this morning? The burnt-out porch light made the entire scene even worse. There wasn't even a light of hope coming from the house.

She laid her head on her crossed arms on the desk. Her emotions spilled out. The worry. The frustration. The sorrow. All of it. She cried for what seemed like an eternity. When every last tear had left her body, she pulled her head up and grabbed a few paper towels, wiping her face and blowing her nose. They were the roughest paper towels she had ever felt. *Let's definitely get new ones.* She ripped a few more off and cleaned off the desk. Nothing like the tears of a lesbian in love with her best friend, who just had sex with said best friend, and that best friend was not speaking to her to clean off a desk.

She looked back to the last half of the boxes she had to go through and sighed. *Busy work will help take my mind off of this.* Standing up and stretching her arms and shaking them out, she walked over to the closest box. This was her nightmare scenario. She and Adora finally expressed their feelings for each other, and then their friendship fell apart. She felt helpless.

———

She was on the last box when an employee came into the back room. "Hey Catra, there's someone here to see you."

Catra shot up, not caring what her employee thought, as she literally ran out. *She came. Everything is okay. She was just busy!* Slowing down as she got closer to the front of the store, an employee pointed to an aisle of shelves. She quickly walked and turned down the aisle, "Adora! You came. I was worri-"

She stopped in her tracks. It wasn't Adora. It was a woman that regularly came in to buy primarily books on the ocean. "Oh hey, Mermista! I haven't seen you around for a while." She tried her best not to seem wildly disappointed. Mermista was a good customer, and they generally had a flirty interaction. Which definitely helped. But not right now.

"Hi, I just came in to like pick up that book you ordered for me on rare shark species." Mermista ran her finger across the spines of books on a shelf next to her. "And I wanted to totally thank you personally. It wasn't an easy book to find. I appreciate you looking for it and tracking it down." She looked directly at Catra and turned her head slightly to the side. "We should hang out sometime or whatever. Maybe we could look at this book together." She took the receipt out of her book and wrote her number on it. "Text me sometime." Smiling, she winked and walked past Catra.

Catra stood motionless in the middle of the aisle, holding a receipt in the air. This should have given her quite a boost, but it just made her sad. Not only did she miss Adora, but now she felt guilty. But why? She was an adult who could flirt with cute women, and they could flirt back. She and Adora were not together, right?

Any other day this would have been more than welcome. She had been eyeing Mermista and wanting to make a move for some time, but now, things were very different. Holding up the receipt, she noticed that Mermista wrote her name with a heart as the *a* .

Catra shoved the piece of paper in her pocket, crossed her arms, and walked to the backroom.

Catra called up to the front end and asked if they needed help closing the store. They said no, and she finished looking over the last numbers from her pre-inventory count. *It seems like we are up a bunch of product. I hope it stays that way after we do the rest of the store.* She was hoping to either break even or have a surplus of product after inventory. Setting down her papers, she turned the computer off and walked out of the backroom.

After the store was locked, she waved to her employees and walked to her car. She was apprehensive. Not knowing what she would find at home, she took an extra moment before opening her car to regulate her breathing. *It's not going to be an easy conversation, but we need to have it.*

She was driving slower than usual. Even for a Prius driver, this was too slow. Wondering if Adora was home yet or if she was asleep, Catra rode in silence. The closer she got to their street, the faster her heart beat. Making a full and complete stop, she sat at the stop sign for a moment before turning. She almost drove past their house because the porch light was out and the driveway was empty. *She's not here.* Sighing, she pressed the park button and stared blankly at the front of the house. Tears welled up in her eyes. *She's gone.*

Turning off the car, she reluctantly got out and walked to the front door. It was all too easy to find her house key tonight, even in the darkness. When she opened the door, she was met with a dark, still house. You could hear a pin drop. She set her keys on the table and walked into the kitchen, double-checking the note she left. The last bit of hope left her body when she looked at the untouched piece of paper.

She walked into the front room and looked around at the empty room, stopping to look at the couch. Adora really wasn't coming home. What had happened between them shouldn't have happened, and now Adora was gone. Maybe she should stay in a

hotel or at Perfuma and Scorpia's, but it was already so late. Without her phone, it would be awkward to just show up at their doorstep. Her head dropped.

Tears started rolling down her cheeks; her body felt heavy. Her skin felt impossibly hot and cold simultaneously. She dropped to her knees and covered her face. Her heart ached. God did it ache. Wanting to scream, she moved her body weight onto her hands in front of her. She felt empty. Alone. Stupid. Why didn't she just say no to Adora the night before? All of this could have been avoided. She wailed as she rocked on her knees. "Adora…"

Confused

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra talk.

Chapter Notes

Oh gosh! It's happening, they are gonna talk. Get ready for some FLUFF. I think it's well deserved!

I hope you like the chapter and thanks for all the support!

When Catra's eyes opened, all she saw was darkness. Her back felt stiff and sore, her hip was numb, and her ear hurt. She groaned as she pushed herself up. *Where…* She felt disoriented. Taking a minute to take in her surroundings, she realized that she was on the hardwood floor of the front room. *Their* front room. She had no idea what time it was or how long she had been there. Finally standing up, Finn stood up from the little nook in Catra's legs they were sleeping in and stretched. She felt comforted by the fact that Finn had been lying with her.

Pulling herself up, she felt how dry her mouth was and walked into the kitchen. *Ugh.* She was so thirty. Grabbing a cup from the cupboard, she filled it with water from the sink. She held the cup to her lips, but the loneliness began to set in. Adora hadn't come home last night; Catra hadn't heard from her at all. She tried to drink, but she couldn't. Finally, setting the glass down, her head dropped, and tears streamed down her face. There had been many times that someone she went on a date with had stopped talking to her after. She had been ghosted by people in the past, even after a sexual experience. But, this was completely different. How could her best friend of her entire life just abandon her?

She yelled into the darkness. Trying to hold herself up on the counter, her legs felt weak. Her chest felt heavy; her head was throbbing. The constant flow of salty liquid from her eyes made it

difficult to see. Then, promptly, she pushed herself off the counter and wobbled to her room, falling on her bed and crying into her pillow. *Adora...*

"Adora? Are you hungry? Bow made some eggs." Glimmer sat next to Adora on the couch.

Adora groaned. She felt like crap. The couch was not very comfortable, and she kept waking up in the middle of the night looking for Catra. Her dreams were filled with moments of Catra rejecting her and moving out of their house. She could with certainty, say, that that was the worst night of sleep she had ever gotten.

"Bow is going to be working from home today. Whatever you need, he's here."

"I miss her, Glimmer." Adora further covered her face with the blanket. The sorrow overtook her. The one person she would call her soulmate had drifted away from her. Devastation wasn't a strong enough word.

"I know, honey." Glimmer placed her hand on Adora's head.

"I love her so much." Adora was starting to cry.

"I think you should go home and try to talk to her. You both truly care about each other, and I know you two can work it out." Glimmer rubbed Adora's head with her thumb. "You have both of us here if you need us. I would be more than willing to sit down with you and Catra to help with future conversations."

"Okay."

"Do you work today?"

"Yes, I close." Adora moved the blanket off her face and closed her eyes to the bright kitchen light. Her entire body felt heavy, like

she had fallen down a mountain. Her cheeks burned as she wiped the salty drops from her face.

"I think you should call into work and go talk to Catra." Glimmer stood up. "Make sure to eat first and text us after."

"Okay, you're right." Adora sat up and ran her hands through her hair.

"Bow left you a plate in the microwave, eat it and let Bow know when you are leaving. I told him a little bit about what was happening, but he does not know that you two had sex. So, that's up to you to tell him. All he knows is that you and Catra are having a hard time." Glimmer hugged Adora before she walked to the front door to leave for work.

Adora sat there for a moment before getting up to go to the bathroom. Glimmer had obviously decorated the room. It was full of purples, pinks, and silvers. It was an interesting collection of decor, but somehow it worked. Multiple towels hung near the shower. They were each embroidered with Bow and Glimmer's name. *Cute.*

Bow was in their home office, typing away on his laptop. Adora knocked on the open door, feeling like she was intruding. "Hey, Bow."

Bow immediately turned around. "How are you doing, Adora? I just made some eggs and left you some in the microwave." He pointed to his plate of food.

"I'm okay. Thank you for letting me stay here last night." Her words felt awkward.

"Of course. Whatever you need. Are you going to try and talk to Catra today?"

"Yeah, I'm going to eat then go home. I'm nervous, Bow." She covered her torso with her arm. She was unsure what exactly he knew about the situation and wasn't ready to tell him that they

had sex. Not that it was really any of his business, but it would help him understand why they were having such a hard time.

"That's understandable. I don't know everything that happened, but I know you two have a strong friendship, and you can work it out." Bow hugged Adora.

Adora laid her head on Bow's shoulder. "I really love her, Bow. I'm so worried about losing her."

"I'm sure that makes it harder." He hugged her tighter. "Whatever you need, I'm here. You're always welcome. We love you, Adora."

Adora sat in her car before pulling out of the apartment complex. *We can fix this. All we have to do is talk.* Her hands held the steering wheel tight, causing her knuckles to turn white. She took a breath and started the car. The drive from Bow and Glimmer's wasn't generally long; it was one of the benefits of the house she and Catra had bought. They were ten minutes away from their friends, and that was with traffic. But, today, the roads were clear. It was like, everyone knew that Adora was on her way to have probably the most difficult conversation she has ever had in her life. She tried not to think about everything that could go wrong. But, damn, was it hard. Focusing on how to start the conversation would prove to be much more helpful. Well, in theory.

All too quickly, she was at the stop sign to their street. Taking longer than needed to check for oncoming cars, she turned. Her blood pressure rose, she felt her vision start to blur. Shaking her head, she slowed to turn into the driveway. Catra's Prius was parked in her regular spot, and the house looked different. It looked unfamiliar. She had called this place home for the better part of a year, yet today it looked alien.

She shifted the car into park and undid her seat belt. Grabbing her wallet, her phone slipped out of her hand and fell between the seat and the door. *Ugh.* She opened the door and kneeled to feel

under the seat for the phone. She found it and pulled it out. But it wasn't her phone. It was Catra's. *Catra's phone has been in my fucking car this whole time?* She stood up, holding the device in her hand. *She didn't have her phone.* Quickly bending over to feel for her phone, she slammed the car door and ran up to the house. *She didn't have her phone!* She felt a jolt of exhilaration, realizing that Catra wasn't avoiding her.

Her hands were shaking, which was making it hard to open the door. She looked up and took a deep breath. *Calm down.* Looking back down at her hands, she found the key and slid it in the lock. She froze. *What if Catra was sitting on the couch? Or in the Kitchen? What should I say? What should I do?* Taking another shaky breath, she turned the key in the lock.

Catra woke up with a massive headache. How was it possible for her head to feel like this? Not wanting to open her eyes, she covered her face with her arm. Finn jumped up onto her bed and started nuzzling her and meowing. It looks like someone was hungry. *Ugh.* As much as she loved Finn, she didn't want to do anything today. Finn's sweet meows and purring made it hard to ignore. *Okay, let's get you fed.* She sat up and looked down to see she was still in her clothes from the day before. If she had to be awake and face the day, she could at least be comfortable.

Picking out some loose-fitting loungewear, she walked to the bathroom to throw her dirty clothes in the hamper and pee. She looked in the mirror as she washed her hands and saw how puffy and red her eyes were. *I'm gonna need some eye drops and something for this headache.* Looking in the drawers of the vanity, she didn't see any eye drops. *Must be in the kitchen drawer.* She picked up Finn and walked toward the kitchen.

Adora quietly sat her keys on the table next to the door, seeing that Catra's keys were already sitting there. The house was still,

there were no lights on, and Finn was nowhere to be found. She walked into the kitchen and set Catra's phone on the table. The morning sun shone through the kitchen windows, giving the room a cool, fuzzy glow. She could see the tiny particles of dust passing through the beams of light as she stood quietly. *Maybe some tea will help me relax?* Grabbing the kettle from the stove, she saw the note that Catra had left for her. She picked it up and read it. *She wasn't ignoring me.*

A rush of emotions flowed through her. The night they shared meant something to Catra, and she was expecting Adora to visit her at work. *Glimmer was right.* Running her fingers over the words, she felt comforted by them and incredibly remorseful. The excited conversations the morning after were missed, replaced only with sorrow and guilt. They could have been together last night. Cuddled. Kissed. Touched. Sighing, she picked the kettle up and filled it with water, setting it back on the stove. Before she sat down, she grabbed a few mugs and tea bags. *I hope Catra wakes up soon.*

She reread the note as the tea steeped. *Your Catra.* Seeing those words felt incredible. There was no other way to describe it. She hoped that Catra would want more from their night together, and it seemed like she did. A smile swept across her face as she stood up to toss the tea bags in the trash.

The sound of a door opening stopped her in her tracks. *She's awake. Oh fuck, she's awake.* Adora sat silently, not knowing what to do. Does she stand up and walk to Catra? Does she sit here and wait for Catra to come into the kitchen? Does she call for Catra? Instead, she sat paralyzed by excitement and apprehension.

Footsteps moved closer to the kitchen, and Adora looked toward the hallway. Panic had officially fully set in. Catra turned the corner holding Finn. Their eyes locked. "Hi," Adora said softly.

Catra immediately looked away and stepped back. Finn was starting to struggle, so she set the cat on the floor, who

immediately walked over to Adora and started rubbing her legs. She wanted to run out of the house and as far away from here as possible. But, her legs were frozen, she felt unable to move. Every worry she had pored over in the last 24 hours had pushed its way back to the surface. For the first time, she felt self-conscious to be around Adora. She felt naked even though she was fully dressed. Crossing her arms, she tried to hold back tears.

"I just found your phone in my car." Adora paused. "I-I didn't kno-" Her anxiety had peaked. She didn't know whether to keep trying to explain herself or to just sit there. They had never been in a situation like this in their entire friendship, and it felt terrible.

Catra didn't look over or say anything. Instead, her ears were folded back, and her tail was sharply waving behind her. It was quite apparent that she was upset.

"I didn't know your phone was in my car. I tried calling you and texting you, but the messages just turned green." Adora explained, her voice was quickly becoming more dejected.

Catra wanted to be mad; she was done being sad. She had cried enough in the last twenty-four hours for both of them. But, her love for Adora held fast. She couldn't stand there listening to Adora, who was clearly panic-stricken and not want to hold her. With tears in her eyes, she kept her head turned away and softly spoke. "Why didn't you come home last night?"

"I…" Adora's heart sank. Hearing the pain in Catra's voice was heartbreaking. She never wanted to ever hear Catra's voice sound like that. Catra was usually able to keep her cool in challenging situations, but Adora could hear the anguish. She had honestly thought that Catra was ignoring her. Would Catra understand if she explained? "I...thought you weren't talking to me, and things would be weird if I came home." Her eyes focused on Catra.

It was now or never. They had spent a very intimate night together, and Catra had to be honest with her feelings. It was their only chance to salvage their relationship. And whatever came

of it would happen regardless. Catra started crying; she struggled to speak. "I missed you so much, Adora. When I woke up, you were just gone. There was no note. Nothing. I felt so stupid." Her headache got worse by the second.

"I'm so sorry, Catra." Adora stood up. "I forgot to set an alarm because…" She scratched the back of her head. "You know." She could feel her cheeks warm. "I woke up late and had to get to work to open the center." She took a step toward Catra, who was still turned away. She wanted to reach out and hug Catra. To hold her and show her that she's here, now.

Catra was trying not to beat herself up over what Adora just said. She knew that Adora had to work, and a series of random events led to this miscommunication. But it still hurt, and it hurt badly. A few moments passed, and Catra finally spoke. "I'm sorry. I had no idea where my phone was. I tried calling you last night when I was at work, but an employee came to get me because of a mad customer and…" She looked up at Adora. "I'm so sorry you thought I was ignoring you. I wasn't. I thought you were upset that we…" She was nervous to say it, almost as if by saying they had sex, she would bring a curse upon them.

Adora finished her sentence. "...had sex."

Catra looked at the ground nervously and wiped her face. "Had sex."

Adora walked over to Catra. "Can I hug you?" She wanted to hold Catra and kiss away the pain. This simpler misunderstanding had brought so much pain to both of them, and she wanted things to go back to normal. She was worried that Catra would push her away, but she knew Catra and was sure she would accept her.

Catra nodded and unfolded her arms. "Yes."

Adora's embrace brought life back into the house. Catra's worries melted away as the warmth of Adora's body pressed against hers. More tears rolled down her face, but they were happier tears.

Adora was here. With her. They were going to be okay. "I was so sad, Adora. I thought you hated me."

"I could never hate you, Catra. I love you." She sighed. "I always have." It was the most accurate statement she had ever said. She had loved Catra for such a long time and was finally able to share that with her. It was both exciting and terrifying.

"I love you too." The words flowed out of her mouth with ease. A weight lifted off her shoulders as each syllable left her lips. The years of therapy she went to to try and get over her feelings for Adora were for naught. As they both felt the same and now they could express it. It felt wonderful.

They stood there holding each other, running their hands over shoulders and backs. Finn had resorted to jumping on the counter and knocking things off to get attention.

"I guess we should feed *our* cat." She kissed Catra. "I missed you." It was a hard night, first for the tension between them and because she simply missed Catra. She missed her voice, the way she said *hey. Adora* , the way her tail moved depending on her mood and her soft ears. She usually slept better when she fell asleep to the sound of Catra's purr.

They placed their foreheads together. Finn's meows were becoming screeches.

Adora palmed Catra's cheek. "Your eyes are so puffy."

Catra looked away. "I-I've been sad."

"I'm so sorry, Catra." Adora hugged Catra again. "I'm so sorry."

Catra rested her head on Adora's shoulder, tears moving down her face. It hurt to cry. Her eyes were so irritated, and her face was tired.

Adora moved first. "Are you hungry?" Knowing Catra, she was probably starving and ready to eat anything that was set in front

of her. She was one of the only people Adora knew who could eat even when the world was ending.

"I can make some oatmeal or something." Catra felt weird asking Adora to make her food. She didn't need anyone to do things for her or to feel sorry for her. Adora was probably asking because she liked to cook, but Catra still felt unsure about it.

Adora poured food into Finn's food dish. Finn acted like this was the first meal of their life.

She walked over to Catra and kissed her. "Can I make you something?" She knew how much Catra liked it when she cooked for her, and she wanted so desperately to see Catra happy again. Even though Adora had eaten at Bow and Glimmer's, the anxiety had almost eaten her alive. She felt a bit famished herself.

Catra rubbed the back of her neck. "You don't have to…"

"I know I don't, but I want to." She ran her fingers through the back of Catra's hair, wanting to soothe the women she loved. In a way, this motion was soothing to her as well. Catra's hair was well cared for, and it felt good to touch.

"Okay." Catra tried not to purr, but she started to anyway. She felt better after talking with Adora, she knew they had a lot more to talk about, but her nerves had been calmed enough to eat. Unfortunately, a cup of coffee was out of the question; that amount of caffeine would cause her to have a panic attack. Good thing Adora already had tea set out on the table.

Catra went to the cabinet to grab the pain reliever and eye drops, then sat down at the table as Adora looked through the fridge. She touched the mug of tea in front of her; it was still kind of warm. She took a sip. It definitely needed to be warmed up and needed a spot of sugar. She stood up and popped both mugs into the microwave. "Do you have to work today?"

"I did, but I called in. We needed to talk." Adora finished cutting up an assortment of vegetables. She usually felt guilty about

calling in; she rarely ever did it. But Glimmer was right. They needed to talk, and they couldn't avoid the topic any longer.

"Oh. I don't work today." Catra folded her arms. "We do have a lot to talk about." Although she felt better, she wasn't quite sure what their relationship status was or what would happen next.

Adora finished cooking Catra's omelet and set it on a plate. "This looks so good. Can I steal a few bites?"

"Of course." She moved to kiss Adora.

"Oh, Catra, your eyes are so red. Want me to help you with the drops?" Adora cupped Catra's cheeks. She knew how hard it was for Catra to put eye drops in herself. She flinched too much. Adora had always helped her with them.

Catra looked into Adora's eyes, speaking meekly, "Yes, please."

Adora kissed Catra's forehead. "Okay, lean your head back and look up." She picked up the tiny bottle and untwisted the cap. "Are you ready?"

"Mhmm."

Adora cupped the side of Catra's face as she gently dripped a drop into each of her eyes. When she was done, she gently kissed Catra before moving her head down to blot the rest of the liquid with a towel.

"Thank you." Catra blinked her eyes a few times. "I never thought this would be happening."

"Neither did I. And I never in my wildest dreams thought that we would ever have sex." Adora blushed at the reminder.

"How are you feeling about that?" Catra asked between bites.

"I feel...good. Really good." Adora set the reheated tea back on the table. "I would like to do it again. Would you?"

"Yes. Very much so." Catra tried to take a sip of her, now scalding tea.

"Glimmer knows."

Catra almost choked and dropped her fork. She looked at Adora. "Wait, you told Glimmer we had sex?"

Adora looked at Catra, her face full of worry. "I-I was upset and...told her. She asked why we were in a bad place."

"Oh." It was Catra's turn to be nervous. "Uh...what did she say?"

"Nothing really. She just said she was sorry that I was so sad." Adora held her tea to her mouth. "She said she didn't tell Bow, and that was up to us to tell him."

Catra was not prepared for their friends to know so soon. She wasn't ashamed, but with all that had happened, there were a lot of conversations to be had. This little admission left Cara interested. Did Adora want more? Would they start dating? Or would they just become girlfriends?

"What does this make us? I mean, are we still just friends?" This was the moment she had been waiting for, and she hoped that Adora said they were together.

"I dunno. What do you think?"

"I asked you first."

Adora laughed awkwardly. "Okay, that's fair." She looked over at Catra and caught her gaze. She quickly looked away. "I..uh...I would like to be more." The familiar beat of her heart echoed in her ears as she patiently waited for Catra to answer.

Catra smiled. "Me too." She ate the last bit of food before setting her fork on the plate. "I think we should take it slow and make sure we talk about things. I don't want something like yesterday to happen again." Her smile faded away.

"Okay. That sounds good. What does 'slow' mean? Like we go on dates?"

"I mean, I would like to go on dates with you." Catra looked up. "I guess I don't know."

"Do you want to wait to have sex again?" Adora felt a bit disappointed.

"I...yes? Well, no. That's hard. Maybe I'm just nervous." She placed her hand on Adora's. "I don't want to lose you or move too fast."

"Catra, I'm here, and I plan on staying. Why don't we just play it by ear and make sure to talk with each other like we usually do? It might be hard at first, but I want to try." She scooted her chair closer to Catra's.

"Okay. We can do that."

Adora bent over to kiss Catra. "So, that's a yes on sex?" She laughed.

Catra laughed. "Okay fine. I think it'll be hard to say no anyway." She folded her arms in mock irritation.

They sat holding each other for a while longer, and Adora broke the silence. "How about for our first official date, we clean the house and go grocery shopping?" A huge grin on her face.

Catra scoffed. "Clean the house and shop for food? That's so lesbian; I'd love to." She stood up. "But, you have to do laundry!" She ran down the hallway toward her room.

"What! That's not fair!" Adora followed her.

Catra had gotten out the Bluetooth speaker for their house cleaning adventure. When Adora went to check the laundry, she saw the stinky clothes from the day before. *Yuck.* She tossed in some soap and restarted the load. Walking into the front room,

she saw Catra swaying her hips to a song as it ended. Adora usually secretly pored over how cute Catra was in her baggy day-off clothes. But now, she could openly think about it.

Sometimes Catra's clothes were so baggy that her tail would stay inside her shorts and come out of the bottom of the leg. It was so cute, almost as cute as her fang getting caught on her lip. The casual clothes were so endearing and kind of sexy. She looked so comfortable, and her shirt fell off her shoulders, teasing Adora. Her cheeks warmed.

A familiar song played on the speaker, and Catra rushed over to her phone to turn it off. "Oops, I didn't know I added that. Awkward."

Adora giggled. "No, you should play it."

"Really? I mean, it is a pretty good song, honestly." She restarted the song.

Adora started to move her shoulders to the beat of *What is Love* and moved toward Catra, who was having a hard time not laughing at Adora's exaggerated dance moves. Adora threw her hands into the air mouthing the lyrics to Catra. Then, she picked Finn up and started dancing while the cat was clearly not into the activity.

Catra stood there smiling and watching Adora's display. She was so damn cute. Catra loved how silly Adora was and her ability to brighten up the darkest of days. They always had a good time goofing off. She was thankful that they could still act like this and be silly. It looked like their relationship wasn't going to change much, aside from now adding sex into the picture. But she was not at all mad about that. After the chorus, Catra joined in. They danced and laughed for the entire song. Falling on the couch laughing when it ended, Adora laid on Catra.

Catra looked up and tucked a few loose strands of hair behind Adora's ear. "Hi."

"Hi."

Catra moved her head to kiss Adora. The kiss was soft, slow, and sweet. Finally, they parted and slowly opened their eyes. "Maybe we should really try not to have sex," Catra said as she moved her hands up Adora's sides, intentionally trying to elicit a reaction in her.

Adora was bewildered by how little it took for Catra to arouse her. "As terrible as that sounds, it could actually be fun. What would the rules be?" She kissed Catra's jaw and neck.

Catra moved her head to allow Adora more freedom. "Um...maybe we...mmm...can just do over-the-clothes stuff."

Adora pulled Catra's shirt down a bit to kiss her collarbone. The temptation to pull the shirt completely off intensified and made it hard to focus on what Catra was saying.

Catra attempted to hamper a moan but failed. "Hey, that's not over the clothes; that's cheating."

Adora groaned. "Oh, you're right." Adora moved Catra's shirt back to its original position and smirked.

Catra whined and pulled Adora in for another kiss.

Adora moved her hands across Catra's clothed breasts as their kiss deepened. She loved the feeling of Catra's firm breasts in her hands. Even over her shift, she could feel Catra's nipples hardening at her touch. It made her mouth water being so close to Catra.

Catra moaned into the kiss and grabbed Adora's ass. "Does over the clothes mean any clothes? Or specifically like pants and shirts? Could underwear count as clothes?" She kissed Adora's neck, breathing in her scent. Her lightly scented lotion perfectly complimented the smell of her hair. The combined scents were intoxicating to Catra. Her hips started to rock into Adora.

Adora moved into the gentle touches. "I think we should stay fully dressed." She moved her hand down to Catra's center, gently running her fingers along the fabric. As much as they were trying not to touch each other, it was not easy. They had barely been able to be with each other thus far, and adding this game on top of that already built-up lust was going to make for a challenging time. Nevertheless, Adora's hands moved with confidence, and she found the place that brought the most reaction in Catra. Even with a fabric barrier, Catra was moaning like her clothes weren't there.

Catra opened her legs to the sensation. "Oh, this is going to be hard." She pulled Adora in for a deep kiss and slid her hands between Adora's legs, rubbing her with more pressure than Adora was giving her. The way that Adora felt as she grinded on her fingers made it difficult not to pull her pants off and give her what she wanted.

The two women moaned and moved on each other, trying to keep to the new rules they haphazardly created.

"God, this is hard. I just want to taste you." Adora groaned, looking at Catra writhe below her with a flushed face. She wanted to hear what Catra sounded like when her tongue teased her.

Catra moaned. "I want to feel your tongue." Although she loved how Adora's fingers felt a few days before, her tongue would only feel better.

The desperation in their movements made it even harder not to indulge fully.

Adora reluctantly pushed herself off Catra and looked up. "I'm so turned on." Then, placing her hands on her forehead, she mumbled. "We should go grocery shopping before we break our rules."

"Ugh, okay." Catra begrudgingly agreed.

Catra pulled into a parking spot and pushed the park button. "Did we bring the reusable bags?"

"I didn't grab them. Do you keep any in here?" Adora unbuckled her seatbelt and moved to look at the back seat.

"I may have some random ones in here."

Adora pulled a cloth bag filled with other cloth bags from behind Catra's seat. "Typical Prius owner." Adora leaned over to kiss Catra.

Catra rolled her eyes and laughed. "Hey! At least I went the speed limit driving here!"

Adora looked back at her as she stepped out of the car. She met Catra on the other side. "Um, Catra?"

"Yeah 'Dor?"

She scratched the back of her neck. "Can we um... *hold hands."* Her voice lowered toward the end of her sentence.

"Of course." Catra took Adora's hand in hers and smiled.

They grabbed a cart and started walking toward produce. They always had grocery shopped in the exact same way, starting from the produce section and going down each aisle. Sometimes they had a list, but they didn't this time. Instead, Catra wanted to try meal prep and thought they could do some simple meals for the week as a test to see if they liked it. "Hey, Adora?"

"Hmm?" Adora didn't look up from the pears she was picking out.

It was hard not to love how sweet Adora was even when she was picking out fruit. Her soft hands were hovering over each pear, almost like it was feeling the aura of the fruit. "Can we try meal prep? We can make a few different meals and have them in the fridge so we can easily take them to work."

"I think that's a great idea. Do you have anything in mind for what we should make this week?" She set the bag of pears in the basket. "Oh, and we need stuff for pasta. We should have everyone over soon."

"I was thinking we could try something easy like baked chicken with steamed broccoli and a bit of quinoa? What do you think?" She leaned over the cart as Adora went to grab some bananas.

"That sounds great. What about meatloaf? We could make mashed potatoes on the side. I think we could freeze those so they last longer."

Catra smiled, she could feel her fang was caught on her lip, but she simply didn't care. She was happy.

Adora always tried to carry every bag into the house to avoid making multiple trips and today was no exception. Catra grabbed a few bags and watched Adora's display of strength.

"I'll start making dinner if you put the food away?" Catra grabbed the stuff to make sandwiches.

"Okay. Will you put a little extra mayo on mine? No tomatoes this time. This bread gets too soggy."

"Oh yeah, we did get different bread. Good call." Catra set out a few plates and added a few slices of bread to each. "So, how are you feeling...about us?" A twinge of nervousness in her voice.

Adora put a few items in the fridge before answering. "I feel really good. I think things are gonna work out." She walked over to Catra and wrapped her hands around her waist. "I'm glad we talked." Adora moved their foreheads together.

"Me too."

After dinner, Catra cleaned the few dishes they had dirtied while Adora got ready for bed. Catra dried her hands and inspected her claws, zoning out a bit. *Do we sleep in separate rooms? Or together?* When she was done, she joined Adora in the bathroom; she brushed her teeth and walked into her room to slip out of her clothes.

"So, uh hey, can I sleep with you?" Adora awkwardly stood in the doorway of Catra's room.

"I'm glad you asked. I was wondering what we were going to do. I mean, I think it would be weird to sleep in separate beds now? Right?"

Adora nervously laughed. "I think you're right. I mean, I want to sleep with you." She rubbed the back of her neck. "Not like that. Well, yeah, I do, but tonight, just sleep."

Catra smiled. "You are so cute."

Adora crawled into bed and waited for Catra.

They faced each other for the first few minutes exchanging sweet kisses. Then Catra turned around, and Adora wrapped her arm around her torso. "Sleep well."

"Sleep well."

The sounds of purring lulled them to sleep.

Just scan everything

Chapter Summary

Catra has to work late to finish inventory

Chapter Notes

Okay! Here is the next chapter and I hope you love all the fluff. I know I do! I have also updated the chapter total number. So, we still have a long way to go!

Thanks for all the support! I'm glad you are all on this journey with me.

Catra felt a hand on her chest and opened her eyes. She laid there for a few moments before she looked over to see Adora cuddled up to her. Adora was awake, and it looked like she had been awake for a while. The blanket was pulled up to her shoulder, her hair fell around her face, and her bright blue eyes caught the beams of sunlight perfectly—y *our Adora.*

"Morning." Adora kissed Catra's cheek. She felt this new sense of control in her life. Like the restraints were finally removed. She felt free, and she loved sharing that with Catra. There was far more excitement than fear, and she was overjoyed by it. The anxiety she felt before had almost completely melted away. She knew that anxiety and apprehension would be a part of this new relationship, but it didn't have to envelop it. Together, they could figure this out. The love was already there; they now needed to figure out how to evolve their relationship from a friendship to a partnership. *Partners.*

"Good morning." Catra smiled. She loved this new sensation of waking up next to Adora. There was no more nervousness because their feelings were clear. They *both* wanted this, and it felt so good. A few days ago, she never would have thought that this could have been an option. She was sure that their friendship

was going to struggle. But, this? She was ecstatic. "How did you sleep?"

"Really well." Adora moved her leg over Catra's. "You look so cute when you sleep." Adora had always admired how soundly Catra slept. Catra wasn't exactly known for loving physical contact and often kept strict boundaries with friends, but when she slept next to Adora, her guard was down. She slept motionlessly, and it was so sweet.

Catra blushed. "What! I'm not cute." She could feel her fang caught on her lip. Moving it wasn't a priority anymore because Adora loved it. If anyone asked, she would deny that she was cute. But, when Adora thought she was cute, she felt pure, unfettered joy.

"Yes, you are. Your tail taps, and your ears move." Adora moved her hand to run the length of Catra's tail. "And sometimes you purr." The feel of Catra's soft tail between her fingers was distracting.

Oh, Catra would never get sick of that. The way Adora gently ran her fingers down her tail was thrilling. Adora had done this many times before, but this was not like those other times. She spent more time at the base of her tail and made long slow strokes. God did it feel good. Catra covered her face with the blanket and grunted.

Adora pushed the blanket up and moved to straddled Catra; she started to tickle her. "You are soooooooo cute!" She loved that she could be as close to Catra as she wanted. The best part was that they didn't have an unspoken barrier between them. They could just be.

Catra laughed and tried to push Adora off her. But, Adora was stronger than her and clung to her easily. Adora's strength was one of the things she loved about her. Not only did it make projects like minor home repairs a breeze, but it was nice to look

at. And due to recent events, Adora straddling her was by far her new favorite activity.

Adora bent down and kissed Catra. "I think you're cute." In reality, she had always thought Catra cute, but now she could be vocal about it. She loved the gentle waves in her hair, the soft fur on her ears, the freckles that were centralized on her cheeks. She was just so pretty.

Catra rolled her eyes, "Okay, fine. Only for you." She pulled Adora down into a kiss. Their innocent kiss quickly turned into something more. They had been doing this dance for years and finally gave in to their feelings, so it was natural that they would be intense, but neither of them was expecting this.

Adora ran her tongue along Catra's bottom lip and kissed her deeply. Running her hands over Catra's clothed chest, a slight moan escaped, motivating her to proceed.

Catra moaned, "Can we get rid of these blankets?" She felt too restricted and wanted to feel Adora's skin on hers.

Adora nodded and moved off of Catra as she threw the blankets onto the floor.

"Can I lift your shirt?" Adora bit a finger, nervous to ask, knowing that it may result in her losing their game. But, she would gladly take the teasing after, for a chance to touch Catra.

"Isn't that against the rules?" Catra smirked, knowing that Adora was struggling brought her a sense of pride.

"Why are we even doing that?" Adora whined. Yes, she realized that she had thought it would be fun to try and not have sex, but now that she was in the moment, she cursed ever going along with it. Her desire had finally been released, and now she needed to keep it in check. She was frustrated, to say the least.

"I guess to see who can last the longest." Catra grinned, fully confident that she would be the victor. She had gone this long in

life; without it, a few more weeks wouldn't be an issue. Well, she hoped so, at least.

"Can we do clothes below the waist? But anything above is free game?" If Adora had to follow the rules, she would push them as much as she could.

"Is it hard not touching me?" Catra said in a low, husky voice. Her arousal rose, knowing that Adora wanted her so badly.

"Mmhmm. I really want to touch you," she moaned. Adora felt the warmth in her core build as she waited for Catra's answer. Since the dam had broken and they had sex, she wanted to feel every inch of Catra's body. She had seen Catra naked many times as best friends, but now she wanted to *experience* her. The need and desire were more potent than she anticipated. It was almost overwhelming to wait.

Catra took a second to think; if Adora was the one that gave in, she could at least enjoy the new stipulations. Oh, and she would. "Okay. Above the waist, anything goes." Catra grabbed the hem of her shirt and took it off.

Adora moaned and quickly removed her shirt. "Do we need to put pants on since we are both in our underwear?"

"No. It seems like we're just lucky today." She grabbed Adora's hips and started to push her pelvis into her. Catra admired Adora's bare chest in front of her. Adora's breasts were slightly larger than hers, and her nipples were much lighter in color. Taking the opportunity to touch Adora, Catra moved her hands gingerly up Adora's stomach and torso.

Adora leaned back to enjoy the feel of Catra's soft hands over her chest. The gentle gestures of Catra's fingers left Adora wanting more, but she had a challenge to win and did not want to be the first one to give in, even though she had technically already given in a bit. "Catra…" She started to grind her hips down.

Bending over, Adora kissed Catra's lips before kissing her neck and down her chest. She only stopped to kiss around Catra's nipples gently. Teasing more than she should have, she finally swirled her tongue around the taut skin. She moaned as her grip on Catra's hips tightened.

"Mmmm, Adora." Catra arched her back into the sensation. Feeling Adora's warm mouth surrounding her nipple, she moaned. Maybe it was the lifetime of craving, but the sensation of Adora's touch was almost reality-shattering.

Adora's fingers trickled down Catra's torso and traced the band of her underwear. "Are these one of the pairs I bought you?" She was elated that Catra had actually worn them.

"Yes." The desire in her core only intensified, knowing the new meaning of her wearing the pair.

"They look *really* good on you." She moved her hand over Catra's center. Feeling the damp fabric, she breathed in sharply. "Oh...I can feel how..." Each circle of her fingers made Catra moan.

Catra had never seen this side of Adora. Not that she was shocked, being that they were only friends their entire life. She really liked *aroused* Adora; she was so confident and smooth. Catra moaned and grabbed Adora's hips tighter.

"I can't wai-"

Before she could finish, Adora's alarm went off, signaling it was time for her to get ready for work. She grunted and reached over to her phone, and turned off the alarm. "Damnit! Why now?!" Leaning down to kiss Catra, "Can we finish this later?"

Catra sighed. "Of course. I'll go make breakfast while you shower." She kissed Adora, not wanting to stop just yet.

Adora walked into the testing center with a huge smile across her face. She felt much different from the last time she worked. Spending the morning with Catra was everything she could ask for. She had a good feeling that things were going to work out. Putting her backpack into her cubby, she pulled her phone out.

Glimmer [9:32 pm]: *How did things go?*

She completely forgot to text Glimmer and let her know how things went. They had focused so much on their conversation that they didn't think about following up with anyone. But that was to be expected. Their friendship had never seen anything like this before. It was understandable that they would struggle and not care about anything else around them.

Adora's realization that she was utterly and entirely in love with Catra had hit her like a bag of bricks. It was hard to handle when the person you would typically go to was who you were in love with. Looking back, she had known all along that she loved Catra. There were the sleepovers where Adora wanted to only sleep with Catra. Or the dates that she went on that she only thought about what Catra was doing, instead of whatever her date had been talking about. Let's not forget the make-out session they had that ended because Adora got freaked out. Not to mention the many times she had thought about Catra while she masturbated and didn't think that that may have been a sign. But she handled it by avoiding the situation and feelings entirely.

She usually avoided her feelings when they came up by going on more dates. Although she usually hated those dates, a few of them were set up by her parents. It was hard enough to deal with them daily, let alone when she said no to one of their setups. She usually just went with it to avoid conflict or more tension between them, knowing that she would be free of their influence in due time.

It almost became a habit. She just said yes to guys to avoid any awkward situations. It was what she had always done to avoid the wrath of her parents. And in a way, the irritation and emptiness

helped her avoid her feelings for Catra. Their friendship was enough; well, she pretended like it was.

She always wanted to go to college, but not for what she started for. Her parents wanted her to join the military as they did. To get them to agree to let her go, she promised them that she would get an engineering degree then join as an officer. She took all of her generals in the first few years to avoid her parents' questions. Then when she and Catra decided to buy a house together, she quickly changed her major to social work. She wanted to help people.

Even though it had only been a few days, she felt like an enormous weight had been lifted off her shoulders. If Intro to Counseling Theories taught her anything, it was that it would take time. And with Catra's support, she could get through anything.

She thought about what she was going to say to Glimmer. The last thing she wanted to do was keep her worrying, but there was a lot more information than she cared to text. Deciding to keep it simple, she quickly responded to Glimmer.

Adora [10:28 am]: *Hey Glimmer. It went really well. We talked and are in a good place.*

Adora [10:29 am]: *Let's get lunch or something this week to catch up.*

Maybe they could just tell everyone about their new relationship when they had everyone over for dinner. That was probably a conversation that she and Catra should have beforehand. They both had expressed that they wanted more, but they haven't clearly defined what 'more' is. That should be an interesting discussion. It was pretty obvious that sex was something desired by all parties. She would see Catra tomorrow and would talk to her about it then. Pulling up her messages again, she went to text Catra.

Adora [10:30 am]: *I like waking up to you.*

Adora [10:31 am]: *I'll miss you tonight. I hope inventory goes well.*

She slid her phone into her back pocket and logged in.

Catra sat at the kitchen table, sipping on a cup of coffee, thinking back to the morning she had with Adora. She wished they could spend the day together, but tonight was the night she had to do a complete inventory. It wasn't fair that she had to work late into the morning instead of enjoying her new relationship with Adora. But, she was looking forward to crawling into bed after work and snuggling up.

She was kicking herself for suggesting that they try not to have sex. It was hard enough not to touch Adora, let alone while they were making out. She was honestly unsure how much longer she could hold out. Clearly, she would need a little extra time in the shower this morning. Her phone buzzed, and she read the texts from Adora and smiled. *She's so sweet.*

Catra [10:33 am]: *I'll miss you too*

Catra [10:33 am]: *can I come sleep with you when I get home*

Setting her phone down, she stood up from the table and walked to the bathroom.

Catra double-checked her numbers before she walked over to the computer to enter them into the program. She finally had all of her pre-counts done. In a few hours, she could close the store and start inventory. Netossa would be there soon to help. Catra was a bit worried that they would get out later than she wanted because this was Netossa's first inventory. Catra had worked retail before, and this was something she was used to. She usually volunteered for the inventory shifts because she was able to sleep the day away after. The fast-food and ice cream she always

rewarded herself with probably wasn't the real reason. Probably. To make things a bit easier for them, Catra started to set books on their side with their barcode showing to make scanning a breeze.

After she had a few sections done, Rogelio let her know she had a phone call. Hoping it was Adora, she greeted the caller. "Hi."

"Hi Catra, this is Netossa, Spinny broke her leg, and I'm with her in the ER. I can't do inventory tonight. I'm so sorry."

"Don't worry about it. Stay with Spinnerella and tell her I hope she has a quick and painless recovery! Keep me updated. When do you work next?"

"Tomorrow. I think I'll be fine to work my shift; she is about to get the bone set. Oh, it's terrible, Catra. "

"Okay, well, let me know if you need tomorrow off too. Good luck." She hung up the phone.

Well, this put a wrench in her plans for the day. But, it could mean for an early night and more time with Adora. She would like to finish what they had started this morning. But, she knew that it was probably best to find another employee to help her tonight. She could do it herself, but she didn't like to be in the store alone; it was quite an old building. As much as she would claim to not believe in ghosts, she had heard some things that she couldn't explain— *time to call everyone.*

Rogelio opened the next day, so he couldn't do it. She picked up the phone and started to dial the first employee on her list. No luck. Number after number, everyone was either busy or had an early morning. She didn't blame any of them. It was almost 6 pm, and who wanted to stay until 3 am scanning books?

On a whim, she thought about calling Adora. She could pay Adora for her time, and it would be nice to spend a little more time together. Why not? Asking couldn't hurt. She took her phone out of her pocket and saw a few missed messages.

Plant girl 🌱 [3:46 pm]: *I'm just checking in. How are things with Adora?*

Oh, man. That was going to be quite a story to tell. She had forgotten to reach out to Perfuma and Scorpia to give them a quick update. Maybe having everyone over soon wouldn't be a bad idea. Swiping the notification away, she called Adora. It rang once, and an excited voice picked up the line.

"Hey, Catra!"

"Hey, Adora. I have a question for you."

"Okay," she was interested mainly because Catra rarely called and especially to ask a question. Texting was their primary form of communication. A bit of worry seeped into her voice. "What's going on?"

"So, I had my inventory person call in, and no other employees could cover for her. I guess that's the downside of having a small staff." Catra felt a twinge of nervousness. Was this weird to call your...well, she didn't know what to call Adora. Was she her girlfriend? Or were they just dating? She didn't realize that they hadn't talked about that detail. Was it weird to ask Adora, whatever she was, to help her at work? She cleared her throat. "And I was wondering if you could come help me do inventory."

Almost immediately, Adora responded, "Absolutely! When do I need to be there? Should I bring anything?"

"Are you sure? We'll be here until around two or three in the morning."

"Yes, I'm sure. I finished all my homework and applied for graduation today. So, I'm free, and I would love to see you."

"Oh, that's great. I can't wait to hear all about graduation. Can you be here at eight?"

"Of course, babe. Are you hungry? I should take a nap, and I can pick us up some food on my way in."

Catra's ears perked up. *Babe.* They hadn't talked about pet names, and it sent a jolt of happiness through her body. "That sounds great. I'll have everything set up when you get here, and I can talk you through the process. It's pretty straightforward. You just scan everything."

"That sounds perfect. I'll see you in a few hours."

Catra set the phone down. *She's so sweet.* Grabbing a piece of receipt paper, she started to jot down everything she needed to do still before Adora got here. If she could turn everything on its side, that would cut down the scanning time.

Thankfully, the store was slow, and Rogelio could help her move all the books. They made quick work of it. The store wasn't very large, so it was an easy task for two people. The front doorbell rang, and Catra went to greet the customer. It was Adora, dressed in her most comfortable gym shorts and flip-flops. In her hands, she had a few bags from their favorite Italian place.

"Hey." Catra felt her cheeks warm. She loved the new dynamic between her and Adora. And she loved seeing her even more.

"Hi." Adora walked up to Catra and kissed her, a slow sweet kiss. "Are you hungry?"

"Very."

They went to the backroom and ate until their bellies were full. Adora had gotten them both pasta. She made sure to get one alfredo and one traditional marinara so that they could share. Feeling a bit hungrier than she expected, she got garlic cheese bread and some cheesecake as well. Adora only had to wipe a little pasta sauce from Catra's cheek after.

Catra locked the front doors after wishing Rogelio a good evening and turned to Adora. "Alright, are you ready? I can show you how the scanners work and all the sounds they make." She took Adora's hand and walked over to the computer. "So, it's wireless, which makes things so much easier. But basically, when you scan something, it will beep. If it does the double beep, that means it didn't accept it.

If you look at the screen here, it'll tell you what it just scanned or give you an error code. If anything gives you an error, just toss it on the ground, and we'll pick all the problem ones up and handle them after."

"Okay, this seems easy enough." Adora took the scanner from Catra's hand. "Is this why all the books are on their side?"

"Yes! That way, you can scan them. Move the book right side up to mark your place, and then we know what we've scanned."

"I bet we could get it done before midnight." Adora had that look in her eyes when she was ready to win.

"Oh yeah? Wanna bet?"

"Yeah. If I win, you have to sleep naked."

"Oh, that's not fair!"

"I think that is very fair."

"Well, what do I get if I win?"

"I'll sleep naked."

"You realize this is going to make it harder to get this done? Now it'll be difficult not to think of you naked the whole time I'm scanning."

"Good." Adora grabbed her scanner and walked to the closest section. "I'll start over here."

"Okay, we are only doing books. So that should make things easier. I'll start on the other side, and we can meet in the middle. Good luck." Catra pulled Adora close and kissed her deeply. "Prepare to lose."

Catra walked to her spot, and they both started scanning. For the first hour, all you could hear was the constant beeping and the occasional book tossed on the ground. When they got closer, Catra asked about graduation. She knew it was coming up, but Adora had had some issues with a few of her credits counting. She was unsure if she was going to have to take the summer semester to finish.

"Yeah, so my advisor said that the Abnormal Psych class I'm in now would count for two requirements. So, my other classes will just be electives. I'm so glad I didn't have to take theories of personality just for fun," Adora laughed.

"What *would* Freud say about me?"

"Well, you would be an *innate* homosexual. We are all bisexual, and your disposition favored women," she shrugged.

"I'm not sorry I asked." She laughed. "What would you be?"

"Probably the same. It just took me longer to be honest with myself." Adora scanned a few books then tossed one of the ground.

"How long had you been thinking about it before you wanted to tell me?" Catra stopped scanning and looked toward Adora.

"Months. There were times I was sure I was gay; then, I'd try to push it away and go on a few more dates. But after each date, I would feel more and more sure that I didn't like guys. It reached a breaking point when we were at the gym, and you caught me…" she took a second to steady her voice. She felt ashamed that she

had reacted so poorly when Catra caught her. "I'm sorry, Catra. I was so nervous that you would push me away if you found out I liked you."

"Hey, come here, honey. I'm glad you told me, and I'm also sorry that I made a joke out of it instead of asking you about it later in private." Catra kissed the top of Adora's head. "I'm glad that we are both on the same page now." She held Adora tighter, and Adora laid her head on Catra's shoulder.

"I'm glad too."

"Hey, look! We are halfway done, and it's only 10:30 pm. It looks like I may be a little cold tonight. "

"Oh, don't you worry. I'll keep you warm." Adora giggled and kissed Catra. She placed their foreheads together.

An hour later, they both set their scanners on the counter and collected all of the books on the floor that needed to be manually entered. "Okay, so what we do with these rejected books is try and scan them up here, then try to type in the barcode manually. If that doesn't work, I can look up the part number over here." She straightened the stacks of books. "Will you scan them and the ones that don't scan hand to me, and I'll fix them?"

"Okay! Since we are gonna finish so early, I think I should get to watch you undress too." Adora grinned. Victory would be sweet and great to look at.

"What! We aren't even done yet! We still have 15 minutes left." Catra's voice had a bit of panic in it.

Adora looked at Catra as she scanned the first book. It was accepted, and she smiled. "Things are looking good for me."

Catra folded her arms. She was not about to lose this bet, but she also did want to go home. She was getting pretty tired and just wanted to snuggle up and sleep.

They worked through the last stacks of books, and Catra quickly looked up the missing part numbers and typed them into the computer. When Adora was done, she went to walk around the store one last time to check for any books they missed. She found a few and scanned them into the system. When Catra entered the last book, they both looked at the phone. It was exactly midnight.

"Who won?" Adora asked.

"Well, you did say *before* midnight. So it looks like I won." Catra grinned.

"Oh no, you don't! It's a tie, if anything!" Adora threw her hands in the air.

"Oh yeah? So does that mean we both sleep naked then?" Her eyes widened, and she felt her breath hitch.

"I guess so." Adora smiled and walked to Catra. "I mean, we both won. You got inventory done, and I got to spend the evening with you." She wrapped her hands around Catra's waist and rested her head on her shoulder.

"You're so damn cute. Let's go home."

They quickly got ready for bed as soon as they arrived. Adora made it into Catra's room first and started to take off her clothes.

Catra walked in. "Hey! Wait for me. I think I should be able to watch *you* get undressed."

"Okay." Adora turned to Catra and removed her shirt. She made sure to be extra comfortable for inventory and forgoed a bra. Even if she didn't win, she was going to make this fun for Catra. She quite liked to see Catra's responses to her flirting. Hooking her thumbs into her waistband, she pulled her shorts down.

"Wait." Catra sat down on the edge of the bed and pulled Adora close to her. She traced her fingers over Adora's stomach. "Can I take your underwear off?" It was harder to watch Adora get undressed than she thought. Her slightly smug attitude from before was quickly dissipating with each item of clothes shed.

"Yes."

Catra kissed Adora's stomach as she slowly slid the garment down, admiring Adora's exposed center. "I'll never get sick of this." She ran her fingers over the neatly trimmed pubic hair. The smell brought back memories from the car *and* the couch. Her mouth started to water; the temptation was in full force.

Adora leaned into the touch; she wanted Catra to continue to explore. There was a chance that Catra would give in, and they could take care of some of this built-up arousal.

"Okay, now I guess it's my turn to undress. Want to sit down?" Catra was reluctant to stop but knew how difficult it would be if she continued.

Adora groaned. "Okay." The disappointment rang in her voice, but a bet is a bet.

Catra stood up and turned toward Adora. Now was the time to step up the game. Adora had almost gotten her to throw in the towel, but it was now her turn to tempt Adora into giving in. She lifted her shirt over her head and reached behind her back to unclasp her bra. Keeping eye contact with Adora, she let it fall off her shoulders and onto the floor. Adora sat slack-jawed, watching Catra's every move. *Success.* Adora sat motionless, staring up at Catra.

Catra turned around, looked back, and hooked her thumbs into her leggings, sliding them down to her ankles. She bent over enough to give Adora a view, her tail waving in the air above her. Knowing how this would affect Adora, she took her sweet time

stepping out of her leggings. She could swear she heard Adora moan.

"Catra…" She sat in awe at Catra standing in front of her. She needed to feel her. The last bit of self-control she had was quickly fading.

Adora placed her hands on Catra's hips and kissed her bare skin. "You're so…" She moaned.

Catra wrapped her tail around Adora's shoulder and turned facing Adora; she pushed her gently back onto the bed and crawled on top to straddle her.

Adora moved her hands to Catra's torso and up to her breasts. Catra breathed in sharply at the sensation. She bent down to kiss Adora; their kisses quickly became impassioned. This would be the biggest test of their willpower. They were both determined to win; however, Catra seemed to want to win more. Adora had slowly broken down as time passed.

Adora's hands moved closer to Catra's center, her thumbs rubbing circles in the curls above her folds.

"How bad do you want to touch me?" Catra moaned.

"Really bad. This is getting really hard," she whimpered.

"Touch yourself." The idea popped into Catra's mind as she was trying to find ways to bypass their rules. If their morning was any indication of their attraction for each other, tonight would leave no doubt.

"Wait, what?" Adora sat up on her elbows. She knew what she heard but needed to make sure Catra meant it the way she took it.

Catra kissed Adora's neck. "Touch yourself. We may not be able to touch each other, but we can touch ourselves."

Adora sat there in silence, enjoying the feeling of Catra's mouth, debating whether she wanted just to give in and let Catra have the win. But, that last bit of competitiveness won out. "Okay." She didn't think of that option, but it was perfect. They could still keep to their bet but also enjoy each other.

Catra smiled and moved her hand down her torso. She leaned back to watch Adora slowly move her hand to feel herself. Catra was the first to part her folds and let her fingers wander.

Adora couldn't peel her eyes away from Catra's fingers moving in tight circles. As much as she wanted to feel Catra, this was more than worth it. Her fingers moved quickly as she watched Catra. The small moans that escaped Catra's mouth and the way her hips were gyrating were making it hard for Adora not to come quickly. She was so sensitive, and her fingers honed in on the spot that usually brought her quickly to orgasm.

Catra tried to hold off her orgasm but watching Adora made that impossible. She finished first. "Adorahhhhh…" Holding herself up with her hand on Adora's chest, she moaned. "Oh god…"

Adora came soon after, throwing her head back as her orgasm took her. "Uhhhnnn."

Catra laid on Adora as they both came down. "Mmmmm." All Catra could think was *wow.* She didn't know why the idea didn't come to her sooner. She really enjoyed watching Adora touch herself, especially knowing that she was thinking about her the entire time. It was hard to tell which she liked more, the fact that Adora was so attracted to her or that they were actually together. She felt such immense joy and held Adora tighter.

"That was nice," Adora said in a sleepy voice. She lightly traced her fingers down Catra's back and sides. It was almost unbelievable. She loved the intimate moments with Catra, but she loved feeling so close to her even more. Their entire lives, they had been very close, but this was on a whole new level. They had

already mastered being best friends, and now they were able to navigate a relationship. Adora smiled.

Catra lifted her head to kiss Adora gently. "Why you smilin'?" She moved off of her and cuddled up on Adora's side.

Adora ran her hands through Catra's messy hair. "I am just happy. And not just because that was incredibly hot. But I just love that we get to be with each other. I don't really know how to explain it. It's just...so wonderful." She was grateful for Catra and the things they had gone through. After the difficulties they have experienced, they deserved some happiness.

"I'm so glad to hear that. I'm really happy too." If Adora only knew how fulfilling their new connection was to her. The years of yearning finally coming to a perfect conclusion.

"Do you think we should tell our friends soon?" In reality, Adora wanted to scream it from the rooftops and make sure everyone knew they were together. But, she would have to settle for telling their friends.

Catra lifted her head. "I mean, yeah. I think that's a good idea; it should go over pretty easily. I honestly don't think anyone will be surprised." She laughed.

"Do you really think so?"

"Yeah 'Dor. We have been inseparable since we were kids. It's practically the building blocks for an epic romance." She kissed Adora's cheek and gave her a little tickle.

Adora giggled. "Catra!" She pulled Catra closer and kissed the top of her head. "I hope you sleep well."

"You too."

Is this officially a date?

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra go on their first date.

Chapter Notes

Yay! Another chapter. This one is so cute. So, yeah a little more fluff is coming.

Adora closed the hatchback of her car and picked up the box of soaps before turning to Glimmer. "Are you ready? I can carry a few more that won't fit on the cart." Adora was ready to be back at the farmers' market. It had been a few weeks since she had been able to help Glimmer. Her school and work schedule had made it difficult, not to mention the situation with Catra reaching a breaking point. But, she had been able to help Glimmer out in other ways, and today she was going to use her people skills to sell their entire inventory. Well, she hoped. They were launching a new line of seasonal soaps that folks could come to expect each season and with some new additions.

"No, it's okay. This way, we can take a break and walk around when we need to restock." Glimmer set the last box on the cart and started pulling it behind her. "Do you have your vendor pass?"

"I haven't seen it for months. Maybe it's in Catra's car," she shrugged.

"Oh, Catra. Speaking of Catra, how are things between you two?" She looked back at Adora and raised her eyebrow.

Adora's eyes widened. She wasn't expecting to talk about Catra so soon in the day, maybe after they set up their booth, so she had some time to prepare. "Well, when I went home that morning, things were tense. She cried. She thought I had left. It wasn't a good idea to avoid going home. It was heartbreaking to see her so upset." Her brow furrowed. "I found her phone in my

car. So it turned out that she wasn't ignoring me; she didn't have her phone."

"Oh wow. I'm glad it was a misunderstanding and not something else. I was worried that you two would have a falling out."

"Wait, you thought we would? You said..." Adora stopped walking.

"I know what I said. And I meant it, but it still was a worry. Obviously, you two have been dancing around each other for years, and when it finally happened, I wasn't expecting it. The fact that she wasn't talking to you was really surprising. I'm happy things worked out." Glimmer slowed the cart down to wait in line with the other vendors. "I hope Perfuma is checking vendors in."

"Honestly, I didn't expect us to..., but when we did, everything clicked. And I'm glad it happened."

"So are you two..." Glimmer handed Perfuma her vendor badge.

"Glimmer! Adora! It's so great to see you. You should be able to get a spot in the main area today. Try to get next to the Seacake vendor. They have been *very* popular, and it'll bring you extra traffic." Perfuma winked and handed them their vendor packet.

Glimmer found an empty spot right next to the Seacake vendor. The food booth was still setting up, and it looked like they had 20 griddles. "I wonder what's so special about those Seacakes."

Adora shrugged and started setting up their table. "Hey, do you want the new soap scents in the front?"

"Yeah, that'll bring attention to them. It took me a while to get the scent right, but I think they are gonna be a decent seller." Glimmer set a few risers on the table.

"Yeah, I'm sorry I wasn't around when you made these." Adora frowned and looked down.

"Hey, don't worry. There are gonna be times when one of us has something going on. I'm glad things are good between you and Catra."

They finished setting up their booth and waited for the farmers market to open. The smell of sweet bread filled the air as the Seacakes booth was setting up.

"Maybe we should have that for lunch?" Glimmer looked at Adora.

"That sounds like a good idea."

The morning sun was beating down on their booth, and Adora was getting thirsty and in need of a snack. "Hey Glimmer, I'm gonna see what they sell at the Seacake booth. Want anything?"

"Yeah, get me whatever you get. And a water? I forgot my water bottle at home."

"Sure thing." Adora exited the booth from the back and casually stood in line, waiting. The line wasn't too long, but long enough that she pulled her phone out. It was barely past 11 am, and Catra must have still been sleeping. They got to bed a bit later than they thought the night before. Her cheeks warmed, and she opened her messages.

Adora [11:09 am]: *Hey babe, I hope you're sleeping well.*

Adora [11:09 am]: *I had a perfect time last night. I can't stop thinking about it.*

Adora [11:10 am]: *Can I take you out tonight? We can go to that new Indian place we wanted to try.*

She smiled and put her phone in her pocket. The person behind her cleared their throat; the line had moved, and she was too focused on texting Catra to notice. She awkwardly walked forward the few steps and stood there looking at all of the other booths at the market. There were several new ones this week. It made sense, the weather was hot, and there had recently been a big push for folks to shop local and support the community. It wasn't a surprise that people were avoiding Horde-Mart, ethics weren't their forte.

Adora and Glimmer were thankful for that. Her job at the testing center helped give her a significant discount on tuition and pay the mortgage, but not much more. But, when Glimmer introduced the idea of creating a soap company together, she jumped at it. They worked farmers' markets in the area and any artisan market they could get into. They made a pretty decent amount of money.

Adora had taken a couple of botany and chemistry classes as her generals to help them create products. Glimmer's parents had a large yard that they didn't maintain, and when Glimmer offered to grow many herbs and vegetables, they agreed as long as she took care of it. So, she spent most of the week tending to the extensive garden, and Adora did most of the scent formulas. Their products were vegan and organic, which was a massive draw for the farmers' market crowd and just a good thing in general.

There was only one person in front of her, and she looked up at the menu. It turned out to be a gourmet pancake company with an ocean theme. Adora decided on the cinnamon sugar Sea-Ra. The dark-haired woman at the register looked like she was already over the day. In her mostly monotone voice, she asked the customer in front of Adora if they wanted their receipt, and when they didn't answer, she rolled her eyes and said, "Cool, thanks."

Adora stepped up to the counter, "Hey."

The woman was dressed in a teal and blue outfit with a nametag in the shape of a shark that read Mermista. Adora had never

heard that name before. What a pretty name. "I like your name. I've never heard it before."

"Oh, thanks." She blushed. "I'm from Salineas."

"Oh, I haven't been there! It's a coastal city, right?" Adora forgot she was supposed to order until the person behind her cleared their throat again. "Oh, oops. I should order. Can I get two cinnamon Sea-ras?"

"Totally." Mermista put the order into the tablet. "Any drinks?"

"Oh, yeah. Could I get two waters?"

"For sure. What was the name on the order?

"Adora."

"Okay, $12.50."

Adora handed her her card and waited while it was processed.

"Thanks. I'll call your order in a few minutes."

"Okay, thanks." Adora walked back to Brightmoon Soaps and stood there for a moment while Glimmer finished with her customer. "They are ocean-themed pancakes. I got us the cinnamon ones."

"Oh, that sounds great." Glimmer turned to her. "We just sold out of the new scent!"

"Wait, that fast? How long was I gone?" Adora was surprised.

"You were gone for like fifteen minutes. But, a few of the regulars came by. It looks like your new scent was a hit." Glimmer grinned.

"Yeah, I guess honey, lemon, and lavender go well together," Adora shrugged. She heard her name being called and excused herself to walk over to grab their order.

When she came back, she took out her phone and saw a few messages from Catra.

Catra [11:30 am]: *hey Adora*

Catra [11:30 am]: *i would love to go out with you tonight*

Catra [11:31 am]: *what was your favorite part from last night?*

Catra [11:32 am]: *mine was when you were undressing, and i pulled your underwear down*

Catra [11:33 am]: *It was so hard not to touch you*

It was a good thing she had already set down their plates of food, or she would have dropped it. She loved knowing what turned Catra on; it gave her many more ideas on what they could do next. As much as she hated not touching Catra, it was exciting trying to figure out ways to be with each other without contact. She wanted to try everything with Catra and learn every way she liked to be touched.

"Adora? Are you gonna eat? I want to go to the car and grab the rest of the boxes, but I can wait." Glimmer looked at Adora.

Glimmer had finished her food while Adora was caught in the allure of illicit texts with Catra. "Oh yeah, let me eat. Then I can go if you want?" Adora took a picture of the delicious-smelling meal and sent it to Catra before putting her phone away.

Adora walked through the door and called for Catra. "Hey, Catra? Are you home?" She knew she was home; her Prius was parked outside. But, there was something about calling out to her when she got home that she really enjoyed. The fact that they owned the home together was such a nice feeling, especially now.

She set her keys down and was about to yell for Catra again but saw her sleeping on the couch. She must be so tired from

inventory. Adora crept over to the couch and bent down to softly kiss Catra. But, Catra woke up and softly said, "Hey Adora."

"Oh, I'm sorry to wake you up." Adora stood up quickly.

"No, don't be; I just fell asleep. Come lay down with me." Catra lifted the blanket and waited for Adora.

"Okay." Adora took off her shoes, pants, and bra and slipped under the covers with Catra. Their couch was not as big as they thought, and with both of them on it, it was a tight fit. She kissed Catra before she fell back asleep. Catra always looked so peaceful when she slept. Adora had found a new love for sleepy Catra. Her eyelids were starting to droop as Catra's purring grew softer.

A few hours later, Catra woke up and stretched, trying not to wake Adora, who lay with her mouth slightly open, with the smallest spot of drool on the fabric below her. *Why haven't I ever noticed that she drools in her sleep?* She tucked a few strands of hair behind Adora's ear, and Adora stirred and groaned. Catra pulled her hand back quickly, worried that she woke Adora.

Adora didn't open her eyes, but she spoke, "Hey, Catra." She would not get sick of saying that. "How did you sleep?"

"I slept well; how about you?" She kissed Adora's temple.

"Good. What time is it?" Adora yawned and stretched her arms above her.

"That's a good question. I'll get up and check." Catra tried to maneuver herself off the couch without pushing Adora off. And by some miracle, she was able to do it. Adora took up the space left by Catra's absence. Catra walked into the kitchen to look for her phone and saw that it was 5:12 pm. They slept later than expected. "Hey Adora, it's 5:12. Do you still want to get dinner?"

Adora sat up, looking slightly panicked. "I didn't know we slept so late. I guess I was a lot more tired than I thought. I still want to take you out if you still wanna go. I'm going to start getting ready." She popped up and skipped to her room.

Catra smiled and walked to her room. She took a shower earlier and watched TV on the couch while her hair dried but passed out. Her hair wasn't fully dry, which would make it easier to style. And you better believe she was going to slick her hair back. With as much as Adora loved it, she was absolutely going to look her best for their first official date. *Their first date*. The more she thought about it, the more excited she got. They were going to go out as a couple. Would it feel different? Would it be awkward to find topics to talk about? What if they saw someone they knew? What would they say?

The excitement was peaking as she picked out her shirt. She could hear Adora's music from the other room. That was new, as she never listened to music as she got ready for her previous dates. It was more like being dressed as quickly as she could, and she usually ran late. Catra loved the feeling of anticipation before their first date. She cycled through her button-up shirts, trying to find the perfect one. The last one was maroon and still had the tag on it. *Oh, I've never even worn this one.* She couldn't remember where she bought it. But, it would be a pleasant surprise for Adora.

She popped the tag off, slipped it on, and buttoned it up. She didn't have a mirror in her room, but she could sneak over to the bathroom and take a look. Looking on the floor for her favorite pair of jeans, she came up empty. Must be in the laundry. She took one more pass in her closet and found a pair of jeans she liked. They weren't her favorite, but they would do. And they were in better shape. So, they were more fitting for a first date. After tucking in her shirt, she walked to the bathroom.

She secretly wished Adora would come into the bathroom and want to slick back her hair again. But, it looked like Adora was focused on getting ready. Catra grabbed the pomade and twisted

off the cap. The second the scent hit her nose, she was taken back to the moment Adora pushed her hips into hers. She was still surprised that she and Adora had become more than friends. *Wow.* At that moment, it really sunk in that she was getting ready for a date with Adora. The woman she had loved for so long, who also loved her. Her smile couldn't get any bigger.

As soon as she was done with her hair, she went to the kitchen, trying not to peek in Adora's room to see what she was doing. She sat at the kitchen table and started playing on her phone. She looked up the menu at the Indian restaurant to see what they offered. It looked like typical Indian food with a Mexican twist. This would be interesting. Finn reached up and stretched on her thigh. "Hey, cutie. What are you doing?" She pet the affectionate cat's head and heard Adora's music shut off and footsteps coming down the hallway. Standing up, she waited for Adora to turn the corner.

Her nerves were fully activated. The butterflies in her stomach and that slight lightheaded feeling swirled around her. She had been to dinner with Adora hundreds if not thousands of times; why should this be any different? In reality, there were many reasons it was different, but she tried and failed at soothing her nerves.

The footsteps stopped at the end of the hallway. Catra stood by the table in anticipation. What would Adora look like? Would it be different? Would it be the same? Her excitement was building. The footsteps started again, and Adora appeared in front of Catra. The only words that came out of her mouth were, "Wow."

Adora blushed and rubbed the back of her neck. "Do I look okay?"

Catra almost had to hold her mouth closed to start talking. "You look...beautiful."

Adora was dressed in a red button-up and white jeans with gold embellishments. The shirt was unbuttoned enough to allow the

swell of her breasts to be slightly visible. It was quite apparent that she wasn't wearing a bra. Her hair was half pulled back, and the rest fell on her shoulders and neck. Catra could only stand there and stare.

Adora laughed. "Do you like it?"

"You look amazing."

"Thank you, so do you." Adora walked over to Catra and slid her hands around her waist, and kissed her. The seemingly innocent kiss was enough to spark the fire within both of them. Adora quickly parted Catra's lips with her tongue, and they stood there kissing and pulling each other closer, both moaning at the intensity of their kisses. They finally parted to catch their breath.

"Why is it so hard not to kiss you?" Adora groaned.

"I feel your pain."

"Okay, let's go eat before we never leave this kitchen." Adora kissed Catra one last time, reluctant to break away.

After they were seated, both of them looked around at the decor in the restaurant. They had never been here, and they wanted to take it all in. Well, and they were nervous. This was their official first date, and even though they had been out many times before, it felt different.

"Do you want to share something? Maybe we can try a few different dishes and take the leftovers home for lunch tomorrow?" Catra turned the page of the menu.

Adora laughed. "You are so cute. I think that's a great idea. I think I want to try this pico masala. Do you want to do chicken or tofu?"

"Why don't you get tofu in the one you choose, and I'll do chicken in this one?" Catra set her menu down and looked around at the other diners. For a new restaurant, it didn't seem very busy. There were a number of couples enjoying time together and surprisingly no birthdays.

After they ordered, they sat quietly. Usually, they had things to talk about when they were out together, but this outing was different. Catra thought about current events she could bring up to break the silence, but nothing came to mind. *What am I doing? Why don't I just sit next to her?*

"Adora? Can I sit next to you? It's weird being across from you." Catra rubbed the back of her neck.

"Please do. I don't know why this feels so different. We go out all the time."

Catra stood up and moved over to sit next to Adora in the booth. "That's better."

The move seemed to break the tension. Their placement was much more natural for them, and it was a perfect opportunity for them to talk. Adora faced Catra, "So, how do you feel about us inviting everyone over this weekend? We could make pasta and tell them about us."

Catra laid her hand on Adora's thigh. It seemed like they had gone full circle, as this whole thing had started with Adora laying her hand on Catra's thigh. She smiled. "I think that's a good idea. Are you nervous at all about telling them?"

"Honestly, I feel good about it, maybe a little bit nervous, but Glimmer already knows, and Bow is always supportive of everything, so I don't think it'll be an issue."

"Perfuma and Scorpia are going to be thrilled."

"Do you think they suspected anything?"

Catra's cheeks turned red. "I kind of talked to them about you putting your hand on my thigh and your texts." Her eyes widened, and she looked over at Adora.

"Oh. What did they say?" Adora took a sip of her water.

"They didn't say much. They just said that I should talk to you. When we went over to Glimmer's, I was planning on talking to you in the car about it, and then, well, you know what happened." She watched the waiter bring over their food. "I honestly thought you would be upset about it when I brought it up. I thought I was making it up. I'm glad I wasn't."

"You weren't." Adora laid her head on Catra's shoulders. "I love you, Catra."

Catra smiled. "I love you too, Adora."

Adora cuddled up to Catra and whispered in her ear, "Do they know we had sex?" Adora's tone sounded less than innocent.

Catra cleared her throat. "Uh...no." She sat there listening intently to Adora's next words. "I can't wait to touch you again. It was so hot watching you touch yourself last night. The way your fing-"

The waiter arrived with their food and carefully set each entree down. "Be careful, ladies; they're hot! Anything else I can get you?

Catra looked up and smiled. "No, this looks great. Thank you." She could feel the warmth building in her center.

They sat there for a few moments while their food cooled down. Adora's hands started to wander coyly. Catra pretended to study the entrees and sides. She had ordered a few different types of naan, three entrees, and a few sides. It was too much, but they could eat it for the next few days. And why not make their first date memorable. Well, more memorable than it already had been.

As soon as they started eating, they shared bites. It wasn't hard sinking into the cute ways that couples interact. Adora held a spoon to Catra's mouth. "Catra, this is so good. This may be my new favorite place."

Catra took the spoonful of food and nodded. "I feel bad about saying this, but I think you may be right. This might be our new spot." She leaned over to kiss Adora's temple.

Adora cuddled up to Catra on the couch. They decided since the night was still young, they could have a movie night. The movie that Catra put on was a new drama neither of them had seen yet. Adora had retrieved the nail clippers and a few nail files to take care of Finn's claws. They were starting to get dangerous.

Looking closely at Finn's paw before clipping, Adora asked, "How do you feel about pet names?"

"Oh, like Finn?" Catra knew exactly what Adora was talking about but really enjoyed teasing her. When Adora called her 'babe' the night before, it sent a chill down her spine. It was adorable and exciting at the same time. Of course, she wanted Adora to call her cute little pet names.

"No silly, like little nicknames for each other." She picked up Finn's next paw. The cat had been a dream when it came to grooming.

"I know what you were talking about. She laughed. "I think it's cute. I have really liked when you've called me babe so far. Is there a pet name you like the most?"

Setting Finn on the ground, she held her hand out, "Your turn."

"Wait, what?"

"You heard me. I'm going to trim your claws." Adora waited for Catra to turn over her hand.

"Wait, you know I have quicks like Finn, right?" Catra's voice filled with worry.

"Yes. I've cut your nails before. Have I ever hurt you?" Adora asked inquisitively.

Catra thought for a second. "Well, no, but...just be careful. It hurts a lot when I hit my quick."

"Okay, I'll be extra careful, and if I do hurt you, I'll sleep naked to make it up to you," she said smugly.

"Oh, that's not fair."

"Don't move. I don't want to hurt you." Adora held each of Catra's fingers up and inspected it before clipping off the sharp tip. Catra retracted her claws and giggled. "Hey! I can't clip them unless I can get to them," She huffed.

Catra grinned and let her claws return to their full glory.

"Catra?"

"What!? They aren't retracted!"

Ignoring what Catra said, she didn't look up from Catra's hand. "What do I call you?" She picked up the nail file and rounded the tips of Catra's now dull claws.

"Is this a trick question? Or did Bow put you up to this? Is it another of his dad jokes?" Catra raised her eyebrow.

"No, no. Like what do I *call* you?" She finished the first hand and set it down while holding her hand out for the other.

"Oh." Catra's stomach dropped. She had never really thought about what they would call each other. Were they girlfriends? Partners? Gal pals? "I mean, what do you think?" She set her other hand in Adora's.

"I asked you."

"Well played. I guess I'm your girlfriend?" Her heart skipped a beat. She was Adora's girlfriend. Well, hopefully, if Adora agreed. If Adora couldn't feel her giant grin, it would be a miracle.

"Okay." She finished with Catra's second hand and started filing.

"Wait, just okay? Is that what you want to be called?" Catra moved her head back to look over at Adora, who turned her head up and smiled.

"Yes, I want to be your girlfriend." Adora kissed Catra's hand and set it down gently.

"So, it's official? We are officially girlfriends." Catra leaned down to kiss Adora.

"Girlfriends."

Sexting? Yes, please.

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra try new things. Gay things. With each other. Because they are gay for each other.

Chapter Notes

Greetings!

This is a fun chapter. I hope y'all are enjoying all the fluff. I know I sure am!

Thanks for all the comments and kudos!

Until next time, enjoy!

Adora stretched and yawned before sliding off the bed to use the bathroom. Catra lay as still as a stone, her tail unmoving, but her ear flicked from time to time. Making her way quietly to the bathroom, Adora smiled at their clothes and belongings strewn about the room. It didn't look like Catra's room anymore; it looked like *theirs* - a welcome reminder of their new relationship. So many emotions were flowing through her that she couldn't narrow it down if anyone asked. The one thing she did know is that she was happy.

After washing her hands, she pulled her hair into a loose bun on top of her head. Today would be a lazy day, as she needed to finish a few homework assignments and catch up on some housework. But, aside from that, she had the morning with Catra. When she exited the bathroom, she took a moment to look down the hall. This was *their* home. It had never felt so warm and full of life. Sighing, she realized it wasn't just a house anymore; it was a *home.*

Adora tiptoed back into Catra's room and tried to get back into bed as smoothly as possible. But, as much as she tried, Catra's

keen hearing made it near impossible to sneak up on her, and Adora wasn't the stealthiest person to begin with.

"Hey, Adora." A sleepy voice emerged from the blanket.

"Good morning, baby." She moved her body next to Catra, feeling the warmth radiate from her. "Did I wake you?" Catra's hair smelled of the sweet and floral shampoo she used, Adora kissed her head.

"No. Do we have to get up, though?" She groaned and grabbed Adora's arm, tucking it in front of her.

"No." Adora kissed Catra's ear and circled her fingers over her stomach.

Adora knew how much Catra liked her ears played with; too bad she couldn't reach her tail because that would get a more considerable rise out of her. Something about lying next to Catra in bed while kissing her ears made it difficult to concentrate. She started to move her hips against Catra's ass while her hand traveled to Catra's chest, feeling the swell of her breast.

"Adora…" Catra was struggling. Hard. Her nipples were responding to Adora's touch, and she was meeting Adora's hips as they pushed into her. This was going to be a problem for them if, one light touch brought on such intense arousal. They had lasted a few days without having sex, and Catra was ready to give in; Adora can have the win. She couldn't wait any longer.

Turning around, Catra kissed Adora and pulled her closer. Adora returned the kiss and ran her hand through Catra's hair. They pulled each other closer, letting their hands wander, and move into each other. Catra pulled away first. "Sit up."

Adora looked at her curiously. Catra repeated herself and sat up. "Sit up."

Following suit, Adora sat up and pulled Catra in, and kissed her again. She pulled Catra's shirt over her head and moved toward

her, stopping only to kiss her before she let Catra pull hers off. She had reached her limit. It was impossible not to think about how Catra would taste. She needed to experience it. After their adventures the other night, her self-control was officially deceased. RIP. Between labored breaths, she spoke. "I can't wait any longer. You win. I give up. I need to touch you." She cupped Catra's face, kissing her with more vigor.

"Yeah?" Catra smiled and kissed Adora's neck while she ran her palms over Adora's breasts. "I'm glad you finally gave in because I wouldn't have lasted another day." She kissed Adora again, pulling her close. At this point, Catra wasn't worried about the bet anymore. She would have graciously given in if it meant she could be with Adora again.

Adora crawled on top of Catra, placing her thigh between Catra's as they kissed and rocked into each other, moaning. The soft moans coming from Catra between kisses were intoxicating. Since first hearing it, she wanted to hear it as often as she could. As amazing as it felt to rub herself on Catra's thigh, she wanted more. Her impatience had reached its peak, and now it was time to act.

Adora kissed down Catra's chest, giving each nipple the attention it deserved. Her tongue gently circled, her lips gently enveloped. She loved the way Catra felt in her mouth and the way her body responded to her every touch even more.

Catra moaned and rolled her hips as Adora's light kisses trickled down her stomach. "Adora…" She was still in awe that they were officially together, and surprised each morning when she woke up with Adora in her arms. A lifetime of worry for naught. She wondered if they could have been together much earlier in their lives or if this was the moment when everything aligned.

She watched as Adora teased and caressed her breasts and stomach. Her wild blonde hair fell on the sides of her face; the bun she had her hair in was doing very little to tame the strands.

Soft curls circled her face when she looked up to Catra, looking for reassurance. Catra smiled and cupped Adora's face. *I love you.*

Adora sat back on her knees and ran her hands up Catra's thighs, lightly running the back of her fingers over the wet spot that had developed on her underwear. "Can I take these off?" She was filled with anticipation, wanting to hurry and press her mouth to Catra's center. But, she knew that she shouldn't rush the process. There would be many times that she would experience this, and her first time should be savored. For now, she would enjoy each second.

"Please." The fire in Adora's eyes was more than Catra could handle. She was hoping that Adora would lick her but didn't want to push her. Watching intently, she enjoyed Adora's liberation unfold in front of her.

Adora moved her fingers to the band of Catra's underwear and kissed her stomach before slowly sliding them down. Catra lifted her butt as the garment moved down her body. Adora stopped and admired Catra. Her claws were anchored in the sheets, and her chest rose and fell in a slow, labored tempo. The soft curls that had adorned her sex were neatly trimmed, leaving her exposed. A trickle of moisture was visible.

Adora let her hands wander up Catra's legs, stopping at her knees and pushed them apart. They effortlessly opened, leaving the target of Adora's endeavor unprotected. She placed soft kisses on Catra's inner thighs before she kissed the slick in front of her. "Is this okay?"

"Mmhm," Catra whimpered and nodded. She waited in anticipation as Adora's mouth moved closer to her sensitive core. The only thing she wanted at this very moment was to feel the gentle pressure of Adora's tongue. The light touches were tantalizing and making it hard not to beg Adora to touch her directly.

Adora's tongue moved through the slick folds as Catra threw her head back, moaning and grabbing the sheets tighter. "Oh god, Adora."

Exploring Catra, Adora listened closely to find the areas and ministrations that brought the strongest responses. Shortly after her exploration began, she felt Catra's hand on the back of her head. She increased her pace and slid her hands under Catra's thighs, holding on as Catra's hips moved with the kneading of her tongue.

Trying to watch Adora move through her folds, Catra’s eyelids lay heavy as each stroke of Adora's tongue brought her closer and closer. Adora only pulled away to kiss Catra's folds before returning to apply slow strokes to her needy clit. Catra spread her legs further, grabbing Adora's head with both hands as she quickened her pace.

The quick flicks of Adora's tongue made it difficult for Catra to keep quiet. She tried to control the sounds she was making but quickly gave in. "Keep going," she sighed. The tension was building inside her; it wouldn't be long before her release flowed through her.

She tried not to be too rough with Adora's head, but it just felt so good. Her claws entangled in the untamed strands. Adora's eyes were open, looking at her, and Catra couldn't look away. Every so often, Adora would trail her tongue the length of Catra's slit and gently suck on her clit, before focusing the strokes of her tongue on her nub. Most of Adora's moans were muffled by Catra's sex.

"Oh god, Adora. Oh, god!" Catra cried out as the intense wave of pleasure moved through her. Her grip on Adora's head tightened before she melted into the bed.

Adora slowed her strokes and kissed the sensitive flesh in front of her. She felt on top of the world. Not only did she just go down on Catra, but Catra came! All the times that she had thought about this very moment, whether she thought about what it would feel

like or how to move her tongue, were nothing compared to what she just experienced. Smiling, she wiped her face on the bed and crawled on top of Catra. She laid her head on Catra's chest as she slowly came down from her high. Listening to Catra's heart, she traced circles on her torso.

"Wow." Catra put her hand on her forehead. "Are you sure you've never done that before?" She looked up at Adora.

Adora laughed, "I have not." She was beaming.

"Could have fooled me." Catra pulled Adora closer and kissed her. "That felt really good."

Adora looked up at Catra, "I wasn't expecting it to taste like that."

Catra blushed as a rush of panic overtook her. "Oh."

Adora sensed the worry in Catra's voice. She didn't think about how her statement could have affected Catra right after she had gone down on her. "No, no, it's not bad. I really like the way you taste," she reassured Catra. "You don't taste like much of anything. I guess I don't know what I was expecting." She kissed Catra. "I can't wait to do it again."

"Neither can I." Gently pushing Adora's shoulder, Catra switched their positions and deeply kissed Adora. "Can I?"

"Yes." Adora tucked a few strands of hair behind Catra's ear.

Catra smiled and straddled Adora. She dragged her claws down Adora's torso, being extra careful around her sensitive nipples. Adora's muscles flexed as the claws traced her taut, goosebumped skin. Adora gasped and arched her back. "Ahhh." Running her claws over the curve of Adora's hip, Catra slid her hand between her thighs.

Catra was eager to taste Adora but wanted to stay in the moment. She hadn't been able to get the thought of Adora spread

out below her out of her mind. The scent and delicate flavor had stolen her attention for much of her time after she had experienced it. After the day without her phone, she thought she would never have that contact it again. But here she was, gingerly teasing Adora while her orgasm was lingering within.

Adora crooned as she felt the brush of Catra's soft fingers on her clit. Even with her underwear still on, the light touch was all she needed. Catra loved watching Adora unravel below her. But, she needed to see Adora fully. She slid the soaked pair of underwear off and tossed them on the floor. With that, she started to slowly circle the eager clit.

Adora's eyes were barely open as she marveled in the feeling. Catra moved off of Adora's hips and laid between her legs. She moved her fingers over Adora's clit, before moving down to her slick opening and gently starting to work her fingers inside. "How does that feel?"

Adora's moan said it all. "Oh my god."

Catra set a relatively slow pace, and she kissed Adora's folds before parting them with her tongue. Her soft tongue delicately moved over Adora's clit. Within a few moments, Catra felt Adora's walls tighten around her fingers. *That was fast.* She felt her arousal peak again, knowing that her touch had such an effect on Adora. Increasing the speed of her tongue, she felt Adora's hands grab the back of her head, pulling her closer. "Please. I'm so close." Catra's fingers pumped faster.

"Unnnnhhh!" Adora's muscles clamped onto Catra's fingers, making it somewhat tricky to keep fucking her at that pace. She slowed down as Adora's body slowly relaxed. It seemed like Adora's orgasms were more intense and prolonged than hers.

"Catra…" Adora laid there slowly swinging her legs together. The orgasms she had when she masturbated were very different from this. She had no idea it was possible to feel this good. "How can something feel so incredible?" She sat up to cup Catra's face,

pulling her into a kiss. Catra haphazardly crawled on Adora as the two kissed.

"I'm glad you liked it." A soft purr radiated from her. "I love you."

Adora looked at Catra and placed their foreheads together. "I love you too."

They lay gently caressing each other in silence. Catra had to work late and didn't know what time it was. "I don't want to work today. I just wanna lay in bed with you," she whined.

"Could we just have sex all day? Maybe get lunch. Then back to bed for more sex." Adora kissed Catra's cheek.

"Oh, that sounds fantastic." She kissed Adora's cheek and sat up. Skipping work and laying in bed with Adora sounded like something she wanted to do every day. But, you can't run a successful bookstore by not showing up. "I have to reconcile inventory today." She whined. "The good news is, after this, I'll have a better idea of what I can do with the store." She got out of bed and stood next to Adora, looking down at the comfortable woman lying across the bed. "I want to start a book club that meets every week and maybe some board game nights." Before she walked to the door, she leaned over to kiss Adora's forehead. "Come take a shower with me." Her tail casually swung behind her.

Adora opened her laptop. It was time to get some homework done. She only had a few more assignments to do before she was finished with the class. It hadn't sunk in yet, but she was going to graduate with a degree in social work. It was such an empowering and scary moment. Her parents would want to come to her graduation. Of course, they would be confused why she was graduating from the social science department rather than the engineering science department. She sighed. Sooner or later, she would have to deal with her parents. She couldn't keep lying to

them. It was time for her to take her life back and live it how she sees fit. In reality, they cannot tell her what to do anymore; she has her own home, will soon have a degree and a wonderful girlfriend. *A girlfriend.*

She hadn't even stopped to think about what her parents would say about Catra. They knew that Catra was her lifelong friend and had been relatively supportive of their friendship, but there were few comments about how "rough" Catra was. Or how she didn't have drive. When the truth was much different than their narrow view of the world; Catra was one of the most driven people Adora has ever known. That was one of the things she loved about her. When she wanted something, she went for it. Independence was her thing, and Adora was glad to be connected with her.

It just wasn't something her parents could handle. And it wasn't something she wanted to deal with. It was her life, and she didn't have to explain it to anyone. However, there would be a time when her parents did come over, and they would ask why she slept in Catra's room. Maybe one day they could share a room; they pretty much already did at this point. She picked up her phone.

Adora [1:34 pm]: *Hey, baby. You felt so good today. I can't wait to taste you again.*

Adora [1:35 pm]: *Do you like to be touched like you touched me?*

She still was a little nervous about directly saying sexual things to Catra. With time, it would probably get easier. Hopefully, Catra liked sexting because Adora really wanted to do it with her. Opening her textbook, she wrote the chapter title on the top of her writing pad. *Time to get this done.*

Catra handed the last customer their receipt and wished them a good day. "Wow, that was quite a rush." She turned to Netossa.

"How is Spinnerella?"

"She's doing well. She took the week off and is just going to rest while she adjusts with the cast." Netossa leaned on the counter.

"I have never broken a bone. I could only imagine what that is like." Catra folded her arms.

"Neither have I. She was miserable the first night, but she seems better as the days pass." Netossa grabbed a pile of trade-ins. "I'm going to finish processing these. What more do you have to do for inventory?"

"I just need to go over the reports and see what we are missing and try to locate it. There are a bunch of boxes of books in the back room, and I want to see if I can make room for a bargain or clearance section."

After she printed the reports, she stood there waiting for the papers to pop out of the machine. She was glad that the previous owners had invested in an excellent printer because it made things much more manageable. This was especially true for printing labels for the books people traded in. As she stood there zoning out, her phone buzzed in her pocket. She pulled it out. Her eyes widened at the texts that popped up on her lock screen. It was fitting, as the picture that now blanketed her screen was a picture they had taken together after their morning adventures. She opened the texts and replied.

Catra [1:37 pm]: *your tongue felt amazing*

Catra [1:37 pm]: *you mean, do i like to be fingered while being licked?*

Catra [1:38 pm]: *i really like it. do you want to do it to me?*

Oh, she was so here for this. Sexting Adora throughout the day after they had a morning full of great sex? Yes, please. It would

help the time pass and give her some ideas on what to try next with Adora. She grabbed her inventory sheets, tossed them onto a clipboard, and grabbed her favorite pen.

She started walking around the store to the sections where the most items were missing. Looking over the shelves for the book she was missing, she quickly found it. Then the next book and the next. It looked like they had forgotten to scan this entire shelf. Maybe she and Rogelio had forgotten to put the books on their side. Either way, she marked all of the books as she found them. Her phone buzzed.

Adora [1:46 pm]: *Yes. I love how you feel when you come.*

Adora [1:47 pm]: *What's your favorite way to come?*

She waited as the three dots popped up, then vanished. Oh, this was heating up. She had wanted to know every way that Adora liked to get off, and it was hot that Adora wanted to know hers. Adora was a much more sexual person than she had ever thought. Living together made sex easy, as they were always around each other and didn't have to worry about anyone else showing up. Only a few people had a key to their house, and those people didn't show up unannounced.

Catra [1:50 pm]: *by myself or with a partner?*

She grinned and slid her phone back in her pocket. Before she could find where she was on her inventory list, her phone buzzed.

Adora [1:51 pm]: *Both.*

Maybe she should tell Adora that she had thought of her many times while she let her own fingers explore her body. There were countless times when she said Adora's name as she reached her peak. She bit her finger, thinking about a reply.

Catra [1:53 pm]: *i really like to use three fingers to feather over my clit. It almost feels like i'm being licked*

Catra [1:54 pm]: *I like being fingered while i'm lying on my belly*

Catra [1:55 pm]: *tell me what you like*

Catra [1:56 pm]: *you are making it hard to fix inventory. I should be home fucking you*

She could feel her cheeks warming as she looked at the texts she just sent. She bit her finger and slid the phone back into her pocket. Shaking her head, she held the clipboard in front of her face. *Okay, get this done.*

Adora thought about what she should say to Catra. She had only had sex with her, and everything they had done so far had felt incredible. When she masturbated, it was usually quick, and she didn't try many things. One summer, she went to an adult shop and bought a vibrator to try it out. She used it a few times but ended up throwing it away because she was worried someone would find it.

It was increasingly difficult to focus on homework. Her book was on the same page as it was when she started. That was probably because the chapter was boring, but she was also extra distracted. When she moved to get up, she could feel how wet she was; the moisture collecting in her underwear was making itself known. She turned on the oven to make something for lunch and grabbed her phone.

Adora [2:00 pm]: *I have loved everything we've done so far. But, your fingers inside me while you're licking me takes the cake. You feel so fucking good.*

Adora [2:01 pm]: *I usually just use my fingers while I think about you.*

Adora [2:02 pm]: *How do you want to fuck me?*

Before Adora sat back down to really start her homework, she got an idea. Maybe it was time to send Catra a picture of what she was missing. She went to her room and stood in front of her mirror. She lifted her shirt high enough to see the swell of her breasts and took a picture of her bare torso. Checking it before sending it to Catra, she hoped she would hear about all the things Catra wanted to do with her.

Heading back to her kitchen, she smiled and put her phone away. She opened the freezer, looking for something for lunch. She was having a hard time choosing between a pizza or chicken nuggets and tater tots. Both were equally unhealthy, but sometimes you need a good comfort meal. The pizza would take less time, but tots were always a good choice. She wished they had an air fryer.

Catra had to excuse herself from the sales floor after she opened the picture that Adora sent. She could not hide her arousal any longer. The temptation to walk into the bathroom and touch herself was getting stronger, but she knew she should wait. The build-up would make her subsequent interaction with Adora delicious.

She took a few minutes to collect herself. Her water bottle was full of ice-cold water, and she thought about pouring it on her lap but knew it wouldn't help the situation; the need was too strong. She loved the increased feeling of intimacy between Adora and her; the sex was an excellent addition, but being so close was the most compelling part.

Maybe it was because things didn't generally work out for her, or she was just still in a state of disbelief, but the excitement she felt about being Adora's *girlfriend* was almost too much. She didn't have to pretend to have only platonic feelings for her and didn't feel like she was lying anymore. The excitement over telling their friends was euphoric. It was real.

She wasn't worried about telling their friends; the only thing she was feeling uneasy about was Adora's parents. They had never really been the most accepting and open people, and Hope never really liked Catra. Well, it seemed that way. Adora always reassured her that her mom liked her just fine, but she just wasn't the nicest person. That was an understatement. Growing up with Adora, she had plenty of sleepovers to know that Mara was the nicer one in the partnership.

Hope never explicitly told Catra she didn't like her, but there was always an undertone of dislike. The comments she would make and the passive-aggressive questions she would ask Adora in front of her. Adora's parents probably wouldn't care that she was gay, but they would care that she was gay with Catra. It was weird to think about meeting your girlfriend's parents when you knew them well and were sure one of them hated you.

Catra knew her home life growing up wasn't healthy; it wasn't a surprise to anyone that Ms. Weaver, as she was referred to, was not a good person. There had been one specific instance where Adora met Ms. Weaver, and suffice to say, it did not go well. After that meeting, Adora didn't come to Catra's house again, not that she even had a choice. Ms. Weaver thought that Catra was bringing down Adora and she should look elsewhere for friends. Catra had learned early in life not to internalize the things that others say and do. Although, it was easier said than done.

She had done a lot of work and personal growth over the years; seeing a weekly therapist had been instrumental in that process. Adora knew that when Catra moved out that it severed the relationship she had with her mother. They did not talk, even on birthdays. She was dead to Catra, and there was no looking back. It took her many years to stop trying to please Ms. Weaver because she knew there was nothing she could do to prove that she deserved love. Adora was the one constant in her life and the sole source of unconditional love.

How Adora learned unconditional love was a mystery with a mother like Hope. But Mara always seemed to care. Catra knew

that it would be quite the endeavor when Adora came out to them. She was sure that Adora would want to tell them because lying was something she couldn't do. Like, it was almost impossible for her to lie. You could see it in her body language and how she spoke. Eye contact was a thing of the past when she was trying to speak an untruth.

It was one of the reasons that Adora finally moved out. She was unhappy being forced to walk in her parent's footsteps and couldn't tell them that she wanted to do something else. So, she left. She and Catra talked about moving in together in college and sharing a room forever. Back then, they meant it as bunk beds, but now that wish had a whole new meaning.

Catra would support Adora in whatever she chose, but with how long they had been friends, she knew exactly what she would do. Leaning back on her chair, she smiled. *Girlfriends* . It was time to break out of her daydream and get back to work. It would be dinner time in a few hours, and she wanted to get her report finished before then.

Adora clicked 'save' for the last time; she was finally done with her last paper for the day. Standing up from her chair, she stretched out her limbs. Finn jumped onto the warm chair she was just sitting in, and she reached down to scratch the cat's head. She was planning on making pasta for dinner tonight and surprising Catra with it at work. Smiling, she washed her hands after pulling out all the ingredients. She separated the eggs she needed and saved the extra egg whites for breakfast tomorrow.

Pouring a few cups of flour directly onto the counter, she moved her hands gently in the center to create a little well for the eggs. She took a pinch of salt and sprinkled it over the flour. Grabbing the eggs, she beat them with a fork and slowly poured them into the center of the flour. She stood there for a second, watching the eggs settle, and slowly added a bit of the flour walls into the eggs.

It had been so long since they last made boxed pasta. But, with their friends coming over soon, they would probably have to rely on the stuff in a box as it would be difficult to make enough dough for six people by hand. There was a vegan pasta recipe that Adora wanted to try out, a vegan chorizo-stuffed ravioli with a spicy tomato sauce. That would be the perfect time to try it out. Maybe she could enlist Catra in the pasta making process, even if her claws always got in the way. Adora usually had to clean them out after with a toothpick, so it didn't harden in an uncomfortable place.

She looked forward to making dinner together for their friends. It wasn't unusual for Catra and her to make meals together. Whenever they were home, they usually tag-teamed the meal and the clean-up. They just worked so well together. There were so many times that Catra could read Adora's mind and offer to do the dishes when she didn't want to. They really knew each other's mannerisms and emotional tells.

Adora set a ten-minute timer with the dough ready to be kneaded and started to work it on the counter. She wanted to get her room cleaned up before she headed to Catra. Their laundry had gotten wild in the last few days, and she needed to get it under control. Usually, they were better about doing laundry, but it had been a roller coaster of a few weeks, and things were starting to settle, and she was thankful for that.

Graduation was coming up, and she was waiting for the approval to come through to start inviting people. *Graduation.* That meant that she had to talk to her parents. She wasn't looking forward to it. Either way, they would be disappointed. She had been hiding her major from them, and her relationship with Catra would not be easy to talk about. She sighed and wrapped the dough in a reusable food wrap and set it on the counter. After she washed her hands, she walked out of the kitchen. It was laundry time.

She walked through each of their rooms and collected all of the clothes on the ground. She dragged the laundry basket down the hall to the laundry room and opened the washer. Empty. *Phew.* Before she tossed the clothes in the machine, she walked to the front room to grab Catra's hoodie. She picked it up and smelled it. It smelled like Catra. *Maybe I'll keep this out for now.* She could wear it to bring Catra dinner while everything else was washed.

She didn't want to separate the clothes, so she just started throwing clothes in the washer; she was good about checking pockets and turning pants inside out to help them last longer. She didn't actually know how that was supposed to make them last longer, but she was told to do it by her parents, so she never questioned it. There were a lot of weird things they did that she never questioned. She shrugged.

There was a bowl on top of the dryer with all the stuff they found in pockets. Mostly change and dollar bills. When they wanted a treat and were both a little short on cash, they could always check their laundry fund. It was usually enough to get at least an ice cream to share. She picked up a pair of jeans and checked the pockets. *Oh, a ten!* This will be a great addition to the fund. She did this a few more times and only came up with lint and a few pens. The last pair of pants she checked had some change and a piece of paper in them. She tossed them into the bowl.

Papercut

Chapter Summary

Adora makes a discovery and does what she does best, panic.

Chapter Notes

Gosh, I was writing a part of a new chapter yesterday and it hit me how much I like this story.

AND oh heck, this story reached over 10k hits! I'm honestly floored. Like, I had never written fiction before, only formal research papers. I do catch myself writing formally and have to redo many parts. My beta reader, myhypotheticalromance, knows full well. haha. But, dang! I'm glad y'all are liking it. (I mean I think you do lol) Thank you everyone!

I also have a drabble collection where I write 1k word little scenes/stories and some of them will turn into full fics! Check it out **Tales of Intrigue: She-Ra**

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora walked into her room and looked at the hot mess in front of her. She hadn't spent much time in her room for the past week, and it looked like it needed some TLC. The bed had not been made, and some of the blankets were still on the floor. Also, the random assortment of shoes throughout the space made it seem like she had many more pairs than she actually did. She sighed. *Okay, start with the bed.*

As soon as she moved onto the bed, images of her and Catra filled her mind. She ran her hand over the messy sheets, almost as if she was re-experiencing their first time. Then, smiling, she moved Catra's pillow back to its spot and straightened the sheets and blankets before she moved on to the wilderness that was the

floor. A distinct upbeat ditty echoed through the walls of the house. *Laundry's done*.

This may have been the first time in Adora's life that she was glad that she had to do laundry. Her room was a disaster, and she was less than motivated to clean it. Opening the dryer, she worried it was full of wrinkled clothes. But, lo and behold, it was empty. It was turning out to be a wonderful day. Switching the laundry, she started the dryer and tossed another load into the washer.

Reaching over to grab the laundry soap, she bumped the glass bowl with all their laundry treasures, and coins, trinkets, and the folded piece of paper fell out, landing with the writing facing up. She did a double-take, recognizing the name. She held it up, and an uneasy feeling bubbled in her belly.

The scrap of paper simply read 'Mermista 555-637-6243' with the *a* in the shape of a heart.

Adora folded the piece of paper and set it in the treasure bowl. She could feel her heart beating in her ears, and she slid the laundry soap the rest of the way to the washer. *Mermista? From the market?* The dark-haired pancake connoisseur was gorgeous, and Adora wasn't surprised that Catra was attracted to her. She finished adding the soap and pressed the button. *Was she attracted to Mermista?*

As she walked down the hall, she looked into Catra's room, which had essentially become her new room, and sighed. Catra worked at a popular bookstore in a very hipster part of town; of course,

there would be cute women who would stop in for books. Fortunately, most of the other bookstores had closed or gone online only. But, Catra was the lone survivor in that arena and was bound to have admirers.

Walking into the kitchen, Adora looked at the ball of dough that hadn't done much since she went to start laundry. She poked the ball, knowing full well it wasn't ready, but she needed to do something with her hands to take her mind off the phone number. *Cat box! Bathroom?*

She walked back down the hall to the bathroom and started moving things off the sink to wipe it down. What if Catra had been talking to Mermista before they had sex? *Or...* She breathed in. *After.* She picked up the bathroom cleaner and her towel. *No. This is not productive. Just talk to her; you promised you would.* She looked at herself in the mirror. This whole thing with Catra was simultaneously so new and so familiar; she didn't fully know how she was supposed to act as Catra's girlfriend yet. And for a moment, she thought maybe she didn't know how to be a lesbian.

Maybe she was doing it wrong. They hadn't talked about monogamy. They just talked about what to call each other and that they were girlfriends. Part of her thought that it would all just fall into place as it does in the movies, but she quickly realized that that was fantasy. Maybe, she could have a nice dinner with Catra, then talk to her when she got home. She didn't want to ambush her or confront her at work.

After the bathroom was clean, she walked downstairs into the basement and started cleaning Finn's box. She was glad that they had the basement to keep Finn's stuff in, because it would have

been terrible to have it in plain view smelling up the house. However, the box wasn't as bad as she thought it would be. Maybe Catra had cleaned it out this week. She stood up and looked around.

The unfinished basement was full of both of their miscellaneous belongings. There were some things they wanted to bring upstairs but had never gotten around to it. She looked at the clear storage containers their possessions were stored in. It was the smartest thing they had ever done. They could see what was in each container, and it would help protect against pests and moisture. Catra had moved a few times in her life, and each time she gained additional tricks and tips on making a move more manageable. Hopefully, this would be their home for a long time.

The boxes were all marked with some sort of label. But most of Catra's were marked with pieces of masking tape, its contents written with a sharpie. There were a few that were filled with winter clothes. It was going to be time to open those soon. Summer was about rounding out. There were a few boxes with holiday decorations. It would be their first year to be festive in their home. Catra wasn't much of a fan of holiday decorating, but Adora liked to do things for Halloween. They would often do a combined Halloween and birthday bonanza for Catra. She was usually broody before the party but always ended up having a good time.

Looking at the other boxes, she saw Catra's video game systems. Catra prided herself on how many old school systems and rare games she owned. Before they moved, she had just finished her NES Castlevania collection. Adora loved going over to Catra's apartment to hang out or do homework, and Catra was sitting on the floor in front of her TV playing her old games. She would get

frustrated at how hard the games were and then jump for joy when she finally beat the game. It took her years to beat a few of them.

The box next to the video games contained their small board game collection. She was excited that Catra wanted to add board games to her store; maybe that way, they could finally have a more extensive collection. Bow liked to buy games on crowdfunding sites, and the collection he had was awe-inspiring. Adora wished she had gotten into that earlier, and of course, had more expendable income. She would love to have the neat things in their storage displayed for all to enjoy. *Maybe one day.*

Adora walked to a container marked *picture albums* . She smiled and opened the lid when she saw numerous photo albums from each of their childhoods. So many of the albums had pictures of the two of them playing or at a carnival together. They had been such integral parts of each other's lives for such a long time. She looked through the album on the top of the pile; it was one of Catra's. It looked like she was five or six, and it was her birthday. The cake that she was given covered her face and hands. There was even some frosting on the tips of her ears—s*till the same.* Turning the page, her phone buzzed in her pocket.

Catra [3:45 pm]: *wow baby, just wow*

It looked like Catra enjoyed the picture she sent earlier. She smiled and texted her back.

Adora [3:46 pm]: *I'm glad you liked it, baby.*

Adora [3:46 pm]: *Can I bring you dinner in a little bit?*

The three dots popped up on the screen, and a few seconds later, a message appeared.

Catra [3:47 pm]: *i would love that*

Catra [3:47 pm]: *im excited to see you*

Catra [3:48 pm]: *i love you*

Adora smiled. *I don't think I have anything to worry about.* She picked the heavy box of photo albums and carried it upstairs. Setting the albums on the couch, she went to wash her hands. She stood at the sink and enjoyed the warmth of the water rush over her soapy hands. It was one of her favorite feelings in the world and usually gave her a nice chill up her body.

The dough had set up perfectly. Before she worked with the dough, she went to the freezer and pulled out a bag of frozen pasta sauce and some spicy sausage. A few weeks ago, Adora perfected her pasta sauce recipe and made a large batch to freeze. She was thankful that they took the time to do that because now they had enough for a few more batches of pasta. After getting the sauce on the stove, she unwrapped the dough, sprinkled on some flour, and started to work with the soft ball.

A few months ago, she had found this recipe, and with how much Catra loved pasta, she was excited to try it. Their first few attempts went as expected. But, Adora now felt confident in her ability to make the perfect pasta. They had not bought a pasta maker yet , so she did everything by hand. Slowly but surely, they were building up their kitchen appliances, but they still only had the basics.

Adora loved making the pasta by hand. It added an extra special touch and showed Catra how much she cared. She was not in a hurry to buy a pasta machine or a mixer. It just wouldn't be the same. And this was an activity that they loved doing together. With a possible friend dinner coming up, Adora was looking forward to cooking with Catra. It was always funny when Catra got frustrated because dough got stuck in her claws. Adora smiled as she cut the dough into sections to roll out.

There was one kitchen gadget that Adora had to have, a marble rolling pin. The old wood one that she used wasn't terrible, but it was well-used, and it was time to be replaced. So Adora decided to splurge and buy the rolling pin. When she bought it, they made pasta that night so Adora could try it out.

Adora hadn't really thought about it before, but when she made Catra pasta, she usually sat purring. Sometimes it was evident that Catra was trying to mask her purrs, but Adora could still hear it. It was one of her favorite sounds, and she would do anything to hear it. While zoning out, her phone dinged and she took it out of her pocket. It was 4:23 pm. She would need to get the pasta in the water soon to make sure she had time to get it in containers to bring to Catra.

Once the dough was rolled out and cut into thick strips, she stood in front of the water and watched the hypnotic dancing tiny bubbles, waiting for it to reach a rolling boil. She held a pile of pasta in her hand and felt Finn rubbing against her leg. She looked down and smiled. The familiar sound of water boiling took her attention away from the sweet cat, and she dropped the raw pasta into the water.

After everything had finished cooking, she packed up the delicious-smelling food, grabbed her keys and phone, and walked out of the door.

*

When she pulled up to the bookstore, the parking lot was relatively empty aside from Catra's black Prius, a teal sedan with several "save the whales" stickers, and an older car with a few faded stickers. She was excited to see Catra. One of her favorite things was to watch Catra reworking displays. She would stand in front of the display and study it before making changes, then stand back and analyze it again until she got it right. Adora loved how cute Catra looked when she was deep in thought or focused on something. Her ears would move and adjust multiple times as she worked through her plan in her mind.

Adora walked into the store, and it was seemingly empty. She looked over to the counter and saw Rogelio pricing books. "Hey, Rogelio. Is Catra around?" As soon as she finished her sentence, she heard Catra's voice behind her.

"Yeah, we got a few books on sharks traded in the other day. But, I think you may have some of them." Catra was talking to a dark-haired woman dressed in teal. When the woman turned her head, Adora gasped and immediately stiffened. When Catra saw Adora

standing by the counter, she lit up. "Oh, Mermista, come meet my girlfriend." Catra walked the rest of the distance between the two. "Hey, babe." She smiled.

Adora's face flushed. "Hi."

Catra held Adora's free hand. "This is my girlfriend, Adora. Honey, this is Mermista. She's a regular who has probably single-handedly paid our rent a few times." She laughed.

"Hey." Mermista didn't look like she was impressed.

Adora tried to break the awkward feeling of meeting the woman whose number you've just found in her girlfriend's pocket. She gave her best fake smile. "Weren't you at the farmer's market last weekend? Those pancakes were delicious."

"Yeah, totally. They are pretty good, I guess." Her cheeks pinked a bit.

Catra knew Adora well and could tell that something was bothering Adora. She looked at Adora, then at Mermista. "It looks like Adora brought us dinner, so I'll have Rogelio help you with those new books. I can let you know when anything else comes in. Sometimes we even get textbooks that come through." She went to finish up with Mermista, then walked back to Adora and kissed her. "Hey."

Adora smiled, a bit of her worry had faded, but the awkwardness remained. "I made it spicy again and added sausage."

"Oh, that sounds so good. I'm so hungry. Thank you for bringing me dinner." Catra's smile could not possibly get any bigger.

Adora watched as Catra beamed. She was so cute when she was this happy. Adora could swear that she heard the sound of light purring before Catra led her to the back room.

Catra took the bag and started to take out the containers. Her purr was very apparent in the quiet backroom. "This looks so good."

"I love when you purr, baby." Adora kissed Catra's cheek.

Catra's cheeks instantly turned red, and she crossed her arms.

Adora laughed. "You are so cute."

As they started eating, Catra inquired about how Adora knew Mermista. She was surprised that the two had met and that Mermista worked at a pancake shop.

"Oh yeah, I saw her booth at the farmer's market last weekend. She works at a gourmet pancake place. They were really good. Glimmer and I had the cinnamon one." Adora handed Catra a napkin and smirked.

"Is it already all over my face?" Catra started wiping her face in random places and looking at the towel before moving to another area.

Adora laughed. "Not yet, but it's inevitable." Her anxiety started to rise as she thought about asking Catra about Mermista's number while they were talking about her.

Catra pouted her lips. "It's just so good. I can't help it."

Adora mindlessly stirred her pasta. "So, uh, I found Mermista's phone number in your pocket while I was doing laundry." She didn't look up.

Catra's face immediately went red; she straightened up in her chair and scratched the back of her head. She had completely forgotten that she put the number in her pocket. Her words flew out rapid-fire. "Oh, yeah. She gave it to me the day that my phone was in your car." She set her fork down and looked at Adora, who had looked up as Catra spoke. "I thought it was you that came in to see me. Then she gave me her number to hang out." Catra sighed. "I shoved it in my pocket and went in the back ro-"

Adora was surprised at how quickly Catra was speaking; she cupped Catra's face. "Hey, hey, you don't have to explain. I just wanted it out in the open, so it didn't become an issue. I trust you, Catra." It was true. She had trusted Catra all her life; why would that all the sudden change? Catra loved her, and she loved Catra. She brought Catra's forehead to her's. "I love you."

Catra's body relaxed. "I love you too."

"If something like that ever comes up, can we promise to talk to each other about it?" Adora rubbed Catra's cheek with her thumb.

"Promise."

Adora walked into the house and set the bag of empty dishes on the table. Bending over to pick up Finn, she cuddled with the sweet cat and gave them lots of kisses. After a few moments, Finn was over it. But, she loved their cat and just wanted to give them a little cuddle. She would admit that she felt extra happy after her dinner with Catra, which may have translated into more smooches for Finn. Their conversation had gone better than she imagined. She understood that she was more nervous than usual because their relationship was new, and they were trying to navigate the transition from friends to partners.

She set the cat down to go do the dishes and clean up from earlier. The pasta turned out perfect this time, and she was excited to have meals left over for them to eat for the next several days. But, looking at the backsplash and the stove, she wondered why pasta sauce was so messy. It was almost impossible to cook pasta without getting sauce all over, and it made sense that Catra couldn't keep it in her mouth.

After the kitchen was cleaned up, Adora went to look through the container of photo albums. Standing next to the box, she picked up the first album and flipped through it casually, setting it down on the couch. She went through all of the albums and sorted them by the ones she wanted to look through with Catra and ones that could go back in the bin. Picking up the chosen albums, she walked to Catra's room to set them on the bed. They could look through them before they go to bed later.

With nothing else to do, Adora plopped down on the couch to watch a little TV. Just as she sat down and turned the TV on, the laundry buzzer went off. *Uggghhhh.* She had forgotten that she turned the dryer on right before she left to bring Catra dinner. She sat there deciding if she wanted to finish laundry or just let it sit overnight. But, she had left the other clean load in the basket to take care of when she got home. Reluctantly, she got up and dragged the clean clothes into the front room to fold as she watched TV.

The distinct sound of a key wiggling in a door piqued Adora's attention. She waited as Catra opened the door and walked in. "Hey, Adora." Her expression was inviting.

"Hi. How was the rest of work, baby?" Adora quickly stood up and went to meet Catra.

"It was good. Went by pretty quickly." She pulled Adora in and kissed her. "I really like being able to kiss you when I come home from work."

Adora blushed. "I like it too." She nuzzled into Catra's neck.

Catra pulled away from Adora, "I need to pee. Give me a second." She quickly walked to the bathroom.

Adora smiled and sat on the couch waiting for her, pushing the box of photo albums off to allow for more room for Catra to sit. She was excited to look at pictures with Catra; they had not looked at them since they moved in. Adora's parents gave her a copy of each photo album after moving out so she didn't "forget" where she came from. Which, she had no idea what they meant by that. But she was glad she had them now.

"What's in that box?" Catra said as she walked over to Adora.

Adora looked up. "Oh! When I was cleaning Finn's box today, I found our photo albums, and I thought we could look at them together before bed."

"That sounds great. Do you want to come get ready with me?" Catra yawned and held her hand out to Adora.

"Good idea." She followed Catra. The little things that they have done together forever had such renewed meaning. Even the simple act of brushing their teeth together was meaningful.

After Adora's post-brush-mirror-teeth-check, Catra commented, "Wow, it looks like you cleaned everything."

Adora blushed, "Yeah, I had a bit of extra time." There was no use telling Catra her worry related to finding Mermista's number earlier, they had talked about it, and things were good. Although they still needed to talk about a few more things, she was glad that Catra noticed how clean the house was. After she was done brushing her teeth, she turned to run into Catra's room. "Race ya!"

"What?!" Catra wasn't done brushing her teeth. "It's across the hall!"

Adora laughed as she leaped into Catra's bed. "I won!" she laughed as Catra quickly followed.

"That's not fair!" Catra huffed.

"Awww, come here, baby."

"Hmmph."

Adora reached out and grabbed Catra's shirt. "Come on."

Catra fell into bed laughing as Adora tickled and nuzzled her neck. "Okay, forgiven."

"Oh, good." Adora smiled and tucked a few loose strands of hair behind Catra's ear. "I love you, Catra."

Catra smiled, looking into Adora's eyes. "I love you, too."

Adora cupped Catra's face. "Are you ready to look at the pictures?"

"Sure thing." She slipped under the covers and watched Adora bring the first album over. "Oh, wow. These are old."

"Yeah, aren't they cool?" Adora settled in next to Catra.

"Let's see how gay you were as a kid." Catra laughed.

Adora blushed and pulled Catra closer.

They flipped through the first book, looking at the stages of Catra's mane throughout her childhood. She had never been one for scheduled grooming, but she had other tricks to keep her hair in check as an adult. There were a few pictures of them together, mostly Adora crying or sharing food with Catra. Surprisingly, there was only one picture of a crying Catra. It was so cute with Catra's wild hair and unproportionate tail. For some reason, her tail always had a growth spurt before the rest of her.

The next album had pictures of them as teenagers and a school dance picture with Catra and Adora with their dates. Adora cringed at seeing these pictures. Not only was the dress terrible, but damn, the guy she was with looked like he was hoping that Adora would be his high school sweetheart. Her focus switched to the girl that hung off of Catra’s arm. A twinge of latent jealousy radiated throughout her body. "What was her name?"

"I honestly can't remember. Connie, or Bonnie, or something. We were friends, and she didn't have a date and asked me to go with her since she had already bought the outfit."

"How did you get your mom to get you that tux?"

"I never asked her." Catra turned the page.

Adora knew that Miss Weaver wasn't at all supportive of Catra, and she had done a lot of work to heal from her childhood. Nevertheless, her heart ached to know that Catra's teen years were not pleasant, to say the least. Adora hugged Catra tight.

The next photo album was a more recent one with them in Catra's apartment; some pictures were from the more wild times. Adora's cheeks blushed when the images from the night they had made out popped up. "Do you remember that night?"

"I do." Catra looked over to Adora. "Who would have thought that almost a year later, we would be laying in bed *together* , looking at old photo albums?"

"I'm glad it happened. I'm sorry I freaked out, and we never talked about it."

"Don't be. Things tend to happen for a reason. It just wasn't the right time for us to talk about our feelings."

"That's true." Adora was silent for a few moments. "Hey, Catra? Can I ask you something?"

"Of course."

"Are we monogamous?"

Catra sat up in bed and looked at Adora. "Oh, um. I guess that is something that we should talk about." She thought for a second before she spoke. "I have always been monogamous, except once, and I am most comfortable in a monogamous relationship. And I'd like to be with you; what do you think?"

"I would like to be monogamous with you and if that changes one day, can we talk to each other about it?"

"Absolutely." Catra pulled Adora in closer, kissed the top of her head, as they looked at the last photo album.

Chapter End Notes

> Catra and Adora working through their new relationship and communicating? Yes please!
>
> I think folks tend to think that important conversations have to be really intense and overwhelming, but in reality, folks can have these critical conversations in more casual ways that validate feelings and create intimacy.

Okay, so we have a guest room now

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra prepare for a dinner party.

Chapter Notes

Gosh work and school have been busy and rough lately! I love the fluff in this chapter, it brings me the joy I need to finish this dang semester! I can't wait for it to end, so I have more time to be a human and write!

Thank you everyone for your support! I hope you enjoy.

Catra sat on the edge of her bed, dreading getting up. It would be a day full of cleaning and preparing for the dinner they were having for their friends. She was excited to see their friends and tell them about her and Adora's new relationship, but a big part of her was anxious. She knew that their friends were loving and accepting; she was just nervous that Adora may decide she does not want to tell them at the last minute. It wasn't so much about waiting to tell them; it was a fear that the person she was dating wasn't as into her as she was into them. As much as she wanted to be with Adora, she was just a bit unsure if Adora also wanted the same things she did.

Adora was still lying in bed petting a very cuddly Finn. Her hair was blanketing the pillow, and she was teasing Finn with a few strands. Finn was having the time of their life playing and cuddling. Catra loved to catch Adora in these moments of innocence where she was just silly, fun Adora - the person she grew up with. She wasn't sure why she thought things would be different when they made it official. Maybe it was her dating history or her less than perfect childhood, but she was always waiting for the other shoe to drop. Her emotions told her that

danger was near, but her brain knew that was irrational and not based on reality. Adora was the same loving and kind woman she had always known, and the only thing that was different now was they had admitted their feelings. She laid her hand on Adora's shoulder. "I love you, Adora."

Adora smiled and stopped petting Finn, who was still trying to attack her hair. She placed her hand on Catra's forearm. "I love you too, honey." Ready to get the house cleaned and her room organized, she gave Finn one last kiss, sat up and kissed Catra, and playfully scooted off the bed.

Catra stood up after Adora bounced out of bed and put on some comfortable clothes. They were both going to dress nicely for dinner, but she would push the boundary of wearing loungewear as long as she could. As she walked out of her room and passed Adora's, she saw Adora walking through the mess that was once a floor. "Wow, it's been a minute since we've been in here."

"Yeah, it's mostly just a storage room now," Adora laughed.

She wasn't wrong. They had not even stepped foot in the room for days. Adora had only gone into the room to get clothes or textbooks. If it wasn't clear already, the state of Adora's room proved that she was very much a different person than a year ago. Catra watched as Adora ineffectively attempted to clean the filthy room. Adora tossed pieces of trash into the garbage and threw some of her shoes into a pile.

Catra scratched the back of her head. "Um, why don't you move into my room. You sleep in there every night anyway, so it would be easier for you to have your stuff in there. This can be a guest room for when we have guests over or when Glimmer drinks too much and can't drive. Then she doesn’t have to sleep on the couch." She let out an awkward laugh. Her over-explanation made it apparent that she was nervous.

Adora slowly stood up, looked at Catra, and wrapped her arms around her neck. "Catra, are you asking me to move in with you?" Her smile couldn't be tamed.

"Well...uh...I guess...only if you wa-"

"Of course, I'll move my stuff into your room. Can we start after breakfast?"

"Okay." She smiled and kissed Adora. Her body was full of excitement. Even though they already lived together, she couldn't wait for them to share a room. For a reason barely known to her, the shared physical space was crucial in proving that this was real. Even though they had agreed that they were girlfriends, those were words and could be changed or taken back, but sharing a room would solidify their relationship and take out any question that they were together. A feeling of reassurance replaced the excitement. *This was real.*

Adora hugged Catra again before turning to walk away. "I'm gonna go start breakfast. Do you want coffee or tea?"

"Oh, I think coffee will help keep me awake for all the house cleaning." She pouted her lips.

"Okay, babe, I'll go start it." Adora smiled before walking into the hallway.

Catra stood in the doorway of Adora's room, looking at all of the personal items that made it evident that it was Adora's room. Her simple white bedding with gold embellishments, and the clothes hanging up in her closet ranging from white and gray, with a few pops of color throughout. The few picture frames that were scattered on her desk were pictures of them together or just Finn.

It was nice to see that Adora had let her room fall into disarray. Yet another example of Adora's independence. Walking across the hall, Catra looked into her room and noticed all of the places where Adora could blend her belongings with Catra's. Neither of them used much space in their closet, and Catra had a lot of free space in her dresser. She opened the top drawer and pushed her underwear to the side, leaving half of the space open for Adora's clothes.

She did this to the other drawers, then went to her closet to push her clothes to one side. Her favorite pair of jeans was hanging up. She held the garment momentarily, the level of care that Adora put into the things she did for Catra was always a source of joy. She felt cared for with each small thing Adora did.

Catra walked into the kitchen, looking for Adora. "Hey, did you send the invitation to Scorpia and Perfuma too? I haven't heard back from them." She looked at her phone.

Adora picked up her phone, "Yeah, I called Perfuma and invited them. We caught up for an hour, and she gave me a few tips on making vegan pasta."

"Oh, she hasn't said anything about it. But Bow has been texting me, and he wants to make sure that they don't bring something that anyone else brings." She laughed. "He is so thoughtful and worried."

"Sounds like Bow."

Catra looked over Adora's shoulder, seeing the multiple pans that she was juggling. "What can I help you with?"

"Oh, it's almost done. Could you get the butter and syrup out?"

Catra retrieved the requested items and sat at the table. "Do you want to move your room over and then divide and conquer the rest of the house before we start cooking? I don't think it will take very long. I moved my stuff over in my closet and dresser."

"That sounds like an excellent plan. Perfuma said it isn't hard to make the pasta; it's just a few different types of flour and water.

For the filling, we just need to fry it and fill the pasta before we boil it. Do you want to wash our bedding too?" Adora sat their plates down.

Catra was so happy. She tried not to let it show, but it wasn't easy. "That sounds perfect. I'll do laundry. Maybe we should go shopping for new bedding for our bed."

Adora blushed. "I would love that."

After they finished eating, they set their dishes in the sink and put away the extra food. Adora held Catra's hand and turned toward her, "Let's go organize *our* room."

Catra blushed.

They worked together to move Adora's stuff over. Catra focused on her clothes and shoes. Adora waved her hands when Catra asked about her shoes. So, she took that as the go-ahead to take care of those. Next, Adora worked on gathering other items and cleaning up the random bits here and there. Adora didn't have many belongings, so the process wasn't complex. The one issue would be the desk that took up a considerable amount of space in the room.

Adora stood, looking at the desk. "We could just keep it in here, so when people stay over, they have a place to work or do homework." She ran her hand over the white desk. "It could be a

good place for friends to store their things when they come over too."

"Yeah, I think you're right. It could be the office and spare room." Catra threw away a few pieces of garbage. "Are you thirsty? I'm gonna go get a drink."

Adora nodded as she studied the desk. Catra walked into the kitchen and washed her hands. She took their matching water bottles out of the fridge and noticed Finn was lying on one of the kitchen chairs, deep in sleep. Catra was surprised that the cat wasn't under their feet while they moved Adora's old room around.

Catra handed Adora her water bottle and sat down next to her on the floor. "It's looking good. We're almost done."

"Yeah, It's weird to think that our relationship started in this room, and now I'm moving out." Adora looked at the bed.

A twinge of nervousness rippled through Catra's chest. "How do you feel about that? We could move into here if..."

"Oh, no. I want to move into your room. It's bigger, and our relationship has really grown there." She took a sip of her water. "I would never have thought that we would be doing this. We are going to *share* a room, Catra. It's like really happening."

Catra smiled and moved their foreheads together. "I love you."

"I love you too." Adora smiled and kissed Catra. "Can I admit something to you?"

Catra raised her eyebrow. "I'm listening."

Adora pulled a book out from under the bed and set it on her lap. "I...um...I have borrowed books from you to read and hidden them from you because I was nervous you would find out."

She laid her hand on Adora's, "I know, baby."

"Wait, how do you know?"

"After the first night we spent together, when I woke up, I saw a book sitting on your desk."

"Oh. Well, that makes sense." She blushed.

"You could have asked me to borrow any of my books, and I'm not at all mad that you borrowed them without me knowing. You know I leave books all over the house." She smiled and cupped

Adora's face. "You are welcome to read any of the books I have. I actually have a big sectio-"

"I know," Adora interrupted and looked away. "Um, when I visit you at work, I usually go look at that section and read the backs. I have always been nervous about buying one."

"Oh honey, next time you come in, let's look through what I have, and you can pick one out."

Adora rubbed the back of her head. "I mean, you don't have to…"

"Baby, I want to. I can show you all the romance novels I have in our room too." Catra kissed the top of Adora's head. "I love you, baby."

Adora looked up at Catra, "Okay, I'd really like that. Do you think we could read some together?" Her cheeks turned a sweet pink.

"I love that idea. You should come in tomorrow, and we can pick our first one out."

Smiling, she bit her lip, "I may have done some of the things I read about in those books when we have had sex." Her face flushed.

"Oh, did you? Was there anything else you read that you still want to do?" While making eye contact, Catra started to crawl over to Adora slowly. She moved their foreheads together.

Adora stiffened at her proximity to Catra. Trying to control her breathing, she spoke. "Yes."

Not pulling her forehead away, Catra nudged Adora back a bit and moved her legs between Adora's. "Tell me about one."

"Catra…" Adora's eyes widened. Her breath hitched as she watched Catra lean her back while moving her hands up her thighs.

"Tell me." She moved her hands to Adora's center, inching ever closer as Adora struggled to answer. Catra had read most of the books she owned and knew that many of them contained risque scenes. She absolutely wanted to know which ones Adora thought and fantasized about.

"I want to fuck you." Adora was barely able to speak.

Catra's hand moved over Adora's center. "You want to fuck me, baby?" She knew full well that Adora would not be able to carry on a conversation while she was being touched. But, there was something about Adora unable to focus that Catra really enjoyed. "How?"

Adora tried to keep focused, but the feeling of Catra's fingers rubbing her made it impossible. Catra knew exactly how to tease and touch her, and she let out a moan.

"Does that feel good?" Catra's eyes widened as she focused on Adora's responses. Obviously, Adora was trying to hold out, but the tremble in her hands gave her away.

Looking down to watch Catra's hands tease her, she finally gave in and grabbed the bed behind her, grinding herself into Catra's hands. "Please, Catra."

Catra smirked, "Do you want me to make you come, Adora?"

Adora sat there wide-eyed, looking at Catra, almost unable to move. Eventually, she nodded and rolled her hips.

Catra hooked her fingers in Adora's pants and slid them off before spreading her legs. The scent rushed into her like a speeding train. She sharply breathed in and honed in on Adora's exposed sex. Then, running the back of her pointer finger through the wet folds, she licked her lips. "Is all this for me?"

"Mhmm." Adora graciously nodded and whimpered. She needed Catra's fingers. It had been hard not to think about them since she experienced her fingers a few nights ago. Her hips pushed

into Catra's fingers; the light touch was not as satisfying as she craved. But, she sat patiently.

Moving her fingers to Adora's entrance, Catra gently circled before slipping the tip of two fingers in. "Do you want my fingers?"

Adora pushed her hips down onto Catra's fingers and nodded.

"So needy." She fully inserted her fingers in Adora.

Adora threw her head back, trying to grab anything to stabilize her. She cursed having hardwood floors for the first time in her ownership of the house. Catra's fingers filled her nicely as they slowly worked their way deeper inside her. "Catra…" she groaned, grabbing the bed behind her head as Catra increased her speed.

Catra watched as Adora accepted her fingers eagerly. It seemed the more she fucked Adora, the wetter she became. She was grabbing at the bed behind her with each thrust of Catra's fingers. Adora was beautiful as she fell apart. The delicate beads of sweat appearing on her forehead and the obvious strain on her face were breathtaking. The definition in her arms was distracting as she struggled to hold on as the pleasure overtook her.

Wanting to taste Adora's growing arousal, she gently removed her fingers from their home. Adora's disappointment was quickly communicated. "Why did you stop?" she breathed.

Catra's smug grin said it all as she positioned herself between Adora's thighs. Not wanting to give Adora what she wanted instantly, she gingerly kissed her inner thighs. Her growing frustration was made apparent when Adora tried to pull Catra's head toward her center.

"Please, Catra," she pleaded.

Catra responded by replacing her fingers where Adora was left open. Sliding two fingers in, she lowered her mouth, adding short quick strokes on the waiting clit. As soon as her tongue made contact, Adora cried out, "Oh my god." She felt Adora's hands on the back of her head, pulling her in. Adora was already getting close.

Catra's ears were at full attention, taking in each moan and breath Adora let out. Increasing her speed, Adora's thighs clamped against her, and each sound she made was strained. Finally, Adora let go. Her walls tightened against Catra's fingers as her orgasm rippled through her. Letting Adora ride it out, she slowed her fingers as the grip on them loosened.

Adora laid back on the bed, trying to regain some sort of composure, but her efforts were fruitless. Instead, her body felt a warm relaxation as she allowed herself to lay on the floor. "Catra…"

Catra smiled as she watched Adora melt into the floor. "I'm guessing you liked that?" The moisture that covered her sex and the muscle contractions were a fair indicator of her enjoyment.

"How is it possible for it to get better each time?"

"I have many skills." Catra stood up and stretched. One of the downsides of hardwood floors, not very comfortable to kneel or lay on. "I'm gonna go start laundry." She grinned as she walked out of the room, her tail casually swinging behind her.

"Wait! That's not fair!" Adora huffed, not wanting their interaction to end.

Adora had finished moving the last few items over to their shared room and stopped to look at how different it looked, but also how familiar it was. This was the first time she had ever seen Catra's closet full. Well, *their* closet. It was surprising that they had kept their belongings so separate thus far, and now that they were together, it looked natural.

The colors that Catra had generally decorated with were dark red, black, and dark grey. Those were almost the opposite of the colors that Adora usually liked. White, gold, and a bright red. She was looking forward to going shopping for new bedding for their

shared space. Who knows what new color scheme they would bring home.

Walking into the bathroom with her cleaning supplies, Adora did a thorough wipe down, making sure to give extra elbow grease to the areas that usually went unseen. She hadn't heard much from Catra for a while; she was generally pretty quiet, but there was usually some sort of sound to know she was there. Then, leaning out of the door, she yelled down the hall, "Hey baby, where are you?"

Catra yelled back, "I'm in the kitchen. Do you need help?"

Adora walked toward the kitchen. "Oh, no. I was just wondering where you were; you are so quiet."

Catra laughed. "I'm light on my feet, I guess." She finished cleaning off the table and set the serving dishes down.

"I'm gonna tidy up downstairs, then can we start cooking?" Adora closed the space between them, kissing Catra's cheek.

"That sounds great. I'm about done in here, so I can vacuum the rug while you're finishing up." She kissed Adora's soft lips. The touch reignited the fire that had been burning since she left Adora panting on the floor. As much as she wanted to get off, she was *really* enjoying the extended arousal that intensified with each touch or caress from Adora.

Adora reluctantly parted from Catra and made her way downstairs. They worked so well together, especially in taking care of their home. She was thankful for that, not that she thought it would have been difficult to own a home with Catra, but it was a great benefit. Reaching the bottom of the stairs, she turned the light on and looked around. Even though no one would be going into the basement, she felt better if it was tidy. She hoped there would be a day when they could finish it and make it an entertainment space. It wouldn't be difficult to set up a projector and a screen for movie nights with friends or build an elaborate gaming table for board games.

After finishing her task, Adora made her way back upstairs, taking a detour to wash up before helping Catra with dinner. She stopped to look at her bare old room and her and Catra's new room; she felt pure, unadulterated joy. It would probably be a while before she could walk past the two rooms without stopping to look. Things had been evolving at an exciting rate. They now shared a room, and tonight they were going to tell their friends about their new relationship. She felt on top of the world.

"Hey, Catra. Did we buy any wine for tonight?" Adora returned to the kitchen.

"Oh yeah! I forgot to tell you. I picked some up while I was at work the other day. I put it in the pantry. Tell me if that will work." Catra had started collecting the ingredients for the pasta.

Adora's heart filled with love. She walked up behind Catra and slid her hands around her waist, kissing her neck. "I love you so

much, Catra."

Catra's ears stood at attention, and her eyes widened. Her awkward laugh cut her nervousness and growing arousal at the soft kisses. She turned around in Adora's strong arms and held her chin in her hands. "I love you too, Adora."

Adora smiled and ran her hands up Catra's torso, and placed her hands on Catra's neck, moving their foreheads together.

The feel of Adora's hands moving over her body sent a jolt of heat to her center. She thought she had a bit more control over her arousal, but it turned out she was wrong. Getting Adora off a few hours ago created a free-for-all in her core. A small moan escaped her mouth. She immediately felt her cheeks warm.

Adora picked up on the subtle sound, instantly recognizing it as one of her favorites. She returned her hands to Catra's chest, palming the pert mounds. Catra's mouth opened as her breath hitched. Adora enjoyed breathless Catra. She felt the softness of Catra's tail on her arm as her fingers circled the hardening nipples. Lifting Catra's shirt, Adora kissed her way down her chest and torso while taking each nipple in her mouth and releasing it with a pop.

Catra grabbed onto the ledge of the counter as she watched Adora make her way down her body. Each touch, kiss, and lick was incredibly erotic to witness. When Adora reached the band of her pants, she made quick work of the clasp and zipper. In the last few days, Adora had really found her power. She was taking

more chances and trying new things. Catra loved it. She felt her pants fall to her ankles; the air felt cooler than usual. But, the light kisses Adora sprinkled across her stomach and thighs quickly helped warm her back up.

Adora placed her hands on Catra's knees and pushed them apart, allowing Catra to readjust before moving her mouth toward her center. Adora maintained eye contact as she licked the entirety of Catra's slit, watching as she threw her head back and moaned. She watched as Catra failed to keep it together as she focused her tight, quick strokes on Catra's engorged clit; moving her hand gingerly up Catra's thigh, she started to pull her hips away, and Adora pulled them back.

"Adora wait...I'm…close." Her claws dug deep into the counter ledge.

Pulling back to hold off Catra's quickly building orgasm, Adora moved her fingers to her entrance. Waiting for Catra's breath to steady, she slid two fingers inside. Catra's walls quickly enveloped the offering. Adora kept her motions slow, not giving Catra entirely what she needed, but enough to keep her on edge.

"Faster," Catra whimpered.

Adora complied and quickened the pace of her fingers pumping inside Catra. She watched as Catra tried desperately to hold herself up, grabbing tighter onto the counter. Returning her tongue to its rightful place on Catra's clit, she honed in on the hard nub. It took seconds for Catra to cry out and partially double

over. Then, not wanting Catra to fall, she wrapped her strong arm around her legs as she slowly carried her through her powerful orgasm.

Catra tried standing up, but her legs were too weak. She needed to sit down; the orgasm she just had was comparably the most intense feeling she had experienced. "I just need to..."

Adora helped lower her to the luckily clean floor. "Are you okay?" Her worry set in. She was fully aware of her lack of experience and had been nervous about hurting Catra during their sexual adventures, and it had finally happened. She bit her lip, waiting for Catra's answer.

"Oh no. That felt fucking incredible." She leaned on Adora, almost putting her full weight on her. "I just need a minute." She laughed.

Adora kissed her forehead. "Oh good. I was worried that I hurt you." But, unfortunately, her heartbeat still had not regulated.

Catra started purring, "Don't be; I would tell you if it hurt." Then, finally, she had the strength to wrap her arms around Adora. "Where the hell did you learn that?"

The flush in Adora's face was spreading to her ears. "I... don't know. I just felt like you'd really like it."

Catra smiled. "You were right. Wow."

A few moments passed before either of them spoke again. Catra broke the silence after looking at the clock on the wall. "Oh shit, everyone's going to be here in an hour."

Adora quickly checked the time. "Okay, you finish the filling, and I'll do the dough." She stood up and extended her hand to Catra, who still had her pants around her ankles. Good thing she was basically a master pasta chef, and Catra had already started making it, or this would be an interesting night. They worked in tandem as Catra diced the vegetables and cooked the vegan chorizo. After Adora rolled out the dough, Catra placed small heaps of filling in each center. Adora set a square of dough on top before pinching the edge together with a fork. "Oh, these are looking so good!"

Catra checked the time. "And we did it in only half an hour. I'm going to start getting ready. Will you be okay to finish?"

"Mmhmm. I'm going to put these in the fridge and let them set up while the sauce simmers. I'll join you in a minute." She kissed Catra before she bounded off.

Catra already had an outfit in mind and could easily slick back her hair after. She took off her shirt in the hallway and tossed it in the hamper before she stepped out of her pants. The set of drawers across from the bed were slightly open. Catra nudged them closed

with her hip before pulling out the top one. She was caught by surprise when she saw that Adora's underthings were nestled in with hers. *It's real.*

She decided to forgo shoes and slipped on some stirrup socks. These were much more comfortable as her claws always got caught on her socks and destroyed her shoes. Catra adjusted her socks before opening the closet, which was now full of her and Adora's clothes. Looking through her button-up shirts, she found the one she wanted to wear but was a little curious to see what Adora had. They were the same size and had borrowed clothes from each other on occasion. She found a white shirt with gold trim and held it up to her black slacks. *Oh, that's perfect.*

Adora walked into their room and saw Catra in her attire for the night. "Wow."

Catra caught off guard, blushed as Adora looked at her. "I hope it's okay that I borrowed your shirt."

"It looks better on you." Adora admired Catra for a moment longer. "You're so pretty."

Running her fingers through her hair as she felt her cheeks warm, "Thanks."

"Are you going to slick your hair back?" She pulled Catra to her.

Catra moved her lips to Adora's, hovering close. "I was thinking about it."

Adora closed the gap with a tender, slow kiss.

"If you hurry and get dressed, we may have time to make out before they get here." Catra winked and walked to the bathroom.

With that, she stripped off her clothes and looked in the closet for something to wear, finally, settling for grey slacks and a red button-up. Adora wished she had a pair of suspenders to finish the outfit, but she would have to make this work. Pulling her phone out of her pocket, she saw that she only had five more minutes to get ready. No fancy braids tonight, but she could tie half of her hair back and let the rest fall on her shoulders.

After Adora had finished getting ready, they made a few last-minute checks to make sure everything was prepared. Adora set the water to boil while Catra set out the place settings and bottles of wine.

"With this much wine, I'm glad we have a guest room now." Catra quirked.

Adora walked toward Catra and slid her hands around her waist. "Me too. I love you."

"I love you too."

After their lips parted, the distinct sound of Scorpia knocking permeated throughout the house. They both looked at each other. "They're here."

So, yeah this is a thing

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra have a dinner party.

Chapter Notes

More cute and sweet. Sorry. :P

Another knock echoed through the hallway. Catra let go of Adora's hand and walked to the door. Before unlocking it, she looked back and smiled. "Are you ready?" Everything had been cleaned, the food had been prepared, and they were dressed to the nines. It was looking to be a great night to decompress, and the joy that filled her heart was about to be shared with their closest friends.

Adora nodded and stood waiting for the door to open. This was it. The moment they had been preparing for the entire day and had been looking forward to for years. She didn't have to hide her feelings any longer.

Taking a deep breath, Catra twisted the knob and swung the door open. "Hey!"

"Catra!" Scorpia stood holding a bowl of salad up. "Gosh, we decided to bring a salad. I hope that's okay." Perfuma stood next to her with her hands on Scorpia's shoulder. Catra had liked Scorpia for as long as they have been friends. So she could guess that Scorpia would say the same thing but remind her of the rocky first few weeks. It took a while, but Catra learned to let people care for her, and boy was she glad.

Adora joined Catra and welcomed the two to their home. "Can I take your bags or anything?" Adora asked after greeting the women. Perfuma usually had a large bag dangling off her arm. It was one of the most extraordinary things about her; if you ever needed something, she probably had it in there. Tonight, Scorpia had an even more oversized tote hanging from her elbow. It looked like she brought a few games for the group to play.

It was nice to have a friend group that shared many hobbies. Bow and Catra could play their video games, Scorpia and Perfuma loved sharing their art, and Glimmer could lose at board games, throw a fit, and blame the dice. It was perfect.

Perfuma gave Adora her bag after a tight hug, "You look nice. I love red and gold on you."

Adora blushed and rubbed the back of her neck. "Thanks." She took their items and walked down the hall to the guest room. Setting the bags on the desk, she took a moment to look around the bare room. The mixture of excitement and nervousness was creeping up her body. They were moments away from telling their friends about their new relationship. *Moments.* Adora took a deep breath, straightened her shirt, and walked back into the kitchen.

Catra was pouring everyone a glass of wine; she preferred dry reds, while Adora liked sweet Rieslings. Their taste in wine mirrored their personalities for the most part. Turning to Adora, Catra handed her a glass of slightly pink wine. "Here ba-" She cleared her throat, "Adora." Her cheeks turned a deeper shade of pink than the liquid in Adora's glass.

Adora made quick work of her drink and set the glass on the counter. "I'm going to get the pasta ready." She could already feel the effects of the wine and was thankful for that. Her nerves had been ramping up since Scorpia and Perfuma had arrived, and she was ready to get this night over with.

Taking the hint, Catra started asking Perfuma and Scorpia about work. Adora uncovered the boiling water and took the chilled ravioli from the fridge. She mainly tried to busy herself to help her nerves, but dinner needed to be cooked regardless. Then, feeling the vibration from her phone, she pulled it from her pocket.

Glimmer [6:07 pm}: *Hi, we are running a bit late. We'll be there in five mins.*

The timing could not be more perfect. By the time that dinner had finished cooking, Glimmer and Bow would be there, and they could just tell everyone and get on with their night. She dropped the first batch of ravioli into the water. They swirled around in the salty water, the orange oil from the filling seeping out from a few as the pasta expanded and cooked.

"Hey, Adora? Where did you put Scorpia's bag? She wants to show us the board game she brought over."

While stirring the pasta, she turned to Catra. "In the guest room." It felt so natural to say it. They had a guest room because they shared a room as a couple. *Their room.* She couldn't help but

smile, thinking about sleeping together in *their* room. It wouldn't really be physically different, but it would just be different.

Without any question, Scorpia stood up and headed toward the hallway. Adora looked at Catra and shrugged. Then, after straining the third batch of ravioli, she dropped them carefully into the sauce and stirred. There was a knock on the door, followed by a "sorry we're late!"

Catra greeted Glimmer and Bow, who had brought a dessert. "This looks great. Adora, they brought a mixed berry pie!" She was already looking at the treat with hunger in her eyes.

"Oh, that sounds good." She turned to them. "Dinner will be done in just a minute. Feel free to put your stuff in the guest room." Her voice hitched. For some reason, telling Glimmer seemed scary. Adora knew that she would be accepting and happy for them, but there was just a dot of uncertainty.

Catra refilled their glasses then stood next to Adora. She set her hand on the small of Adora's back. "Are you doing okay?" She whispered to Adora, noticing how tense she was. It would not be worth telling their friends if it made Adora feel worse or sick.

"I'm okay. Can we get this over with?" She responded quietly, knowing Catra's ears could pick up on the low sound.

"Are you sure you're ready? We can wait for another time too." She rubbed Adora's back, trying to comfort her. "I don't want you to feel pressured. We have all the time in the world, honey."

"No, I want to do this now. We are together, and our friends should know. I love you, Catra."

"I love you too."

When they turned back to the quiet group, everyone was looking at them inquisitively.

Glimmer spoke first, "Is everything okay?"

Adora and Catra looked at each other. "Yeah, everything is okay. We wanted to invite you all here because we have something to tell you." Catra quietly spoke.

Glimmer held her glass to her mouth, knowing full well what was about to happen but desperately wanting to see it play out. Unfortunately, Adora had not updated her on what had happened after she and Catra talked. But, it looked like things were very good. *A guest room? Come on, if that isn't a dead giveaway.*

Scorpia held Perfuma's hand, expecting that they were going to sell the house because they decided not to be friends anymore.

She covered her mouth, assuming the worst. *What if this is their going away party?*

Perfuma held onto Scorpia tighter, unsure what the two women were about to say. It didn't look like good news. Adora had been very clearly nervous and avoidant while Catra was trying to make conversation since they had gotten there. Their combined auras gave them away. *This isn't good.*

Bow sat hopeful, knowing that Adora and Catra had been going through a rough patch. But, he believed in the power of love, friendship, and communication. He was the optimist of the group, that was for sure.

Catra removed her arm from Adora's back and grasped her hand instead. She looked at Adora and smiled.

Adora nodded, not knowing exactly how she was going to say it, but she just spoke. "We wanted to invite our closest friends to dinner to share something wonderful with everyone. This is something that I have wanted for a long time, even if I couldn't admit it to myself. Catra is my best friend and the person I care about the most in this world. She has been with me through the fun times and stuck by me when things were hard. So, I guess what I'm trying to say is, Catra and I are together." She paused before taking another breath, looking at everyone and trying to gauge their reactions. But, a sea of smiles quickly appeared across all of their faces. The weight of a thousand secrets slid off her shoulders. It was officially out. They had told their friends, and Adora felt a powerful sense of relief.

Catra smiled and kissed Adora's forehead. "Adora is my best friend and now my girlfriend. I love her more than anyone." Making eye contact with all of their friends, she continued. "I know you probably have questio-"

The screams of Perfuma and Scorpia rang through the kitchen. A series of "oh my god!" And "finally" followed the screams. Catra turned to Adora and laughed.

Glimmer was the first to say anything fully intelligible. She walked up to Adora and Catra, "I'm glad you two could finally admit it. All of us have basically known for years." She rolled her eyes. After hugging both of them, she pulled away, "I'm proud of you."

As much as Adora tried not to cry, the tears welled up and started to roll down her cheeks.

In turn, each of their friends hugged them and gave them encouragement, congratulations, and praise.

When Scorpia sat back down, her joy was clearly visible. "Oh gosh! This is just such a great day. Here we thought we were just gonna have a friendship dinner, and now it's a celebration!" She held up her glass.

The love that Adora and Catra felt was unimaginable. They knew how loving and accepting their friends were, but there was always

the fear that the worst possible thing would happen in the back of their minds. Their parents may have had a part in that.

"We would love to hear about your journey." Perfuma moved her chair closer to Scorpia before sitting down.

"Honey, that sure is a good idea. I would love to hear that too!" Scorpia seemed more excited than anyone else.

Glimmer smirked. "Do tell." Bow poured her another glass of wine, leaving much more room at the top of the glass.

Adora and Catra looked at each other again, quietly figuring out what to do. "Okay, why don't we start eating, and then we can tell the story." Catra opened the fridge to find the toppings, dressings, and sides - a little apprehensive about reliving the sorrow and pain.

Adora worked to set the pan of ravioli on the table and made sure everyone had utensils and napkins. "Okay, I think that's everything. Does anyone need anything else?" She took another gulp of wine and took a deep breath before sitting down. Then, turning to Catra, she took her hand. "Where should we start?"

Catra's eyes got wide. "Um, I guess from the beginning." She looked around the table at the group of friends who had been through thick and thin with her. And when she was at her lowest, they were there when she needed them at a moment's notice. "I

have always loved Adora. When I was a teenager, I knew it was more than friendship. I think that was the hardest part, knowing how I felt about her but not knowing how to talk about it and not wanting to lose her."

Everyone sat and listened intently. Scorpia had stopped eating to cover her heart while her eyes welled up with tears. She was such an empathetic person and was always as emotionally invested in whatever the other person was experiencing.

"For me, I had these intense feelings but didn't know what they were. I just thought I was *really* good friends with Catra. I always wanted to be close to her and missed her when we were apart. But, as you know, my parents are a bit strict."

Glimmer snorted. "An understatement, but continue." The glass of wine that Bow had previously poured her was gone at this point.

Adora scrunched her face and held Catra's hand tighter. "You're right. They have never really been a fan of Catra, and that made it easier to ignore my feelings." She sighed. "I think moving out was the best thing I have ever done. I'm my own person and can do what I want to do rather than what they want me to do."

"Including Catra." Glimmer laughed, and everyone else followed.

"Wait, have you two…?" Scorpia leaned toward them.

Catra quickly chimed in. "You're getting ahead of yourself. Be patient...and yes."

Scorpia blushed, absolutely not expecting that answer. She knew how Adora generally avoided sexual topics and assumed that she would need extra time to get comfortable with the idea. Fortunately, it looked like she was wrong.

Adora was blushing so intensely she had to rub her face to loosen it up enough to talk. "Catra!"

Catra shrugged and took another sip of her wine.

"Well, I guess let's fast forward to *the night* . I had been feeling more in need of Catra's presence and touc-"

“Whoooo!” Glimmer hollered.

Bow stood up and got her a glass of water, and served her some more pasta. It was evident that Glimmer had taken in more wine than food at this point.

" *Anyway,* " Adora looked at Glimmer, talking with her eyes to let her finish. "I think unconsciously I was trying to see if Catra felt the same, but I don't think I went about it in the right way."

Catra pulsed her grip on Adora's hand. "Baby, you couldn't even put a name to the feelings. Be gentle with yourself. It worked out, and I'm glad it happened. I love you." She kissed Adora's forehead.

Perfuma let out what sounded like a whine. "You two are so cute!"

Bow joined in Perfuma's cooing.

Adora hid in Catra's shoulder. Catra kissed her head. "Yeah, so Adora was acting a bit different and putting her hand on my thigh, which I was very confused by. So, one day after going to Glimmer and Bow's for a game night, we talked."

Glimmer finished her plate and looked at Catra, and asked, "So, how did that *talk* go?" Yeah, it was official; she was a bit tipsy. It was a good thing that they had a guest room now. But, Bow had not touched his wine from the beginning of the night so that he could drive them home. Smart guy.

Catra scratched the back of her head and let out an awkward laugh. "Well…"

Adora quickly interrupted. "It was the hardest conversation I have ever had, even harder than telling my parents I was buying a house with Catra."

"So what you are saying...is that you Uhauled *before* you were even together?" Glimmer giggled. "That's probably a record."

Everyone laughed. Glimmer was 100% correct. They had been living their best queer life even before they knew they were in love. Adora stood up and refiled the water pitcher. "Okay, you are not wrong. But, it was hard for us to, you know, figure it out." She sat back down. "Okay, so we talked, and I asked if I could kiss her, and she said yes. The rest is history."

"Wait, so what happened after you kissed? Did you decide then that you were together?" Scorpia set down her fork.

Adora looked at Catra and blushed. "Um..well, not exactly. That was also the first time...we..uh…"

“Haaaddddd seeeexxxxxx!” Glimmer chimed in.

Catra laughed. "That is correct."

Grabbing her chin, Scorpia looked confused. "Wait, you had your first kiss and your first time, in the same night?"

"Uhh...well, no." Catra awkwardly laughed.

"We've, um, kissed before." Adora had basically not stopped blushing since they started.

Bow finally chimed in, "Wait, WHAT?"

Adora and Catra looked at each other again. Catra slowly spoke. "Well, um, when I lived in my old apartment, we may have made out once."

"So this sounds like something that has been building for years." Bow continued.

"Yeah, we just finally talked honestly with each other and were able to share our feelings." Adora leaned on Catra. "She's the same person I've always loved; I just know what that love means to me now."

"I'm really glad to have Adora, and I'm excited to build a life together." Catra tried to catch her purr but gave up and just let it come out.

Scorpia, naturally, was wiping tears from her eye. "This is so beautiful."

Glimmer had sobered up a bit in the time since the conversation started; it seemed like those ravioli were sitting well in her belly. "I'm thrilled that you two have each other, and it's great to see people who obviously love each other deeply be able to share that."

"How can we support you two?" Bow smiled.

"Thank you. I think you are all doing exactly what we need. I don't think that I will need to sleepover at your house again." Adora turned to look at Catra. "Even when I'm nervous, I promise to talk to her."

"You both seem so happy." Perfuma wrapped her hand around Scorpia.

"We are." Adora brought their foreheads together.

"And, these ravioli are delicious," Scorpia announced.

"Thanks, Adora is the pasta chef in the house. It's her specialty." Catra started clearing away the empty plates. "Why don't we play one of the games you brought over?"

"That sounds like such a good idea." Scorpia started toward the guest room.

Gimmer, who was now solely drinking water, asked, "So, when did you get a guest room?"

Adora refilled Glimmer's glass before moving the water pitcher to the counter and retrieved dessert from the fridge. "This morning. We talked about it, and it made sense because I've already been sleeping in Catra's room, so we decided to combine the rooms." She set the pie down after Catra wiped off the table. "Okay, and Catra was so cute and asked me to move in with her."

"What! I'm not cute! It just made sense." Catra crossed her arms, and a healthy pink overtook her cheeks. "And, I love you and wanted you to share a room with me." She pouted out her lips.

"Does that mean we can officially call you Catradora?" Bow beamed.

Adora laughed, and Catra scoffed. "Yep!" Adora replied as she tickled Catra.

"Hey!" Catra laughed and kissed Adora.

"They're kissing!" Perfuma squealed. It seemed she was also more excited than they were about the union. "Your auras have changed drastically. This is good for you both. Let love in."

Scorpia walked back into the kitchen and held up a game. A game that Glimmer hated. A game that Glimmer could not win to save her life. Scorpia brought *the game.* "Anyone up for a litt-"

"WHYYYYY!?" Glimmer screamed.

After Glimmer had actually won a few games, the group decided to call it a night. Bow declined to stay because Glimmer would wake up with a headache, and no one wanted that. Scorpia hugged Adora and Catra for what seemed like twenty minutes. Perfuma had to pull her away just to get them out of the door.

Not wanting to wake up to a dirty kitchen, Catra and Adora spent a while cleaning up the kitchen. Finally, they finished the dishes and put away all of the extra food. Adora stopped for a second after she closed the fridge. "Catra?"

"Yeah, Adora?"

"We just told our friends."

"We did, didn't we? That went very well. How are you feeling?" Catra walked to Adora and pulled her close.

"I feel...really, really good. We told them, Catra, and everything went so well!" Her voice hitched at the end of her sentence as tears started streaming down her face. "We did it, Catra."

"Honey, what's wrong?" A bit of nervousness seeped into Catra's veins. Adora seemed happy, but maybe she regretted telling their friends. Catra gently rubbed Adora's back.

Adora nuzzled into Catra's neck. "I'm just so happy." She could not think of a time when she was this happy. She felt free. The intense burden that had been weighing her down for years was gone. Her step felt lighter; her breathing seemed easier. The world was brighter. She had Catra.

The drops were wetting Catra's neck and shirt, but she didn't care. Instead, she reveled in Adora's happiness and love. Finally, everything was working out, and her worries were quickly being dispelled. Maybe this would work out. Maybe there was no other shoe to drop. Maybe she could have happiness. "I'm so happy too, honey."

A book or two or six

Chapter Summary

With graduation coming up, Adora has a lot to figure out.

Chapter Notes

Cute, fluffy, smutty. The only three things you need in life.

Thanks for all your comments and kudos! I hope you enjoy the chapter.

Adora and Catra stood in the kitchen holding each other. Their dinner with friends had been a roaring success. Not only was the food delicious, but their friends were excited about their new relationship. But not just excited, ecstatic. Scorpia and Perfuma were over the moon about it, and before they left, they kept asking Adora and Catra if they needed anything. Things could not be better. Catra's purr vibrated through her chest, sending a feeling of calm to Adora.

"I kinda want another piece of that pie. Would you share one with me?" Catra nuzzled in the nape of Adora's neck, feeling the warmth. Unfortunately, she had been too busy telling their story to really enjoy dinner; her belly was letting her know that more calories were needed.

"Oh, that sounds really good. Sit down, and I'll get it."

Catra sat down, watched Adora take the pie from the fridge, unwrap it, and carefully place a large piece on a plate. She felt loved when Adora cooked for her, and okay, this technically wasn't

cooking, but it had the same effect. The extra work Adora put into the food she made was not lost on Catra.

Adora filled a glass of water and brought their little snack to the table. Before she sat down, she ran her thumb across Catra's lip, releasing it from her fang. "You're so cute." She was glad that Catra still felt comfortable letting her guard down around her. It seemed like transitioning from a friendship to a relationship had changed very little between them.

Catra blushed. They ate the pie by feeding it to each other and giggling at the mess they were making. More pie made it onto the table than in either of their mouths, but it wasn't really about the pie. By some sort of miracle, neither of them got any of the fillings on their shirts.

"I'm excited to sleep in our room tonight." Adora cleaned Catra's mouth off with a towel.

"Me too." Catra looked up at Adora. "I'm kind of nervous." Even though it was still the same room she had been sleeping in for months, it had changed drastically. It had much more meaning.

Adora set the fork down. "What are you nervous about, honey?" She put her hand on Catra's, wanting to comfort and reassure her. Catra was a very independent person and had never lived with a partner before, especially one she lived with before dating. So, there was much to be nervous about.

"I think it's a happy nervous." She covered Adora's hand. "Things have changed a lot, and this is our first night in our room. I want it to go well."

"Honey, we're going to sleep and cuddle, and you know, maybe kiss a little." She cupped Catra's hand. Catra's worry over their first night in their room warmed Adora's heart. Even though they had been sleeping in there for more than a week, it was understandable that today might feel different. Adora loved how caring and sweet Catra was. Not everyone got to see that side of Catra, but she always did.

"I know. I guess I really want it to feel like your room too."

"Oh, Catra, it already does." She leaned over to kiss Catra. "Anywhere with you feels like home."

Catra latched onto Adora and hugged her tight. "I love you so much, Adora."

"I love you too, honey. Why don't we go get ready for bed?"

"Okay." Catra smiled. She felt so lucky to have Adora.

In the bathroom, Adora couldn't help but splash water on Catra when they were brushing their teeth. Their playful mood hadn't changed in the time it took to walk down the hallway. They both

ended up with wet clothes but laughing all the way to their room. Adora tried to tickle Catra, but she was too quick and agile.

Attempting to jump into bed, Adora felt soft hands wrap around her waist and snorted. "Hey! How can we sleep if you won't let me in bed." She laughed, trying to push Catra off her.

"You're all wet! You've got to change first!"

"Says who?"

"Your girlfriend."

"Oh yeah? Or what?"

Catra kissed Adora's neck. "Or we sleep in a wet bed, silly." She laughed. "And we cannot wear these nice shirts to bed." She poked Adora.

"Fine, okay. Good point." Adora opened the dresser and grabbed them both a pair of underwear, not bothering to pick one from each side. "You can pick out our nightshirts." Knowing full well that their respective wardrobes would merge eventually. The only thing that had kept them separate so far was the spatial difference. When Adora turned around, Catra stood before her, completely naked. Her skin was covered in goosebumps, an arm covered her torso, and her nipples were stiff. "Oh."

Catra's ears were back as she walked toward Adora and took a pair of underwear. "I guess I'm a bit cold."

Adora stood speechless. Even though she had seen Catra's body several times in the last few weeks, she couldn't help but revel in her beauty. This may have been the first time she truly noticed Catra's stripes. She had them on her arms, legs, and back, but most of the time, they were covered up. But now, she saw them in all of their alluring glory. "You're beautiful." She moved her hand and ran her fingers along Catra's stripes. Caressing her skin, she trailed her fingers down to the curve of Catra's hips and marveled at the definition of her thighs. The softness of her skin made it difficult to focus. They had already had sex earlier in the day, but the need to touch Catra again built inside her. Finally, she reached her hand to Catra's. "Can we…"

Catra raised her eyebrow, waiting for Adora to finish.

"Catra, can we have sex in *our* bed? " The combination of Catra's exposed body and their newly shared room made for a very emotional juncture in their relationship. She needed to experience this with Catra. The house had never felt as alive, and she wanted to be in the moment with the woman she loved.

She looked at Adora, who was slowly admiring her body. Catra *really* enjoyed it when Adora did that. She felt desired and knew that Adora was very turned on by her. "Absolutely." Tucking a few strands of hair behind Adora's ear, she gently kissed her lips. Adora kissed her back with reverence and grace. She reached

down to take Adora's hand and led her to the bed. "Can...I take your shirt off?"

Adora blushed and nodded, watching as Catra slowly unbuttoned her shirt and slid it off her shoulders. A slight chill percolated through her body; her nipples were already hard. The cold water had cooled her down a bit too much.

"You're so cold; let's lay under the covers." Catra slid under the blanket and held it up for Adora to join her.

Adora slipped off her underwear and quickly got under the blanket. She moved closer to Catra and let warmth build between their bodies. Catra's soft breasts pressed against hers, sending a chill through her already cold body. She looked into Catra's mismatched eyes. "I love you."

"I love you too." Catra leaned in and kissed Adora; their mouths connected and moved slowly and thoughtfully. She pulled Adora close, feeling her already warming body move against hers. Catra was tempted to speed up their kisses, but the tenderness of their interaction was far too satisfying. Instead, she nudged Adora on her back as she moved on top of her, letting her hands feel the supple breasts below her. Adora's soft moans motivated her to focus her attention on the pert nipples.

"Mmm, Catra." Adora's hands moved up Catra's back, feeling the soft fur at the base of her tail before moving slowly up toward her shoulders. She loved the feeling of Catra on her; their bodies fit together perfectly. There was no doubt in her mind that they were

meant to be together. Then, spreading her legs, she allowed Catra's hand to continue its exploration.

At this point, they had both warmed up; Catra ran her hand over Adora's center. This was different than the other times they had had sex; there was a reverence. A softness. Not that she didn't love their desperate and energetic sex, but this was just more intimate. Then, resting her forehead on Adora's, she parted her folds.

Adora sharply drew a breath in as Catra's fingers moved over her clit. Her hips moved in tandem with the soft strokes as they expertly found a perfect tempo. It was true that their years of friendship and deep understanding of each other fueled their deeply gratifying sex life. Catra knew how much Adora liked being touched a certain way even before Adora knew it. And as good as Catra's fingers felt, she wanted to feel their stretch. "Inside," she breathed and almost immediately felt Catra's fingers move down to circle her slick entrance. She moaned and grabbed Catra's ass and pulled her closer; her breathing became more labored. "Please."

Catra slid two fingers inside Adora's slick. She kissed down Adora's chest, moving closer to her center, wanting to make Adora come hard under her.

Adora's moaning had gotten louder with each thrust of her fingers. Grabbing onto Catra's shoulders, she was lost in the sensation as her moans became more audible. The stretch of Catra's fingers was hard to deny. But, she wanted, no needed a deeper connection. "Wait...Catra."

Catra slowed down and stopped. "Did I hurt you?" Her brow furrowed and ears folded back.

"No, please keep going." Her hips moved down on Catra's fingers. "I just...want to look at you."

Catra smiled and moved back to kiss Adora. The tenderness that Adora craved was more than welcome and something that was relatively unknown to Catra. She slowly moved her fingers inside Adora again, feeling the clench of her muscles tighten around her fingers.

Adora licked her fingers, getting a bit of extra slick before she moved down to her clit. She looked into Catra's eyes as her fingers worked her nub, and Catra's fingers pumped inside her. The perfect rhythm played out between them; she held onto Catra's arm, in an attempt to steady herself. The look of arousal and care on Catra's face was focused on Adora. Her pupils were expanded as she watched Adora's every response. Her ears cycled between alert and back and focused and up when they had sex. Adora could always tell how close Catra was depending on what her tail was doing.

A particularly deep thrust pushed Adora much closer to release. "Oh god." The curl of Catra's fingers were hitting all the right spots, and before long, her back arched as she came. As hard as she tried to maintain eye contact, she couldn't keep her head from being thrown back as she deeply moaned.

Catra laid in awe as she watched Adora's peak, and the plateau before she came down. Adora looked so beautiful when she was experiencing such intense pleasure. She couldn't compare it to anything she had experienced before. Not even the crisp morning air and the sun peeking over the mountains had anything on the sight and feeling of Adora coming.

Finally calming down, she pulled Catra close and kissed her. "Oh, that felt so good, baby." A few moans escaped her mouth as a few aftershocks pulsed through her. "I love you."

Catra leaned down and kissed Adora again. Lying her head on Adora's chest, she listened to her heartbeat slowly go back to normal. She had heard Adora's heart so many times that she knew its steady rhythm well. Without Adora telling her, she would know when she was calm. "I love you, too."

Adora tucked a few strands of Catra's hair behind her ears. "Can I touch you? "

Catra nodded and pushed off Adora.

"Wait. I want you to..." She moved lower under Catra, trying to move her arms under her thighs.

Catra quickly caught on. "Oh." She positioned herself above Adora's mouth. Catra was feeling more aroused than nervous as she looked down at Adora, who had already started to work her

tongue through Catra's slick. Catra leaned forward, holding herself up on the wall. Her hips unconsciously grinded down on Adora's warm mouth as each stroke of her tongue expertly massaged her clit.

The sight of Catra barely able to hold herself up above her was one of the most erotic scenes she had the pleasure of viewing. Each moan that left Catra's mouth matched the gyrations of her hips. Adora moved her fingers to rub her own clit as Catra's orgasm was getting ever closer.

The warm, wet tongue moving over her sensitive center felt amazing. She was slowly getting better at holding off her orgasm when having sex with Adora. It just felt so good; it was hard not to give in immediately. Only a few moments passed before Catra fisted Adora's hair and threw her head back as her orgasm pulsed through her. Adora wasn't far behind as she quickened her pace, watching Catra double over, panting. She moaned into Catra's sex, grabbing her hip as she came.

It took Catra a few moments to collect herself and move off of Adora's face. She laid next to Adora, not bothering to cover herself with a blanket as her breathing steadied. Her soft purr began as soon as her body relaxed into the bed. Adora felt the soft tap of Catra's tail on her thigh as she turned over to cuddle up to her.

"Feelin' relaxed, baby? "

"Mnmm." Catra's eyes were closed, her breathing slow, and she sounded like she was almost asleep.

"Get under the covers with me before you fall asleep." Adora nudged her and smiled. She had seen Catra exhausted many times in their lives, and it usually looked painful. But now, she just looked peaceful and happily relaxed. Adora did love seeing Catra fully and completely spent, especially when she was responsible for her girlfriend's state.

Catra groaned and slowly opened her heavy eyelids. "Okay." She moved under the blanket and rested her arm and head on Adora's chest. "Sorry, I'm just so relaxed." She yawned. "That felt so good."

"We did have a long day, baby. Are you comfortable?" Adora ran her fingers through Catra's short hair.

There was no reply, only the sound of light snoring. Although Catra would deny it until the day she died, Adora had always known that Catra snored. It was so soft that sometimes she could barely hear it, but it was there. She kissed Catra's head and whispered, "I love you." Then she turned off the light.

Adora's alarm went off, waking her from a deep sleep. She groaned and turned it off, tempted to go back to sleep and risk losing her job. But, she decided to suck it up, be an adult, and get

ready for work. Catra stirred and turned over, latching on to Adora.

"Do you really have to go to work this early? " She yawned and rubbed her face on Adora's chest.

"I know; I'd rather stay here cuddling you. I'll be home a little after two, though. When do you work?"

"I close."

"I'll bring you dinner, and we can pick out a book to read together. How does that sound, baby?" She kissed Catra's head and slid out from under the half-asleep woman.

"Mhmm. I love you."

"I love you too." Adora walked to the bathroom before she got dressed, grabbed some quick breakfast, and drove to work.

The semester was almost over, and campus was as busy as ever. Even at 5:45 in the morning, students waited to take final tests and finish up group projects. The crisp morning air had a hint of fall lingering within. She loved the few days that signaled the changing of the seasons. It seemed too early in the season for it to be winding down. After all, it was the beginning of August and usually the hottest time of the year in Brightmoon. But maybe a nice canyon drive with Catra was in order. They could see if there

was any change in the leaves yet. Usually, Brightmoon canyon gave the first inklings of fall before a truly noticeable difference in the temperature.

It had not dawned on her before, but this would be their first fall together, their first fall in their home. She couldn't wait to hear Catra complain about how cold it was or why the heater isn't warming up fast enough. The thought of making them cookies and warm drinks was splendid. Who knows, maybe a batch of special brownies they could share with their friends would be fun.

Unlocking the door to the testing center and quickly locking it after she entered, she saw that Octavia was already starting the computers. A feeling of calm took over her body. With how busy the center was going to be, she was glad to be spending it with someone competent.

She waved to Octavia and started to get the supplies for the paper tests ready. After the main computer was booted up, she located all of the exams that needed to be printed. Most of the professors numbered and delivered their tests to the center the day before it opened to students, but a few were uploading them into the system for testing center staff to print and hand out. That way, they could have multiple versions of the test available depending on the day. Unfortunately, security in the testing center was serious business. There had been a cheating scandal at the university a year ago, and the protocol was updated and tightened. As a result, it was not common to see a paper test anymore, but Adora thought they were fun to prepare in the mornings.

The clock beeped when it turned to 6 am. Adora unlocked the doors and let the students waiting to start lining up to sign into their tests. It looked like many students were trying to avoid the bottlenecks later in the day and get their tests over with as soon as possible. Octavia started signing students in as Adora siphoned half of the line to the other side of the desk to help speed up the first batch of students. Once everyone was signed in, Adora took the first shift monitoring the testing room.

A few students needed new pencils because their lead had fallen out, but other than that, it was mostly calm. Kyle showed up at 7 and relieved Adora from her post.

"Adora, are you graduating this semester? Because you've looked extra happy lately." Octavia raised her eyebrow.

Adora wasn't sure if her supposed mood change was due to the introduction of fantastic sex with the love of her life or because of graduation. "I hope so! I put in for graduation a few days ago; I should hear back soon if I was approved and can order my cap and gown." She stood at the materials collection station as the first few students dropped off their paper exams or notepaper.

"Dang girl, that sounds exciting. I still have another year and already have senioritis."

"That's the worst." She laughed. When she was finished with work, she could check to see if she could order her cap and gown. It would be nice to check that off her list. With graduation so close, Adora realized that she needed to start looking for jobs

because she couldn't work at the testing center after graduating. Another senior would take her full-time position and reap the benefits of tuition assistance. That was a lifesaver for her last year; when she bought the house with Catra, she had fewer funds to pay for tuition. Her parents paid for a portion of her first year to help her get going, but she was on her own for the rest. She worked multiple jobs in the first few years to afford tuition without having to get loans. It was not easy, but somehow she managed to do it. The few scholarships she was able to get were instrumental to her success.

Instinctively she checked her phone. But, there were no new notifications. Catra was most definitely still sleeping. They had a long day yesterday, and Catra had almost instantly fallen asleep after sex. That was something Adora could get used to - a spent Catra barely able to stay awake because she was so worn out from the earthshattering orgasms. Her cheeks started to warm the more she thought about it.

After a quick nap, Adora started on one of her essay finals. With a yawn, she logged into her student portal and pulled up the questions for her essay. The questions turned out to be a personal reflection on what she had learned, what surprised her in the class, and it only had to be five pages long. What an excellent surprise; she could finish the essay in the time before she needed to bring Catra dinner.

Luckily, the essay took less time than she expected. Thank god for double spacing in APA format. She ran the paper through a grammar and spell-checker before logging on to order her cap

and gown. Although Adora was excited to pick out the extras for graduation, she was pretty sure she would be graduating with honors and could order the honors rope to adorn her accoutre.

As soon as she clicked the link to order her items, an error came up. She tried it again, and the same thing happened. *Hmmm.* She logged out and logged back in, and the same thing happened. So, doing the next logical step, she checked the status of her graduation. She had forgotten to check it before trying to order her cap and gown. When the website loaded, the status updated to "error - insufficient credits" instead of "pending."

Adora quickly logged into her degree tracker, and everything looked in order. The credits were at 100%, and the degree requirements were at 98%. There shouldn't be anything else that she needed to do to graduate. On the other hand, maybe she was missing something? Was one of her classes not counting? Scrolling through each section, she saw the green checkmark for completion. The anxiety was starting to burn through her; another semester sounded horrible. The cost alone would be difficult if she couldn't work at the testing center. Opening her email, she typed out a quick inquiry to her academic advisor. Maybe she would know what the hang-up was. Looking at the clock, she noticed that it was time to bring Catra dinner.

Adora pushed the big wooden door open and immediately saw Catra helping a customer. Catra was a skilled salesperson, always able to link the person with what they were looking for. She had a knack for finding out people's needs and making them feel comfortable. That was an excellent quality for a bookseller.

Sometimes people would come in without a specific book in mind, and Catra could find them something perfect and link them to new genres. Naturally, Adora loved watching Catra; it could have been the fact that Catra was just fun to observe, or Adora was deeply and madly in love with her. Who would ever know, either way, the butterflies in her stomach may hold a clue.

"Rogelio here will be able to ring you up. I would love to know what you thought of this. If you like it, I know a few more I can recommend to you. Thanks for coming in." Catra turned around, smiling. "Hey, Adora."

"Hey, babe. I hope you're hungry." Adora stepped toward Catra and kissed her.

Catra grabbed her hand, "Let's head to the back room?"

The store was quite busy. Netossa was walking through the aisles helping customers. Many of the patrons were carrying the same tote with a logo that Adora was not familiar with. She wondered if there was an event or sale that Catra told her about, but she forgot until now, but nothing came to mind.

Catra pushed open the back door, "Oh my gosh. Did you see how many people were out there? One of the local food places was having a big grand opening and invited us to switch flyers, and I gave them some of the old promotional crap I found back here. It feels like the whole city has come in today! We have made more tonight than we normally make on a *good* weekend." She kissed Adora before grabbing her bag.

"Whoa. That sounds great. I'm guessing those bags everyone is carrying around are some of those freebies?" Adora sat down next to Catra.

"Oh yeah, they are from a book that came out years ago. But they just released a movie for it. So, that was perfect timing." Catra popped the bowl in the microwave above the desk. "How has your day been?"

"It's been okay. I finished one of my essay finals. I just had to write about what I learned in class. So, that was easy."

"Oh, that sounds great. How many more do you need to do? Maybe when you are done, we can go spend a night somewhere and celebrate, just the two of us. "

"I really like the idea of that. " Adora stirred the ravioli when Catra set it down. A hint of embarrassment traveled through her body, her cheeks warming, and her eyes avoided Catra's. "Um, I checked my graduation today, and it was denied. "

Catra held the bowl of pasta in mid-air. "Wait, what? How is that possible? "

"I don't know. I emailed my advisor. I hope she can figure it out. I don't know if I can keep working at the testing center without

being a full-time student. I need the tuition discount. " Her speech was quickening, a tell-tale sign that she was starting to spiral.

Catra sat down and put the bowl of food on the desk. "Oh honey, don't worry about money. We can figure that out together. The store is doing really well, and we are going to be fine." She picked up Adora's hands. "We're in this together, okay?"

Adora looked up, her expression softened. "Okay, thank you. I'm trying not to panic, but another semester feels overwhelming. I hope it's just a mistake." She leaned into Catra, hugging her loosely.

"Does your advisor usually respond quickly?" She pulled back from Adora, holding her hands.

"Yeah, she's good about that."

"Okay, hopefully, she'll be extra quick this time. We can pick out a book after we eat to help you keep your mind off of things. Do you think that would help?"

"I would really like that. I've been looking forward to it all day. I want to show you the ones that I have looked at before." Adora smiled, and a hint of pink appeared in her cheeks.

Catra was so ready for this. In the times she let her mind wander and believe that Adora was gay, she thought about what kind of lesbian she would be. Bookworm had never crossed her mind; outdoor enthusiast definitely did. But it made sense. She had seen Adora hunched over a book for most of that last four years. A little personal reading would have been a nice change from the heavy sociology textbooks she basically slept with. After Catra found her missing book in Adora's room, she leaned toward Adora being into the more romantic books, but only the future would tell. "I can't wait." Standing up, she put the pasta in the microwave for the last time.

Adora picked up book after book, looking at the covers and reading the backs. "This one always looked interesting." She handed a small book with a woman in chaps holding a whip to Catra.

"Oh whips, huh?" Catra winked and let out an unusually high giggle.

Adora turned to look at Catra after hearing the unusual sound. "What was that sound?" She laughed.

"Hey! I'm supposed to be teasing you!" Catra started to blush and immediately crossed her arms.

"Oh yeah?" Adora stood up and kissed Catra's cheek. "There are so many that I had never seen before now that I have time to

look through them. Is there one that you own that you haven't read yet? Maybe we can start there?" She hung on Catra's shoulder.

"Well, I just started a book club, and it's meeting in a few days. I know it isn't a lot of time, but do you want to join and read the book?"

"Yes! Do you have any copies of the book?"

"We are actually starting with the first She-Ra book. I've read it a bunch of times, I don't think we have any copies in stock, but you can use my copy at home." She awkwardly scratched the back of her head, not sure if Adora would like the idea of borrowing a book from home instead of buying a new one.

Adora kissed Catra and took a moment to savor her lips. "I'll start reading it as soon as I get home," She took the cowgirl book from Catra's hand. "And I'm buying this. "

Catra rolled her eyes and scoffed, "Okay, well, it's actually really good." She laughed. It was one of the first books she rented after the change in ownership. Even though she created an employee rental program for used books, she didn't use it as much as she should. "This is kind of a big thing, Adora. You're buying your first queer romance novel." As much as Catra wanted to buy it for her, or at least let her rent it for her, she knew this was an important part of Adora's journey and independence.

Adora's face lit up. "I didn't even think about that." Adora hugged Catra tightly, "Thank you for supporting me."

"Of course. I love you." She kissed the top of Adora's head. They stood there for a few more moments before Netossa walked up to ask Catra for help. "I'll be there in just a second." She turned to Adora. "You can keep looking if you want. Just come check out whenever you're ready, okay?" With one last kiss, Catra made her way to the front of the store.

Adora stood there for a moment, looking at the book in her hand. She had been in this exact spot dozens of times before, watching to make sure no one would see her looking at the section or waiting for Catra to be busy with a customer and pretend to be browsing. But, now she could freely look at them. Pick them up and even buy them. A part of her felt silly for hiding it from Catra for so long. She had no idea why she thought that Catra would not be completely supportive. It was nothing she could change now, and all she could do was embrace the life she chose to live. Did the fact that that life included being Catra's girlfriend help? Absolutely.

Taking a few more moments to pick out another book or six, she took one final look at the stack she had in her hand and smiled. *Here is to the first day of the rest of my life.*

It makes pizza, right?

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora shop for some kitchen appliances

Chapter Notes

Oh heck! We are so close! I have finishing writing the drafts and am just working on all the edits.

I hope y'all enjoy. Thanks for being so great!

Adora knocked on the bathroom door. "Catra?"

"Come in."

Adora opened the door, not bothering to shut it behind her. "Hey, I need to pee. Is that okay?"

"Yeah, but don't flush. I don't want the water to get messed up." Catra laughed from behind the shower curtain, about to wash the shampoo out of her hair.

"Can we get lunch while we're out? I have to meet with my advisor before work."

"Oh, that's happening today? It feels like it's been forever since you emailed her."

"Yeah, she was out of the office for a week, then didn't have an appointment until today. It isn't technically finals week until next week anyway, so I still have time to figure it out."

"That's good." Catra finished rinsing out her conditioner and let the water flow over her face and head.

Once Adora was done, she slid the shower curtain open and peeked in on Catra's shower. "Longest two weeks of my life."

Catra jumped. "Adora!"

"What!? I just wanted to admire my beautiful girlfriend."

Catra laughed, "Okay, okay." Catra stood in full view of Adora, giving her a bit of a show. There was no way she would let a perfect teasing moment pass without at least slightly frustrating Adora. She was too cute when she was even the slightest bit flustered.

Adora reached her hand out to cup Catra's breast.

"If we start that, we'll never get an air fryer!" Catra turned off the water. "Will you hand me the towel?" She tried to shake off a bit,

but it didn't help very much. Her tail was soaked, and it would take a while to dry thoroughly.

Adora handed her the towel and took a smaller one to start drying Catra's tail. They worked in tandem to get her as dry as possible. Her hair and tail were wildly out of order by the end, but they were partially dry. "Well, that's one way to do it. Thanks, babe."

Adora grabbed a cart while Catra was messing with her tail. It had mostly dried but was a bit fuzzy. She was trying to tame it with a bit of lotion and wasn't paying much attention to Adora. The cream wasn't her first choice to moisturize her tail, but she had run out of the leave-in conditioner she liked to use because the stuff in the shower just didn't work well on the fine fur of her tail. "Do they sell conditioner here too?"

"Um, that's a good question; I think it's only bath and bedroom gadgets. Are you out of your tail conditioner?"

"Yeah, I forgot to buy some last time we were at the store."

"We can swing by the store on our way home?"

"'Yeah, maybe we should." Catra continued to fuss with her tail, loosely following Adora throughout the store. Her tail was still

slightly damp, so the lotion was easier to blend into her fur, and the pleasant scent would be nice when she was working. But, unfortunately, she had completely forgotten why they were at this store. When she looked around, she saw many bathroom supplies like toilet seat covers, scales, and even some interesting shower curtains.

They walked around the store a few times before finding the air fryers. Adora took Catra's hand and led her to the surprisingly large selection. "Wow. There is a lot to choose from."

"Yeah, have you ever owned an air fryer?" Catra had to bend backward to look to the top of the display entirely.

"No, but I think it would be nice to throw in something quick for dinner or, honestly, to make tater tots." She laughed.

"Oh, that sounds good. We should get some for lunch." Catra poked at some of the display models and pulled out their drawers. "Can we make pizza in these?"

"I think so. It's kind of like a small oven." Adora pulled out her cell phone to find the answer online. She held her phone up to the QR code next to one of the displays. After a few moments of loading, she handed Catra her phone. "I'm gonna go ask that guy; maybe he can help us choose one. Will you see if this will pull up? It's being slow."

Catra nodded and took Adora's phone.

Adora walked out of the aisle and toward the employee who was stocking some monochromatic throw pillows. "Excuse me, hi. I had a few questions about the air fryers."

"I love my air fryer; it's the best purchase I've ever made." He laughed. "What are you planning on using it for?"

"Well, that is what I'm wondering about. Can you cook pizza and stuff in one? Or is it just for chicken nuggets and fries?"

"I use mine mostly for fries, not gonna lie. But, I have made frozen pizza in mine once. Depending on the size, you'll have to cut the pizza up to fit. You can really cook most anything in one and you can find air fryer instructions online."

"Okay, that's helpful. Thanks." She turned to talk away.

"Oh, hey, before you leave. Aren't you Adora from the testing center?"

Here we go. It had been a while since she had to deal with a guy asking her out. She hoped that this would not have to be something she had to deal with anymore. But, it turned out that it would be a thing until the day she died. She tried not to sound

irritated, but the chances of that happening were slim. "Yeah, why?"

"Oh, well, I think you're very attractive and have been meaning to ask you to dinner. Are you busy this Friday?" He smiled.

"No, thanks, but thanks for your help." She turned and walked toward Catra, making sure not to turn around to see his reaction. She was not going to deal with the guilt today. As she made her way back to Catra, she felt more empowered. She had just said no to a guy without thinking about it or wallowing in guilt. She did it. The biggest grin covered her face.

*

When Adora walked away, Catra scanned another QR code that popped up almost instantly on the phone. This one had a large basket, multiple heat settings, and a broil option. All of those things sounded like they would be a good thing. But, honestly, she was unsure if those features would work well in a portable oven. So, looking at another model, she scanned the code. It was similar to the previous one, but she recognized the brand, and it was in black, not white. That was definitely more of her color.

Just as she was scanning another code, a call notification popped up on the screen. *Mother.* Catra was not about to answer. It probably would not go well to answer Adora's phone without her being here, and especially a call from her mom. After a few rings, it went to voicemail. Thirty seconds later, a voicemail notification popped up, then a text notification. *Mother: We have been trying*

to get ahold of you, Adora, to find out about graduation. Your Mara needs to request the time off. Please call us back.

From the looks of that text, it didn't sound good. An anxiety knot started forming in Catra's throat. Has Adora been ignoring her parents? Is she avoiding talking to them to hold off on telling them about their relationship? Before Catra could worry any more, Adora walked up. "Hey, did you find anything out?" She handed Adora back her phone.

"Yeah, they can cook pizza and other things; you just have to cut them down." Adora took her phone and scanned another QR code. "The guy also asked me out." She laughed. "I told him I was too busy with my lesbian lover to pencil him in."

"Wait, did you really?"

She turned to Catra and smiled. "No, I just said 'no thanks' and walked away."

"Oh wow. How did that feel?"

"Really good actually. I guess I just assumed when I got a girlfriend everyone would know and I wouldn't have to deal with it anymore." Adora shrugged.

"I wish. I still get asked out by the occasional guy. I'm glad it doesn't happen often though."

"Well, you are really cute." Adora winked and scanned another QR code.

Catra folded her arms and watched Adora look at more information pages on her phone. She thought about ignoring the phone call and just letting Adora deal with it, but Adora could easily figure out that she got the call and text while Catra had her phone. It wouldn't be hard to figure out that Catra knew she had not been returning any of her parents' contacts. "This one looked like it had the things we want. And your mom called while you were gone."

Adora lowered her phone and sighed. "Yeah, they have been calling and texting all week. I have nothing to tell them until I talk with my advisor today." She turned to Catra, "What am I supposed to do?" She shrugged. Avoidance. It had worked in the past; why not utilize that skill today. She simply was not ready to deal with her mother's judgmental attitude toward the things happening in her life. And in all honesty, she wanted to talk with Catra first before coming out to her parents. It wasn't just her anymore, and Catra's input was an important part.

Catra knew Adora, and she knew her well. She was someone who had a tough time lying, which means she would avoid the issue rather than confront it. However, there was more to this than just the graduation issue. Something weighed heavily on Adora's shoulders. "Have you answered any of their texts or calls?"

She turned from Catra, pretending to look at the box for one of the models in front of her. "Um...not really."

"Are you nervous they are going to be upset if you have to take another semester?"

She stood up and folded her arms. "It's not just that. I haven't told them about my major, and then there is the part where we have to explain our relationship to them. So it's everything all at once."

Catra tucked a few strands of hair behind Adora's ear. "Honey, how can I support you?" The best thing she learned from therapy was that phrase. Instead of trying to guess what someone needs, just ask them.

Adora hugged Catra. "You just being here is perfect."

Catra kissed Adora on the head. "I'm here."

She nuzzled into Catra's shoulder, "I'll tell them about school after my meeting." Then, after she released Catra, she meekly asked, "Can we figure out how to tell them about us?"

"Of course. We can talk about it after I get off work or even tomorrow."

Adora spoke softly. "I'm not hiding you from them. They accept us together or not at all."

Catra instantly felt a pang in her stomach. She had been through this before with her mother, and they had not talked since. Not that she missed her; she was a terrible person and parent. But, in a way, she longed for the chance of having a caring and loving parent. She couldn't imagine what it would be like for Adora to lose both of her parents, even if they weren't the most supportive. It would probably change their relationship when Adora came clean about everything. In reality, it might be good for Adora to be honest with them. But, it seemed to cause her a lot of stress. "We can take it as slow as you need, okay?"

The thought of telling the Grays about her and Adora's relationship was terrifying. They had never been the biggest fans of Catra, to begin with, and they were going to get bombarded with a lot of other news they were not prepared for. Catra was glad to see Adora talking about the boundaries she wanted to set with her parents, but actually setting them was another story. Hope could be scary. Mara was a sweetheart, but Hope was usually the outspoken one and was absolutely known as someone never to mess with.

When they were kids, Catra accidentally spilled a drink when she was over at Adora's playing, and the look on Hope's face as she cleaned it up was blood-curdling. She calmly said that drinks were not allowed outside of the kitchen. Catra was six. That memory stayed with her throughout her childhood and teen years. Catra made every attempt to steer clear of Hope and went to Mara if she ever needed anything.

Maybe they didn't know the extent of Catra's home life, or perhaps they didn't care, but when it came to Catra, things were different. She was always invited last to Adora's birthday, even though Adora told her first. When they brought out snacks for the neighborhood kids, they either ran out or only had a smashed one left. But, Adora always shared with her. This was bringing up more feelings than Catra wanted to admit. It was almost like a second coming out for her. But, she knew that she needed to be there for Adora. A few meditation sessions with Perfuma might be in order.

Adora stood in front of her advisor's office before taking a deep breath and lightly knocking.

"Come in!" A cheerful voice sounded from the other side.

She pushed the door open and immediately saw the wild-haired woman sitting behind an ancient desk. "Hi, Razz."

"Oh, Mara dear, we have a problem."

"Razz, I'm Adora."

"Yes, yes. Sit down, deary."

Adora sighed and sat down. Razz had taught her mother ages ago and had always mixed the two up. Even though Mara wasn't related to Adora by blood, they just happened to share a similar facial structure and features. "Do you know why I was denied graduation?"

"They rejected the double requirement for your Abnormal Psychology class. The note said it could only apply to either your major or minor, not both."

Adora was getting irritated. She had been through this before, and it had been approved. "Do I have to take another class?"

Razz typed for a few moments and clicked a couple of times. "Look here." She moved the monitor. "You need one more elective. But, it can be anything you'd like in either social work or psychology."

This was going to cost Adora a lot of money. They didn't charge by the credit hour, they had base tuition, and additional fees were charged depending on the classes. "Nothing will be available now. The new semester starts in three weeks." She wanted to yell. Not only did she have to take another class, but she would have to find a way to pay for it in three weeks. Also, the testing center would be closed for two weeks before the semester. Maybe she could take a job delivering food for that time.

Razz typed for a second more. "Here are the classes available for you."

Adora looked at the screen, trying to hold back the angry tears threatening to explode from her eyes. There was nothing she could do. She had been through this before and had to take another class on top of the required ones. This semester had already been a lot, and now she had to take another. "So, you can register me for one of these classes right now?"

"Yes, yes. But, you have to choose one, deary."

"Okay, I guess I'll take the Directed Readings: Sexual Orientation class."

After a few clicks, "You're in! You should be able to see the class in your student portal. Talk with the registrar's office to see what they can do about tuition."

"Okay, thanks."

"I'll email the graduation office and double-check if this will fulfill the requirement. So keep an eye out for an email from me."

Adora walked out of the office, feeling slightly relieved to have the matter settled, but she needed to let off some steam before going

home. She could talk with Catra about it more later. Before she could walk down the hall, her phone buzzed.

Catra [2:49 pm]: *hey Adora*

Catra [2:49 pm]: *I just got to work. I hope your meeting goes well*

Catra [2:50 pm]: *I love you*

She's so sweet. Adora already started to feel better, but the gym would help her process some of these feelings enough to finish her homework. The walk from Razz's office to the campus gym could almost count as cardio on its own. Brightmoon University was located on the side of a mountain, and getting anywhere was a climb, even if you were going down.

Adora [3:13 pm]: *I love you.*

Adora [3:14 pm]: *I have to take another semester.*

She put her headphones in and turned on the treadmill.

Adora sat at the kitchen table with her after-gym meal remnants, staring at her phone. Her thumb hovered over her mother's contact information. The hesitation was debilitating. On the one hand, if she called Mara, things would probably go better, but if she called Hope, the conversation would be over quickly, albeit with a lot more frustration. So she promptly switched over to Mara's number and called.

As the phone rang, she kicked herself for not writing notes to help her through this process. She quickly stood up and grabbed her book bag to find some sticky notes. After a few more rings, it went to voicemail. She groaned. This was the only time she'd have enough courage or lack of anxiety to talk to her parents today. She took the sticky notes and started writing a small list of topics. At the bottom, she wrote *Catra.* She was primarily unsure of what this would entail but wrote it in case it came up.

After her list was written, she pulled out her laptop and books. So she could get a bit of homework done before her parents called back. Logging into her student portal, she saw the new class listed in her schedule. She clicked over to the bookstore to see what the book would be. When the screen finally loaded, there were two books listed. She grabbed her phone and pulled up her messages to text Catra.

Adora [6:02 pm]: *Hey Catra, I found the books for my class. Do you have these at work?*

She took a picture of the screen and sent it to Catra. Before she could set her phone down, her mother's picture popped up on the screen. It was Hope calling. *Ugh, here we go.* She grabbed her list from behind her laptop and answered.

"Hi, mother."

"Hello, Adora." Hope's voice was flat. "We have been trying to get a hold of you for a week."

Adora sighed; she was well into her twenties and was not a child anymore. But, her mother insisted on treating her as an infant. "I know. But, I have been busy, and there were school issues."

"The least you could have done was text us back."

Irritation was not the correct word; she was getting pissed. She had a hard time interacting with her mother, to begin with, and it had been a few months since they had talked on the phone. Then, the anger and frustration flooded back. "I'm not going to fight with you. If you want to know what's been going on, I was denied graduation because one of my credits didn't apply. So, I have to take another semester."

"Did you not take the right class?"

This is why she avoided talking to her parents. At least Mara was friendly; Hope, on the other hand, needed to blame everything on someone, and Adora was done with it. "Stop. I'm not doing this. Either get mom or just listen."

"Mara is at work."

"I have met with my advisor every semester to plan accordingly; the graduation office would not accept one of the classes I had taken as the credit we were trying to use it as. It sucks, but after next semester I'll be done." She had a lot of pent-up anger toward her mother, and that, combined with the stress of having to take another class, was making the conversation very difficult.

"It sounds like you need a better advisor."

"Razz has been the most supportive person at that school. You could learn a thing or two from her." Adora had officially crossed the line. There was no going back now. "And, I'm graduating with a Social Work degree. If you don't like it, that's your problem. I do not want to hear another thing about it. This is my life, and I get to make my own choices." She regretted the outburst as soon as it left her mouth. *Well, that could have gone better.* An intense feeling of guilt was sinking in. She wanted to beg and say sorry for being short. But, it was too late. Hope was going to lash out and tell her she was overly emotional.

"Okay."

Adora sat in silence for a few minutes. She had just stood up to her mother, and Hope didn't try to argue with her. *Okay, what now?* Should she also talk about Catra since she was on a roll? It would give her parents something to think about before reaching out to her again. But, it would open it up for more questions and a longer conversation, and she said she would talk to Catra about

it first. *Just end the call.* "I...uh...will text you when graduation gets closer, and we can make arrangements then. Okay, bye."

She didn't wait for Hope to respond; she took the phone away from her ear and quickly ended the call. *Fuck.* Without wasting a second, she pulled up her messages.

Catra [6:23 pm]: oh baby how are you doing

Catra [6:23 pm]: ill give you extra cuddles when i get home

Catra [6:24 pm]: i have good news thou i own the book of essays and will buy the other one tonight and bring it home

Catra [6:25 pm]: is it okay if its used

Adora [6:35 pm]: I love you so much, Catra. I'm so lucky to have you.

Adora [6:36 pm]: I just called my mother, and it went...okay. I basically just yelled at her and then hung up. I'll tell you about it when you get home.

Adora [6:38 pm]: Used is perfect. Thank you.

She leaned back in the kitchen chair, looking up at the ceiling. There was still some homework and essay finals she had to do, but something told her that she needed to take the night off and take a bath. So she closed the laptop and didn't bother to clean up her school stuff. Instead, all that she did was quietly tuck the chair under the table and walk to the bathroom.

New Addition

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora go shopping.

Chapter Notes

Oh heck, I present to you more fluffy smutty goodness. It's wild that we are already on chapter 18! I feel like this story has rushed by. Some good news! I got a new job and a new kitten. lol So that'll be fun. I only have one more paper to write then the semester is over (I'm literally gonna finish it after I post this lol). I can't wait to lay in bed all day writing fluffy, smut.

Thank you everyone for supporting me and this story!

Catra brought the car to a stop and pressed the park button. "Did you bring the list? Because I forgot." She smiled awkwardly.

"I did. I added a few things. First, I want to try and make lasagna. I think the noodles would be the same as I normally make, but just…wide." Adora shrugged.

They got out of the car, and Adora instinctively took Catras hand. They had been together for several months at this point, and Adora had stopped asking to do things with Catra for the most part. "Oh, I haven't told you about what we are reading about in my class." She pulled a cart from the mess of cart storage.

"I really liked the book of queer essays. Which one are you on?"

Adora cleared her throat. "Strap."

Catra smiled. They had not talked about toys or strap-ons yet, and that didn't bother Catra. She wasn't very experienced in their use, and thus far, their sex life had been fantastic. But it would be a lie if she said she hadn't thought about fucking Adora with a strap. On the contrary, she very much enjoyed thinking about Adora unraveling beneath her.

"Ahh, yes. I am interested to see what you think about that one when you read it." Catra looked over at a somewhat distracted Adora.

"I-I've...um...already read it." Her cheeks were starting to pink. "A few times."

"Oh, have you? And what did you think?" Catra was more than intrigued. She wanted to know every thought that went through her lover's head. It had been fun navigating their relationship and Adora's quick study of all things queer. She had essentially become an expert in a few short months. Some of the books and movies that Adora talked about with her were things she had never heard of. And she owned every season of Xena *and* the books!

"Would you be mad if I had been doing research?" Adora said quietly, trying to avoid the judgemental gaze of the woman next

to them. She was more than excited to talk about this with Catra, but maybe not with everyone in town listening.

"Absolutely not; I love that you're interested in this. What have you been looking up?" It was a shame that they were at the grocery store and on such a busy day. Talking in code was fun, but damn did she want to know every tiny detail. Catra placed her hand on the small of Adora's back.

"Well, I have mostly just been looking at what different kinds are out there." She cleared her throat and grabbed a box of cereal next to her, hiding her mouth. "I may have watched a video or two as well." Her cheeks were bright red at this point.

Catra's ears stood tall, and her tail swung excitedly behind her. "Did you watch them while you were texting me...the other day?"

Adora scratched the back of her head and awkwardly laughed. "I...um...yes."

Walking up behind Adora, Catra slid her arms around her waist and kissed her neck. "I *really* like that."

Adora let out a tiny whimper and caught herself before it turned into something more. She cleared her throat and looked around. Thank god the aisle was now empty. "Um, have you ever thought about using one before?" She fumbled with the bags of trail mix in front of her before picking one and tossing it into the cart.

"Yes. I've even used one."

"Oh, have you ever thought about using one together?" She was interested in Catra's response and looking forward to utilizing her experience. Reading about straps online was much different than actually using one.

Catra's cheeks were quickly becoming red. "I...um…" She looked around, checking to make sure no one was around. "I have."

Instantly noticing Catra's demeanor, she asked, "What have you thought about specifically?" Adora's eyes focused on the blushing woman, biting her lip in anticipation.

Leaning in closer to Adora, she whispered in her ear. "I want you to ride me."

Adora wasn't expecting that forward of an answer while they were shopping. But she did ask. "Wow." She cleared her throat and pretended to look through the chips. "Baby, can we go look at the *store* down the street?"

"Yes!"

The door chimed, and the person at what looked like a watchtower asked them both for their IDs. They supplied the requested items, and then once they were let in, they meandered through the large store of adult novelties. Adora made her way directly to the giant wall of dildos, vibrators, and strap-ons.

"Whoa," Adora said as she waded through a sea of crotchless panties and lingerie.

Catra followed closely behind, feeling much more uncomfortable than she appeared. "This is a lot." She looked over at the expansive selection of lube, picking one up that was very clearly marketed toward men who had sex with men.

Adora was making her way down the wall of toys. There were things she had never seen before and some that had been part of her research. She abruptly stopped when she found the selection of harnesses. "Do you have any suggestions on which one we should try?" She held a few of them up, trying to figure out how they work.

The truth was that Catra had only ever used one once, and it didn't last very long. So, her supposed *expertise* was basically non-existent. "Um, the jockstrap one will be the most comfortable and easiest to switch out toys." She ran her hand through her hair, partly to get it out of her face and to soothe herself. Imposter syndrome was a thing, right? Fake it until you make it. She had done her fair share of research on toys in the past, so at least she knew a bit more than the basics, but that was a different story in actual use.

"Oh, this one is soft too, and it has an O ring, so most of these will work with it." Adora hung the harness back up and looked at the back of a few dildos. "Look at this one. I like the color, and it looks like a good size."

Catra's eyes widened. There was no way she was going to be able to take something that large. And she highly doubted that Adora would be able to either. "Honey, let me show you a good way to gauge size." She held two fingers together and put them next to the shaft. "This is what you're used to. Do you see how much bigger this is? I don't think you'll be walking comfortably after this." She smiled and let out a small laugh.

"Oh." Adora looked at the size difference; she did not even think about that. "You're right. I think we should start small then. We can always try new ones." She walked down the display, looking for the smaller models. The first few times she and Catra had had sex, Catra's fingers were easy to get used to. They felt wonderful, but there was a bit of a stretch. It had been quite some time since she had used anything other than maybe one of her fingers, so she *would* probably need to take it slow.

"Yeah, that's what's nice about these. We get to choose the size, and if we need one bigger or smaller, we can just come to buy one." She saw a similar one to the one Adora had previously picked up. "How about this one? It's the same color and a more manageable size." She handed it to Adora. "And it looks like it's compatible with the harness we were looking at."

Adora stood looking at the package for a few moments, turning the container over a few times and looking at it from different angles. "Hold your fingers up again." She made a quick comparison and then nodded. "I think this is the one. What do you think?"

"Let's get it. We should also look at lube. It couldn't hurt to be prepared."

"But, it could hurt not to be prepared." Adora giggled.

Catra laughed and kissed Adora's cheek. "You are the cutest person ever, do you know that?"

Adora packed a bag of food, books, and her phone. It was book club night, and they were on their third book since the first She-Ra novel. She had seen the monthly meeting grow since its inception. But, the humble beginning did not prepare them for what it had become. There was a seemingly random cast of characters that attended each meeting. But, Catra was planning on creating a second group with a different theme. One of the issues was coming up with a new theme for the new book club; the store had become a queer hot spot for the city, and she wanted to keep the theme of any new book clubs, well, queer.

The first idea that came to mind was a "Queering the Classics" group. So naturally, they would start with Virginia Woolf's *Orlando* and work their way to Emily Dickinson. She would have to hire someone to help with staffing the store while she ran the book clubs, though. Adora had helped out around the store before, but it may be a bit of a challenge while she was in school and working at the testing center.

Catra had added board games to their inventory and cleared space to add tables for folks to play tester games before buying. In addition, Catra held weekly board game nights with prizes. Adora praised Catra's creativity. She had turned a pile of boxes full of what looked like junk at first glance into an effective marketing tool. Of course, the power of nostalgia and movie adaptations helped too.

The book club had stuck to a queer theme which Adora was grateful for. She had spent far too much of her life living a hetero lie; she was not about to waste any more time on things that didn't bring her joy. This month they were reading a romance novel that had recently been released. It was the first book that Adora didn't care for. It fell into too many heteronormative tropes, and she couldn't get into it. It was the old story of an unhappy woman about to get married to a jerk guy and meets a cute, somewhat sassy lesbian. They fall in love and blah blah blah. Also, there was a surprising lack of sex.

Adora hauled all of her and Catra's things from her car. Then, pushing the heavy wooden door open, Adora walked directly to the back room, looking for Catra. She was much more comfortable in the bookstore than she had been in the past. The multiple dinner visits and help covering shifts had made it a second home

to her. She unpacked their dinner and set it up on the backroom table as Catra walked up behind her. "Hey, Adora."

"Hey, baby." She turned around to kiss Catra. "How has work been?"

Returning the kiss, she smiled. "It's been busy. I set out a little survey for people to fill out while they waited and got some great feedback on future book clubs and possible events."

"Oh, that sounds great. Are you going to do the other book club then? I know you were thinking about it. This one seems to have really taken off." Adora popped open the last container. "I made cheeseburgers. The buns are in there, the veggies in that one, and those small ones have mayo and stuff." Adora pointed as she explained.

"Why are you so good to me?" She cupped Adora's cheeks and kissed her deeply. "I love you."

Adora blushed and scratched the back of her head. "You know I love to cook for you, baby." She wrapped her arms around Catra's neck. "I can't have my girlfriend go hungry, now can I?"

"I really appreciate it. And this looks so good." Catra moved their foreheads together.

They sat down and made their dinner. Adora explained the seasoning she used this time around and what she wanted to try next. Catra listened and nodded while she ate, surprised at how crispy the fries were.

"Are these from the air fryer?"

"Yeah, isn't that wild?"

A knock on the door interrupted their amazement. Catra stood up, looked back at Adora and shrugged, then opened the door.

"Hey Catra, a few of us are already here. Should we, like, set up?" Mermista stood at the door with a smile on her face. There was always a first time for everything.

"Oh, yeah, that would be great. If you ask Rogelio, he should be able to get you the snacks and drinks. I already set up the table and chairs, so you all can hang out and set the food up. Adora and I are just finishing up dinner and will be out in a few."

Mermista leaned to look over Catra's shoulder. "Hey...Adora."

Adora waved. Mermista's saltiness had mainly subsided since the book club began. She was pretty funny and relaxed; she just also happened to have a crush on her girlfriend.

Catra wouldn't admit it, but she was uncomfortable during many meetings, especially when Mermista insisted on sitting next to her. But Adora thought it was rather cute. Catra tried so hard to keep her distance from Mermista that it was almost comical. Adora assured her it was okay to be attracted to Mermista. But, Catra was still working through those feelings, obviously.

"We'll be out in a few minutes, and then we can probably get started. Thanks, Mermista."

Catra sat down and looked at Adora before they both started giggling.

*

Adora waved as the last few people walked out of the store. The meeting went better than expected, and a few of the members pointed out a couple of things that Adora had missed in the book. It took her most of the meeting to agree with most of the other members, but she could now say that the book wasn't *that* bad. The good news was that the group settled on the next book to read. The theme they are covering next month was *subtext* . And the book they chose was about a warrior princess and her sidekick traveling through ancient Greece. It seemed interesting enough. Catra already had a copy at home, so they decided to share since Catra had read it numerous times.

"Are you sure it's okay to leave? You can stay and close if you want." Adora pushed the last chair back to its original place.

"Oh, no, Netossa and Rogelio are here. They are the closers tonight; I was just a mid to cover the book club." Catra picked a few pieces of what looked to be popcorn from her tail and straightened the fur out. "Anyway, we have plans tonight." She winked.

Adora's cheeks immediately turned a bright red as she waited for Catra to collect the last of their belongings. She had thought about using their new toy throughout the day, but the closer it came to going home, the more the excitement turned into nervousness. She was glad that Catra was experienced and could lead them through the process.

In the parking lot, they kissed and said their goodbyes. "I'll see you at home," Catra said before getting into her car.

Adora stood by her door as she watched Catra pull out and drive away. She wished she had a bit more time to do some quick research before going home. Then, taking a deep breath, she opened her door and got in.

When Adora walked in the door, Catra was getting ready for bed. She walked out of the bathroom with a toothbrush in her mouth. "What took you so long, baby?"

"Oh, nothing. I was just thinking."

Catra leaned back into the bathroom to spit out the mouthful of toothpaste in the sink and wiped her mouth. "What's on your mind?" She walked toward Adora extending her hands.

Adora took Catra's hands and looked at them intently, "I...uh...I'm a bit nervous all the sudden. "

"Hey, honey? We don't have to do anything tonight. We can just talk about it or even just go to bed." She pulled Adora closer to her, hugging her and kissed her forehead. "You can always say no or change your mind, baby. "

Adora nuzzled into Catra’s shoulder. "You promise?"

"Promise." She kissed Adora's head. "Just because we buy something or talk about it doesn't mean we have to use it later. We get to make that choice together, babe."

"Okay. Can we look at it and maybe look some things up together?"

"You want to do research together? I thought you'd never ask." Catra immediately started tickling Adora. Then, finally, they made their way to the bathroom.

Adora jumped into bed and threw her pants and bra on the floor. She immediately snuck under the covers as Catra was finishing her nightly routine.

Before Catra joined Adora in bed, she grabbed the bag filled with their new accoutrement. "What are some things you want to look up?" She sat down and pulled the lube out to read the label.

"Well, I guess I'm just worried it will hurt or that it won't feel good for me. So, I want to look into positions that feel better for first-timers."

"Okay, I think that sounds like a great idea. I'm interested in why you think it will hurt?" Catra set the lube down and pulled out the jockstrap harness.

"I don't know. I was excited earlier. I think it just became a reality after the book club ended that we were really going to go home and use the strap." Adora set her phone down.

"I want it to be a pleasurable and positive experience for us. There are a lot of other things we can do with it, too." Catra finished popping off the tags and held the harness out in front of her. "Wow, this thing is impressive."

"I read on a lesbian sex advice site that it may be more comfortable for the person wearing it to wear boxer briefs or something on under." Adora looked over at Catra unfolding the harness, using her nails to cut any leftover tags or plastic bits.

"Oh, a lesbian sex advice website, huh? What else did it say?"

"Well, it did say the first time can be a little uncomfortable, but it usually doesn't last long." Adora tried to focus on her phone, but Catra's nimble hands moving over the smooth silicone caught her eye.

"That's good news." Catra inspected the blue member closely. "I like that it's soft and flexible but still firm." She bent it back and forth a few times. "I'm gonna go wash it. "

After Catra stood up, Adora looked at the lube and the harness. In all honesty, she had no idea how it was supposed to fit on a human person. But, watching Catra play with it, and move her hands over the soft leather, was enticing. She wondered what Catra would look like in the get-up.

"Adora, it's really easy to clean, and it warms up in hot water." Catra walked into their room holding the dildo like it was an offering.

"Will you put it on?"

"Wait, what?"

Adora looked up with apprehension, "I want to see what you look like in it."

Catra's eyebrow raised, and she smiled. Pulling her underwear down, she took the harness from Adora's hand and held it up to see if it was facing the right way. Then, pushing the dildo through the O ring, she double-checked to make sure it was secure. "Let's see if I remember how to put one of these things on."

It wasn't as hard as she thought. All she had to do was step into it and pull it up like a pair of underwear. As soon as she felt the harness on her hips, a familiar feeling of power flowed through her. She adjusted the straps around her ass and snapped them when she was done. The one time that she had used a strap before, she really enjoyed it. She tightened the straps one last time, grabbed the shaft, and looked down at Adora. "What do you think?"

Adora looked Catra up and down like she was a cold drink on a hot summer's day. "Wow."

Catra lifted her shirt up, showing her stomach and the entire harness; she turned around, giving Adora the full view, feeling a slight chill on her exposed skin. Then, fighting the urge to look back to see Adora taking every inch of her in, she slowly swayed her hips and gingerly swung her tail.

Adora was sold. Catra looked fucking delicious in a harness. She loved the way her ass popped with the straps framing her taut skin. If Catra's skilled fingers were any indicator of how being fucked by her would feel, Adora couldn't wait to find out. Adora moved to the side of the bed and reached out to the soft skin in front of her. "You look so good."

Catra clenched at the touch and looked back. "Do I, baby?" She turned around.

Adora reached out and wrapped her hand around the new toy. "Can we…" She pushed it into Catra and continued to move her hand around the shaft. "...try it?"

With a smile, Catra answered. "Absolutely." She bent down to kiss Adora, slowly at first, but she allowed her tongue to move over Adora’s lips within a moment or two. Adora quickly responded to the addition. Feeling the push and pull from Adora's mouth was a clear signal that she wanted more. Her intensity was met only with the building arousal in Catra's center.

Moving away from Adora, she knelt and traced her hands over Adora's thighs. "Do you want me to fuck you, Adora?"

Adora looked down at Catra meekly and replied, "Please."

Catra smiled and continued to trace her fingers on Adora's inner thighs, stopping to run the back of her fingers gently over the apex of her legs. Little by little, Adora was slowly coming out of her shell, asking for things, doing things, wanting things. "Take off your underwear."

Adora swiftly obliged, tossing the pair on the floor. She lifted her shirt, wanting to give Catra more to look at. Catra intently watched her every move.

"Open your legs. I want to see you."

Spreading her legs, she held her fingers over her mouth, watching Catra, waiting. Catra's wide pupils were focused on Adora's, only briefly peering down at Adora's exposed sex.

She licked her lips, "Mmm, you look so good. You're already so wet for me." Catra teased her thumb through Adora's folds, causing her to gasp.

Adora's hips moved in line with Catra's gentle motions on her clit. Catra knew precisely how much pressure and where to touch her. With how many times they had had sex, it was more than understandable.

Kissing down Adora's stomach, she wasted no time parting Adora's folds with a quick stroke of her tongue. The sound of

Adora moaning was the motivation she needed to focus the flicks of her tongue on the hard clit.

Adora intertwined her fingers in Catra's hair, pulling her closer. The feel of her soft, skilled tongue always promised a delightful experience. Tonight was no different. She luxuriated in the feeling of Catra's ministrations, focusing on extending her pleasure. She had orgasmed quickly in many of their past encounters, and she wanted a protracted experience. "Catra, you feel so good," she whimpered.

"Are you getting close?" She quickened her focus on Adora's clit, waiting for an answer.

She couldn't help but moan; it felt so perfect. "Really close." She grunted. As soon as her grip on Catra's head tightened, Catra pulled away. Adora groaned. "Catra...I was abo-"

The grin on Catra's face grew as Adora's desperate plea left her lips. She stood up. "Lay down."

Adora perked up and nodded, moving to the middle of the bed to wait for Catra. She was already so close and struggled to stop herself from just reaching down to bring herself to orgasm. The slick that had collected between her legs was slowly trickling down. She watched as Catra adjusted and gathered.

"Put a pillow under your butt." Catra took the lube from the nightstand and broke the seal. She picked up a towel from the floor and set it next to Adora. Then, crawling on the bed and maneuvering herself between Adora's legs, she stopped. "I'll go slow, okay? Tell me if you want to stop, or it starts to hurt."

"Okay." She nodded.

Catra slathered lube on the strap before running her lube-covered fingers through Adora's slick.

"Ohhh, that's cold." She let out a little giggle and winced.

Catra smiled. “Oops.” In response, She slid two fingers inside Adora, which immediately garnered a pleasant reaction.

"Oh, Catra." Adora threw her head back as the slippery fingers slowly pumped inside her.

"I'm going to add another finger, okay? Tell me if it's too much."

"Mmhmm." She moved her hips to meet the exploring fingers, wanting to feel every bit. The stretch from the third finger was enough to be filled but wasn’t uncomfortable. "It feels good. Go a little faster."

Catra increased her speed, watching Adora writhe below her. And almost as soon as she began, she stopped. "Are you ready?"

"Yeah," she panted.

Catra positioned herself below Adora and lightly moved the tip through her folds. Adora was watching intently as Catra applied a small amount of pressure to her entrance. A little bit at a time, Catra worked the strap in. Adora let out a few soft moans as Catra glided in and out, going deeper with each roll of her hips. Once she was almost entirely in, she asked. "How are you doing?"

Adora wiggled a bit at the full feeling. "It's a little tight but doesn't hurt."

"Want me to keep going?"

"Yeah, just go slow."

She leaned down to kiss Adora. "I love you."

"I love you, too."

Catra let her hips slowly move into Adora, making sure to feel for any resistance to her thrusts. The end of the dildo was pressed

against her almost perfectly, pushing her lips together, creating exquisite friction as her slick slid against her clit. A small moan fell from Adora's mouth as she held onto Catra's arms. She looked so beautiful and candid, her bright blue eyes looking into Catra's mismatched ones. Catra was unsure of the look in Adora's eyes. Adoration? Trust? Sincerity? Genuinity? Either way, she was lost in the moment. Her hips must have been on autopilot because Adora's possessive grip tightened.

"You can go faster," Adora breathed.

Catra was right. This was a perfect size. It was bigger than Catra's amazing fingers, but not by too much. Adora couldn't decide which she liked more, the view of Catra thrusting into her or how blatantly obvious it was that Catra was *very* into fucking her. Catra's moans were almost as roaring as Adora's.

"Does it feel good, baby?" Catra panted.

Adora's quick breathing made it difficult to respond. "You...ohh… feel...mmm...so good." She moved her fingers to her clit, making quick circles. The warmth inside her, Catra on top of her, and her fingers working her nub seamlessly were otherworldly. With her free hand, she grabbed Catra's ass, pulling her deeper. "Don't stop!"

Catra pushed Adora's thighs up to her body and wrapped her thighs around Adora's hips, allowing her to fuck Adora more freely. She held herself up on Adora's thighs as her hips moved into the panting blonde. She used every last ounce of energy she

had to properly fuck her girlfriend. The angle gave her clit more direct pressure from the base of the dildo, and god, did it feel good. She could feel Adora's walls tightening, which made her work through the burning in her thighs to bring Adora to her peak.

Within a few moments of the position change, Adora cried out in a way Catra had never heard before. It was primal; it was raw; it was *loud* .

Adora's fingers sunk into Catra's ass as she exploded. Her face was red as expletives spilled from her mouth. Then, when her climax slowly faded, she breathed in and released Catra's tender flesh.

Catra slowed her thrusts significantly as Adora lay practically gasping for air. "Wow."

Adora didn't acknowledge Catra's comment or even look at her. She was still floating in space, and Catra was merely there to make sure she didn't fall.

"I'm going to pull out, okay?"

Adora blinked a few times and looked at Catra. "Okay." She flinched as she felt the emptiness return. "Catra…"

Catra undid the strap and slid out of it, setting it on the side table and moving to lay next to Adora. "I think that's the hardest I've seen you come. How are you feeling?"

"Mnmm." She looked at a very smug Catra.

"I take that as good." Catra leaned down to kiss Adora's forehead.

"I love having sex with you."

Catra laughed. "I'm glad you like it. I have a special spot in my heart for it too." By small, she meant huge, enormous, basically the entire organ.

Adora smiled as she melted deeper into Catra's shoulder. "I want to fuck you, but I need a minute."

Catra's cheeks warmed, and a pang of nervousness shot through her stomach. Her awkward laugh said it all. She had still not admitted to Adora that she had never had a strap used on her, and she was unusually nervous about the act.

"What's that laugh for?" Adora raised her eyebrow, knowing full well that something was on Catra's mind.

Catra laid there for a moment thinking about her answer; it’s not that she didn't want to do it. She was just a bit too nervous, and that may interfere with her enjoyment of the activity. "I um...can I tell you something?"

Adora sat up, "Of course, honey." She cupped Catra's face.

Catra turned her head away from Adora, trying to hide her embarrassment. But, in reality, she had nothing to be embarrassed about. There were things she just had not done, and that was okay. But, the pressure to be an experienced lesbian was getting to her more than she cared to admit. "Well, to be honest... I've only ever used a strap once, and it was on someone else."

Adora took Catra's hand, instantly recognizing her body language. "Honey, that's okay. If you're not ready, you're not ready. We have all the time in the world. There are plenty of other things we can do."

Catra sighed.

"It's okay to say no." Adora kissed Catra's cheek.

"Okay." The feeling of never being gay enough or being too gay was a fear she had been working through for years. One part of her was nervous about being that vulnerable, while the other part felt like she was supposed to have the experience already.

"We're in this together, remember? I want you to enjoy it and not worry."

"Thanks. I just need a bit more time. Can we do something different?" Catra turned over to face Adora, who was looking intently at her.

"Of course. I have something in mind. Lay on your belly."

Catra's ears perked up instantly; she took off her shirt and quickly readjusted onto her belly.

Adora took a deep breath and moved, straddling Catra's legs. She kissed down the beautiful back in front of her as her fingers made their way to Catra's core. "You're so wet." Teasing her fingers over Catra's glistening lips, she breathed, "I want to make you come as hard as you made me come." Before her sentence was even finished, she slid two fingers inside Catra's slick entrance.

"Adora!" Catra cried out as Adora's fingers spared no time working her nicely.

"Do you like my fingers, baby?"

"Fuck." She was moving her ass to meet the pumping fingers, wanting only to feel their full length for as long as she possibly could. "Oh, just like that." She grabbed at the sheets trying to gain purchase; not even her claws were helping. Adora's fingers knew the perfect curl to bring her close to release.

Adora marveled at the sight before her. Her fingers sank into Catra easily as she squirmed and pushed into Adora.

Thrusting her ass up, Catra moaned as she spilled over the edge. "Adoraaahhhhh."

Adora slowed her movements but didn't stop. Instead, she stayed inside Catra, slowly curling her fingers as Catra calmed. "Mmm, you look so good when you come," she moaned.

Catra looked back at Adora, who looked proud as hell. Adora’s fingers were still gently moving inside her. "Harder."

Adora obliged and increased her speed; it didn't take long for Catra to peak again. Then, after a few moments of gently curling her fingers, she pulled up on Catra's hips. "Butt up." Her fingers still gently curling inside her bent-over girlfriend. "Come for me, baby."

Yes! Tacos!

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora try to figure out a way to tell Adora's parents about their relationship.

Chapter Notes

Oh HECK!! Only two more chapters after this!! I hope you like it. It's a little emotional and spicy. I am working on a Catradora one shot and hope to have that posted in the next few days as a little bonus for y'all.

Thanks for your continued support!

CW: coming out

Catra set her fork down on her now empty plate. "Wow, baby. I didn't even know what compote was." Her belly was noticeably popping out after the extensive meal she just ate. She loved when Adora surprised her with a full breakfast. If Adora wanted to try out a new recipe or technique, Catra was more than willing to be her test subject.

"Isn't it the best? I love blueberries and lemon together. It's hard to go back to pancakes with just syrup after that." Adora set down a fresh cup of coffee for Catra. She had received another text from her mother the day before, and she was trying not to avoid it, but that was proving to be rather tricky. Graduation was only a week away, and they would be here in no time. The moment she was trying to avoid was upon her. It was time she and Catra decided precisely how to tell her parents. "My parents texted yesterday about graduation. I think we need to come up with a plan to tell them about us."

Catra looked up at Adora from her mug. "Damn, that snuck up on us, didn't it?" She had honestly been putting off having this conversation. The last interaction she had with her own mother still stung, and she was dreading a repeat. But, it wasn't just about her anymore, it was about them, and it hurt even more thinking about Adora potentially losing her parents because of her.

"Yeah, I think they should stay in a hotel. I am not willing to have them here criticizing me, our house, or us." Adora's voice had a hint of irritation. This was obviously something that had been profoundly affecting her as well. "Catra? I just want to get this over with. Graduation is about my accomplishment, not their constant disapproval." She sighed and leaned back in her chair, staring at the ceiling. "I would love, just once, for them just to be accepting and supportive. No comments. No questions. Just happy for me."

Catra reached out for Adora's hand. "Honey, I'm here with you. We do this together."

"Thank you. I don't even know where to start. Should I just tell them in a text? Should we call them? What should we do?" Her head was spinning. It felt almost hopeless to try and develop a plan that would mitigate some of the backlash. But, on the other hand, it did help her feel a bit more control - to choose how they did this.

"When do they arrive?"

"On Wednesday."

"They're coming early? Isn't graduation Saturday? How long are they staying?" Catra finished her coffee and studied Adora's face and expressions. Even if Adora couldn't verbalize how she felt, Catra could figure it out by her very expressive body language.

"Yeah, they want to spend time with me and catch up."

"We could suggest a hotel that is close to us, but not the closest one. That way, they are not within shouting distance."

"Good idea. I think I just want to text them about us. Or maybe we can just let them figure it out?" She was feeling apprehensive.

"Adora, I think you should do it however you feel the most comfortable. It would probably be a good idea to tell them beforehand, so they can have a bit of time to...process it." Catra hated the idea that Adora's parents had to process that Adora was with her. It was infuriating, to say the least. They had been inseparable since childhood, and it was always a fight to get Hope even to give her the time of day.

"You're right." Adora sighed.

The tell-tale sound of Catra's ringtone blasted throughout the kitchen. She pulled out her phone but just missed the call.

Netossa's number popped up on the screen, as well as a voicemail notification. She opened her voicemail that had countless messages that had gone unlistened to. Answering her messages or voicemail was not on the top of Catra's priority list. She played the voicemail, and it was Netossa asking Catra to call her ASAP. "That sounds bad."

Catra scrolled through the other messages, noticing that many of them were spam calls or unknown numbers. She deleted a few before she saw an unplayed message from Adora. "Oh, I have one from you. Did you send me a sexy voicemail, and I missed it?" She winked and hit play. The message was short, and the distress in Adora's voice was evident.

Uh...hey...Catra. I haven't heard from you today and I...uh...just wanted to say hi...to you. Text me back. Bye.

Adora frowned and instantly recognized the message. She folded her arms. "That's the day your phone was in my car." Hearing that message didn't help the situation. If the conversation with her parents felt anything like the day she made that phone call, she would not bounce back nearly as fast.

"Oh." After a moment, Catra scooted over to Adora. "Hey, we're past that, and we are going to get through this conversation with your parents." She rubbed Adora's back gently. "Is it okay if I call Netossa back really quick?"

"Mmhmm." Adora sipped her tea, watching Catra put the phone to her ear.

When Netossa answered, Catra just said, "Okay. I'll be there soon." She set her phone down and pushed her coffee mug away. "Well, I do have to work after all."

"What happened?"

"Netossa isn't feeling well. It will only be a few hours. After that, we can have dinner together; how does that sound?"

"Okay, I'll look up recipes and go to the store. Can I send you a few ideas and drafts of what I want to say to my parents?"

"Of course."

Adora looked up from her phone and stared at the ceiling. She had tried to be productive today but knew that she was putting off the exchange she had to have with her parents. A few hours ago, the conversation with Catra had helped chill her nerves a bit, but she still had to actually to contact her parents.

Adora [12:34 pm]: *How about I just call them and tell them that I'm in a relationship, and then they can find out with whom when they arrive?*

Catra: [12:35 pm]: *okay, that is better than the last suggestion, but they may be disappointed when they find out its me*

Adora [12:37 pm]: *Ugh. How about I send them a picture of us cuddling and being cute?*

Catra [12:40 pm]: *i mean, as much as i love pics of us, i think they would just think we were friends or say soemthing rude*

Catra [12:40 pm]: *something**

Adora felt Finn jump on the couch as she was replying to Catra. Her parents also hated cats, so did she need to tell them they had a cat too? This business of telling her parents about everything in her life was exhausting. Why did she even have to say anything to them? Why couldn't she just be, and they would have to deal with it like adults? She groaned and picked up Finn and snuggled the cat, albeit maybe a little too tight.

Adora [1:00 pm]: *What about I tell them on Wednesday morning before they board their plane?*

Catra [1:01 pm]: *that could work then they have the plane ride to think about it*

Catra [1:02 pm]: *but that does not give them much time to figure it out before they arrive*

Adora [1:05 pm]: *Honestly, they are going to be upset either way; it makes no difference in how I tell them. I think I'm just*

going to text them now.

She set her phone down, waiting for Catra to text back. So this was it, the moment she was going to tell her parents. She expected them to react badly, but it had to be done. They would find out in a few days anyway, and this way, she could do some damage control before the ceremony. After this, there was no question that she had earned the romantic getaway that Catra had planned for them.

Catra [1:09 pm]: *okay, baby. tell me how it goes i lvoe you*

Catra [1:10 pm]: *love* lol*

Adora pulled up the last text from Hope. Here goes nothing. She started to type out a message, stopping only to delete half and redo it. It took her another twenty minutes to get the wording right, stopping a few times to cuddle Finn or get a drink. Mostly, she was getting distracted by everything and anything. For a moment, she even thought about reorganizing the basement. When she finally finished the drafted text, she hovered over the send button before deciding to copy the memo and switch over to Catra's message.

Adora [1:50 pm]: *What do you think of this?*

Adora [1:50 pm]: *Mother, before you arrive for my graduation, I want to tell you something that has been weighing heavy on my*

shoulders. As you know, Catra and I have been friends for a very long time. We bought a house together last year, and now our friendship has become something more. Catra is my partner. I hope you understand and can treat her and our relationship with respect.

A bolt of anxiety pulsed through her body as she hit send. She couldn't wait to hear what Catra had to say about the message, but even just sending it to Catra was terrifying. This was one of the only times that she wished that she had to work so she could zone out, but the testing center was closed for the last two weeks of the semester. She applied for social work jobs in the area for the previous few months and found a full-time position at an LGBTQIA+ youth resource center. Unfortunately, she had just taken her test for social work certification and would not hear back with the results for some time - a few weeks before she started her new job. It was a blessing to have time off after completing school, but it gave her a bit too much time to think.

Catra [2:05 pm]: *i love it, and i love you*

Catra [2:06 pm]: *im proud of you, baby*

Catra [2:07 pm]: *tell me how it goes*

Adora smiled. Catra's support was so comforting. She had to remind herself that they could get through this and whatever her parents said together; Catra was there.

Adora [2:10 pm]: *I really love you, Catra. Thank you for being so supportive.*

She pulled up her mother's message, looked over the text again, making a few changes, and hit send. After she heard the sound of a sent message, she felt a sort of elation. She had just told her parents she was gay and had a loving partner. Picking up Finn, she nuzzled the sleepy cat and kissed them close to one hundred times. The cat was too tired to care about the extra attention. A few moments later, she had still not heard back from Hope and started to feel an unfocused panic. The house was silent; not even the clock in the kitchen made a sound. It was unnerving, to say the least. So, she pulled up the message again, reread it, checked if she had reception, and typed another message out.

Adora [2:30 pm]: *There is a hotel close to our house that you two could stay at. They have reasonable rates, and it's clean. It's called Brightmoon Suites. They have a special for anyone going to graduation, so you could get a good deal if you hurry.*

She set her phone down and sat up on the couch. An uncomfortable warmth radiated through her body, and her chest felt tight. Time to get up. She shook her head and took a deep breath, grabbed her keys, and walked out the door.

*

When Adora arrived at the grocery store, she had no idea what she should make for dinner, but that didn't really matter. This trip was now more about distraction than meal planning. She followed

the same pattern that she and Catra took when they went to the store.

This had done wonders to help calm her nerves. The routine and knowing what was coming next were comforting to her. Then, as she looked at the produce, she felt the vibration of her phone. As if her anxiety couldn't get worse, someone was calling her. Fuck.

She closed her eyes, took a deep breath, and pulled her phone out of her pocket. It was Catra. Thank god.

"Hey, baby."

"How are you doing? I took a quick bathroom break to check on you."

"Wait, are you peeing right now?"

"Is that weird?"

"Are we a married couple already?" Adora laughed. Just the sound of Catra's voice was soothing, but the added silliness definitely helped.

"I mean, we have been together for like all our lives." Catra teased.

"Okay, that's true." She paused for a second, thinking of what to say to Catra. "I think I feel okay. I started to have a panic attack, so I left the house and went to the store."

"Oh, honey. I'll be home in about an hour. So we can cuddle on the couch a bit before we start dinner."

"That sounds wonderful. I can't wait to see you. I miss you."

"I can't wait to see you either."

Adora sighed. What did she do in her life to deserve such a supportive partner? It wasn't much of a surprise that Catra was a supportive and loving partner. She had always been that way with Adora. It was one of the reasons their relationship had always been so strong. Adora smiled as she continued looking at vegetables; she noticed the jalapenos. *Tacos.*

"This isn't exactly what I thought you meant by cuddling," Adora breathed.

"Me neither." She panted. "God, keep going."

Adora planted her feet squarely on the floor as she slammed her hips into Catra. She held onto Catra's hips to guide each of her thrusts as the woman moaned vociferously on top of her. Her partner's eyes were tightly shut as she grinded down on the strap Adora was wielding. Catra still had Adora’s hoodie on and it could not have been comfortable at this juncture in their connection.

"You look so good, Catra." Adora could barely get the words out. Her ass was feeling the strain of the pace she kept as she gave Catra everything she needed.

Catra opened her eyes and kissed Adora as a powerful thrust moved perfectly through her. "Oh god, I'm coming, I'm-" she cried out as her grip on Adora's shoulders tightened. "Unnnnhhhh."

Adora slowed her pace as her lover collapsed onto her shoulder, breathing heavily. She moved her hands gently under the hoodie Catra was still wearing, moving to pull it over the exhausted woman's head. "Let's take this off, so you can cool down."

"Mnmmm." Catra barely acknowledged her but pushed off the strong woman's chest and lifted her arms. "Thank you." She muttered as she again rested on Adora's shoulder.

Adora ran her fingers down Cata's sides, gently kissing her neck and shoulder. Catra's uneasiness surrounding the strap had mostly subsided in the days after they had first used it, and when Catra got home that day, their cuddle pile on the couch quickly turned

into a passionate lovemaking session. And damn was she glad. Seeing Catra absolutely come undone while straddling her was what she desperately needed to take her mind off of things.

After a few moments, Catra sat up and began moving her hips again. "I love when you fuck me, baby." All the uncertainty she had previously was now but aforethought in her mind. Nevertheless, the plunge into the experience was one she would not soon forget.

Adora watched Catra move on her lap, enjoying the new toy almost more than Adora had a few weeks ago. "I want you to pack for my graduation."

Catra slowed her hips. "Wait, what?" she breathed.

"I want you to pack at the ceremony. I want to know that you're ready to fuck me anytime I want before, during, and after." She rolled her hips into Catra, eliciting a moan.

Wow . All Catra could do was stare at her incredibly sexy girlfriend. She was officially speechless. If she was unsure of her ability to orgasm again, that was quickly forgotten. "Harder." She moved her hips into Adora as each thrust sank into her. "Fuck!"

It only took a few moments before Catra was, again, brought over the edge. She collapsed onto Adora, letting a few moments pass

before lifting her hips to release her grip on the strap. "Mmm, baby," she mumbled.

Adora laughed softly. "I'm glad you liked it. You look beautiful." She kissed Catra's head.

"What did you get for dinner?" Catra softly asked.

Adora smiled. "Are you hungry? Did I wear you out?"

Catra sat up and put her hand over Adora's face. "You wish!"

A sharp laugh followed a loud snort as Adora tickled Catra. "How embarrassing for you that your girlfriend fucked you so well, that you're all worn out."

Catra wiggled and playfully bit Adora as the two giggled their way onto the floor. "No fair!"

“It's more than fair!"

Catra kissed Adora and looked into her eyes. "I love you."

"I love you too, and I got stuff for tacos."

"Yes!" Catra tried to stand up, but her legs were not willing to provide the support she needed to take a step.

Adora watched as her girlfriend tried to push herself up on the couch unsuccessfully. "Do you need help, baby?" She laughed.

Catra pouted her lips out. "Yes, please."

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Catra set the vegetables on the counter. "Do you want the whole thing diced?"

"Yeah, leave some on the side so we can put some on top of the tacos."

After rinsing everything, Catra picked up a knife and slowly started dicing. "So, where did you learn about packing?" She tried to hide her smile, but it was almost the most prominent thing in the kitchen.

Adora looked quickly at Catra, who was, thankfully, focused on the knife. She could feel her cheeks warming. "I, uh, saw it when I

was looking stuff up the other day."

"Tell me more about it."

"Well, I was just looking at different positions and stuff we could try...and this article came up about packing. I honestly thought it was about how to travel with your strap. You know, like on planes, but it was something very different."

"Do you want me to fuck you at graduation?"

Adora looked over at Catra and then down at the pan and smiled. "Yes."

"Mmm. I like that. I honestly didn't think you were really into the strap."

"I mean, I do like it, but I *really* like your fingers and mouth."

Catra hopped over to Adora and kissed her neck, holding her spicy pepper-covered hands away from any sensitive spots. "We'll need to buy a new packing harness."

Adora turned around and playfully cupped Catra's face. "I like the sound of that." She kissed Catra and started tickling her. "You

done with those onions yet, baby?" She laughed.

Her hands were covered in jalapeño, and she could not fight back. "No fair!"

"Okay, okay." She kissed Catra again. "Is it okay if I put most of the jalapeño in this too? I don’t think it will be too spicy."

"Yeah, yeah." Catra waved her hand in the air and walked over to toss the onion, garlic, and jalapenos into the mixture on the stove.

"Can I put potato in this?" Adora asked as she stirred the ground turkey.

"Um, sure. It's been a minute since we've done that."

"Yeah, I don't know why I'm craving it right now."

Catra washed her hands and wrapped them around Adora's waist, and kissed her cheek. "I think I know why. Have you heard back from Hope?"

Adora set the spatula down. It wasn't clear to her before, but now it made perfect sense. She was craving the comfort of her

parents. "I...no." She looked at Catra. "Maybe the message didn't send or something."

"Hey, honey? It's only been a few hours. Maybe they are both at work."

Adora sighed. "You're probably right." She started shredding the potato into the pan. "I guess it has only been a few hours. I think I'm just waiting for the worst."

"Oh, honey. I can only imagine what that feels like. But, whatever happens, I'm right here." She rubbed Adora's back.

"Thanks. Eating will probably help. You did kind of wear me out earlier." She winked at Catra.

Catra smiled and kissed Adora. "Let's eat."

There was something about adding potato to tacos that just did it for Adora. Her parents probably did it to stretch meals a bit further, but for some reason, it made it a comfort food. Tacos just weren't the same without it. But, of course, tacos weren't the same without Catra struggling to eat them either. She usually got tortillas to make it easier for Catra, but this time she forgot. Catra said she didn't mind, but Adora still felt bad watching Catra struggle a bit with the taco shell and her fangs. "I'm sorry I forgot tortillas!"

Catra laughed. "Don't be. I hope this cheers you up a bit. These are really good, so I don't mind the challenge." The smile that appeared on Adora's face was more than worth a little struggle to enjoy dinner. She was about to give up anyway and just make a sort of taco salad on her plate. Standing up to get a bit more of the bean and turkey mixture, she made sure to add a little extra sour cream for the trouble before she sat down. Then, there was a knock on the door.

Adora's head snapped toward the door. "Were you expecting someone, Catra?"

"No. I haven't even talked to Bow or Glimmer today."

She stood up and walked toward the door, looking back at Catra. She unlocked it, and as soon as she swung it open, her parents were standing in the doorway. *Oh fuck.*

Mara smiled. "Adora! We came early!"

Uninvited guests

Chapter Summary

Adora's parents show up early and force Catra and Adora to have the conversation they have been dreading.

Chapter Notes

CW: coming out, invalidation

Alright y'all! Here you go. With all the comments from the last chapter, I am excited to see what y'all say for this one!

I cannot believe there is only one more chapter left!! Thanks for the support!

Okay, so that one shot I was talking about...turned out to be 8600 words and is being editing right now lol. So hang tight haha.

Adora and Catra stood in the doorway, staring at the two women dragging their luggage and bags.

"Hey, Mara and Hope!" Catra awkwardly said as she pulled the door fully open. "We weren't expecting you so soon. The house is a bit of a mess." But, as usual, the house looked fine. Aside from their half-eaten dinner on the table.

Mara stepped into the house, immediately dropped her bags, and hugged Adora. "Look how long your hair is. Have you lost weight?"

Adora quickly pulled away. "Ugh, mom, stop." But she did secretly love it. Even though there were difficulties in their relationship, she still loved her parents. There was something special about the love that a parent gave. Mara was a kind woman but much too passive compared to Hope's blunt personality. But, her tenderness was appreciated.

Hope walked toward Adora and placed her hand on her shoulder. "Hello, Adora. You look well."

Catra stood and watched while the women mostly ignored her. This was already incredibly uncomfortable and awkward. On top of that, she didn't know what to do, whether to initiate contact or just let Adora get through this. While she was standing there watching their interactions, she wished that Adora could quickly convince them to go check in to a hotel, so they could at least get back to dinner. She quietly sighed.

"Why are you here this early?" Adora frowned.

"Your graduation is in a few days, and we wanted to see you. It's been a long time." Mara smiled from the couch.

Hope looked over at Catra and raised her eyebrow. "Adora, I think it would be appropriate for Catra to sleep on the couch so we can have a place to stay for your graduation."

Before Adora could answer, Catra noticed that Mara had set down her bags on the couch and stared at the obviously used strap and lube. "Shit…" She quickly walked over to the items and whisked them away to their bedroom. *Fuck fuck fuck fuck.* If things couldn't have gotten worse than the surprise visit that was quickly turning their house into a damn bed and breakfast. Catra stood in their room, pacing and trying to calm herself. *Oh, this is bad. Yeah, hey Mara and Hope, I fucked your daughter an hour ago on the very couch you are laying your bags on.* She stood in front of the mirror and saw her tail was a puffy mess. She took it in her hands and tried to smooth it out. But, alas, it was unsuccessful.

After she had given up, she heard Adora's elevated voice from the front room.

"No, Hope. Catra is not going to sleep in the front room. We have a guest room. If that isn't good enough for you, then there is a hotel down the road." Adora's arms were tightly crossed. She was upset and *trying* to keep her voice down.

"Adora, I do not know why you are so angry. We are your parents and need a place to stay for *your* graduation."

"Mother, you didn't ask us to stay, and I texted you earlier. So why didn't you message me back?"

Hope looked toward Mara. "We must have been in the air when you sent it. Anyways, we're here now" She walked into the kitchen, seeing that their dinner was half-eaten. "Where are your cap and gown?"

Mara was opening their bags and looking through the items and clothes packed inside. She was doing as she always did when Adora and Hope got into a tussle, trying to make herself useful.

"They are in our room."

"Have you gotten them pressed yet?"

"I'm not getting them pressed."

"Why not? You need to look nice." Hope folded her arms, looking bothered.

Mara looked up from the bags she was messing with. "Adora, honey? How are your classes? Your mother said you were having some trouble."

Adora turned to look for Catra, who was standing behind her. The look in Adora's eyes was panic. They screamed for help.

Catra grabbed Adora's hand and smiled. "I'm here." she whispered.

Adora was overwhelmed; she felt like she was going to explode. "Stop! Both of you. I'm not getting my cap and gown pressed; they are fine the way they are. Mom, I'm graduating with a social work degree. It sounds like Hope didn't tell you that detail."

"But, I thought you were going for engineer-"

"I never wanted to join the military; that was what you wanted. I've always wanted to help people, not hurt them." Her voice cracked as she blurted out everything she was feeling, and Catra pulsed her grip on Adora's hand. "I went along with the idea because I didn't want to fight with you. But, I want to make my own choices and live my life the way I want to." She didn't mean to blow up on Mara, it was Hope that she was primarily angry at, but it just came out. Adora wasn't prepared to have this conversation yet.

Mara stood up and went to Hope, placing a hand on her shoulder.

Adora looked over at Catra and took a deep breath. Tears were starting to collect in her eyes. "I love both of you, and I need you to trust me to make the decisions that are right for me."

Hope held her chin up. "Adora. We only wanted what was best for you. Both of us had a positive experience in the military and wanted you to experience the same."

Not knowing how to respond, Adora stood there staring at Hope.

Mara softly spoke. "I think what your mother is trying to say is that she's sorry." She looked at Hope, who stood there stone-faced. "We thought we were supporting you and helping you find out what your path was. But, we were hurting you."

Adora sighed. The apology and pseudo support felt good, but this was just the beginning of the many secrets she had kept from them. "Thank you for saying that." This was the only time she could remember being truly honest with her parents. It felt empowering, scary, and stressful. She was glad that Catra was here with her, so she didn't have to do it alone. There would be many challenges ahead of them, but she knew this had to be done for them to have any chance of a healthy relationship.

She could admit that she had a hard time setting and upholding boundaries. And boy, did it show. The mess that they were in could definitely use a bit of boundary setting. The guilt was starting to bubble up. It was a mix of worry for finally telling her parents about school and for what she was about to talk to them about. Her parents were queer women themselves, but it wasn't a question of her sexuality that was the issue; it was Catra.

Hope cleared her throat, "We love you."

Adora walked toward her parents and hugged both of them.

"This has been a very long year without you. We miss you, Adora." Mara hugged Adora tight.

Catra stood back, wiping her eyes; her nerves were shot, watching Adora bare her soul to her parents. She knew how hard this would be and how Adora's anger was the catalyst for her admissions. Yet, there wasn't another moment in their history together that she felt prouder of Adora.

Adora was on a roll. Her parents were listening and even taking responsibility for things. This was the time to lay the Catra bomb down. She refused to spend another moment denying her love for Catra, and she was ready to shout it from the rooftops. But, without a sturdy ladder, telling her parents would have to do. Adora walked toward Catra and held her hands out. "Are you ready?"

Catra nodded.

"There is something else I'd like you to know." She turned towards her parents. "As you know, Catra and I have been friends since we were children. We bought this house together last year as best friends, and today we show you our home as partners. Catra has loved me unconditionally for our entire lives. I never had to be anything or do anything to earn her love. She just loved me. I am so thankful to have her in my life." Adora kissed Catra and placed their foreheads together.

"That would explain why you have a guest room," Hope murmured.

Mara bumped Hope on the shoulder.

"I love her, and I couldn't imagine a world without her."

Her parents stood there watching the two women.

Adora looked at her parents with a sense of relief. "I expect her to be treated with respect and kindness. She's a wonderful person, and I'd like you to get to know her."

"Adora, we have known her almost her entire life. We do no-"

"No, you have treated her poorly for years. I think you would love her as much as I do once you learn more about her."

Catra was feeling very uncomfortable and focused on. She didn't really think that once Adora came out to her parents, they would become her family. The fear that they would continue to reject her bubbled within her. She crossed her arm over her torso and looked away.

Mara looked at Catra, who was obviously distressed. "Of course we can do that, Adora," she said as she walked toward her. "Welcome to the family, Catra." She took Catra in for a big hug.

The action surprised Catra and also oddly comforted her. She couldn't even remember the last time she felt the touch of a caring parent. Catra hugged her back in earnest.

Hope met Catra with a pat on the shoulder. "I am looking forward to getting to know you better."

Catra wiped a few tears from her eyes. "Thank you," she said meekly.

"Okay, let's show you to your room." Adora turned around and took Catra's hand.

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Adora reheated the meat and bean mixture before handing her parents a plate to put their meal together before she sat down next to Catra.

"You still put potato in it," Hope said before dressing her tacos.

"We actually stopped doing that a few months ago, but for some reason, I wanted to do it tonight. I guess I know why now." Adora stared at her plate.

Catra stirred her slightly warm taco salad around her plate, not feeling as hungry as she was an hour ago.

"Adora, when did you change your major? That must have been why you are having trouble with credits," Hope said flatly.

"As soon as I moved out. It didn't affect my major at all. I had been taking social work classes as generals the whole time. I just didn't tell you."

"You have been lying to us for a long time, Adora."

"I did what I had to. It was almost impossible to reason with you. Lying was the only way to be able to do what I wanted and have a peaceful home."

Catra watched as the two women went back and forth. Surprisingly, Adora held her own and did not give in to her mother's pressure. Although it was more than uncomfortable to watch, Catra knew that she couldn't step in and defend Adora. This was yet another part of Adora's journey, and she had to do it independently.

"I couldn't have graduated without Catra. She has been supportive from day one." Adora took Catra’s hand.

"So, Catra, what do you do? Are you going to school with Adora?" Mara looked at Catra over her taco.

"Oh, um, no, I finished my degree a few years ago. I actually own a bookstore in town."

"You *own* a bookstore?" Hope chimed in, almost questioning her statement.

Catra awkwardly laughed, "Yeah, I bought it last year, after the owners retired and wanted to liquidate. I've pretty much turned the store around. We're doing great."

"That's impressive. How did you manage that? I haven't seen a brick and mortar bookstore for a while," Mara said as she pushed her empty plate away from her.

"I found a bunch of old promotional items that just happened to be for books that had movie adaptations coming out and did a few events." She took a drink and set her fork on her plate. "I also started a few queer book clubs and brought in board games."

"Oh." Both older women were genuinely taken aback by the information. They had never thought Catra would result in much of anything. Let alone a successful business owner.

"Yeah, I'm pretty proud of it, and I've loved having Adora by my side throughout the transformation."

"Catra has really improved that store, and it's in a great area of town."

"That's good to hear. Hope, are you ready to get ready for bed? We have been traveling all day. I hope you two will excuse us." Mara stood up from the table, waiting for Hope to follow suit.

"Good night."

Catra and Adora waited for the two older women to leave before turning to each other and shrugging.

"That went...okay?" Adora whispered.

"They were *trying* to get to know me. It still seemed forced."

"I agree. Do you want to see how the next few days go? How are you feeling?" Adora cupped Catra's face, knowing how difficult this was for her.

"I feel okay. I think that's a good idea. How are you doing? You just came out to your parents, and now they are staying at our

house."

"You know, I think I feel alright. I feel a lot lighter and am very glad that I don't have to hide anymore." She kissed Catra. "I love you. Thank you for being so supportive."

"Of course 'Dor, I love you."

"Adora! What are you doing?! Your parents are across the hall!" Catra firmly whispered.

"It's been days, Catra." Adora kissed down Catra's torso, licking and caressing every muscle. "I need you."

Adora had woken Catra up earlier than expected. Catra hadn't figured out why until that moment. Adora was horny. Not that Catra was against the idea, but it had been a rough couple of days trying to share space with Hope and Mara. It had been peaceful most of the time, but the passive-aggressive comments continued while the forced questions arose at the most inappropriate moments. Catra didn't know if she could relax enough to even enjoy the experience. But, she couldn't deny how great Adora's mouth felt on her.

"Adora, what if we get caught? What if they walk in?"

"I'll lock the door." She stood up and tiptoed to the door, and as quietly as she could, she turned the lock. When she laid back down, she kissed Catra before continuing. "We can cuddle if you want. We don't have to have sex." Adora kissed Catra's shoulder before laying her head on her chest.

Catra ran her fingers through Adora's hair. It had been a long few days. But, God did she want to fuck Adora, she had been thinking about packing for graduation, and it was only a day away. So she snuck away from work the day before, purchased a packing harness, and modeled it for Adora, which only worsened things. They were interrupted shortly after, stopping their exploration before it could even begin. "No fingers because I won't be able to be quiet if you do. Okay?"

They had tried to have sex multiple times over the last several days, each failed attempt frustrating the women even more. The constant stream of pictures of their hands sent to each other was not helping either. Mara and Hope were always around, even when they physically weren't. There was the time when Catra and Adora snuck to the basement to do laundry and even tried to hide in the corner opposite of the stairs. They managed to make out for several minutes, but just as Catra's hand made its way into Adora's underwear, the familiar voice of her mother rang down from upstairs.

And then there was the time when Mara and Hope went for a walk by the river close to the house. Adora locked the door as soon as they left. Catra quickly led Adora to the couch, where the two didn't even bother to make out before sliding their hands under their shirts and pants. They were close to actually

completing the task until they heard the sound of a key in the door. The only problem there was, they never gave Adora's parents a key.

The last time they tried was when Adora suggested that her parents try a new brunch place while they stayed home and cleaned the house. She even suggested they take her car and explore the city, but that lasted all of five minutes, as Hope had managed to hit the garbage can, spreading trash all over the street. Adora had barely even undone Catra's pants when her parents unlocked the door and informed them of the accident. Adora wasn't even mad about the car, garbage can, or the trash all over the street. But, what she was angry about, was the universe's refusal to let her fuck her girlfriend. But, now they had their chance. Well, they hoped.

"Deal." Adora quickly got up and moved between Catra's legs, trying as hard as she could not to make a sound. That was a challenging task because they had hardwood floors, and sometimes they creaked when they were stepped on. "I'll go slow."

Adora slid off Catra's underwear and moved her legs apart, taking a few moments to enjoy the view in front of her. She kissed her way up Catra's thighs as she gently teased Catra with the back of her fingers.

Catra focused on her breathing and remaining as quiet as possible. Her hips moved with Adora's light touch; she only wished she could feel all of Adora at this moment. She had craved her girlfriend's touch for days.

Parting Catra's folds, Adora gently licked up her slit. She was wetter than Adora had expected her to be; maybe Catra had been as desperate as she was. Making tight, slow strokes on Catra's clit, she felt her partner's hand on the back of her head. She watched Catra move her head back as Adora gave her the gentle pressure she needed.

"Just like that," Catra whispered. Adora's tongue knew precisely how to please her, and with how long it had been since she last came, it wouldn't be long. She watched as Adora's eyebrows furrowed with each stroke; it was apparent she was trying to hold back her own moans. The soft-touch was teasing and incredibly arousing. It almost felt better than the long, quick strokes she usually liked.

It was hard not to use her fingers on Catra; Adora knew how much she loved it and how quickly she would come. But, at this point, it wouldn't be needed; Catra's hips were moving quicker than before, so Adora increased her speed, and just as she did, she heard Catra gasp.

Catra softly moaned. She grabbed the sheets as she breathed heavily and gently rolled into her orgasm. Finally, the feeling was much more intense than her previous orgasms. The build-up and edging for the last several days had strengthened her release. "Adora…"

Letting Catra come down gently, she kissed her center before moving to lay on her chest.

"Damn, I didn't know how much I needed that." Catra tried to keep her voice low. "Can I…?" She lifted Adora's chin.

"Please. Same rules." She laid back before sliding her underwear off and watched Catra make her way down her body.

Catra wasted no time finding Adora's clit. Her tongue made long slow strokes. She made sure to listen for the sounds Adora was making and adjusted her speed and pressure accordingly. A few times, it seemed like Adora forgot their situation and moaned a bit too loud. Catra pulled back, allowing Adora to calm down and remember the need for silence. Finally, it came to the point that Catra had to remind her to keep quiet verbally. After that, Adora held a tight hand over her mouth.

Even with the reminder to be quiet, it didn't take Adora long before she tightened her grip on Catra's head, tensed, and relaxed breathlessly into the bed.

"Oh, that felt so good." she breathed.

Catra kissed the spent woman and nuzzled into her neck. "So, I guess we found out that we can be quiet if we need to," she snickered.

Adora laughed softly, "I guess you're right. But I do really like hearing you moan and beg me to fuck you."

Catra's eyes shot fully open, and her cheeks warmed. "Adora!" she whispered.

"What, baby? I just really love it." She smiled and pulled Catra closer.

"You're the worst."

"Or the best - just depends on how you look at it."

"You need to stop before all this goes to your head." Catra jumped on top of Adora, tickling her.

Adora tried not to laugh out loud, but it was getting hard. "We have to be quiet!"

"Okay, okay." Catra laid her ear on Adora's heart. The sound she loved almost more than Adora's voice. If she was ever in a situation where she had to choose Adora's heartbeat apart from other people's, there was no way she would lose. She couldn't even recall how many times they had laid just like this when they were growing up, just finding comfort in each other's arms after a long, troubling day. Or when they had returned from an adventure. Just being with each other was enough; they didn't

need anything else. "Why don't we go get breakfast, just the two of us?"

"Right now?"

"Yes?"

"That sounds really good." She kissed Catra's chest. "Race ya!"

Before Catra could respond, Adora had already slipped out from under her.

Don’t forget your cap!

Chapter Summary

It's time for Adora's graduation.

Chapter Notes

OMG I feel so bad that this is being posted a few hours late. I mean, I guess it's okay lol. I normally post before I go hiking, but I ran out of time this morning. You gotta get to the good spots way early where I live, or it's a nightmare. My last semester of grad school starts tomorrow! I also, start my new job in a week, so that will be an adventure! I can't wait to be done with school, then I can have more stories in the works! (I usually work on one story at a time and write it until completion. I also switch between Korrasami/Cartadora so the next is a Korrasami)

Also, don't drive and do sex. Eyes on the road. Stay safe y'all.

Thank you so much for all your support! I was really nervous about posting this story and it makes me so happy to see that people are enjoying it. I am loving this hobby and CANNOT WAIT to share the next story with y'all!! Hit me up on twitter @omoshiroimidori **@omoshiroimidori**
and tumblr **@FriendshipSnakes**

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Adora!" Catra picked up the boy shorts as she tried to put the packing harness on so Adora could help her adjust it. "You can't keep touching me like that if you want to get to the venue on time."

With a huff, Adora folded her arms. "I just want to touch you a little bit."

"I know, baby, but we have to get there so you can get lined up. I'm sure your parents are already waiting for us." Catra leaned down and kissed a pouty Adora. "Don't worry; I'll be fucking you soon enough."

Adora's eyebrow raised; she liked the sound of that. "Well, okay." In all honesty, she didn't want to go to the graduation ceremony. It was going to be an all-day event, and it seemed overwhelming. She would just be waiting there most of the time, anyway, so why did they even have to be on time? *Ugh* . But, Catra was right. They needed to get ready and get going soon. She sat there as Catra fussed with the harness, making sure to tuck the member in the fabric before she asked Adora how it looked. "Well?"

"Hot. It looks hot...I want to fuck you." Adora mumbled as she rubbed the bulge before her, appearing to be mesmerized by the sight.

Catra enjoyed the sensation for a few moments before pulling away. "Good. Now, let's see how it looks in these slacks." Grabbing the garment from the hanger, she checked for cat hair before slipping them on. As much as they tried, all of their clothes were constantly covered in a thin layer of Finn's hair.

After slipping on the burgundy bottoms, she fastened them and turned to Adora. "Can you tell it's there?"

Adora stared at the front of the pants and moved her head from side to side, trying to see different angles. "Okay, turn a little this way."

She looked and ran her hand over the front of the slacks. "Okay, the other way." It didn't show at either angle. "Try to sit down. See how comfortable it is, and let's see if it pops out."

Catra sat on the bed with her legs spread. "It feels fine; like, I can obviously tell it's there, but it's not bothersome."

"Yeah, it looks fine. Try and put your legs together."

Catra closed her legs, then, after a minute crossed her legs. "Yeah, it's pretty comfortable, and it doesn't look different to me."

"Yeah, it is surprisingly hidden." Adora rubbed her chin. "Okay, how do you feel about wearing it today?"

"I feel good. Even if we don't do anything with it, it'll be good practice for later." Catra stood up and kissed Adora. But, not a small little peck; she gave Adora what she had wanted all morning. Then, hearing a small moan from Adora, she broke the kiss. "Okay, let's finish getting ready."

*

They stood in front of the full-length mirror, double-checking their suits. Adora had a simple black and white number on, and Catra had a more elaborate burgundy suit with a few ruffles in the front. They had picked out their outfits separate from each other on purpose to see what the other one would choose. Catra was not surprised that Adora chose a basic suit. It was probably more to get a rise out of her parents than anything, and Catra was living for it. It would be a complete and utter lie if she said she didn't enjoy Adora's parents being shocked by her new bolder and confident demeanor. The feeling she got just watching Adora stand up to her parents was thrilling and almost empowering for her. She felt proud of Adora for all that she had gained in the last year.

Adora pulled the front of her suit jacket together and did a button-up. "I think I like it open. What do you think?"

"Honestly, your gown is going to cover it anyway. But, your parents may want a few of the buttons done up for pictures. You look really cute," Catra said as she adjusted Adora's black tie and kissed her cheek. "Are you going to put braids in your hair? I just need to slick my hair back before we head out."

"Yeah, I don't think it'll take too long. Want to help me?"

Catra sighed a happy sigh as she looked at her girlfriend. Adora smiled in her cute, dumb way that always melted Catra's heart. She had never been so in love with this woman as she was at this moment. These simple interactions they had made their relationship so satisfying. Things just clicked. The minor

disagreements they had had, were easily solved with a bit of time and communication. Catra had finally accepted that she not only deserved Adora but knew that they were *partners* in every sense of the word.

"Of course 'Dor." She looked at Adora as she opened their bedroom door and bounced away to the bathroom. *God, I love her.*

Adora did the honors of slicking Catra's hair back as she stood staring at her in the mirror. The last time they were in this situation, the tension in the room could be cut with a knife. But, now, there was a lightness and clarity that was more than appreciated. After Adora had finished Catra's hair, Catra turned around to help braid Adora's very long hair. She had been letting it grow out, primarily due to the new sense of independence she felt, but either way, it was now almost to the small of her back.

Before she started braiding, she pulled Adora's hips into hers and tucked a few strands of hair behind her ear. "Adora? I'm thankful to have you in my life. I love you more than you'll ever know."

"Catra…" Adora looked at her girlfriend, who had been such an impactful part of the vast majority of her life. "I love you so much. I'm so glad to have you." She pulled their foreheads together.

Footsteps pounded down the hallway, but it didn't interrupt either woman as they stood there in each other's embrace.

"Oh, there you are. We need to leave if we want to get there in time," Hope stated.

"Yeah, okay. We are almost done. Catra is gonna help me braid my hair," Adora replied without breaking their embrace. When her mother finally walked away, Adora quietly laughed, kissed Catra, and whispered, "I can feel you through your pants."

Catra's eyes widened. She had all but forgotten she was packing. Then, clearing her throat and bringing her attention to Adora's hair, she brought her lips to Adora's ear. "And I can't wait to fuck you."

After having to circle back home to retrieve Adora's cap she had forgotten, Catra and Adora finally made it to the graduation venue. Due to hundreds of graduates from dozens of colleges, each graduate had to line up according to their major. Adora's group was located in the lower level of the arena. Catra walked her to her area as they talked about the details of dinner after the ceremony.

It was just a joyous day for them. Not only was Adora graduating, but she was also finally free. Her life was entirely in her control, and it felt wonderful. She felt an elation that could not be compared to anything she had experienced. Holding Catra's hand as they walked down the ramp to her hallway was a moment she would remember. Her partner was by her side, and a difficult chapter in her life was coming to an end.

"Hey, Catra? Can we stop and go to the bathroom first? I feel like I'll be waiting for a while and don't want to have to fight to find the bathroom."

"Oh, of course. Didn't we just pass one a second ago?"

"Let's go look."

The two women turned around to look for the bathroom they thought they passed. Finally, after a bit of walking, they found the hidden room. Adora had her cap and gown on as they walked into the restroom.

"Ugh, now I have to take this off to pee."

"Well, wait, we may be able just to scrunch it up. I'll hold your cap."

Adora handed Catra her cap before fussing with the gown. Even though it was a light piece of fabric that shouldn't have been as much work, she gave up and took it entirely off and draped it over the sink. "Okay, well, this works." She started to undo her pants while looking at Catra. Their eyes locked, and the fire that had been building all morning was ignited.

Catra didn't want to turn away. However, there was something different about the way Adora was undressing. She was starting to think that Adora didn't have to pee after all. Adora unzipped her pants and pulled the front down a bit, almost like she was showing Catra. *Wow.* Catra watched as Adora walked toward her and placed a soft kiss on her lips. "I can't wait for you to fuck me." She ran her hand over Catra's crotch, which immediately made Catra straighten up.

"But, Adora...you need to line up," she said as she rolled her hips into Adora's hand. A soft moan escaped her mouth.

"You feel so good, Catra. Do you want to fuck me?" Adora was almost thrown back by her own confidence. However, she was more than ready to feel Catra inside her. They were alone, and no one would be looking for them for a few minutes. She had never seen this bathroom during the rehearsal and doubted that anyone else had either.

Catra nodded as Adora applied more pressure to the packer. *God.* The way Adora was pushing on her felt so good. She was more than just a little excited to pump into Adora.

Adora moved Catra's hand into her pants, allowing Catra to feel how wet she was. "I want you, Catra," she breathed.

Catra's eyes widened. Adora was very wet, and she couldn't help but gently glide her fingers through Adora's slick. "Adora…"

She moved her hips into Catra's hand as she leaned in to kiss her. It started passionately and intensified as she became more emboldened. "Please, Catra." She undid Catra's pants and started to work the strap out of its hiding place.

"Turn around," Catra said as she took her hand out of Adora's pants.

Adora placed her hands on the sink, looked forward, watching Catra in the mirror, and waited.

KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK

"Fuck." Catra's face snapped toward the door.

"Ugh."

"One second!" Catra resheathed the strap and fixed her pants, making sure to tuck her shirt back in.

Adora huffed over to the toilet. "Well, I better pee while I'm here."

Catra went to the sink and straightened up the gown before holding it up for Adora to slip her head in after she washed her

hands. She made sure her cap fit on her head before kissing her cheek. "You look so cute."

Adora blushed. "Thank you."

She grabbed Adora's hand and looked up. "Are you ready?"

They quickly left the bathroom and headed to Adora's meeting spot.

"Okay, this is my stop. Are you going to go sit with my parents?" Adora tried not to laugh at their little adventure and pretend to be normal.

"I am. You'll hear me when you walk. I'm gonna scream so loud, baby. I am so proud of you." Catra smiled.

"I love you, Catra. Thank you for being you." Adora kissed Catra softly and placed their foreheads together. She never wanted this moment to end. It was perfect. There was so much to be happy about.

"I love you."

*

Naturally, Catra grabbed a soft pretzel on her way to meet Mara and Hope. They had waited at their gate while Catra escorted Adora to her waiting area. It was probably the anxiety, but she was famished and could not wait until dinner to eat something. It took her all of five seconds to decide on a cinnamon sugar pretzel before she meandered to Adora's parents. It was the first time that she was, indeed, going to be alone with them. She could not wait for Bow and Glimmer to arrive.

"I see you're spoiling your dinner, Catra?" Hope fussed.

"I was too excited to grab a snack before we left the house," Catra said before walking through their gate. She quickly found their seats and waited for Mara and Hope to follow. This was going to be a long few hours if Hope was going to pester her over menial matters. Catra sighed.

After Adora's parents sat down, Catra pulled out her phone to see where Glimmer and Bow were. The last of the previous college graduates had walked, and they were cleaning and organizing the area again before the College of Social Sciences began.

Catra [4:35 pm]: *where are you? I'm alone with Adora's parents*

Glimmer [4:36 pm]: *Those are your future mothers-in-law. You better learn to get along.*

Catra [4:37 pm]: *yeah like they would let me marry Adora*

Bow [4:37 pm]: *YOU ASKED ADORA TO MARRY YOU?*

Scorpia [4:37 pm]: *WIldcat, you're getting married?*

Catra [4:38 pm]: *bow! no sparkles is just psychic*

Catra [4:38 pm]: *are you all together?*

Glimmer [4:38 pm]: *Duh.*

Catra [4:39 pm]: *just hurry*

Before she put her phone away, she quickly texted Adora.

Catra [4:41 pm]: *You're gonna do great. I love you.*

She took another bite of her pretzel before updating Mara and Hope on Glimmer and the gang's location.

Hope didn't acknowledge what Catra had said but replied with an unwanted fact. "I saw your mother at the store the other day. She looks like she's seen better days. How old is she now? I didn't think she was as old as she looks."

"I don't know. We haven't talked for years."

"Oh." Mara looked at Hope with a look of foreboding. "She didn't seem to notice us until we walked up to her."

"I'm not surprised. She rejected me after I came out to her. I'm sure she blamed Adora." She tried to shove more of the never-ending pretzel in her mouth, to give her something else to focus on. But, in all honesty, she had no idea how to interact with Adora's parents. She tried to start a few conversations over the last few days, but it had just been weird, and things felt incredibly awkward now.

"I knew she wasn't the most loving of parents, but I didn't kno-"

Catra interrupted Mara, "There is a lot that you didn't know. Going to your house was one of the only safe places I had to go, and the way you two treated me was terrible. I thought you knew what was happening at my house for the longest time and just didn't care. I just don't know how someone could treat a child like that after knowing what they were dealing with." Catra took out her phone and looked at the picture of her and Adora, trying to distract. This conversation was becoming increasingly uncomfortable. She wished she was anywhere but where she was at that moment.

"We... didn't know," Hope added.

Hearing that they didn't know was almost more painful. How could someone not notice the scrawny, dirty, clingy kid who would flinch when anyone came near her, who was also best friends with their daughter? Adora's home was one of the only places Catra could escape to, and it was still filled with almost as much rejection. "It seems like there was a lot you didn't know."

As hard as Catra was trying to self-soothe, she was getting upset. It was hard to talk to the two women who had treated her almost as poorly as her mother. But, a conversation was needed. It had to be addressed to have any sort of relationship between Mara, Hope, and Catra. "Everywhere I went, I was rejected. I had to fight for love and care. But, with Adora, I never had to. She just loved me. She never rejected me. She never batted an eye when I came out. She was just supportive. She always was."

The reality of their actions seemed to have started to sink in. The older women were silent for several moments.

"From what I've seen this week, you are a loving and caring partner to my daughter. I can tell you two really love each other." Mara spoke lightly.

"That's really good to hear because I love her more than anyone. She's a wonderful person, and I am lucky to have her in my life." Catra popped the last piece of her pretzel in her mouth.

"Catra! We finally found you. Has it started yet?" Glimmer blurted out from the aisle.

Catra was not expecting to hear Glimmer's loud voice at that moment. But, boy, was she as glad as ever to hear that slightly shrill voice. Glimmer took after her mother in more ways than one. Catra slightly choked on her food, coughed, then sat up in her chair. "Hey, Sparkles."

"What have we missed?" Glimmer yelled as she slid her way through the chairs to Catra.

"Nothing yet; they are still setting up. But, it looks like they are going to bring everyone in in just a minute."

Glimmer sat down and hugged Catra, whispering in her ear. "How are things with her parents?"

Catra just frowned without saying a word.

Trying to give her most comforting expression, Glimmer rubbed Catra's shoulder and mouthed. "I'm sorry." Then, she leaned over to greet Mara and Hope, who waved and smiled.

*

As Adora's name was called and she walked across the stage, the squad all screamed and yelled, Scorpia being the apparent winner. Who knew she could be so loud and powerful? Everyone. Everyone knew. Catra tried her damnedest to take a video of Adora walking, but they were so far away because the arena was sectioned off. Still, regardless of the quality of the video, it was a memory she would not soon forget. Adora wasn't just graduating college; she was stepping into the next chapter of her life.

Catra had been with Adora through many stages and chapters in her life, but this one seemed to be the biggest. So many things were coming to an end and starting anew that it was unmatched to other things they had experienced. As difficult as it was to get along with Adora's parents, she was glad they were here; they had mostly accepted Catra and Adora's relationship and had been as supportive as they could be in the last week.

They had a long way to go to get to the point of being a happy family, but even if that didn't happen, the future felt bright. Catra was aware that to get to a place where her relationship with Adora's parents was positive, they would need to iron out their history. And that means talking about the hard parts. She felt a sense of relief for being honest with the older women about how their lack of care had affected her. She was unsure it would change anything, but it had to be said.

Adora walked toward the seats and waved up to the group, and Catra knew it was time to meet her outside. "Let's go find Adora."

The group got up and slowly made their way out to the concourse. They waited at the entrance, looking for Adora. After a few minutes, Catra pulled out her phone and texted Adora.

Catra [5:23 pm]: *hey babe we are waiting by the entrance*

After she sent the text, she shared her location.

Glimmer was making small talk with Adora's parents while Catra was looking out for Adora. She could hear Mara talking about how cute Glimmer was as a kid and all the weird things she would do. Glimmer denied she ever did anything so unpolished. Catra couldn't help but smile; she had seen Glimmer passed out in a number of unusual places after a night of wild drinking. But, Glimmer liked to appear like she was always put together.

For a moment, Catra's heart sank. It seemed like everyone but her had a good relationship with Mara and Hope. A part of her wanted to run and give up, believing that it was a waste of time to try and win the women over, and eventually, they would push her and Adora apart. But thank god for the part of her that had been in therapy for years and had learned that uncomfortable feelings happen sometimes. They suck, and sitting with them before taking action was the better option.

She loved Adora more than anything. The years they had been best friends had been the best part of her life. There was no certain way she had to look or speak for Adora to care for her. Their connection was real, and Catra was dedicated to making it

work. She sighed, even if that means having to put in the effort to repair her relationship with Mara and Hope.

There was no doubt in her mind that Adora was behind her one hundred percent. She had already stood up for Catra in every interaction they had had and even countered any untrue thing her parents had said about her. Adora was just as committed to changing the relationship with her parents as Catra was.

Catra felt the familiar feeling of Adora's arms around her waist. She felt the warm air of Adora's voice in her ear. "Hey, honey." Turning around, Catra kissed Adora.

"Scorpia was so loud! I could barely hear anyone else." Adora laughed.

Catra cupped Adora's face. "We were just so excited for you. We're proud, baby."

Adora placed their foreheads together. "I love you."

Glimmer walked up to the wildly in love couple, "Okaaayyyy. Keep it for the bedroom. Are we going to head over to the restaurant soon? I think Scorpia got a table reserved for us. We have a big one for eight people. Will that be enough?"

Adora kissed Catra before turning to Glimmer. "That sounds perfect. Catra and I are gonna go home and change out of these suits. With how she eats pasta, both our outfits will be ruined by the end the night."

"Hey!" Catra pushed off Adora's cap and laughed.

Adora immediately picked up her cap and put it on Catra's head, and snorted as the cap flattened out her ears. She snorted while Catra pouted her lips out before laughing.

Mara raised her hand to get everyone's attention. "Everyone, can we get together for a few pictures?"

Scorpia and Perfuma almost jumped up and down at the request. But then, everyone started to line up, and Catra just stood there, knowing that when Mara said 'everyone,' she really meant everyone *but* Catra.

Adora looked at Catra and waved her over. Catra just frowned.

Hope walked over to Catra and placed her hand on her shoulder. "Go stand next to Adora." She smiled.

Catra looked up at Hope as she crossed her arm over her torso. This was probably the first time that the smile on Hope's face was genuine. It may have also been the first time that Catra had ever

seen a smile like that. Hope meant what she was saying. It wasn't a trick or just to please Adora. Catra stood there in disbelief, looking up at Hope.

"Catra, you're family. Please stand next to your partner."

"Okay." She walked over to Adora, who immediately pulled her in for a hug, then the rest of the friends hugged Catra. As soon as the cuddle puddle started, there was a flash of light, and Mara laughed. Adora turned to Catra and kissed her on the forehead. "I love you."

After several poses, pictures, and laughs, including family pictures with Hope, Mara, Adora, *and* Catra, the group dispersed to meet at the restaurant. Adora's parents were borrowing her car, so Adora and Catra didn't have to carpool, which was good for everyone. Adora let everyone know they were going to stop at home and change out of their formal wear. The group was meeting at Adora and Catra's *former* favorite restaurant a few blocks from their house, so it wasn't much of a trip.

They said their goodbyes and walked to their respective cars. As soon as Catra and Adora pulled out of the parking lot, Adora started rubbing Catra's thigh and whispering in her ear. "I can't wait to feel you inside me." She moved closer to Catra's core. "I want you to make me come." Then moved her fingers over Catra's center.

"Fuck," Catra breathed. She could not wait to get home. "Undo your pants. I want to feel you."

Adora quickly obeyed and pulled her pants down a bit to give Catra better access. She continued to rub Catra's thigh and move her hands over the bulge she was about to experience. As soon as she felt Catra's fingers part her folds, she moaned. "Catra…"

Focusing on the road, Catra made light vertical strokes, which invited Adora's moans and the roll of her hips. Dipping lower to her entrance, she made tight circles, truly feeling how wet Adora really was. "Wow." Adora was basically panting at this point; Catra wished she could watch Adora as she was brought closer and closer to spilling over the edge. The blonde woman was holding on the door handle so tightly, Catra thought it'd rip off.

"I'm close." Adora moaned and pushed the front of her pants even further down. At this point, she didn't care if anyone saw her. She needed Catra to touch her.

Catra removed her hand and brought it up to her nose. "Mmmm. I can't wait to taste you."

Adora whined and looked at Catra.

"We're almost home." She turned down their street.

As soon as the car was parked, Adora flew out of the car and ran to the front door. She checked her pockets but remembered her

parents had her keys. *Damnit.* Waiting for Catra was like watching water boil; she walked toward the car. "Catra, hurry!" she pleaded.

Catra smiled. She kind of loved Adora's new desperation and begging. It was a sight to behold - seeing Adora with her pants undone, craving for Catra's touch on their doorstep. She walked up to the doorstep, locked her car, and unlocked the door. "Lean over the back of the couch for me." Catra walked past Adora as she positioned herself on the couch. Even though Adora was very wet, she wasn't gonna take any chances of hurting her. She walked back to the front room with the bottle of lube and a towel. "Oh...wow."

Adora had kneeled on the cushions of the couch and leaned over the back. Her slacks and underwear were around her knees, and her ass was in the air waiting for Catra. The suit jacket she was wearing was draped over the side neatly. "Please, Catra."

Catra quickly took the strap from its hiding place, took off her jacket, and placed it on top of Adora's before unbuttoning her shirt and letting it hang open. Then, placing her hand on Adora's hip, she covered the toy in lube before wiping her hands and docking the tip at Adora's opening. "Are you ready?"

"Mmmhmm." Adora pushed her ass out a bit more, looking back to watch Catra.

Catra pushed her hips slowly into Adora, moving out slightly before going deeper on the next push. She held onto Adora's hips

to brace herself as she felt the strap move fully inside.

"Oh, fuck," Adora moaned.

"Tell me how bad you want to come." She slowly pulled out and reentered. Catra could feel the friction Adora's inner walls produced, which applied perfect pressure on her own sex.

Adora fisted the couch cushions as each slow thrust filled her. It felt better than any other time they had used the toy. She wanted to watch Catra fuck her, but the sensation was far too pleasurable to change positions anytime soon. "I need to come," she moaned and grabbed the couch tighter. "God, please let me come." She pushed back on each of Catra's thrusts.

"You feel so good." Catra's moans were matching those from Adora. The sight and sound of Adora begging Catra for release were hot. There was no room in her mind to describe it any differently; the woman in front of her begging and pushing her deeper was intoxicating. The pressure of the strap on her made the experience even more enjoyable. With each thrust, her folds rubbed against her clit and brought the promise of a peak ever closer.

Catra increased her speed, and Adora cried out and begged Catra for more. At this point, the two women were moaning in tandem as each thrust brought them both closer. Catra couldn't wait any longer; she grabbed onto Adora's hips and let herself go. "Adora, I'm gonna come. Oh, god, I'm gonna come."

"Harder!"

Catra gave it her all as her orgasm ripped through her. Her moans filled the open room as Adora's soon followed. Their joint orgasm was powerful. Catra could feel Adora's walls tightening around the strap as her subsequent thrusts were met with resistance. Her hips slowed as both women came down and were increasingly sensitive.

"Oh...fuck…" Adora panted.

"Baby…" Catra breathed. "I'm gonna pull out, okay?"

"Mnmm," Adora said as she collapsed onto the couch, not bothering to fix her pants. "Lay next to me for a minute," she mumbled.

Catra wrapped her arms around Adora after she laid down. "How did that feel, baby?" she breathed.

"So, good. I didn't even think I could come that way." She nuzzled into Catra's neck.

"That was so hot. I could feel when you came"

"You technically came inside me," Adora said before she sat up to kiss Catra.

Catra immediately blushed and covered her face.

"What, baby? It was really hot." She kissed Catra again. "I like making you come."

Catra peeked out from behind her hands. "It felt real-"

The easily recognizable sound of Adora's ringtone vibrated throughout the couch. "Oh shit."

They both got up, looking for the phone, knowing full well it was probably Glimmer calling to yell at them. Finally, after untangling the device from Adora's slacks, she answered. "Hello?"

"Hey, we all just barely got here, and our table won't be ready for another 20 minutes. Where are you?"

"Oh, that's a long time. Well, we will be there in about five minutes. I just have to pee really fast; then we'll walk over. Are my parents there too?"

"Oh yeah, they were the first to arrive. Hope has already had words with the host about the table not being ready."

"Oh no. Okay, we'll see you in a few minutes."

Adora turned to Catra. "Okay, we cut that close." She laughed before kissing Catra one last time. "I love you."

"I love you too." Catra shot up and started running toward their room. "Race ya!"

"What!? That's not fair. My clothes are all…"

*

Catra and Adora walked through the door to the restaurant ten minutes later and saw that their group had just been seated. They quickly joined them with a series of hugs. Glimmer gave them *the look* , knowing full well they went home and had sex. Little did she know that they had barely survived the handful of days Adora's parents had been there, and they needed the release. Glimmer would probably give them crap for it when Mara and Hope weren't sitting next to her. And, with the experience they just had, it was well worth the teasing.

Many gift bags and wrapped gifts sat on the table as an assortment of pizzas and plates of pasta were placed in front of

the group. Catra had ordered her favorite, Alfredo, and Adora had gotten traditional marinara; that way, they could share and probably end up feeding each other. If it wasn't clear by now, they were incredibly gay and mainly for each other. They both smiled and looked at the group of loved ones surrounding them.

For the first time in both of their lives, things were going their way.

Chapter End Notes

hehehe Did any one catch the Easter eggs in the story? There are a handful. I would love to hear which ones y'all found. Comment below!! I think the next Catradora story will have more Easter eggs. So look out for that!!

I also forgot that this story was kinda inspired by the song "Soma Coma" By Apoptygma Berzerk. I listened to this song on repeat while I was writing most of this lol.

The story is over, so now what?

First, I would love to hear what you thought about it in it's entirety. What were your favorite parts? (Comments give me life) I will post that Catradora one-shot next week. The edits are being finished up. Then, I will start posting a Space/Sci-fi Korrasami story! I'm jazzed about that. So, if you like Korrasami, check it out!

Thank you all for being so accepting, inviting, and wonderful! Until next time~

Hit me up on twitter @omoshiroimidori **@omoshiroimidori** and tumblr **@FriendshipSnakes**

Do we really have to visit them?

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra take a vaction and visit Adora's parents. (Bonus chapter!!)

Chapter Notes

Okay, I am obsessed with bonus chapters lately lol. I feel like I can let loose a bit and try new things. I hope you like this little treat! Also, it is 100% smut.

CW//

a little anxiety related to flying on planes.

Hit me up on twitter! i post updates on stories like posting delays, bonus chapters, and one-shots. Recently I have been doing polls for folks to choose the next story/theme. (That has been kind of fun, maybe I should let folks choose a few tags for short stories too. HMMM WHAT A COOL IDEA hahah okay anyway) **@omoshiroimidori**

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Ugggghhh. Do we really have to go visit your parents for the holiday?" Catra was literally throwing a fit lying next to Adora in bed. She hadn't even gotten under the covers before Adora broke the news. Falling asleep was off the table because she'd be too irritated to pass out.

"I know. It's not my first choice, but it will be nice to get away. It's free food and lodging, *and* we can check out all the cool things by their house." Adora stood next to the bed, removing her pants. "We need a break, Catra."

"How long do they want us there? It's going to take me a while to find coverage for the store." Catra crawled under the blanket, not wanting to even think about trying to get all of her shifts covered. She needed to hire another part-time person anyway, but the training alone would be time-consuming. On the other hand, the holiday was only a month away, and that gave her the bare minimum time needed to get a new employee up to speed.

"A week." She took out her hair tie and set it on the nightstand. "Didn't Mermista talk about wanting a part-time job in the last book club meeting?" She ran a brush through her hair.

Catra's cheeks warmed, and she scoffed. "Adora."

"Come on, baby. It'll be fun."

"Do we have to fly? You know how I feel about flying." Catra folded her arms. As much as she wanted to avoid any interaction with Adora's parents, a free getaway did sound nice. And things with Adora's parents weren't *bad*. Hope had even called Catra a few times to get books special ordered.

"How about this…" Adora straddled Catra. "Why don't we…" She kissed down Catra's neck. "Drive and leave a few days early…" She lifted Catra's shirt and kissed around her breasts. "And check out a few sights." She sat up. "We could even stop at that diner you like. It could be a fun adventure."

Catra was a little bit hot and bothered at this point and didn't care about making plans any longer. She knew that she would go regardless of how much of a fight she pretended to put up. "Yeah, that's fine. Now, kiss me."

Adora leaned in and ever so gently kissed Catra. "I'll make it worth your while."

"Oh, will you?"

With a smirk, Adora hooked her fingers in Catra's waistband and pulled. Catra lifted her butt and relaxed her legs after her underwear was off. Adora kissed up Catra's chest, stopping only to give her taut nipples some much-needed attention. "You can't come until I say."

A soft moan escaped Catra's lips. Adora was on a mission, and there was nothing she could do to alter her plans. But she could sit back and enjoy them. "Will you let me come?" Catra's voice sounded a little concerned. Adora had found a new liking of orgasm denial and edging. It's not that Catra hated it; it was just that it turned her on so profoundly it was hard not to come. One of the first few times they had tried it, Catra came without Adora touching her. She was just so worked up that one roll of her hips was all she needed.

Adora kissed Catra, moving her hips between her thighs, and grinding into her. "That depends on how well you listen." There

was no doubt in Adora's mind that Catra was utterly soaked at that point. Even the mention of denial made Catra whimper.

The delicious pressure on her center was enough to make Catra agree to anything Adora wanted. She held Adora's hips, pulling them into her. Adora knew how to please her and when she took charge, it drove Catra wild. "Adora…"

"Do you want me to touch you?"

Catra nodded.

"Tell me."

A deep blush penetrated Catra's cheeks. She had no idea what Adora had in store. Adora had been extra experimental in the last few months, and Catra had been surprised by a few of Adora's requests. There were obviously some things that Catra didn't know about her. Catra softly spoke. "I want you to fuck me."

Adora kissed Catra's neck, "I can't hear you."

Catra repeated herself much louder and closed her eyes in anticipation of Adora's response. She could feel Adora's grin.

"Such a good girl." Adora moved her hips away from Catra's center and kissed her way down her chest, taking her time to kiss and lick her nipples. Catra immediately responded with a slight arch of her back. Adora could tell she was holding back. She was trying not to show Adora how aroused she really was. Adora accepted the challenge.

Dragging her palm across Catra's inner thighs as her mouth distracted her, she inched closer to Catra's warm core. The control Catra was trying to maintain was slowly dissipating; it wouldn't be long before she begged for more contact.

Catra moaned as Adora's tongue circled the sensitive nub, her claws digging into the sheets. She couldn't wait for what Adora had in mind, she knew she would be frustrated, but it would be more than worth it. Her hips rocked, trying to increase the pressure from Adora's lingering hand.

Adora was genuinely surprised that Catra hadn't started begging for her yet. Catra's underwear had already given her away. But she couldn't wait any longer; she wanted to taste her. Removing her mouth from Catra's chest elicited a whimper. Then, on her way to the apex of Catra's legs, she ran her nails down her sides, being rewarded with another moan.

Finally reaching Catra's center, Adora pushed her thighs apart. As Catra lay open, Adora admired her glistening folds. The position left nothing to the imagination. Adora could almost taste her.

"A…" Catra stopped herself before begging. She knew it would draw out the experience longer, and she was already desperate to come.

Adora pressed her lips to Catra's folds. Feeling the heat radiating off her center. "You smell good."

Catra moaned and rolled her hips.

"If you get close, tell me." Adora delicately flicked her tongue over Catra's clit.

Another louder moan escaped. Catra felt high. The focused, gentle strokes of Adora's tongue were teasing in the most delicious way. Her brain just couldn't keep up. But, Adora's motions stayed at a slow, delicate pace. It wasn't fair. Adora could bring her to the edge quickly, but she chose to draw it out. Patience was not Catra's forte.

"You taste so good, baby." Adora drew long, slow strokes across Catra's clit. As much as she wanted to hear Catra's cries, she wanted to give Catra the most powerful orgasm she's ever had.

"Please, Adora." Catra whimpered. She threw herself back on the bed, covering her eyes with her palms.

Adora kept her slow pace. Catra continued to beg quietly. Her body became increasingly tense with each pass of Adora's tongue.

Catra could feel her orgasm build, and it was going to be intense. It felt like every cell in her body was stimulated. The desperation and need were growing as quickly as her impending release. Catra grabbed the back of Adora's head, pulling her closer. "I'm…"

Adora pulled back, not wanting Catra to come just yet. "Not yet, baby."

Catra groaned in frustration.

With a smile, Adora placed two fingers at Catra's entrance, lightly circling. "You're doing so good."

Unconsciously, Catra's tail briskly swished on the bed. She would never admit it to Adora, but she craved the praise. She always wanted to hear how good she was doing. She wanted to be rewarded. She needed it all.

Adora placed her tongue back on Catra's sensitive nub and gradually slid her fingers inside.

"Adora!" Catra grabbed the sheets, barely able to breathe, her muscles tense, as the slow-moving fingers curled inside her." It's

not fair," she panted.

Keeping the slow pace, Adora watched as Catra came undone. It wouldn't be long before Carta exploded. Even with her painfully slow strokes, Catra's walls were tightening around Adora's fingers. "Don't come."

Catra's head snapped toward Adora. "I… it's…so hard…please…" her moans became guttural, primal.

"Control it. Don't come."

She tried to clench her muscles and focus on something else, but it was hard to deny how good Adora felt. Her body was going to come with or without Adora's say. "I'm trying." She moaned. "You feel so good."

"Good girl."

The soft strokes kept Catra on edge. An edge she desperately wanted to spill over. "Oh my god. I can't…I can't…"

Adora felt Catra reach her peak. The silent scream from Catra's mouth was enough to tell Adora how intense her orgasm was. She could barely move her fingers as Catra's grip was unrelenting. When Catra did finally come down, her face was red, and she hadn't taken a breath since it began. Adora shot up, worried that

she had killed her partner. "Catra!? Breath! Are you okay? I'm sorry…I just…"

Catra breathed out and inhaled quickly, trying to catch her breath. She didn't even register Adora's panic playing out next to her. She had just had the most powerful orgasm in her life, and nothing else mattered. Her body felt the most relaxed than she had ever felt. She felt free.

Adora took in Catra, lazily recovering from an orgasm that almost took her out of the world. "Are you okay?"

Catra laughed as best she could for having a liquid body. "Of course, silly. Holy shit."

Adora kissed Catra's temple.

"I don't know how you came up with that, but we should do it again."

There was never a moment in her life where she felt as proud. She had just blown Catra's mind. Catra lay motionlessly for several moments before leisurely propping herself up. "Your turn."

—---

"What!? Why isn't it working? I thought you had the app!"

"Catra, please just hold on." Adora tried to reload the airline app. "It's just not connected to the WiFi."

Catra's tail was swinging wildly behind her, her breathing was fast, and her hands were sweating. "I hate flying. This happens every time." She bared her teeth at the phone. "I don't want to go anymore; let's just go home." She folded her arms. Tears welled in her eyes.

Adora turned to Catra and held her shoulders. "Honey, everything is going to be okay. It loaded, and now I can scan our passes. Did you bring your medicine?"

Catra pouted her lips. "Yes."

"Have you taken any of it?"

"No, I-"

"It might help you feel better." She rubbed Catra's arms. "I'll play with your ears and tail when we get through security." Adora kissed Catra's forehead.

With a huff, Catra reached into her pocket, taking out the bottle of anti-anxiety medication. She only ever needed it for travel on an airplane, but like usual, she held off taking them until she was at the point of panic. Then, putting one in her mouth, she took a swallow of her water.

She hated flying. She would rather walk a thousand miles than get on a damn plane. Unfortunately, their plans to drive were spoiled by the lack of coverage at the bookstore. She had hired Mermista after all, but it was a pain to get her trained. The last thing that she wanted to do was leave Netossa high and dry with a new employee and Catra gone. But, now they were going through security on their way to a week-long getaway at Adora's parent's house. *Yay…*

Adora popped their carry-on in the storage above their seats. She made sure to get Catra an aisle seat. It helped with her anxiety if she could see what was happening. Adora didn't much care where she sat, as long as she could fall asleep. Planes were boring to her. All she wanted was to be at her destination and doing what she needed to do.

This was probably a leftover symptom of undergrad. She didn't have much time to waste when completing assignments for four or more classes. It had only been a few months after she graduated, and she hadn't fully let herself relax. Instead of homework, she filled her time with deep cleaning and building projects. Their house now had more than enough shelves.

Catra was visibly anxious through take-off. Adora tried to distract her and play with her ears and tail, it helped a bit, but Catra couldn't relax. Her tail was puffed up, which added to her anxiety.

She wasn't one to allow others to see her in such a state. "Hey, they are gonna bring snacks soon."

Adora's comment didn't even register with Catra. She was focused on the flight staff down the aisle. Her tail was still a bit puffed out but was close to being calm. With ears pinned back, she drove her claws deeper into the armrest.

"Hey, honey?" Adora gently took Catra's hand.

Catra's head snapped toward Adora. "Huh?"

"Come cuddle me."

"Oh, okay." Catra's guard had dropped a little, and her tail relaxed.

"I love you." Adora nuzzled into Catra's neck.

"I uh love you too." She looked down the aisle again.

Adora huffed at Catra's lack of attention. She had no idea what had Catra so enthralled but knew it was probably an anxious need to know everything that was happening on the plane at that very moment. "Baby, what you lookin' at?"

Catra looked over at Adora, "Snacks." She looked back down the aisle.

"Are they coming?"

"No."

"Then why not come cuddle?"

Catra didn't avert her attention. Adora had tried almost everything she could think of to help Catra relax. They had a few more hours in the air, and it was going to be a very long trip with Catra so on edge. There was one thing that she knew would pull Catra out of her state. She took Catra's hand and moved it under the blanket keeping Adora warm. She set her hand innocently on her thigh before quietly undoing her pants. Taking Catra's hand, she placed it on her center. "Come cuddle, baby."

Adora officially had Catra's attention. Whatever she was looking at was unimportant; she had a new goal. Catra shifted her position and leaned closer into Adora. She moved her hand intentionally over Adora's folds. A slight smirk appeared on Adora's face as Catra focused on Adora.

"Much better." Adora laid her head back, looking into Catra's intense eyes. She felt the warmth build as Catra's hands delicately

traced her slit, knowing just how to touch to arouse her. The building slick was starting to make itself known as Adora gently rolled her hips.

Parting her lips, Catra drew her finger along the length of Adora's slit. Then, applying the lightest amount of pressure, she feathered Adora's clit. Catra looked down the aisle, ensuring that the staff was not on their way with any distractions.

A small gasp escaped Adora's mouth. She tried to spread her legs wider, but she was already wedged against the window and Catra. Her plan was backfiring; she couldn't stay silent with Catra's skilled fingers finding her spots perfectly. The distraction was working a little too well. She felt Catra's fingers at her entrance and looked at Catra with wide eyes. "I can't be quiet if you go inside." She whispered.

"Try." Catra's fingers slid inside. She could feel Adora's hand grip her thigh as fingers found their place.

Adora was having a difficult time regulating her breathing. She wanted to scream. "Catra…I can't…"

Catra removed her fingers as quickly, and they entered. "Come for me." She continued feathering Adora's sensitive nub, knowing that she would reach her peak soon.

With a grunt, Adora came, closing her eyes and arching her back. She wanted to scream but knew she couldn't. She held Catra's thigh until Catra pulled her fingers away.

"Drinks? Snacks?" An unfamiliar voice sounded next to them.

Catra answered the woman and moved their trays down in preparation for their treats.

After handing Catra their cups and cookies, the woman looked at Catra. "Is your friend okay?"

Catra looked at Adora, who was still attempting to regain control of her breathing, and replied, "Oh yeah, she always has bad dreams when she naps. She'll be fine with a snack. Thank you."

Nodding, she turned around to serve the following people.

Catra couldn't help but laugh. Adora looked at her with slight irritation in her expression. "I bet this is so funny to you." She kissed Catra and quietly spoke. "I almost blew our cover for a minute there."

With a smile, "That would have been hot." Catra took a sip of her soda. "Eat up; you must be famished."

Adora rolled her eyes. "Will you nap with me after this?"

"Mmhmm." A slight purr filled the space between them. "I love you."

—---

"Mom! We have only been here for twenty minutes. Please let us unpack and get settled." Adora yelled.

"Adora, do not raise your voice at your mother." Hope folded her arms.

Catra stood there awkwardly with her arms folded and her tail wrapped around her waist. It had been a while since she last saw Adora's parents, and it was already proving to be incredibly uncomfortable. "Hey, Adora? I can put our stuff away, and you can go with your mom."

"You don't want to come with us, Catra?" Mara frowned.

"Oh, um, no, I do want to come…I just…"

"Mom, can we have half an hour to ourselves, and then we can go to dinner?"

"Okay, honey. "Mara patted her hand on the bed before standing up and walking out of the room.

Adora looked over at Catra and closed the space between them. "Baby? You are part of this family. I don't go anywhere you don't go." She placed their foreheads together.

Catra forced her attention on Adora's hands in hers. "Okay." A soft purr warmed her chest. "I just…"

"You're always welcome. I love you."

She hugged Adora. It had been a very stressful day for her, and she was having a hard time regulating her emotions. A hot meal would do wonders for her state of mind.

Adora pulled back enough to look at Catra. "Do you remember this room?"

Catra looked around, recognizing the stuffed animals, terrible pale pink paint, outdated bed frame, and the shag carpet. "How could I forget? I can't believe they still haven't changed the carpet." She let her feet enjoy the softness of the long fibers. It was unsurprisingly in good condition. Hope knew how to maintain things.

Taking Catra's hand, Adora led her to the bed. "Do you remember when we used to have sleepovers?"

Catra sat down, feeling the familiar bedding. "How could I forget? The sleeping bag that your mom would set up for me always smelled weird and made weird sounds." Now that she was back in this spot, a rush of memories filled her mind. They snuck around Adora's parents to be close to each other and have small moments together. How either of them didn’t know the other was gay is a mystery of time.

"And when they would check on us before they went to bed, you would be tucked into the terrible sleeping bag on the floor. But, as soon as they left, you'd jump into bed with me."

Laughing, Catra finished the story. "And then in the morning, when they would find us in bed together, you'd tell them I had a bad dream!" They both bellowed with laughter. When they were younger, they didn't realize what their actions meant. It was always innocent fun.

"We used to sneak kisses and talk about getting married to each other one day."

"Yeah. Weren't we going to get married at the arcade because they had your favorite hot dogs?" Of course, Catra loved those hot dogs too. But, she would always deny it when Adora asked. But, they reminded her of Adora, and she couldn't help but love them.

"I think that arcade closed down, so we'll have to think of another place to get married." Adora laid down, with Catra following suit.

"Can you imagine that? Us getting married?" Catra asked inquisitively. She had never seriously thought of it after their childhood. There was never a chance that Adora wanted her the way she wanted Adora. But, here they were in a relationship with a house, a cat, and on vacation at Adora's parent's house. Life was strange in that way.

"I mean, I have thought about it. I like the idea of you being my wife." Adora's cheeks turned a bright red. "Don't you think about it?"

"I…" Catra thought very hard about what her following words were going to be. She would love to be Adora's wife. Nothing would make her happier. "I may have already picked out our outfits." She pulled her phone out of her pocket and opened an app. "See, I thought I could wear this, but then I didn't know what you'd feel more comfortable in, so I found a few ones I like."

Adora looked at all of the options on the phone and actually liked a few of the things that Catra picked out. "You really know me. I would wear most of these."

"I mean, we have been best friends for most of our lives." Catra laughed.

Adora took Catra's phone from her hand and set it behind her. "I'd like to marry you one day. I don't want to be with anyone but you. I love you so much, Catra."

Catra laid wide-eyed. Was this really happening? Was Adora asking what she thought she was asking? "Wait, are you…asking me to marry you?" The bright blue eyes looked back at Catra with enthusiasm. She didn't have to say yes. Adora *was* asking Catra to marry her.

"I mean, I'd like to propose to you first formally. But, yeah, I guess I am asking if you'd like to marry me."

It didn't seem like Adora had thoroughly thought this out, which was par for the course. It wasn't terrible to have conversations about marriage before a proposal, but further discussion were definitely required. "Yeah, I'll marry you."

Adora smiled and wrapped her hands around Catra. "I love you!"

Catra laughed. "I love you too, dummy."

Chapter End Notes

I did not plan this to end like this, but I'm here for it. What do you think?

End Notes

This story has easter eggs/secrets. If you can find at least one, I will write you a one-shot of your choosing. (of course, there may be some restrictions lol) No one has been able to figure them out thus far. But, if you can, a fic just for you awaits

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!